

DUNGEON
CRAWLER CARL
ROLEPLAYING GAME



GAME MASTER'S CAMPAIGN TOOLKIT



MOBS, BOSSES, AND RIVAL CRAWLERS

NAME	TYPE	PAGE
Aranaea Magnus	Neighborhood Boss	59
Bad Llama	Mob	51
Ball of Swine	Borough Boss	142
The Bar Render	Neighborhood Boss	37
Barflie	Mob	30
Beloved Mimic	City Boss	145
Blind Goblin Survivor	Mob	129
Brindle Grub	Janitor Mob	106, 139
Brindled Vespa	Janitor Mob	107, 140
Bruiser	Crawler	136
Bugaboo Goblin-napper	Mob	128
Bugaboo Socket-Picker	Mob	128
Canidna	Mob	31
Canis Knights	Mob	87
Cardium Clam	Neighborhood Boss	125
Chef BoyardOoze	Mob	62
Chilly Goat	Mob	40
Cocaine Kobold	Mob	96
Cow-Tailed Brindle Grub	Janitor Mob	106, 139
Critical Consensus	Neighborhood Boss	69
Danger Dingo	Mob	97
Danger Dingo	Mob	141
Dread Wizard Grimblegore	Neighborhood Boss	93
Dream Eaters	Mob	118
Fire-Fighter	Mob	41
Giant Spiders	Mob	51
Gnawtria	Mob	18
Goblin' Gators	Mob	18
Goblin	Mob	136
Goblin Bomb Bard	Mob	137
Goblin Engineer	Mob	137
Goblin Shamanka	Mob	137
Grimes	Mob	87
Hide-Hitter Crib Daddy	Neighborhood Boss	27
Hissing Scatterer	Mob	139
The Hoarder	Neighborhood Boss	143
Homogenous Humors	Mob	32
Jacked Kangaroo	Mob	97
Jazmanian Devil	Mob	98
The Juicer	Neighborhood Boss	147
Kobold	Mob	140
Kobold Rider	Mob	140

NAME	TYPE	PAGE
Krakaren Clone	Neighborhood Boss	115, 146
Laminak Rev-Up Consultant Manager	Mob	108
Literal Murder Hornets	Mob	52
Lost Souls	Mob	119
Melon-Baller Marvin, Head Bugaboo Socket-Picker	Mob	130
Mick Moran, Hulking Crockodilian Chef	Neighborhood Boss	103
Mind Horror	Mob	119
Mirror Cat	Mob	31
MisChief	Neighborhood Boss	47
Pack Rat	Mob	32
Pickmees	Mob	109
Prosperity Prophet	City Boss	144
Rage Elemental	Mob	141
Rakish Werehound Shocker	Borough Boss	147
Ralph the Frenzied Gerbil	Neighborhood Boss	148
Rat	Janitor Mob	138
Rat Brute	Mob	41, 62
Rat Hooligan	Mob	42, 64
Rat Shaman	Mob	42, 63
Rayzer	Mob	19
Riff Roughers	Mob	19
Rot Sticker	Mob	138
Scat Thug	Mob	20
Scatterer	Mob	138
Scatterer Brood Guardian	Mob	139
Screye Drone	Mob	129
Shambling Acid Impaler	Mob	86
Slimy Croakers	Mob	52
Smombie	Mob	108
Spit—Goblin Survivor Who Lives in the Now	Mob	130
Spit—Goblin Who Just Can't Seem to Let Go of the Past	Mob	131
Sprites	Mob	86
Stiggy, Dungeon Surveillance Architect	Borough Boss	135
Trash Princess	Mob	21
Troglodyte Basher	Mob	120, 142
Troglodyte Pygmy	Mob	142
Troglodyte Virtuoso	Mob	142
Trollogs	Mob	88
Unvaccinated Clurichaun Rev-Up Consultant	Mob	107
Vine Creeper	Mob	50
Whambat	Mob	98
Wise-Guy	Crawler	136

TABLE 2: TUTORIAL FLOOR GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL	RESULT
1–6	See the current Neighborhood.
7	A local NPC tax collector patrol accosts your party, demanding Floor Number × 100 Gold for killing scores of subjects of the local warlord. If you do not pay, they try to arrest you, and word of your lawlessness spreads to officials on lower floors.
8	You encounter another crawler party grinding in the same area. Only one party can get credit for this grind session. What to do... oh, and if you have a rival crawler party, it's them.
9	Some of these poor Mobs' mothers show up to see what all the ruckus is about. They are double the level of their children.
10–16	Nothing bad happens.
17	You got lost. Subtract 1d4 × 10 as a percentage (10–40%) of lost Time to Floor Collapse.
18–19	The party has stumbled into a trap.
20	One of the Mobs drops something interesting that they were carrying for the local Boss.

TABLE 3: ADVERSARY POWER

	PARTY SIZE					
	2	3	4	5	6	7
Weak (50%)	1	2	2	3	3	4
Moderate (100%)	2	3	4	5	6	7
Strong (150%)	3	5	6	8	9	11
Overwhelming (200%)	4+	6+	8+	10+	12+	14+

TABLE 10: GAINING AND LOSING POPULARITY

CHECK RESULT	EFFECT
Critical Fail or Major Fail	−2 Popularity or −1 Popularity and alienate the host
Standard Fail	−1 Popularity
Near Miss Fail	No Change
Standard Success	+1 Popularity
Amazing Success or Critical Hit	+2 Popularity, and the host likes you; Or +1 Popularity for your whole party

TABLE 11: INTERVIEW SHOW QUIRKS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	QUIRK
1	The crawlers must sing a karaoke song.
2	The crawlers must show off a Skill, talent-show style.
3	The crawlers must answer personal, probing, or unhinged questions from the audience.
4	The host brings out a rival or antagonist crawler to stir up drama.
5	The host initiates a competition of some sort, pitting two crawlers against each other.
6	The host lets the audience vote on what kind of prize the crawlers receive—if any.

TABLE 12: GREEN ROOM COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The green room isn't properly locked down, and crawlers can change their equipment or take items from their Inventory after learning about the host, show format, and/or interview topics.
2	The green room is luxurious and contains showers or beds that allows for a short rest in just a few minutes.
3	The crawlers are late, and a producer or production assistant rushes them onto the show without warning.
4	The crawlers get an unexpected five minutes to talk to a Communications Agent or Production Assistant in the green room.
5	Through chance or a rival's machinations, the party gets a different green room than expected, which may be less beneficial to the party.
6	The green room's amenities malfunction or are nonexistent, leading to a negative experience for a crawler that they'll possibly carry with them onto the show.

TABLE 13: CRUEL BEHAVIOR

ROLL OR CHOOSE	CRUEL HOST BEHAVIOR
1	The host offers the crawler or party a chance to fight a Boss near their location in the dungeon. Refusal results in mockery from the host or even the audience.
2	Two guests are encouraged to duel one another to the death. The host may offer a reward to the victor. See <i>Rules</i> , p. 7, for advice on including or excluding violence among party members.
3	The host brings out a surviving human (or Earth pet) tied to the crawler's Past Trauma, Loose Ends, or Regrets.
4	The host encourages the crawlers to give their full, unfiltered opinion of other crawlers they've met, only to bring those crawlers out as surprise guests to confront any giving negative opinions.
5	The host provides a choice of gifts for each guest, but each choice ties back to a crawler's recent failure in the dungeon or a Regret, Past Trauma, or Loose End.
6	The host puts one or more party members in danger, forcing the guest(s) to choose who to save.



GAME MASTER'S CAMPAIGN TOOLKIT



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New Achievement! Start a Campaign.

So you just got suckered into trying to be the Game Master?

Reward: You're going to have so much fun!

Running a long-term game of the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game*** might seem intimidating, but we're gonna help you out here. This book covers the basics to get you playing a bunch of sessions on the Tutorial Floors. When you're done with this, you can make up how the Third Floor goes, or move on to the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Core Rulebook*** which expands on everything here for the Third, Fourth, and Fifth Floors.

In this book, you'll find some advice on running a longer-term game. These long-term games are made up of a bunch of short sessions of play: usually two to six hours long, the sort of thing most adult humans can sneak into a busy schedule on a Wednesday evening or Sunday afternoon. These are strung together for weeks, months, or even years and tell the story of a plucky group of crawlers surviving the horrors of the World Dungeon. These multi-session games are usually called campaigns, harkening back to wargames and military terminology.

This book has it all in a few parts.

The first section covers how to run your campaign, including sample Non-Player Characters (NPCs) that might advise or rival the players' crawlers, Neighborhoods, and Quests, plus the dangers within them.

The second section provides four Neighborhoods and one Quest for the First Floor. You may want to use some or all of these in your campaign: they're not ready-to-play scenarios, but more of par-baked. You, the GM, can use them as a starting point and adapt them to create the same sorts of obstacles that Carl and Princess Donut faced in *Dungeon Crawler Carl*.

The third section gives you the same information for Neighborhoods on the Second Floor. Plus it includes information on getting crawlers on various interview shows. Five sample shows can be found there.

Finally, we present a few adversaries for adventurous (or foolhardy) GMs who want to go off-road or recreate some of the problems that Carl and Donut ran into.



STARTING A CAMPAIGN

In an ongoing **Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game** campaign, the Tutorial Floors serve to introduce you, the players, and the characters to the World Dungeon as well as the game itself in a few ways:

First, they're a simpler, fun way to start out rather than jumping straight into the action on the Third Floor. By the time you get through the Tutorial Floors, the players are ready to start race and class selection on the Third Floor.

Second, they're a great place to plant seeds to reap later, just like Matt Dinniman did. Think Hekla, Lucia Mar, Frank Q and Maggie My. The Rev-up plotline with Krakaren clones. Artifacts of Divine Suffering.

Third, they're presented here in this boxed set with quite a bit of detail. (You're welcome.)

Finally, the Tutorial Floors are a perfect place to start your campaign, since every crawler comes through here—unless they die, of course.

If you don't have much experience running RPGs, the brief sketch that follows will give you a few ways to start. If you do have a lot of experience running RPGs, you might prefer to start in the middle of some action and cover these elements as flashbacks.

There are three basic ways to begin a campaign:

- Neighborhood trouble, then flashbacks to playing the collapse and meeting a Game Guide (you'll do things out of the order below).
- Playing the collapse, Neighborhood Trouble, and meeting the Game Guide. Here it may work best to start playing with no rules and create a character when they meet the Game Guide.
- Start sometime later, perhaps with the *Par for the Course* scenario in this box. Playing the collapse and meeting a Game Guide may not be the most exciting events, so you can jump into the action whenever and fill in the backstory later.



PLAYING OURSELVES

Some players may want to play themselves (not play *with* themselves—that's different) as they go through the Crawl. This seemingly easy option can lead to unexpected issues in the game, however. Failure can feel much more personal, as well as dealing with Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets like Carl and Donut do. This may be more fun for a single session or short campaign rather than a long-term one.

PLAYING THE COLLAPSE

In *Dungeon Crawler Carl*, the collapse occurs on Tuesday, January 3rd, at approximately 2:23 a.m. Pacific Standard Time (UTC-8 for those of you outside the US and Canada). But there's no reason that your version of *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth* needs to follow this exactly.

You may start your campaign by asking your players a few questions about their crawlers. Tell them to keep their answers relatively short: just a sentence or three (not more than 30 seconds or a minute of talking). You might tailor the questions to each player or their crawler. This isn't the heart of the game, so don't spend hours on it.

- Describe your crawler. What is their physical appearance? Their occupation (if any)? Do they have any obvious quirks or physical mannerisms?
- Most parties on the Tutorial Floors enter the dungeon together, or at least come from the same geographic area. Does your character have any relationship to other crawlers?
- What were you doing before the collapse, and why were you outside?

THE ANNOUNCEMENT

Chapter 1 of *Dungeon Crawler Carl* provides the announcement that all surviving humans on Earth received. You can also find an abridged form in the *Atlas: Tutorial Floors* booklet (p. 3) or cue it up from the audio book (about 13:33 in Chapter 1) to play for your group.

NEIGHBORHOOD TROUBLE

The action in the *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game* takes place in Neighborhoods. Choose one of the Neighborhoods from the First Floor later in this

book. You can assume the crawlers have already met their Game Guide and understand what happened during the collapse. Then jump in with a Strong Start and let the crawlers deal with whatever they find in the Neighborhood.

If it's relevant, you can later flash back to the first meeting with the Game Guide, or the collapse, or entering the dungeon. Quests aren't official on the Tutorial Floors, but Quest-like content can be chosen after you've established some locations from a Neighborhood (see *Food is Love*, p. 61 or *Passive (Aggressive) Perception*, p. 127).

Neighborhoods and Quests are described below (p. 12).

GAME GUIDES AND DUNGEON ADMINISTRATORS

When the World Dungeon opened, millions of crawlers made their way out of the cold and down the stairs into the dungeon, clueless as to what lay in store for them at the bottom, much less what they needed to survive. The current producers of the Crawl, the Borant Corporation, could've just left them to their own devices, throwing them to the proverbial wolves (which may or may not be an actual Mob). But even the System AI would consider that a real dick move.

Sure, views would spike briefly as the crawlers all met grisly ends, but the real payoff of the Crawl is some of them surviving long enough for the audience to get to know the crawlers, feel a connection—and then have 'em all go down in a gory blaze of glory. Instead, the crawlers get access to some folks who might help them survive.

For Game Masters (GMs), these Crawl-related Non-Player Characters (NPCs) can interact with the players' characters (PCs) in a variety of ways, leading to some interesting roleplay and intriguing storylines. These NPCs can provide varying levels of assistance to the crawlers, and this may result in some mechanical game benefits for the Player Characters (PCs) as well. As such, it's important for GMs to understand the background of each of these types of NPCs and the roles they might have while interacting with PCs.

Some NPCs, such as Game Guides, managers, and lawyers, work on behalf of crawlers. Others, such as agents and liaisons, ostensibly work on behalf of corporations and other entities involved in the Crawl, such as the Borant Corporation or even the Syndicate (the massive intergalactic governing body).

In addition, anyone else involved in managing, operating, or overseeing the World Dungeon can interact with the PCs, including the System AI itself. Some might play large recurring roles in the PCs' lives, while others might lurk more in the background or not come up at all.

It's important for the GM and players to collaboratively establish the nature of the roles these NPCs will play in the arc of a given storyline, be it for an adventure or a character's backstory. And of course, the System AI can and will throw all this planning out the window at times!

Every crawler should find a Tutorial Guildhall and speak to the Game Guide inside early on. Character creation assumes you've done this already, but it's okay to backtrack a bit if you want to play this out. If you're starting the same way as Carl, you'll want to have the players encounter their Game Guide and the Tutorial Guildhall after one or more encounters.

You can select a sample Game Guide or invent your own. You might use one of the Strong Starts from a Neighborhood description just before the party encounters their Game Guide. The Game Guide starts with a roleplaying scene where you can answer some of the crawler's questions (or the players', even!).

DUNGEON NPCs

On the Tutorial Floors, the PCs are unlikely to meet a many employees of Borant or other corporations. The major exception is guildmasters, who rapidly fill the role of the crawlers' Game Guides, along with Communications Representatives. There are other types of Dungeon Admins but not many the PCs are liable to encounter directly.

For the First Floor, the GM should choose which guildmaster has become (or will become) the group's Game Guide. They'll advise folks through Race and Class selection on the Third Floor, which is detailed in the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Core Rulebook***. They may even stick around if someone in the group can gain the Manager Benefit.

On the Second Floor, the party (as a whole or as individual

members) is likely to appear on one or more interview shows (see p. 72). To facilitate this, the Borant Corporation (or whichever corporation is in charge of your version of *Dungeon Crawler World*) assigns Communications Agents or Outreach Associates to help connect crawlers to shows and rake in the cash for lending their up-and-coming intergalactic stars to the highest bidder.

These dungeon-employee NPCs are all better informed than other NPCs in the dungeon. They receive updates in the form of a newsletter that crawlers can't access.

GUILDMASTERS OR GAME GUIDES

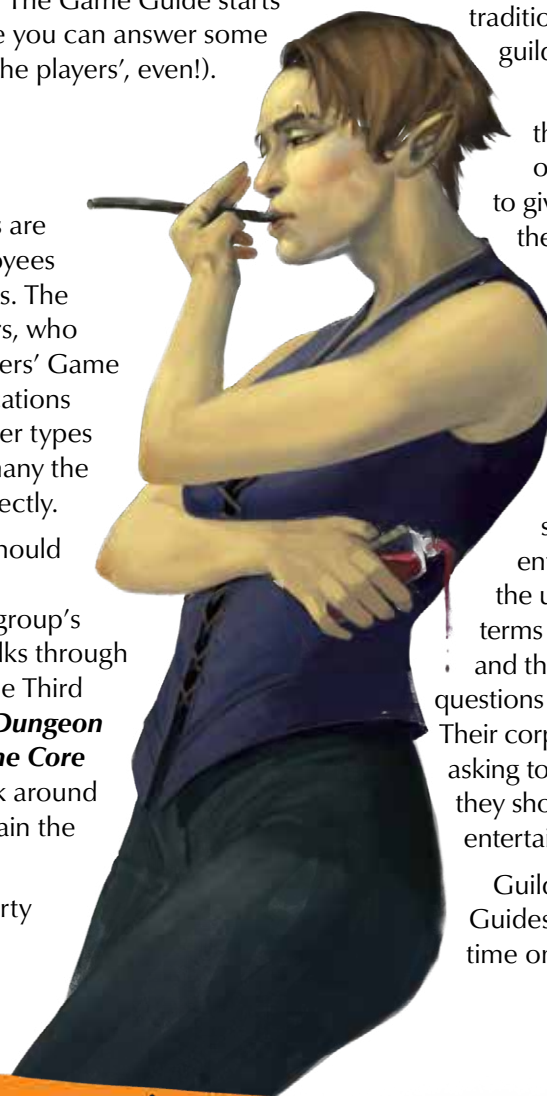
When the World Dungeon opened, Tutorial Guilds were installed on the First Floor, each with its own guildmaster. These are generally the first NPCs, apart from Mobs, that the players encounter when they start the game. Once the PCs enter a Tutorial Guild, the guildmaster will be assigned to the PCs as their Game Guide for the first three floors of the dungeon.

On the Third Floor, guildmasters assume a more traditional role, whether they lead a magic guild, a Dodge guild, or something else.

Game Guides show new crawlers the ropes or at least answer questions on the basics of the World Dungeon to give crawlers a chance at surviving to the Third Floor. They explain how to use a Heads-Up-Display (HUD), how to navigate crawler menus, how to access the Inventory system, what Skills do, and what the World Dungeon is all about.

Generally, Game Guides provide crawlers with the basics to survive just a little bit longer (for the entertainment of sadistic voyeurs across the universe). Their hands are also tied in terms of answering big-picture questions, and they're freer to answer a crawler's questions than to offer information themselves. Their corporate overlords don't want crawlers asking too many probing questions, though; they should be focused on the mayhem and entertainment within the World Dungeon.

Guildmasters and potential Game Guides usually spend decades ahead of time on the crawlers' planet, preparing





for the opening of the World Dungeon. This includes consuming popular media and learning the planet's customs. By doing so, Game Guides are more readily able to explain things in a manner the crawlers can comprehend, using terms and examples from the crawlers' own world and culture.

Guildmasters and Game Guides are often former crawlers themselves who survived long enough in a previous World Dungeon to negotiate an exit deal with the production company for that Crawl. Game Guides have access to the Dungeon Codex, which is a detailed explanation of the dungeon's Mobs, Bosses, items, and Spells. Game Guides can share limited information about the dungeon itself but are restricted from revealing certain information to prevent cheating.

Game Guides cannot be seen by most viewers, except those with press passes. Game Guides are not covered by any sort of protections (unless your World Dungeon is different) and can be permanently killed while in the dungeon. As such, they generally remain in saferooms.

Around halfway through the Second Floor, Game Guides can start instructing crawlers about the Third Floor, including the Race-and-Class-selection process. Upon reaching the Third Floor, as crawlers make their race and class selections, Game Guides can advise them but must refrain from overtly telling them what to do. On the Third Floor, Game Guides can also become managers for crawlers. If they do, they lose access to the Dungeon Codex but gain the freedom to share their full knowledge to aid crawlers. Choosing a race and class and the Manager Benefit are fully detailed in the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game Core Rulebook***.

GAME GUIDES IN PLAY

Just as guildmasters give crawlers the basics, the GM can use guildmasters to give players new to the ***Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game*** the general background on what Crawls are about, how to use their Skills and abilities, how combat works, how Inventory works, and all the rest. The Game Guide's access to the Dungeon Codex allows them to give the PCs more detailed information about everything they might see on that floor of the World Dungeon. GMs can also use guildmasters to explain some of the basic aspects to players completely new to the Dungeon Crawler Carl book series or even to tabletop roleplaying games altogether.

Neither Game Guides nor guildmasters can access the crawler messaging system. The PCs will need to find a Tutorial Guild to contact them.

Following a Game Guide's advice usually grants a crawler 1 AI Favor if they have none.

SAMPLE GAME GUIDES

Below are three example Game Guides along with information for playing them as major characters in an adventure. GMs can choose one of the following Game Guides or make their own for interacting with their players. Cousin Vinnie D'Parmigiano (from *Food is Love*, p. 61) or Xaggra and Jonai (from *Prickly Pack Alley*, p. 29) could also be the group's Game Guide.

MORDECAI

Mordecai—Rat Hooligan. Level 50.

Guildmaster of this guildhall.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

BACKGROUND

Mordecai is a former crawler who took an exit deal after reaching the Eleventh Floor hundreds of cycles ago. As an indentured employee for the Borant Corporation, he acts as a Game Guide in a Tutorial Guild for the first three floors before being transported deeper into the dungeon to run a magic guild.

After completing his contracted number of cycles, Mordecai will become a full Syndicate citizen and receive a moderate stipend. As such, Mordecai is most interested in fulfilling his obligations as efficiently as possible so he can move down to his magic guild, which he prefers these days.

Mordecai was originally from an avian race known as Skyfowl and chose Changeling as his race when he was a crawler. Now, every time Mordecai transfers floors, Borant assigns Mordecai a new race, with the race always being that of a Mob on the current floor.

Mordecai keeps his general advice conservative, aimed at helping his crawlers survive as long as possible while minimizing risk. He is generally grumpy but tends to perk up when talking about potions. He often gets drunk and emotional when thinking about the loss of his family. He harbors a grudge against his former crawler allies, whom he blames for the death of his brother hundreds of cycles ago.

MADAME TOUSANT

Madame Tousant—Gossamer Weaver. Level 50.

Guildmaster of this guildhall.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

BACKGROUND

Madame Tousant is a relatively new Game Guide, having participated in the Crawl less than fifty cycles ago. Rather than take an initial deal that was offered on the Tenth Floor, Madame Tousant chose to continue with her party down to the Eleventh Floor before accepting a deal with the Chrysalis Collective.

After completing her duties as a Game Guide on the Third Floor, she's slated to operate a crafting guild, specializing in textile and armor modification. Her creative use of Mob parts for decorative and protective applications has been widely hailed as bold, yet practical, with her designs often showcased on Syndicate fashion tunnels (that's like a TV show, Earthling!).

Madame Toussant was originally a Bune—a slight, dragonlike lizard from a peaceful planet that was the site of a previous season of *Dungeon Crawler World*. She and several of her seamstress friends had been outside their shop taking a vape break when the World Dungeon opened.

Upon entering the Third Floor, she chose the Arachnid race with the Rogue Trapmaster class. During her Crawl, Madame Toussant became famous for her innovative use of spider silk mechanics in trap designs, perfecting various types of silk with a variety of effects. These included acid-infused silk, molecular filaments, and conductive coils.

Besides her expertise with traps, Madame Tousant also became known for her incredibly positive attitude, even during her team's darkest moments. Her relentless enthusiasm proved not only infectious with her party but also with the viewers. She and the majority of her party survived to the Eleventh Floor, something few Crawl oddsmakers expected.

Of the four other crawlers she entered the dungeon with, only one failed to reach the Eleventh Floor. This member sacrificed themselves on the Tenth Floor to save the rest from an ambush just after the crew decided to forgo the deal they were offered.

Though this loss bitterly stung her, she still pushed the survivors onward to their eventual exit on the next floor. All the while, she spoke with joy and gratitude concerning her lost party member rather than with grief.

Madame Toussant's advice tends toward creative problem-solving and taking calculated risks that can yield significant rewards. She is relentlessly optimistic, sometimes to the point of seeming naïve, but her strategies are sound, and her knowledge of the dungeon is fairly comprehensive.

SHAELLIAN

Shaellian—Thornbound Wanderer. Level 50.

Guildmaster of this guildhall.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

BACKGROUND

Shaellian is one of a select few crawlers who made it to the Twelfth Floor before accepting an exit deal. When not working in a Tutorial Guild, Shaellian operates a Survival guild on the lower floors.

Currently their contract requires the completion of forty-three more cycles before they earn their way out of the dungeon. Shaellian openly resents their position, the dungeon, the Syndicate, and most crawlers who come through, though they perform their duties with technical competence because the alternative is a contract extension.

Shaellian was originally a Sasquatch from a forest world that was the location for the Crawl many hundreds of cycles ago, when the process was still relatively new. They chose the Bush Elf race during Third Floor race selection because they found it a stark contrast to their original ungainly one.

They later realized this was a mistake, as the new race seemed very frail compared to their original, offering few useful benefits. Still, they trudged their way through the dungeon, usually working alone due to their distrust of other crawlers.

Shaellian's advice is technically excellent but delivered with pessimistic fatalism. They assume most crawlers will die, and they frame their guidance around minimizing suffering rather than achieving success.

They occasionally show reluctant engagement when discussing explosive or incendiary devices but quickly retreat back into their morose shell. They avoid mentioning having worked with other crawlers as long as they possibly can.

COMMUNICATIONS AND PUBLIC RELATIONS AGENTS

After the PCs begin gathering followers on the Second Floor, they may be assigned a Communications Agent who manages their appearances outside the dungeon. While these NPCs work on behalf of the PCs, they are employed by the corporation that runs the Crawl, and as such, they don't necessarily have the PCs' best interest at heart except as it aligns with their employer's. These agents manage the PCs' schedules and may interact



with the PCs in a very formal or very informal manner, depending on the admin's personality.

Communications Agents are prohibited from providing the PCs with information that might give them a leg up during the Crawl, though they may provide the PCs with insights into how organizations outside the World Dungeon interact both with each other and with the System AI, such as sponsors and the like. These agents may also provide the PCs with information about the shows they are booked on, the hosts of those shows, and other guests who might appear alongside the PCs.

COMMUNICATIONS AGENTS IN PLAY

The GM can use Communications Agents to give the PCs information about their Popularity and sponsors, how the PCs can influence those numbers, and how the PCs might benefit from them. Although strictly prohibited, agents may also directly or indirectly provide PCs with information that might aid them in the Crawl.

Such disclosures are rare, as the agent will be harshly punished or even fired. Generally, PCs are prevented from harming agents, but in some circumstances, these protections can be circumvented. Such an interaction can only happen in a specific way once, as security failures get patched right away.

On the Second Floor, most crawlers in demand for interview shows, including the PCs, will be assigned a Communications Agent as their public relations agent to manage and book appearances.

As with Game Guides, following the advice of a Communications or Public Relations Agent can grant a crawler a point of AI Favor if they have none.

SAMPLE COMMUNICATIONS AGENTS

ZEV

Zev—Borant Corporation Assistant Communications Representative: PR Agent.
This is a Dungeon Admin.



BACKGROUND

Zev works in the Borant Corporation Communications Department as a low-ranking PR Agent. When too many public appearance requests are received for a crawler, their party is entered into the Crawler Assisted Outreach Program, and an agent like Zev is assigned to them. As such, Zev acts as a liaison between Borant and privately produced shows that wish to interview and showcase crawlers.

Besides acting as a go-between to coordinate show appearances, Zev also tracks her clients' Popularity, conducts focus groups to collect viewers' opinions, and can sign official documents on their behalf. Zev is a Kua-Tin, an alien race of small water-breathing humanoid fish that are the dominant species in the Borant System.

Unlike many others who work for the Borant Corporation, Zev is not a member of the Bloom, the Borant System's controlling political party. As such, she tends to struggle to advance her career and often shows more compassion for her clients than others of her kind.

Prior to the opening of the World Dungeon, Zev spent fifteen years in Earth's orbit, watching nothing but Earth programs, and became particularly infatuated with *Gossip Girl* and *Riverdale*. She tried to write a *Gossip Girl* fanfic, but it didn't receive many hits. The nuances of compelling scripted drama are challenging for Kua-Tin.

ZEV IN GAMEPLAY

Zev is a Dungeon Administrator who may show up once the PCs have started to gain notoriety and views. The Borant Corporation is heavily reliant on advertising, licensing, and broadcast proceeds from *Dungeon Crawler World*, which it needs to stave off bankruptcy and a hostile takeover by the Valtay Corporation.

As such, the GM should have Zev constantly advising the PCs on how to improve their Popularity and ranking, as these factors help increase revenue for the Borant Corporation. As someone who isn't fond of the Kua-Tin's Bloom Party, Zev can

readily identify with the plight of the crawlers. As such, Zev may, from time to time, slip the PCs crucial pieces of information when their lives are on the line.

Mechanically, this enables the PCs to gain AI Favor if they have none when following Zev's advice.

MUKTA

Mukta—Borant Corporation Senior Communications Representative: Public Relations Agent.

This is a Dungeon Admin.

BACKGROUND

Mukta is a male Kua-Tin and an acolyte of the Bloom, the dominant Kua-Tin political party. The Bloom actively cooperates with the Borant Corporation in running *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*. Loyalty to one often means enforced loyalty to both.

Mukta is a no-nonsense Communications Specialist who often covers for others who are too busy or unable to complete their duties due to poor performance or reeducation training. He's focused on the bottom line, but canny crawlers may be able to turn his greed and conservative beliefs to their advantage.

He's also an expert with contracts and a bit of a rules lawyer (though not a lawyer in the legal sense). If a client leaves holes in a contract that crawlers can exploit, it's not Mukta's fault they didn't understand what they signed. And like other Borant representatives who work with crawlers, he has authority to sign on his crawlers' behalf.

As a Kua-Tin, Mukta dresses conservatively and prominently displays a Bloom pin on his clothing so everyone knows he's party-affiliated. He trusts Borant's protections and has no qualms about appearing in-person in the dungeon or in a production trailer, unless he's too busy to bother. The only other exception would be if he finds proof that he might be in danger.

Mukta comes across as ruthless at first. His interests are the Borant Corporations interests, regardless of whatever displeasure a crawler may express. He may warm to crawlers eventually, but he's certain he knows better than they do, and he'll do his best to further a crawler's career as long as they keep bringing in money.

Before the collapse, Mukta worked the Bloom and corporate bureaucracy like a pro. He does harbor other interests, however, and is likely to be fascinated with one Earth hobby familiar to the crawlers. Of course, the Kua-Tin version is superior in just about every way, and he'll doubtless remind any PCs of that fact.

Mukta doesn't trust assistants with important things. He'll personally deal with scheduling and negotiations for important crawlers, though he's not likely to take much input from said crawlers unless one of them proves especially competent or if they bond over an obscure hobby.

MUKTA IN PLAY

Even if Mukta isn't the PCs' primary Communications Agent, they may be forced to deal with him once or twice before they gain a reputation. In the event he becomes their permanent Communications Agent, his no-nonsense approach may inspire rebellion against his brusque demeanor and seemingly heartless focus on the bottom line.

His focus and dedication could push crawlers to new heights of fame and fortune (for Borant), or crawlers under his charge might find a way to exploit his overconfidence and get a new agent that they like better.

VARLEY

Varley—Borant Associate Communications Representative: Public Relations Agent.

This is a Dungeon Admin.

BACKGROUND

Varley is absolutely in over his head. He's used to slacking and doing the bare minimum to set up crawler appearances on various shows, but after his supervisor, Mooz, was somehow killed in the dungeon, Varley received an unearned and unwarranted promotion. Surprise!

In light of his old supervisor's untimely demise, Varley is paranoid and terrified of the dungeon itself, and he may break the rules by appearing as a projection from cheap equipment he bought himself rather than in person. He goes out of his way to learn anything about dangers that he and his fellow admins might face in the dungeon.

He's not a Bloom party member, and despite his promotion, he somehow remains optimistic enough that if he keeps his head down, he'll be overlooked and can look for a new job once the season is over. He's friendly with the crawlers he's working with, but he's often frazzled and complains about being overworked. He'll use the crawlers as a sounding board to spitball interview show ideas and for advice on dealing with his teenage son, Dayv, whom his elderly father-in-law, Larf, loves to spoil with lavish gifts.



Still, Varley somehow always comes through with quality shows for any crawlers he's working with. He often books crawlers for the first compatible show, then books them in incrementally better shows, waiting until the last minute if he can find something he views as an infinitesimally better opportunity than the last booking. This has a tendency to piss off both show producers and the crawlers he's working with, as neither side develops a lot of trust or respect for Varley's hollow promises and assurances.

Varley has worked in Borant's communications department for years, but he also has a host of connections with other corporations, particularly with fellow lower-level peers. He's shaken a lot of show host hands but generally deals with their producers and assistants. He used to like his job, but since his promotion, he's hoping to get a new position that's less stressful, probably with a different corporation. And if it pays better, that's a bonus.

VARLEY IN PLAY

Varley is overwhelmed with work and home life and just wants a few good days off so he can get some sleep. He won't break the rules for the crawlers—at least not early on. If they can offer a comforting ear for his work and family problems, he may be easily swayed to their side, though initially he has very little power to help them directly. Over time, he may become a powerful advocate for any crawlers he oversees, as long as they don't add to his stress.

If the crawlers ever hear of a Dungeon Admin that's been killed on the First Floor, GMs may consider making that admin Mooz, Varley's supervisor. Varley didn't like Mooz much, but he feels compelled to learn everything he can about any Borant employees or Dungeon Admins who are injured or killed in the dungeon.

BOPCAS

Bopca Protectors are magical, gnome-like creatures who exist solely to watch over Safe Rooms. They do everything from scrub the toilets to prepare your food. They are surly, smelly, and they never wash their hands.

—Dungeon Crawler Carl, Chapter 9

Bopcas run saferooms. They keep them stocked, prepare food for crawlers, and otherwise ensure they're running well. On later floors, they perform additional tasks in saferooms. Like many other NPCs, they qualify as non-combatant NPCs.

BOPCA PROTECTORS IN PLAY

Bopcas serve as both NPCs for crawlers to order around (if PCs are mean), or be kind to (for kind-hearted PCs), or just ignore outright (for those trenchcoat-katana types). They're great sources of information and can often give crawlers directions to major landmarks nearby.

They'll try to fulfill any crawler's wishes to the best of their ability (though they may do so with a lot of grumbling if the crawler's Charisma is too low). They can't do it all, but they can attempt to whip up comfort food from a crawler's childhood or provide towels to help crawlers clean up blood and gore from their battles in the dungeon.

TABLE 1: BOPCA NAMES

ROLL OR CHOOSE	NAME
1	Gordo (Masculine)
2	Hirut (Feminine)
3	Leilani (Feminine)
4	Nadia (Feminine)
5	Nora (Feminine)
6	Pahzi (Masculine)
7	Sebastian (Masculine)
8	Tally (Masculine)
9	Qwist (Masculine)
10	Vitasy (Feminine)

RIVAL CRAWLERS AND OTHER NPCs

Most Mobs don't have much personality, and that's no fun in a roleplaying game. Of the few that do, many of them are remnants of a bad idea that was just good enough for the Tutorial Floors. Maybe they just slipped through the cracks. It doesn't really matter. These NPCs have personality for some reason.

Sometimes the GM gets to portray crawlers, too. These GMCs, or Game Master Crawlers, tend to be rivals more than adversaries, but things can get real rough in the World Dungeon. These rivals are usually centered on role-playing, not roll-playing, so their Stats probably don't matter as much as a basic Mob's. Plus, if a PC kills one, they get a Player Killer Skull (see *Rules for Survival*, p. 38) which is not usually a badge of honor. Remind the players of this fact: their Game Guide probably explained it even if the players have forgotten or missed it.

Even though they're not elements of the dungeon like traps or other obstacles, the quick and dirty way to run rival crawlers and weird NPCs, particularly on the Tutorial Floors, is to consider any PC Action related to them to be Unopposed. Just use a Difficulty of 12 for the First Floor or 14 for the Second Floor. If the rival crawler or unusual NPC is acting within an area of expertise or what should be their best Skills or Stats, just increase the Difficulty by about 5. If the PCs are exploiting a weakness, decrease the Difficulty by 5.

Full statistics for sample rival crawlers can be found on p. 136. Use or adapt them as needed.

NEIGHBORHOODS AND QUESTS

Neighborhoods and Quests are the heart of the *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game*. As written, they're parbaked scenarios or adventures; they're not fully mapped-out scenarios like *Par for the Course* in this box, but they're much more complete than a pile of notes or random tables to create adventures from scratch. They're a jumping-off point with Mobs, Bosses, locations, and NPCs already tied together. Each Neighborhood or Quest is reasonably short: you should be able to read a Neighborhood or Quest in about 20–30 minutes, and with another 30 minutes to prepare some notes, you'll have an evening's worth of material for play.

Neighborhoods and Quests are organized in similar ways. The key difference is that Neighborhoods focus on the physical location, and Quests focus more on a mission. Technically, official Quests don't come online until the Third Floor, but we included some Quest content on the Tutorial Floors both to give a sense of what they're about and provide some adventure opportunities that are Quest-like. In the novels, the Rev-Up and Krakaren plotline is an example of what might be a "Quest" on the Tutorial Floors.

Here's how Neighborhoods and Quests are organized:

- **Summary and Overview:** Right away, you'll get a quick description of the Neighborhood, its themes, and what sorts of stories might emerge from the Neighborhood. Use this section to help you decide if a Neighborhood or Quest is right for your group.
- **Strong Starts:** These give you a couple of ways to hook the players' crawlers into an adventure in the Neighborhood.
- **Story Arcs:** These are likely stories that will emerge in the Neighborhood. Emphasized terms refer to NPCs, locations, or items described later in the Neighborhood.

- **Mobs:** These are the Mobs most likely to be encountered in the Neighborhood.
- **Environment:** This section describes what the Neighborhood is typically like, and how it differs from the rest of the floor.
- **Traps:** Use these traps against the party (see p. 14 for more on traps).
- **Items & Quest Items:** These are key items the party might find in the Neighborhood or useful in the Quest.
- **Achievements and Rewards:** Sample achievements you can read verbatim or use as inspiration, and what the AI might grant for each.
- **Grinding for Experience:** These are random events that might happen in the Neighborhood. Typically, you'll want to use them if the party grinds for experience to help liven up those scenes, but you can also use them for inspiration or drop them in if the pace is lagging or you need to fill a little more time in a session.
- **Exploring the Neighborhood (Neighborhoods Only):** This lists four quarters of the Neighborhood. Expand a Neighborhood by adding your own quarter, or remove some to make the Neighborhood smaller or fit your session length.
- **Quest Stages (Quests Only):** Where Neighborhoods explore a location (and have quarters), Quests focus on a plot line (with stages). The Stages are key story beats in completing the Quest.
- **NPCs or Walk-On Characters:** Key NPCs that may exist in the Neighborhood.
- **B-B-B-Boss Battle!:** This describes the biggest fight the crawlers are likely to encounter in the Neighborhood.

TUTORIAL FLOOR GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

When crawlers start a grinding session in a Neighborhood (see *Crawlers & Customization*, p. 43), roll 1d20 and consult Table 2. A complication could influence the grind. Roll only once, even if the crawlers are grinding for different amounts of time.

Note that results of 1 through 6 on the table below are found in the Neighborhood write-up. Feel free to do a fake roll and then make up a complication if there's something you want to happen. Gotta keep things from getting too predictable, you know?



ADVERSARIES

MOB AND BOSS STAT BLOCKS

Each Neighborhood contains a number of Mobs and Bosses, and each of these has a full set of traits called a Stat Block.

HOW TO READ A STAT BLOCK

A stat block is a list of the mechanics, important numbers, and attacks of a Mob, Boss, or other NPC in a truncated format for easy referencing. Keep this a secret from your players, except when you want to taunt them. All stat blocks follow the same format.

Top Lines: The name, type, and size of the creature.

Colorful Line: The Health Bar (HB) of the creature. When creatures take damage, you can let the players know what percentage of Health the creature has remaining. Keep track on scratch paper. Use numbers and math or just make a quick set of HB boxes or whatever works for you.

Middle Lines: You should already be familiar with most of these numbers. Remember to add the current Floor Number to values with "+F." The Surprise value is the Difficulty of crawler Stealth and Ambush Skill Checks, which is really just an INT-Opposed Check spelled out for you. Subtract the creature's Damage Resistance (DR) from each damage value they will be suffering.

Attacks: The "to hit" value is the Difficulty of the crawlers' Evade Checks, followed by the damage

dice, damage type, and the range of the attack. Some attacks have additional effects in italics directly under the attack, often when crawlers fail spectacularly at Evading an attack, but some apply in other situations as well. Fail effects are in addition to the Major Fail "additional damage equal to the Floor Number" or Critical Fail "double damage."

Notes: If there are any special notes about this creature, they are listed here. Additional flavor is often found in the lead-up to the stat block, especially where the AI announces the creature.

RAT

Rat

Mob; Tiny (1), Beastly



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
1	11+F	11+F	20+S	0
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)	2 (+1)	1 (+1)

Bite: 12+F to hit, 1d4+2 Piercing, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poison Debuff.

Notes: *Janitor Mob*—This Mob is responsible for cleaning messes on floor 1 and prioritizes eating corpses. It attacks crawlers when provoked, or when no other food options are nearby.

TABLE 2: TUTORIAL FLOOR GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL	RESULT
1–6	See the current Neighborhood.
7	A local NPC tax collector patrol accosts your party, demanding Floor Number × 100 Gold for killing scores of subjects of the local warlord. If you do not pay, they try to arrest you, and word of your lawlessness spreads to officials on lower floors.
8	You encounter another crawler party grinding in the same area. Only one party can get credit for this grind session. What to do... oh, and if you have a rival crawler party, it's them.
9	Some of these poor Mobs' mothers show up to see what all the ruckus is about. They are double the level of their children.
10–16	Nothing bad happens.
17	You got lost. Subtract 1d4 × 10 as a percentage (10–40%) of lost Time to Floor Collapse.
18–19	The party has stumbled into a trap.
20	One of the Mobs drops something interesting that they were carrying for the local Boss.

SCALING ENCOUNTERS

Though the dungeon may seem like it's a total meat grinder... well, it's just a meat grinder. Not a total one. Scaling battles for the PCs is a bit of an art, but it starts out with a table to make it feel like a science. Table 3 shows you a good starting spot for the number of Mobs for the party to kill, kill, kill... Spoiler: the base line is the number of members in the party.

Weak: These encounters are most useful on the outskirts of a Neighborhood, or as a complication for parties that are worn down. Combat against a Weak group of enemies is often quick but can be complicated by the environment or traps. This is the kind of stuff you might hand-wave away or skip in a montage like grinding.

Moderate: Fights against a Moderate group of Mobs are typical. The crawlers shouldn't have much trouble against them, but they'll likely use some resources.

Strong: Combat against a Strong group of Mobs should leave the party sweating but probably not in too much danger. The more the Mobs outnumber the crawlers, the greater the danger the crawlers tend to be in.

Overwhelming: An Overwhelming group of Mobs may risk character death and force difficult choices. The party may be better off fleeing from an Overwhelming number of adversaries.

The strength of a group of Mobs rests largely in the number of Mobs, because more enemies just get in more hits against the PCs. A Weak group of Goblins will be outnumbered by the PCs two to one, while an Overwhelming group of Goblins would outnumber the PCs two to one or more.

As you gain experience running the game, adjust these numbers up or down accordingly. Tactically-minded players or parties with really great loot can make Strong enemies feel like Moderate ones. Those playing the game for the story may make fun choices that complicate fights. The goal is an enjoyable game, not repeatedly killing Player Characters... unless everyone enjoys that sort of thing.

You can adjust the number of Mobs on the fly as well. Reinforcements show up. A rival group of Mobs appears. Other crawlers intercede in a fight. Rather than kill party members that are down, a Mob or two might pick up a fallen crawler's weapon and run off. The party can heal and find them to recover the lost item later.

TRAPS

The System AI is always on the lookout for creative new ways to kill crawlers. Sometimes a sudden impersonal execution scratches that itch, and other times long drawn-out suffering provides satisfaction. With traps, you can explore both extremes or anything in between!

Each Neighborhood below lists several traps that you may spring on your crawlers when you need to inject some random danger. You need not deploy them all. If there's no time for a Boss fight, a cliffhanger trap makes for a great end to a session.

Note: Traps cannot be placed in rooms with stairwells to lower floors.

The deeper in the World Dungeon you go, the more dangerous the traps become. Not all traps need to deal

TABLE 3: ADVERSARY POWER

	PARTY SIZE					
	2	3	4	5	6	7
Weak (50%)	1	2	2	3	3	4
Moderate (100%)	2	3	4	5	6	7
Strong (150%)	3	5	6	8	9	11
Overwhelming (200%)	4+	6+	8+	10+	12+	14+



damage. Nasty Debuffs are often more interesting, last longer, and create tension. Traps that simply hold or freeze the crawlers are most potent when the clock shows 30 hours or less to Floor Collapse.

Generally, interactions with traps on the Tutorial Floors occur via Unopposed Detect Trap checks. Noteworthy or particularly dangerous traps may be Opposed by the INT of their maker instead. On the Third Floor, Skills that allow crawlers to auto-detect, disarm, disassemble, and build traps become available.

TYPES OF TRAPS

Examples of traps you'll find in the dungeon include:

Dungeon and Environmental Traps: Trapdoors-over-a-spike-pit, crumbling ceilings, and darts from holes in the wall are classic dungeon traps, which typically deal a number of d6s in damage equal to the Floor Number. But the World Dungeon is known to crank simple features up to 11. Brindle Grubs clean up dead bodies on the Second Floor, spawning 1 to 15 for the job, but if 2,500 suddenly appear, that's a problem, and it's better resolved as a trap than with 30 rounds of combat. Immobilization, snares, alarms, and Mob-spawning traps are also common. Such traps might cause the victims to gain a Debuff, drain hours from the Time to Floor Collapse, or separate the crawlers ahead of an attack.

Crafted Traps: We all love a good jump-scare, making explosive traps perennial audience favorites. Best of all, collateral damage can hit other members of the party. The damage of such explosives is typically Xd6, where X is the Floor Number. Not all crafted traps explode; some apply a Debuff instead.

Psychological and Narrative Traps: Sometimes just getting crawlers to do something against their better judgment is enough. When the AI or another intelligent adversary really wants to twist the dagger, they dig into a crawler's history and exploit their fears and regrets.

Teleport Traps: These consist of a trigger and an anchor, both of which must be placed by the same user to properly sync them. When a victim steps on the trigger plate, they're instantly teleported to the anchor spot. On the Tutorial Floors, these traps are rare—the kind crawlers hear about, but may not find themselves.

NOTICING TRAPS

Spotting and avoiding traps doesn't make for good ratings. Viewers would rather see a trap get sprung and watch the crawlers fight for their lives to escape it. So it's okay to suddenly hang your crawlers upside down over a pool of lava, then let them find creative solutions to escape it. Escaping certain death is way more fun. However, the Detect Traps Skill can alert crawlers to traps, typically allowing them to avoid the triggers.

Totally Hidden: These traps were built into the dungeon by the architects and are very hard to spot. An Amazing Success or better with a Detect Trap Skill Check is required to spot one.

Something's Off: If there are subtle signs like faint lasers crisscross the room, or raised stepping stones are visible, then a Detect Trap Skill Check needs just a Standard Success.

Obvious Traps: Some Mobs—and crawlers—aren't that bright. Still, sometimes a basic Alarm Trap can catch crawlers unprepared, or crawlers might tumble into hastily dug spike pits. Some smarter Mobs mix obvious traps with those where something's off.

GMs can grant bonuses on checks to find obvious traps, allow a very generous variety of Skills to find them, or just declare that wary crawlers automatically notice them. The environment around a trap can make obvious traps less obvious, and smart foes may pile on basic obstacles (such as darkness or smoke) with traps to increase the danger.

THE FIRST FLOOR

"This first floor is huge, as you can imagine. It's almost the size of the surface of your planet."

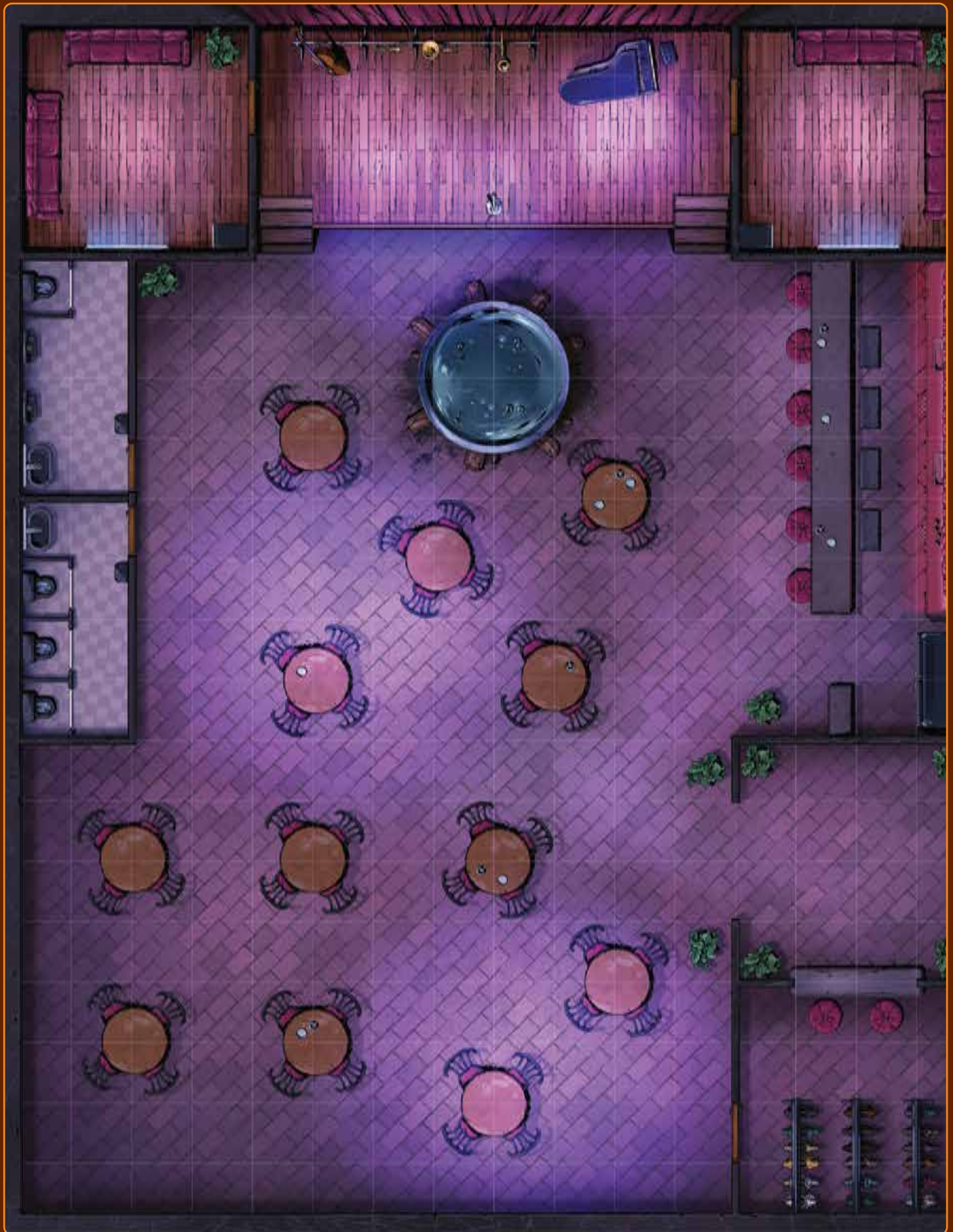
—Mordecai

Time to Collapse: 5 Days

Janitor Mob: Rats (p. 138)

Features of the Floor:

- Entry point for the Dungeon
- Crawlers don't get gold
- Only Borant Corporation personnel and the press can view this floor
- Crawlers can enter stairwells whenever they want
- Bosses cannot exit their chambers





NEIGHBORHOOD: BOGBRICKS

FLOOR: 1 (TUTORIAL)

THEME: SMOOTH JAZZ AND CHOPPY WATERS

Everything here smells Delicious! ...Unfortunately, I think that includes us.

—Crawler Selina Poe

Red brickwork stretches far into the distance. The sound of water dripping echoes through the hallways. Scents of delicious meat and spices assail your senses, and beneath that, insidiously mixed in, lies the distinct scent of rot and fetid water.

Far in the distance, something heavy slides into water, and the thump of bass drums is ever-present. You're not entirely sure where you are, but you're certain what comes next won't be particularly pretty.

The denizens of this Neighborhood are clever and use their superior knowledge of the terrain to their benefit. Somewhere in the darkness and the damp, the Hide-Hitter Crib Daddy waits, the sound of his drums reverberating through the Neighborhood.

STRONG STARTS

Here are two ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- The lights flicker as the pounding drums assail the crawlers' ears. It's not immediately clear which direction the sound comes from, and the heavy staccato matches the rhythm of the flickering light.
All at once, the lights go out, chased by the sound of many skittering feet. One of the crawlers feels something taken from them. And when the lights return, the crawlers see a group of Scat Thugs waiting high overhead, holding up their pilfered item in triumph, daring the crawler to come get it.
- The smell of delicious food draws a crawler down a nearby corridor almost immediately, where brackish water laps against the bricks. They see another crawler, perhaps one they've met, ahead. The other crawler notices them and turns to wave, only for a gigantic alligator to rear from the water, snap its jaw shut around the crawler's torso, and drag the crawler into the water.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine the contents and characters of this Neighborhood into easy-to-assemble adventures:

- Shortly after the dungeon was sealed, a Scat Thug NPC named Mad Driscoll lost a leg to a giant alligator known only as Ghost, a non-sapient gator who entered the dungeon and was assigned a crawler number. Mad Driscoll wants revenge and chases the alligator throughout the Neighborhood.
If the crawlers assist him in slaying the alligator, Mad Driscoll not only presents them with an enchanted longsword (roll two Silver-level bonuses; see the Randomized Magic Item tables in the *Atlas*, p. 26). If they are willing to hang around for 2 hours, he also teaches one crawler how to use it, granting them 1 Rank in the Longsword Skill. He also convinces the other Scat Thugs to stop attacking the crawlers. Additionally, the Scat Thugs in the Boss Chamber turn on the Boss and his other minions.
- Crawler Seline, a marine biologist, followed Ghost into the dungeon, hoping to protect him from whatever horrors were inside. Upon entry, she received an Enchanted Pet Carrier and an Enhanced Pet Biscuit in one of her loot boxes but lost track of the alligator.
Now she's trying to save Ghost before Mad Driscoll, or another Mob, ends him for good. If the crawlers help her rescue Ghost and kill Mad Driscoll, she and the alligator aid the crawlers against the Boss and his minions.
- Ghost is a giant alligator who was assigned a crawler number. He's used to being around humans. Outside the dungeon, Ghost on the loose would be bad, but in the dungeon? Enterprising crawlers might try to entice him with meat or Charisma, and securing an Enhanced Pet Biscuit and giving it to Ghost may also yield interesting results.
These are dangerous, but the Potion of Reptile Repose (p. 22) would put the alligator into a trance, making him much more docile. Of course, bonding with Ghost causes Mad Driscoll to attempt to kill the party and also leads to a confrontation with Crawler Selina. Sometimes you just can't please everyone!

MOBS

The Mobs in this Neighborhood have a predilection for inflicting Poison and Sepsis Debuffs either through their own attacks or the traps they employ. As such, they also have incredible resistance to both.

GOBBLIN' GATORS

These are not true alligators. They're clearly made up by some alien writer or an AI that saw an alligator and thought they were fun but recognized they were too strong for this early floor. While their bodies are proportionally too small, their mouths are every bit as large as a normal alligators, if perhaps a little narrower.

They strike lightning-fast near the water's edge anywhere in the Neighborhood, but on land, their stubby legs and oversized mouths make them much more ungainly. However, even a single bite from one of these creatures can be fatal, as their lack of dental hygiene means they might well poison or infect a crawler with Sepsis. They primarily lurk in the Still Waters quarter of the Bogbricks Neighborhood.

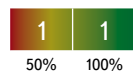
Goblin' Gator, Level 2

These creatures are about half the size of a normal alligator with twice the attitude. Although, if you asked them, they'd tell you it's not the size of the gator in the fight, it's the size of the bite from the gator!

These adorable little swamp kittens may have smaller bodies, but their massive maws are just as threatening and impressive as those belonging to their earthen inspirations. Be careful near sources of water, or you may find yourself shorter by a foot... or possibly a whole leg.

Goblin' Gators

Mob; Petite (3), Animal



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	11+F	11+F	10+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)	2 (+1)	1 (+1)

Bite: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Piercing, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Sepsis Debuff.

Tail Thrash: 13+F to hit, 1d8+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: *Swim*—Goblin' Gators can move twice as fast through the water as they can on the ground.

GNAWTRIA

These amphibious mammals have both an insatiable hunger for meat and all the equipment necessary to take a huge chunk out of anyone they can find. Gnawtria are large, about the size of the average dog, and possess a very long, prehensile tail. They're not much for strategy, and fortunately for crawlers, they don't typically operate in groups.

Unfortunately for crawlers, they don't need much beyond their quick reflexes and their armor-piercing teeth. (That is not a metaphor. Their teeth go through armor as if it weren't there.) Bitten crawlers have a chance of becoming poisoned. The Gnawtria can be found in the Vibrant Walls quarter of the Bogbricks Neighborhood.

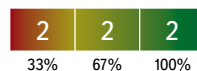
Gnawtria, Level 3

Have you ever seen a possum mixed with a beaver and given blood-red teeth the size of small knives? You haven't? Well, you're in luck, because one is coming right for you!

These furry little bastards are aggressive, vicious, and those teeth aren't just for show. Their slavering teeth phase through anything that's not made of flesh. If you value your ankles, start moving now.

Gnawtria

Mob Petite (3), Animal



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	13+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Bite: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Piercing, 5ft range, Armor Piercing
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Swim*—Gnawtria can move through the water as though on the ground and trade water in place.

RAYZER

The Rayzer resembles a large stingray with eyestalks protruding from the front. They float through the air as easily as their water-dwelling cousins drift along the ocean floor. They make a habit of hanging upside down from the ceiling to drop onto unsuspecting crawlers or rolling into bundles on the floor in an attempt to trip the unwary.

When all else fails, these floating menaces fire magic missiles from their eyestalks, alternating between that and a poison sting that confuses and disorients crawlers, making for easier targets. These Mobs are found throughout the Bogbricks Neighborhood on ceilings, underwater, and wherever else they can make life difficult for crawlers.

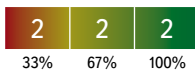
Rayzer, Level 3

The Rayzer is a deceptively cunning ambush predator. Sure, they can fly and shoot magic and even blend in with their surroundings, but that's not what makes them so successful. Their true power lies in their patience and their intelligence. These crafty little devils have been known to hide in the perfect ambush spot and wait up to sixty hours without moving.

Watch your step *and* your head, because these guys hide above and below before striking at unsuspecting prey. If you have the fortune to see one before it springs its trap, take a good look around, because there's probably at least two more you don't see, just waiting for you to lower your guard.

Rayzer

Mob; Petite (2), Beastly



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
2 (+1)	1 (+1)	4 (+2)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Magic Missile Spell: 11+F to hit, 1d4+3 Force, Line of Sight range

Tail Sting: 11+F to hit, 1d4+1 Poison, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Notes: *Wall Cling*—Rayzers can land vertically or even upside down.

Flight—Rayzers can move through the air as though on the ground and hover in place.

RIFF ROUGHERS

These spry creatures stand nearly four feet tall and have the heads of coatimundis. Where the Scat Thugs may prefer to stay at range, the Riff Roughers prefer to make use of their slender limbs and quick reflexes to fight up close.

They are dangerous swordsmen, and their fashion sense never quite got past the 1800s. They'll eat pretty much anything, making their breath potent enough to poison crawlers who get too close. They roam the Cypress Halls quarter of the Bogbricks Neighborhood.

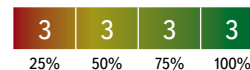
Riff Roughers, Level 4

If you've ever wanted to get into a swordfight with a pirate, well... here's your chance, Orlando Bloom!

Some think the Riff Roughers are just older Scat Thugs while others think they're a separate species entirely. One thing is sure: That debate is for Nerds! And if you don't do something quickly, you won't get a chance to form your own opinion!

Riff Roughers

Mob; Petite (3), Animal



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	11+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Breath: 13+F to hit, 1d4+3 Acid, 10ft Cone

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Cutlass: 14+F to hit: 1d8+3 Slashing, 5ft range

Notes: *Swordsmen*—Riff Roughers are expert swordsmen, and their Stat Block reflects this.

SCAT THUGS AND TRASH PRINCESSES

These raccoon-headed creatures stand three feet tall with skinny bodies. They wield needle-like spears in melee, or fire from the short bows some of their number carry.

They prefer long-range combat, but if forced to fight in close quarters, they'll attack in pairs using coordinated charges. They're clever hunters and have a natural predilection for both creating and avoiding traps. They are mostly present in the Gaslamp District of the Bogbricks Neighborhood, but if they see an opportunity for a quick score, they may venture further.



Female Scat Thugs, known as Trash Princesses, outnumber the males in this Neighborhood by a factor of 15 to 1. With Mad Driscoll and the Hide-Hitter Crib Daddy as two of their only partnering options, things tend to get a bit frantic around mating season. Despite their propensity for thievery, both genders smell as awful as the scat they live in. So instead of blaming a fellow crawler for cutting the cheese, maybe check if you still have all your credit cards.

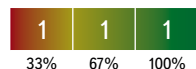
Scat Thugs, Level 3

Don't let their adorable little faces and sad beady eyes fool you—these scrappy little guys rob and ambush crawlers whenever an opportunity presents itself. And if they're hungry, all bets are off.

These furry creatures are highly food-motivated; when they're not hungry, they make for interesting conversational partners. Mostly, they'll chat about food and trap-making (and they're ingenious when it comes to crafting simple, yet effective traps).

Scat Thug

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	12+F	13+F	30+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Spear: 12+F to hit, 1d8+2 Piercing, 10ft range

Scat Pellet: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Bludgeoning, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stank Rot Debuff: Take 1d6+F Poison at the end of each round.

Notes: *Thief*—Crawlers who start their turn adjacent to one or more scat thugs must make an INT Stat Check vs Difficulty 10+F+the number of adjacent scat thugs. On a Major Fail or worse, they lose one equipped or held item. One scat thug drops their spear and takes the item if the item is small and light enough to carry. Otherwise, the item falls to the ground in the nearest unoccupied space.

Trapper—Each Scat Thug can activate one trap in a space within 60ft alongside their Action. Entities who move into a trapped space may trigger the trap, which deals 1d10+F Piercing damage and applies the Poison Debuff. Each trap only triggers once.



Trash Princess

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid

2	2	2	2
25%	50%	75%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	12+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	7 (+3)

Eat Trash and Die: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Poison, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stank Rot Debuff: Take 1d6+F Poison at the end of each round.

Trash Thunderclap: 12+F to hit, 1d6+3 Force, 15ft Cone
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler is pushed back 10ft.

Seduction: See below, 1d6+3 Psychic, 15ft Cone
The target must make a free INT Stat Check vs Difficulty 14 or gains the Seduced Debuff: a PC must spend their next two Actions on ill-fated Persuasion Skill Checks.

Notes: *Collateral Trashing*—Trash princesses don't care who they hit. If their Area attacks hit 3 or more entities (allies or enemies), they deal an additional 1d6 damage to each target.

ENVIRONMENT

Old crimson bricks form the hallways of this Neighborhood. The ceiling looms sixty feet above. Stretches of walls are plastered over in old yellow, pink, or blue pastels, but most of the colors have flaked away. No matter where you are in the Neighborhood, the aroma of good food and the sound of drums in the distance permeate the air.

The music changes every so often, from upbeat and festive to dark and ominous. At first, there's no obvious connection between the crawlers' activities and the sound of the drums, but clever crawlers might notice the tempo gets faster the closer they get to the Boss Chamber in the Cypress Halls quarter.

The Neighborhood is roughly divided in half, with the Gaslamp District and the Cypress Halls quarter being drier and more urban in character, while the other two quarters (Vibrant Walls and Still Waters) seem decidedly more rural. Water collects in corners between the alleys and thoroughfares of the Neighborhood but completely covers the floors in the Still Waters and Vibrant Walls quarters.

Throughout most of the Neighborhood, balconies, galleries, or even light foliage provide a semi-transparent "second level" about thirty feet above the ground. This may be tempting for some crawlers to explore, but in many cases, these are either laden with traps, difficult to get to, or already occupied.

TRAPS

This Neighborhood represents a huge opportunity for trap-makers. Narrow thoroughfares, high vantage points, and flooded corridors all make excellent places to strike the unwary. Scat Thugs are likely to set mechanical traps, while Goblin' Gators and Rayzers are more likely to set ambushes.

- **Bricktop Barrage:** Tripwires and weight-sensitive plates are easy to hide in the flickering lights of the Gaslamp District. If anyone is unlucky enough to set one of these off, the sound of stone scraping on stone precedes the plummeting of piles of blue-painted bricks from above. If the crawler doesn't get out of the way, they risk being buried, injured, or even killed.
- **Pothole Plot:** Crawlers traversing the Cypress Halls or Vibrant Walls quarters may step upon a piece of stone, brick, or flooring that appears sturdy but immediately gives way, dropping the unwary adventurer into a hole and potentially breaking their leg. If the crawler can't escape quickly, Mobs attracted by the noise attack the injured crawler.
- **Shadowfall:** In either Cypress Halls or the Gaslamp District, stepping on the wrong brick triggers a click and a strong gust of wind, which blows out the lanterns. Scat Thugs descend, attacking the crawlers in darkness as the smell of gas fills the area over the course of two rounds. If the crawlers don't defeat the Mobs in that time, the Mobs withdraw and ignite the gas to try to incinerate the crawlers.
- **Romeo Render:** Balconies offer tempting vantage points and high-ground ambush opportunities for Mobs and crawlers alike. The pillars conceal iron spikes that pop out when hands grip near them. It takes three rounds to climb up and one round to slide down, no Skill Check required. For each round on the pillars, the crawler takes damage.
- **Early Rayzer:** As the crawlers emerge from a saferoom, they may fail to look down, expecting it to be as clear as when they left. In doing so, they may step on a rolled-up Rayzer that has bedded down for the night. In the ensuing pandemonium, as the crawler crashes face-first onto the floor, another Rayzer falls from the ceiling directly toward their head.

ITEMS

Scattered throughout the Neighborhood are remnants of everyday life in the heart of an aging city, as well as those from life in the more rural parts of a swamp.

- **Chairs:** All types can be found on the iron balconies of the Gaslamp District, from old ornate sturdy rockers to cheap patio chairs.
- **Construction Barriers:** Fences, dividers, traffic cones—there's no end to the heavy, bright-orange plastic that litters this Neighborhood.
- **Floating Wood:** Pieces of boats, floating shipping palettes, and even bits of old homes drift through the Still Waters quarter.
- **Signs:** All manner of signage decorates the different quarters, proclaiming political leanings, advertising legal services, and voicing support of local businesses.
- **Potion of Reptile Repose:** This inky blue drink makes a reptile who consumes it lethargic and docile for up to 60 hours.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards.

- **Bog Bait:** "You tempted fate and stood in still water. Unfortunately for you, still did not mean empty! Better shake a leg if you want to keep the rest of your appendages attached!
Reward: You've received a Silver Shoe Box."
- **Where the Wild Things Are:** "You've spotted an earth animal the AI and showrunners did not create. They do wind up in the dungeon from time to time, but they aren't typically that ungodly large.
Reward: You've seen nature at its most majestic and terrifying! That's reward enough."
- **Reality Sets In:** "You have slain a living legend. Congratulations! You killed someone who inspired hope (or terror) in people, making their already mundane lives that much more boring.
Reward: You've received a Gold Mythbuster Box."
- **Distracted Daddy:** "You killed a Neighborhood Boss by causing enough pandemonium to steal his focus."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Crawlers that wish to test themselves against the wits and teeth of the Mobs of this Neighborhood might run into some of the following complications. Roll 1d20.

TABLE 4: BOGBRICKS GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A Mob that the PCs were fighting manages to escape. In their desperation to get away, the Mob wanders too close to the water and is devoured by Ghost, the gator, who stares at the players, daring them to attack, before crawling back into the water in the direction they were going.
2	A fight goes against the crawlers. As they struggle to escape, the sound of the drums gets louder and faster, making it harder to focus. One of the party trips over a concealed Rayzer and stumbles into the water. Something starts surfacing.
3	A small pond boils, with delicious smells wafting from it. Crawlers who fail to resist its magical allure draw closer, leaving them vulnerable to ambush by Riff Roughers attempting to push the unwary crawlers into their stew.
4	While crawlers explore the Neighborhood in search of more Mobs, a wall explodes outward, possibly injuring a PC as Mad Driscoll runs by cackling, chased by Crawler Selina.
5	A frantic male crawler screams, warning the party to stay back and raining automatic gunfire above their heads. He'll scream about ghosts in the water and drums in the dark. He is on the ragged edge, and if his fellow crawlers can't talk him down, they'll have to find another way to get past him.
6	The crawlers round a corner and find themselves directly in front of what appears to be an open-air bar. It serves only mead. A group of Riff Roughers scramble over and promptly attack another crawler who is already at the bar.
7+	See Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications (p. 13).



Then you took advantage of his distractible nature and killed him. Kind of a dick move, bro.

Reward: You've received a Gold Asshole Box."

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: THE GASLAMP DISTRICT

The brickwork of this level is precise but feels ancient, as if the buildings from which they originated were hundreds of years old. Occasionally, bits of plaster and paint cover the brickwork, always in hues of pastel pink, yellow, or blue. The thoroughfares here are wide and regular, with narrow alleyways every four hundred feet.

- About thirty feet overhead loom balconies of intricate ironwork, covered in slowly withering plant life and patio furniture. The gas lamps that give this area its name flicker in the darkness of the dungeon, leaving most of the ceiling in shadows.
- The crawler party triggered a Scat Thug trap. One is injured, potentially immobile, or poisoned. Scat Thugs rush down the brickwork walls to capitalize, cackling as they come, and it seems they have drawn the attention of nearby Rayzers.
- Perhaps the crawlers made the decision to try and parley with the Scat Thugs (or maybe they've convinced Mad Driscoll to vouch for them). The Scat Thugs are willing to trade all manner of interesting things to the crawlers in exchange for food, from random weapons and potions to pieces of literal garbage. They're also not concerned about how fresh the food is, either.
- The crawlers manage to disarm or negate a Scat Thug trap in spectacular fashion. The Scat Thugs that watched this are so impressed, they descend to converse with the crawlers, (perhaps being mistaken as an attack), speaking excitedly of trap theory and practice. If the crawlers further impress the creatures in the conversation, the Scat Thugs show the party some interesting commonalities in most common traps, granting 1 Rank in the Detect Trap Skill to the crawler most involved or injured by the trap.

QUARTER: CYPRESS HALLS

Red and blue-painted bricks give way to polished wooden boards (ironically, not all cypress), and gas lamps still provide the majority of the light in this quarter, but they glow brighter, and the ceiling is lower. Although the light still flickers, very little lies in shadow here. There are no thoroughfares or alleyways; this

quarter is all uniform hallways laid out in an almost-perfect grid. High above, wooden balconies look down over the halls. Some of the doors along the walls lead into small bunk-style barracks, some open only on bare walls.

- As the crawlers journey through this quarter, the floors gently roll and dip, and the drums beat louder and more ominously as they get closer to the Boss Chamber. The crawlers hear a mad cackling from above, and an explosive lands in their midst. Anyone who doesn't bother to move away takes 1d6 Bludgeoning damage. As it explodes, a Moderate group of Riff Roughers descend on ropes, swinging down with cutlasses in hand and knives in teeth. One steps forward and demands either gold or something valuable in exchange for the crawlers' lives.
- Throughout the quarter, in addition to the saferooms, guildhalls, and restrooms, there are various "open air" establishments—mostly shopfronts with doors and windows removed that look as if they've been taken straight from the surface world. They are devoid of most things beyond rotting food. In one of these, Crawler Selina desperately looks for some kind of meat. She's jumpy and ready to use the magic spear and the net in her hands, but if the crawlers lend her some meat, she'll trade several Potions of Healing as thanks before asking if they've happened to see a "real-life alligator" around.
- The Hide-Hitter Crib Daddy waits behind one of the hundreds of second-level doors. Crawlers can find this Boss Chamber by listening to the music, but they may be ill-prepared to attack him and his band on their own. Instead, crawlers can gain foreknowledge of his tactics or even assistance from Mad Driscoll, or aid from Selina and Ghost.

QUARTER: STILL WATERS

Creeping vines and plant-life cling to and cover most of the walls in the section. Where brickwork is visible, it is old and feels as if it might crumble at the touch. There are no alleys here to speak of. The thoroughfares are widened, but they twist and turn, winding their way through the quarter. Light shines from above, where what appears to be ambient sunlight drifts down in jagged patches.

The floor is rough and uneven, but usually not visible due to the brackish standing water, ranging from one to four feet in depth, throughout most of this area. Pieces of old furniture, wooden pallets, and other debris float through the water. The drums are much softer here, making it easier to hear the gentle splashing as... things... surface and disappear.

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- *As you round the corner, the smell of delicious food assaults your nose, and you hear a friendly voice calling out, beckoning you closer.*

Outcome: If the crawlers try to resist, they can recognize the impending ambush. If not, the attack surprises them.

- *As you move through the ankle-deep water, you feel something brush against your foot.*

Outcome: If the Crawler stands perfectly still, the Mob moves on. If the crawler does anything else, the Goblin' Gator attacks.

- *Every step resounds from the brickwork. Overhead, glowing eyes open in the shadowed heights of the iron balconies.*

Outcome: If the crawlers pay overmuch attention to the eyes, they wander directly into a Bricktop Barrage trap. Otherwise, the Scat Thugs attack the moment their back is turned.

- *The sound of the drums is an ever-present companion, changing in pace, faster and slower. But the worst, by far, is when it drums in a horrific monotone, each new beat pounding at your ears.*

Outcome: If the crawlers plug or cover their ears, they suffer no ill effects. If they do not, they gain the Terrified Debuff.

- This entire area is an ambush hunter's wet dream. If the crawlers try to walk through the water, there is no end of Rayzers and Goblin' Gators trying to take a bite out of convenient crawler legs. If the crawlers create a boat (perhaps from some of the old driftwood floating around), the Mobs tear the paddles from their hands, leaving them adrift unless they come up with another means of propulsion. Rayzers drop, stinging and shooting as they take advantage of the crawlers' lack of mobility.
- The crawlers hear Mad Driscoll shouting. As he stands atop a makeshift boat, he lights an explosive and throws it into the water. The corpse of a Goblin' Gator floats to the top, and Mad Driscoll swears and looks about. Seeing the crawlers, he warns them he's hunting a monster: a Goblin' Gator the size of which he's never seen before. He asks the crawlers for help hunting it down, swearing to help against the Boss if they do.
- The Still Waters quarter is dark, and the entire floor is covered in brackish waters. However, those who brave the deepest parts of the region may notice a piece of green wood buoyed in the water. Unlike other debris, it does not move, as if anchored in place. The water is especially deep there, and Rayzers, Goblin' Gators, (and potentially Ghost himself) lie in wait. At the bottom, nearly eight feet down, the brickwork was ripped apart, and a

treasure chest is buried. Inside is a Potion of Reptile Repose (p. 22), an enchanted flintlock pistol, and an enchanted eyepatch (both have one random Silver Benefit, *Atlas*, p. 26).

QUARTER: VIBRANT WALLS

Beyond the Still Waters lie the beautiful Vibrant Walls quarter, an area of nearly untouched wilderness. The floor here is made of dirt and moss, and water pools in large areas, submerging some streets. The quarter gets its name from the bright, vibrant flowers and plant life that make up the thin "walls" of the region. Vines hang from above, where a heavy canopy of leaves looms over a hundred feet higher up. Light that looks and feels like natural sunlight filters through them.

- The crawlers could well find themselves lost in the bright mazelike walkways of the Vibrant Walls. As the party traverses the Vibrant Walls quarter, they find themselves on a path, half of which is submerged in water. With a great squeal, a Moderate group of Gnawtria charge at the crawlers, surprising them. They leap at the parties, trying to knock them down and get at their tender face flesh. The sound of this scuffle rouses a Weak group of Rayzers from the riverbed, and they begin shooting magic missiles at the party.



- The sound of gentle singing drifts from what appears to be a gentle glade set beside a small stream. Crawler Selina sits in the center of the glade, humming (her tune syncs up unnervingly well with the distant drumbeats) and tossing meat into the river. An instant later, Ghost emerges and snaps his jaws closed on the meat, before sliding back under the water and disappearing utterly. Selina asks for the crawlers' assistance in capturing him, holding up an Enchanted Pet Carrier. If the players decline, she leaves but attacks them next time they meet.
- After a battle with Gnawtria, a crawler notes the hole from which they emerged. Upon investigation, crawlers find the holes are small but can be expanded. The tunnels within are large enough for adult humans to crawl through. The tunnels spiral throughout the quarter, running beneath the water and emerging in dry places, usually near saferooms. There are many Gnawtria inside, but traveling through tunnels cuts off the chance of encountering other dangers.

NPCS

SELINA POE DEVERAUX

Prior to the collapse, Selina was a marine biologist and an environmental scientist. She studied how the changing world affected the trees and animals of the swamp. The night everything changed, Selina was in the field, surreptitiously studying an alligator she took to calling Ghost.

On her own, she wouldn't have gone into the dungeon. But seeing the alligator enter? She couldn't help herself.

She's determined to see him safe, if only because it would mean she saved something in her time. There's very little she won't do to fulfill that goal.

Crawler #9,329,440. "Selina Poe"

Level 5.

Race: Human.

Class: Not yet assigned.

MAD DRISCOLL, THE SCAT HERO

Mad Driscoll has developed into a folk hero among the Scat Thugs. He's tough, fast, competent, and clever. Right now, he's also on-edge, injured, and desperate to settle a score.

Mad Driscoll—Scat Hero, Level 6 NPC.

Mad Driscoll, an explorer and a master trapsmith, is a living legend among the Scat Thugs. He can match swords with any Riff Rougher, eats Goblin' Gators for breakfast, dodges Rayzer missiles for fun, and outbites even the most ravenous Gnawtria. Most of the stories about him don't include the fact that he's one-legged, but that's because it's fairly new, courtesy of the dungeon's first and only alligator crawler, Ghost. He was supposed to be a Neighborhood Boss but somebody changed his mind at the last minute and didn't finish him. I probably shouldn't have said that, but... oh, well...

GHOST

Once, Ghost haunted the Mississippi Delta. He carved out a long life on the edges of the bayou, living off the river's bounty. He mostly ignored the people of the region because he learned early on that most would not appreciate him or his sensibilities.

Also, the fact that he was an alligator probably didn't help.

Most humans didn't bother him, though one in particular liked to visit in the wee hours of the morning. She brought him food and watched him eat. She was nice. Smelled sweet, too.

It was a good life... right up until the night of rumbles. One moment, everything was fine, then he looked up, and all the distant buildings were gone. A bright light shone nearby, emanating from the swamp, and its undeniable warmth tempted the cold-blooded Ghost closer. He couldn't help but enter.

Inside the World Dungeon, water's not as big, and there's not as much of it, but the prey is so nice.

Crawler #9,329,439. "Ghost."

Level 7.

Race: Alligator.

Class: Not yet assigned.

Okay, I'll admit it. I don't know *how* this guy got in here. But he's here, and he's bigger and badder than most things I had planned for you until *at least* the next floor. Good luuuuck.





B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The party enters a large old jazz hall that looks like it was plucked straight from New Orleans. A huge stage dominates the far side of the room, and the room reeks of garbage, feces, and a pungent musk.

The Hide-Hitter Crib Daddy, an oversized raccoon wearing a blue fedora and a red tie—and nothing else—is set up at the rear of the stage. He's surrounded by drums, laying down an ominous jazzy beat with exceptional prowess. Trash Princesses, beholden to their stinky sire, sit on nearby risers, playing instruments of their own with varying degrees of proficiency, while others sit at the tables before the stage, bobbing their heads to the music.

When the Boss spots the crawlers, time stops, but the beat continues, growing steadily faster as an image of the Crib Daddy pops into view, with a menu coming into focus in the background. As the AI announces the battle, the crawlers' portraits and names appear as if they were items on a menu.

When the battle begins, the Trash Princesses immediately start running interference, trying to keep the Crib Daddy safe. If the crawlers manage to deal damage to the Crib Daddy, the Trash Princesses descend into a frenzy, attacking the crawlers (and each other, because why waste an opportunity to eliminate some breeding competition?).

If the crawlers aided Mad Driscoll, he appears during the Boss fight and distracts the Trash Princesses with a foul musk of his own, leaving the Crib Daddy more susceptible to attacks. But don't linger near the Crib Daddy for too long—his odor alone can inflict the Sepsis Debuff.

Hide-Hitter Crib Daddy. Level 7 Neighborhood Boss!

Surrounded by his troop of Scat Thugs, the Hide-Hitter Crib Daddy knows how to keep things chill. A good rhythm section lays down any tune, and with the Hide-Hitter Crib Daddy leading the battle on the drums, you're in for a screaming, steaming good time.

Crib Daddies are masters of improvisation, unexpected timing, and ferocious violence. Their large claws are excellent for beating drums and cracking skulls. Their battle music inspires their Trash Princess fangirls to ignore their wounds and keep fighting. Attacking the Hide-Hitter Crib Daddy sends his troops into a frenzy, often leading to unexpected side effects.

Hide-Hitter Crib Daddy

Neighborhood Boss; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
9%	18%	27%	36%	45%	54%	63%	72%	81%	90%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
7	13+F	14+F	30+S	1
STR	INT	CON	Dex	CHA
6 (+3)	7 (+3)	10 (+4)	12 (+4)	11 (+4)

Pocket Groove: 14+F to hit, 2d6+3 Psychic, 5ft range (requires drumsticks)

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Wooly Debuff.

Downbeat: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Sonic, 30ft Burst radius (requires drumsticks)

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Fatigued Debuff.

Stick-Click: 14+F to hit, 1d6+4 Bludgeoning, 30ft range (requires drumsticks)

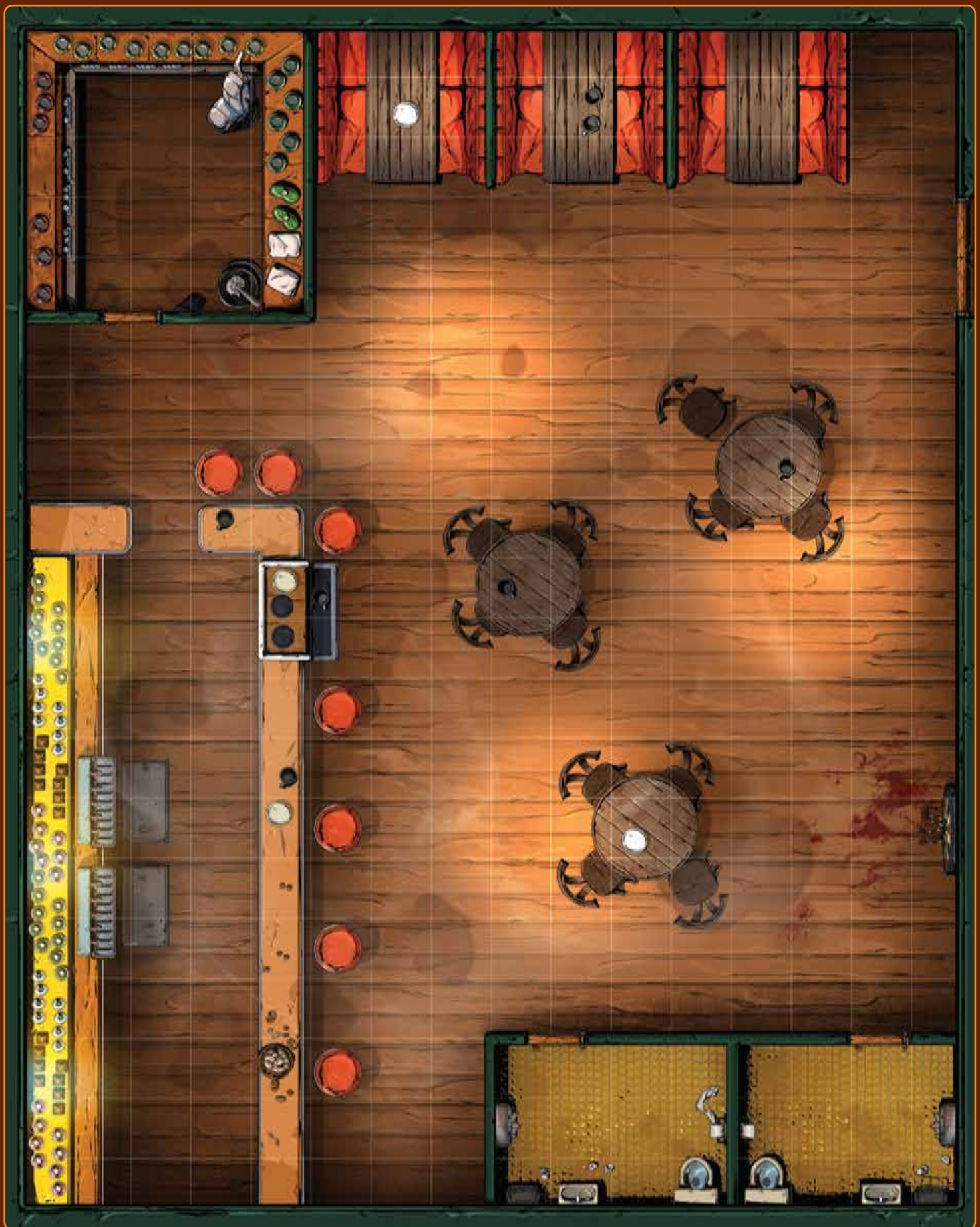
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stuck Debuff: The crawler cannot perform Interrupt Actions until the combat ends.

Notes: *Smelly*—Any crawler melee attack that results in an Amazing Success or better gets splashed with his musk and blood, gaining the Sepsis Debuff.

Bodies Hit the Floor—While the Crib Daddy wields drumsticks, Trash Princesses who start a round within 10ft of him gain a 1d4 damage bonus to their attacks, but must roll a 1d6 if any other Trash Princesses are within range. On a roll of 1, she targets the nearest trash princess instead of a foe.

Daddy's Princesses—The Crib Daddy is immune to damage from trash princess Area attacks.

Hide-Hitter—The Crib Daddy's drum kit functions as a weapon rack. When he is within 15ft of it, he is never unarmed unless fully incapacitated. If he is disarmed, he immediately gains another weapon. He favors drumsticks and can't use Pocket Groove, Downbeat, or Stick-Click without them. If he loses his drumsticks, he picks up one of the following weapons: club (1d6+3, 5ft range), throwing dagger (1d4+4, 50ft range), or spear (1d8+3, 10ft range). The drum kit is immune to damage but can be picked up with a successful STR Stat Check with Difficulty 13+F. If it's not in a crawler's Inventory, it's always the item a Scat Thug steals.





NEIGHBORHOOD: PRICKLY PACK ALLEYS

FLOOR: 1 (TUTORIAL)

THEME: TESTING BULLSHIT TOLERANCE

"The Law of the Jungle might have been Survival of the Fittest. But the Law of the Dungeon is Survival of the Collaborative. Being the strongest doesn't mean much when you're completely surrounded."

—Crawler Terri C

If every Neighborhood on the First Floor is meant to be a tutorial, this one seems designed to teach crawlers two simple truths: the dungeon isn't fair, and Mobs *will* gang up on you. Like most of the First Floor, this area looks carefully carved from bluish rock with flecks of green sparkling throughout. The twisting hallways here have no rhyme or reason, and there are far fewer main thoroughfares. In their absence, a nearly endless number of smaller cramped alleyways connect in a confusing maze.

Growling, keening cries echo throughout the labyrinth, harrying crawlers from every twist and turn and making concentration impossible. When crawlers are well and truly disoriented, that's when the Mobs strike. Packs of vicious Canidnas chase crawlers into ambushes by groups of Homogenous Humors. At the heart of the Neighborhood, the Pack Alley Naturalist hides, stalking and jealously protecting the Mobs of this floor for his (sure to go unpublished) documentary.

STRONG STARTS

Here are some ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- As the crawlers explore the Neighborhood, they pass an alley intersection where six narrow passages stand, each cast in shadow. A Weak group of Canidnas jump from the darkness to attack. In the next round, more join from the alleys. Every round thereafter, more and more Canidnas join the fray until the crawlers must run deeper into the Neighborhood. This pack of Canidnas stalks the crawlers, driving them toward other threats to soften the party up. The crawlers must stay on the move or risk a potentially fatal encounter.
- The crawlers hear an ominous buzzing sound growing steadily louder. The sharp report of a gunshot sounds, and then the buzzing stops. As the crawlers approach the sound, they see a crawler (Terri Campion) dressed in what remains of a police uniform, holding a glittering shield in one hand and

a service pistol in the other. She's got a wild look in her eyes, and she asks the players if they've been backwashed while pointing her weapon at the party.

STORY ARCS

- Terri Campion is a former police officer. While she doesn't understand everything that's happening, she knows right from wrong when she sees it. She sees a crawler attack and kill another with an enchanted pickaxe. She wants to bring that crawler to justice but lost them as they entered the Packrooms. If the players can find this crawler (now a Barlie in the Pack Alley Pall), Terri will not only take them to the Boss Chamber but also help them defeat the Bar Render.
- After the first meeting with Terri, if the players find the Murdered Kua-Tin, their Game Guide (p. 6) suggests they might earn some goodwill with Borant if they can identify who or what killed the poor Borant employee. The Game Guide suggests they might let Mobs weaken whoever or whatever killed the Kua-Tin.
- Jonai is in mourning. If pressed, he explains that he's a Gnome, not a Bopca. He was supposed to be a guildmaster in a new Master-Apprentice program for this season, but they came out of stasis with the rest of the NPCs and have no assigned Tutorial Guildhall and no protections. When hiding with his apprentice in a saferoom waiting for the floor to collapse, his apprentice, Xaggra, vanished when he went to look outside to the sounds of a mysterious buzzing noise.

Unbeknownst to Jonai, Xaggra, the apprentice, is nearly finished mutating into a Barlie in a nest within the Sprawl. If given a Potion of Clarity, he can be saved. However, Xaggra has progressed far enough along in the mutation process that he will attack the players, so giving him the potion isn't simple. If the crawlers manage to save Xaggra, Jonai is grateful. The System AI might even resolve the error by assigning Jonai and/or Xaggra as the group's new Game Guide.

MOBS

Prickly Pack Alley Mobs prefer pack tactics and excel in using the narrow confusing passages of the Neighborhood to isolate and annihilate unwary crawlers.

BARFLIE

Barflies are humanoids standing roughly five-and-a-half feet tall with human bodies of different shapes, sizes, and sexes. Each of them, however, has the ruby-red compound eyes and dripping proboscis of a fly. They travel in packs of one to three but mostly keep to the Sprawl. Utterly disgusting to behold and incredibly quick but clumsy fighters, they wield simple weapons like crowbars, baseball bats, and boards with nails.

However, the Barflies' true horror lies in their backwash attack: The Barfly sprays a sickly sweet-smelling mixture upon a crawler, inflicting the Washed Debuff. If the crawler perishes before drinking a Potion of Clarity, they become a Barfly themselves, one that also wields all the Skills and Spells they possessed in life.



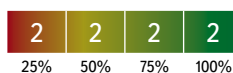
Barfly, Level 4

These formerly human creatures prefer to stick near bright lights and foul smells, often congregating in small groups, lapping up the latest buzz from around the dungeon. Here's a fun fact: we only spawned a few thousand of these guys, but there's at least three times that many now! Where'd the others come from?

Watch out for their backwash attack, or you might find yourself becoming one of these tragic creatures. The upside is that *you'll* be privy to all the latest buzz! The downside is you'll be a mutated abomination, but sometimes there's just no pleasing you people.

Barfly

Mob; Medium (4), Mutated Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	11+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	5 (+2)	4 (+2)	1 (+1)

Backwash: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Poison, 30ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Washed Debuff: If a Washed crawler perishes before drinking a Potion of Clarity, they will become a Barfly themselves, one that also wields all the Skills and Spells they possessed in life.

Club: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Notes: *Flight*—Barflies can move through the air as though on the ground and hover in place.

CANIDNA

These canine creatures are nearly identical to wolves, except for the jagged spines that cover nearly the entirety of their back and their flanks. Their stiff spines make melee attacks against them dangerous. Their eyes are smaller than those of normal wolves and shine darkly from within their narrow faces. However, their lengthened snouts give them an excellent sense of smell.

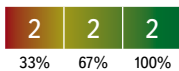
They typically hunt in packs of three to seven. When between one to three remain, it is not uncommon for them to charge crawlers before rolling into a tight ball, attempting to impale said crawlers with their strong spines. These Mobs can only be found in the Pack Halls.

Canidna, Level 3

Don't let their beady little eyes and adorable faces fool you—these spiky bastards have personalities as prickly as their appearance. They want you dead, and they're not shy about how they accomplish it! These creatures use pack tactics to harry their prey and have been known to chase crawlers across half the floor rather than giving up a meal. Whatever you do, be sure *never* to corner a Canidna. They may curl into a ball, but rest assured, *you're* the one who should be very, very afraid.

Canidna

Mob; Medium (4), Animal



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	13+F	30+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Bite: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Piercing, 5ft range

Spike Ball: 12+F to hit, 1d8+2 Piercing, 5ft range

On a Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Notes: *Pack Hunting*—When two or more Canidna are adjacent to a target and the target has no adjacent allies, the target makes Evade checks with Disadvantage.

Desperation—Canidna only use their Spike Ball attack when cornered or when their numbers have been cut in half.

MIRROR CAT

These are simple, ordinary cats. They look exactly like Hairless Sphinx Cats... from the side. Seen straight on, instead, it appears as if the cat has been perfectly bisected down the middle. This doesn't seem to bother them in the least, however.

When they spot a crawler, these Mobs immediately move to attack, using their ability to phase in and out of dimensions to strike and disappear without warning, shifting between their right and left sides with every attack. Crawlers who survived these assaults say the damage done to one side does not transfer to the other, but both sides drop dead if either is slain.

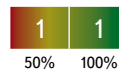
Be warned: The longer a fight with one goes on, the more of them appear. One becomes two, two become four, and so on. Typically, they make their homes in the Packrooms (though a few have been seen in the Pack Alley Palls).

Mirror Cat, Level 2

And I'll bet you thought sphinx cats couldn't get any weirder, huh? Well, watch out, because the weird doesn't stop with their bisected appearance. These guys don't make their home in holes in the ground, but in holes between dimensions. They pop in and out of these spatial holes, only showing half of themselves at any given time, making them harder to kill. To make matters worse, if you *don't* kill them, these things multiply exponentially. Hope you were good at Whack-a-Mole...

Mirror Cat

Mob; Small (2), Animal



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	11+F	13+F	30+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	2 (+1)

Claw: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Slashing, 5ft range

Phase Claw: 11+F to hit, 1d4+1 Psychic, 30ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Confused Debuff: The crawler must spend their next Action attacking an ally.

Notes: At the end of every other round, another Mirror Cat appears, until their numbers double the size of the party. Then they stop for the remainder of the combat.

PACK RATS

These giant white rats range in size from that of an ordinary rodent to that of a medium-sized dog. They scurry about the Neighborhood, eating away at any corpses left on the floor. Their fur varies in shades of gray, but in the Pack Alley Palls, their fur is snow-white, their bulging eyes as red as blood, and they look almost excited to see the crawlers. These ghostly Pack Rats appear more aggressive and intelligent, and they make no noise as they scurry about, but they're otherwise identical to their more common kin.

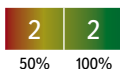
Pack Rats, Level 2

Rats. There's always rats. If you've ever played a video game before, you know killing these guys can take up your first few hours of gameplay. If you're familiar with that grind, then there's good news and bad news.

The good news is you're familiar with how this works. The bad news is these rats know you're coming, they know what you're trying to do to them, and they're ready for you. I'd elaborate further, but that would ruin the surprise.

Pack Rat

Mob; Tiny (1), Animal



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	11+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	2 (+1)	3 (+2)	4 (+2)	1 (+1)

Bite: 11+F to hit, 1d4+1 Piercing, 5ft range

HOMOGENOUS HUMORS

The Homogenous Humors resemble nothing so much as giant floating eyeballs. They silently hover through the air, slowly opening and closing their eyelids as they go. They lurk in the shadows above, where the lights of the torch don't reach, waiting to drift down to ambush unwary crawlers. Those unlucky enough to be caught in their gaze find their thoughts confused and their feet sluggish.

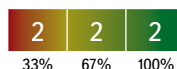
However, the true power of these creatures is that, as blobs of floating goo, they're largely immune to ranged weapons and blunt weapons. Worse yet, several of them can combine together, increasing in size and toughness. They travel in packs of two to six.

Homogenous Humors, Level 3

Silent and vicious, the Homogenous Humors are the literal definition of the "Evil Eye." Those caught in their paralyzing gaze soon have great difficulty thinking or moving. If you find more than two of them in the same vicinity, you probably want to keep them separate. If they merge together, there's no telling how big they can get. Trust me: you don't want to "see" what happens then.

Homogenous Humors

Mob; Medium (4), Aberration



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	13+F	12+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Evil Eye: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Necrotic, 50ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Fatigued Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Homogenous Humors can move through the air as though on the ground and hover in place.

If two or more of these Mobs are within 5ft of each other, they will merge into a single larger creature. This merged form gains +1 to hit and +1 damage die for each additional creature that merged into it.

ENVIRONMENT

The Prickly Pack Alleys are a classic Tutorial Floor Neighborhood. Most of the area looks like an ancient Earth dungeon that would fit in almost any video game, with one exception: while the area appears to be made of uniform bricks and stone, all of these are carved from a rock that glitters bluish-green. Speckles within the rock shine in the flickering light of the torches that punctuate the walls.

Very few "main" hallways track through this part of the dungeon, but each hall is at least large enough to drive a full-size car through with plenty of room. At first glance, these wide thoroughfares seem straight, but a slight curve creates subtle twists and turns, making navigation difficult.

The smaller alleyways, no more than six feet wide, run alongside these larger paths. They twist and turn in a labyrinth, sometimes running for miles before spitting the crawlers out less than ten feet from where they started. They can avoid this happening more than once with an Unopposed Tracking Skill Check. Otherwise, crawlers can pay special attention to either their minimaps or maps they create and slowly learn how to navigate these alleys to save time, but beware: the cramped nature of these alleys makes them ideal for ambushes.



TRAPS

In the Prickly Pack Alleys, crawlers are far more likely to find ambushes than they are to encounter traps. However, in a few places, the party may run afoul of these traditional traps:

- **Topographical Disorientation Trap:** Displayed as runes upon the ground in the rough shape of a compass rose, they're incredibly difficult to see at first glance. If crawlers fail to notice them, the rune illuminates, followed by a bright light flash (potentially drawing the attention of nearby Mobs), and their minimaps scramble before failing entirely. This effect lasts until 30 hours have elapsed, or until a crawler sleeps or ingests a Potion of Clarity.
- **Neon and Chromed:** As the crawlers traverse the Sprawl, they come upon a dazzling array of bright neon lights with advertisements displayed in Syndicate Standard. At first, they seem like normal advertisements, but as the crawlers approach, the lights begin to change colors. They blink faster and faster, disorienting any crawler who Fails a CON Stat Check. Then a Moderate group of Barflies attack, targeting the disoriented crawlers, who cannot perform Actions other than Evade Checks with Disadvantage during the first round of combat.

ITEMS

While the Prickly Pack Alleys themselves are barren of most items or distinguishing marks, a few unusual items left behind by someone or something litter the quarters.

- **Packrooms Office Furniture:** A desk, a rolling chair, and a filing cabinet. All of these are empty, clearly part of a set, and identical apart from varying degrees of wear and tear.
- **Packing Crates:** Crates of beer sit outside or nearby some Barfly nests. It's rotgut, but do you care?
- **Cable Reels:** Found in the Sprawl and Pack Alley Pall, these large industrial wooden spools are wrapped in electrical cabling.
- **Abandoned Duffel Bag:** Packed for an overnight camping trip, this duffel has been emptied of everything but outdoorsy clothes.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood, each with its own reward.

- **Flying Blind:** "Thanks to a trap, a Mob attack, or something else outside your control, your map failed! Hope you took notes in cartography class.
Reward: You've received a Bronze Adventurer Box."
- **Another Round:** "You got hit by a Barfly's backwash attack. If I were you, I'd find something a little stronger than mouthwash to negate that stink.
Reward: You've received a Silver That's Enough Box."
Box Contents: A Potion of Clarity, which has specific uses in this Neighborhood.
- **Regular Customer:** "You just walked past the same place for the fifteenth time. You must *really* like this place.
Reward: You've received a Bronze Adventurer Box."
- **Manifest Space:** "You survived the Packrooms and emerged stronger for the experience!
Reward: Did you not hear me? You emerged from the Packrooms, stronger for the experience."

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: PACKED HALLS

This is the largest part of the Neighborhood and the one that crawlers likely enter first. It's the most "normal" of all the quarters. The number of offshoot alleyways and smaller paths absolutely dwarfs the number of wide thoroughfares, making it extremely easy to get turned around.

- As the party acclimates, navigating the maze-like passages of the Packed Halls, they spot a Weak group of Canidnas tearing at the body of a deceased crawler. Even as they watch, the Canidnas begin growling as a Strong group of Pack Rats starts eating some dead Canidnas the crawler must've killed. At first, it seems as if the two groups of Mobs might fight it out, but then you have second thoughts. Each crawler may attempt an INT-Opposed Animal Handling Skill Check, choosing either Canidna or Pack Rat. If there are no Successes against a side, that side attacks the crawlers. Which means if there are no Successes at all, all of the Mobs attack the crawlers.
- The party is hopelessly lost in the narrow pack alleys. Their minimaps reveal they've managed to make it almost as far away from a main thoroughfare as they can get. They haven't slept in some time, and they're beginning to get hungry. Just then, Terri Champion (or another crawler if Terri is deceased) rounds the corner with a physical map in hand. It's crude and drawn in pen on notebook paper, but it's enough to help them get to the nearest saferoom... if they can

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Crawlers desiring more experience may make the mistake of braving the twisting passages of the Prickly Pack Alleys, and in doing so, they risk more than simple confrontations with Mobs. In here, people risk losing more than just their way. Roll 1d20.

TABLE 5: PRICKLY PACK ALLEY GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The players are hopelessly lost in the maze of the Sprawl, losing $1d6 \times 10$ as a percentage (10–60%) of lost Time to Floor Collapse. There are no saferooms nearby, the crawlers' maps aren't updating, and a Strong group of Homogenous Humors descend from the ceiling to confuse and scatter them further.
2	The party finds three Pack Rats fighting over a scrap of paper. It reads like a last will and testament written in blood. Nearby, the blue dot of a crawler heads directly toward a cavernous chamber with several Mobs inside. Whatever the fate of the crawler, it's likely they'll lead the party to good loot.
3	Two Barflies drag a paralyzed crawler into what looks like the entrance to a Barfly nest. The crawler begs for help. Based on the description of the Barflies, it's easy to understand why.
4	The party rounds a bend to find what looks like a broken-down Jeep left at an intersection. Smoke roils from beneath the hood. What's left of a crawler corpse is slumped over the wheel. Their Inventory is empty, and it's clear the Pack Rats were gnawing at them. A trail of blood and oil leads deeper into the Neighborhood.
5	Crawlers find a corpse without a dot. It's immediately obvious that this is the corpse of a Kua-Tin admin alien killed by a gunshot. As the players approach, the System AI warns that approaching may be dangerous.
6	The party sees a blue X on their minimap, indicating a dead crawler nearby. Following it, they find themselves embroiled in a confrontation. Three other crawlers (the dead crawler's party) fight over a Potion of Clarity. Weapons are drawn, and while the rival party won't attack the PCs on sight, it wouldn't take much to provoke them.
7+	See Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications (p. 13).

convince Terri to give it up, accompany them, or let them copy it.

- The crawlers find themselves in an area notably free of any Mobs. At first, they may suspect it's simply good fortune, or someone else cleaned them all out, but an appropriate Skill or Stat Check tells them there's a very clear odor in the air. Following this to its source leads them to a wall, blank but for the graffiti: "The Pawn may fear the King in his Castle, or the Priest on his Path, but safety is found in the Darkness of the Knight."
- A crude drawing on the wall shows a pawn facing down a rook, a bishop, and a nearby knight. If the players tap on the brick closest to the knight, where the pawn would be momentarily safe if it moved to, they reveal it's hollow. Within lies a fine potion of Pack Repellant that keeps all Neighborhood Mobs, except the Barflies, away for fifteen hours.

QUARTER: PACK ALLEY PALL

There's a slight change to the hue of the stone in this area: it slowly fades from bluish-green to a pale gray. The farther into this quarter they venture, the fewer ambient sounds they hear. There is also a distinct lack of torches, but the area still glows with a dull ambient light coming from the stones themselves.

- The alleyways gradually open up, becoming straighter and more uniform until forming a steady grid-like pattern of wide thoroughfares. Contrary to the area's comfort, however, its color and silence give it an uneasy feel compared to the rest of the Neighborhood.
- The crawlers encounter words spray-painted on the wall: "We are all dead, and this is Hell." Before it, the stones of the floor have been removed and scattered, and a hole in the earth yawns wide. As the crawlers approach, a ghostly white Pack Rat attempts to trip them (make a DEX Stat Check or



suffer the Take Down Debuff) into the grave, where a Weak group of Pack Rats attacks the prone crawler with Advantage.

Regardless of whether a crawler fell into the hole, a freshly-created-crawler-turned Barflie attacks within the next round as a Moderate group of Homogenous Humors attacks from the other direction. The Barflie has a crawler number and attacks as a Level 5 (one extra HB slot, 16 to hit, and deals 2dX damage.

- The deeper into the quarter the crawlers explore, the less the areas between roads look like walls, and the more they start to resemble tombs. Gradually, the crawlers realize they're staring at actual tombs repurposed from the collapse. One crawler notices a specific mention on an epitaph that the deceased was a "beloved grandparent." A crack (or several) sounds from around the corner, and they notice another crawler trying to break open the tomb to see if any valuables linger within.
- Deep within the sepulchral quarter, crawlers notice white Pack Rats disappearing into a crack in the wall from which a sliver of orange light appears. If they peer through, they see the interior of a small tomb with a sarcophagus inside without its lid. Is the sarcophagus protected by a trap? You tell me. Should they find a way to break through the wall into the tomb, they find a real skeleton with an enchanted weapon lying across it and a Potion of Clarity beside it.

QUARTER: THE PACKROOMS

This is technically the smallest of the quarters, although the Neighborhood's overall confusion makes it impossible to tell whether this is true. The party's first warning they've entered the Packrooms is the lowering ceiling, followed by passages gradually opening up until each is an identical room approximately twenty feet by twenty feet, all containing old-style office furniture. Crawlers that turn around note the same rooms seem to extend in all directions with no obvious path back the way they came. There are no true saferooms in this quarter (but each room has a restroom).

- Their minimap ceases to function (accompanied by a notification warning them of such), and an eerie silence lingers throughout the space. Only their own footsteps, movements, and words provide any sort of sound. As the players move from one office to the next, they realize exactly how identical and never-ending these rooms are until, at last, they hear a meow and see what appears to be a sphinx cat sitting on a

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- *You emerge onto a main thoroughfare—finally. Now you just have to decide: right or left?*
Outcome: Going right leads to an ambush by a Moderate group of Canidnas, and going left attracts a Strong group of Homogenous Humors that drop from above.
- *The mouths of the different alleys you pass begin to blend together. You turn a corner and wonder if you've gone in a big circle. Tracking Skill helps.*
Outcome: Checking your minimap is useless; it's still updating. Checking any hand-drawn map reveals you're making progress.
- *A Canidna pup emerges from around a corner, sits, and wags its tail at the crawlers. It's cute—possibly too cute.*
Outcome: Attacking the pup or trying to walk away causes it to bark, summoning a Strong pack of very territorial Canidnas. Feeding it keeps it quiet.

desk, licking its paw. Hearing them, it turns, revealing only half a cat... right before it hisses and jumps at the party. Every two rounds, if at least one Mirror Cat still lives and is in combat with the party, another Mirror Cat appears, up to double the size of the party.

- As the crawlers traverse the Packrooms, they notice that nothing they do seems to stick. Chairs they moved are moved back if they return later. Although they can take pieces of furniture into their Inventory, they reappear where they once stood, and no more than one of each piece of furniture (a desk, a rolling chair, and a filing cabinet) can exist in their Inventory. Every ninth room, a typewriter sits upon a desk with a sheet of paper in its spool that reads "In is out, and out is in. We've seen too much, and that's a sin. Freedom comes from clarity, not without, but from within."
- There are two ways to escape the Packrooms: One is to drink a Potion of Clarity, which immediately transforms the nearest exit between two rooms into an exit to the Packed Halls. The other is to grapple or grab a Mirror Cat while it phases. This takes the individual (only one!) from the Packrooms to the Pack Alley Palls. Crawlers who do this successfully still have an angry psychic cat Mob to deal with!

QUARTER: THE SPRAWL

This quarter is a bit more colorful than the others in the Neighborhood. Every so often, large decaying panes of glass, covered in heavy globs of sticky dust, segment the stone of the walls. Some of these flash with what looks like neon within. Occasionally, a door sits between the two panes of glass. In reality, these are Barflie nests, and players that stare for too long may trigger a “Neon and Chromed” trap and run afoul of Barflies.

- Players who are curious, brave, or unlucky enough may find themselves inside the Barflie nest. These are bars or taverns ripped straight from Earth and covered in what looks like decades of decay. A Weak group of Barflies are active at any one time, but nearby, corpses of crawlers slowly mutate into Barflies. If the ensuing battle doesn’t conclude in three rounds (or unless the corpses are otherwise prevented from mutating further), additional Weak groups of Barflies join the fight each round.
- The crawlers may try to explore an abandoned or otherwise cleaned-out Barflie nest. Within, they find old alcohol of a higher quality than in the crates that dot the Sprawl. They also find the corpses of several crawlers, none of them holding anything but minor loot. However, they can also find alchemical ingredients: Barflie residue used as an ingredient in several potions once an Alchemy Table is acquired.
- However, one of these Barflie nests differs from the others: grander and larger. A sign emblazoned overhead read “Patti Render’s Beer and Tenders—Bar and Grill.” This is the Bar Render Boss Chamber (refer to *B-B-B-Boss Battle* below for more information).

NPCS

JONAI

Jonai is a former crawler who was supposed to become a guildmaster in a Tutorial Guild this season for a new challenge. He was going to have a really good deal, and was looking forward to the end of his indentureship after a few seasons. He should be training additional Tutorial Guildmasters in an on-the-job training program. His Gnome form resembles a Bopca.

Borant, however, screwed him over. The new Tutorial Guild program he contracted for didn’t materialize, and system glitches left him and his trainee Xaggra

without an assigned Tutorial Guild. The two of them have since wandered the dungeon like crawlers, without any special protection and unable to benefit from other Tutorial Guilds themselves. Unfortunately, Xaggra got captured, and now Jonai thinks Xaggra is dead. Now, Jonai just keeps his head down, waiting in a saferoom, hoping to run out the clock on his indentureship term. Although, if someone offered to find out what became of his friend, Jonai might be very grateful.

Jonai—Gnome SYSTEM ERROR Master, Level 5

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

This SYSTEM ERROR once had an apprentice working with him... you know what? I’m not going to lie to you. This poor sucker shouldn’t be here. The mudskippers scrapped the Guildmaster-Apprentice program, and his contract keeps him here until the floor collapses. He’s got no protections and no real prospects either. What’s worse, curiosity got the best of his poor trainee Xaggra, who left the saferoom. The last Jonai heard of Xaggra, he was dragged down the hallway, the sound of his screams lost amid a horrid buzzing. Jonai can still hear his trainee’s shrieks when he closes his eyes.

TERRI CAMPION

Terri’s life before the dungeon was one of toil and drudgery. She was born in Detroit, and she dreamed of making the city safer. She did everything she could to prepare for her eventual job. She went to college, trained in her off-hours, and dedicated herself to becoming a champion of justice. The day she graduated from the police academy was the happiest day of her life. She couldn’t wait to join the force and make a difference.

It was such a shame the force didn’t feel the same about her. Terri saw herself as a knight, protecting her kingdom. The force saw her more as a meter maid. However, that all changed when the dungeon opened up. She didn’t know what she’d find down there, except for people who might need her help. Her first box gave her the Knight’s Shield. She knew she’d made the right choice.

Crawler #13,123,444. “Terri Cam.”

Level 7.

Race: Human.

Class: Not yet assigned.



XAGGRA

The apprentice to Jonai, Xaggra is supposed to be a guildmaster in training on the same bunk contract as Jonai. He didn't yet understand all the rules and dangers of the dungeon, especially when he thought being a guildmaster's apprentice meant safeguards were still in place. While Jonai was occupied trying to figure out what went wrong before the arrival of the crawlers, Xaggra heard a strange buzzing sound from the saferoom door.

Hoping the glitch would be corrected when he met his first crawler, Xaggra threw open the door and stepped out to greet the adventurers, only to get hit by two Barflies' backwash attacks.

He doesn't remember what came next, but he does know his head feels awfully itchy lately. And his eyesight's gotten better. And he's got the strangest feeling in his throat...

Xaggra, Gnome SYSTEM ERROR Trainee, Level 3

This poor creature clearly *used* to be a Gnome. Someone contracted this sucker for a now-scrapped Guildmaster-Apprentice program. Now he's something out of a nightmare, halfway through the transformation into a hideous Barflie. At first glance, there appear to be diamonds where his eyes should be. However, when those "diamonds" blink, it's clear you're staring into formerly humanoid eyeballs in the middle of mutating into compound monstrosities. His skin bristles with hair, and he can no longer speak—only buzz.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The moment the crawlers enter the Boss arena, the door locks behind them, and two beefy-looking Barflies sidle into view next to the bar.

A monotone voice calls out, "Sometimes, legalities are civil. Sometimes, they're criminal. This time? They're a full-on battle royale. This is a bar room Boss Battle." The image of a cartoon courthouse manifests around a portrait of the Bar Render Boss with the word "Defendant" beneath her title. Below that, the word "Plaintiffs" appears, followed by the portraits of the crawlers.

The Bar Render is a formidable older woman in a dusty-gray suit and spectacles. She stands nine feet tall and holds glasses in each hand. She calls out pseudo-

legal puns like "bar to clear" as she jumps atop the bar, or "I wish I didn't have to drop your case" as she hurls a case of alcohol at the party.

She fights mostly with long-range improvised explosives (most akin to Molotov cocktails) as a never-ending stream of Barflies dressed as bailiffs try to keep the crawlers back (though never more than two at once). When finally slain, the Bar Render falls back, looks up gratefully at the players, and says, "The defense... rests."

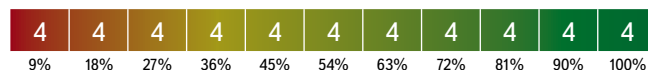
The Bar Render. Former Lawyer, Current Bartender—Real done with cleaning up your mess
Level 8 Neighborhood Boss!

Once upon a time, Patti dreamed of defending her fellow man from the twisted, perverted farce you know as the justice system. She utterly crushed the BAR exam and became an attorney, a public defender, and a tireless advocate for justice. For thirty years, she did everything she could for everyone she could, serving those most vulnerable and most in need.

It's a shame that it only ever amounted to a few pitiful thank-yous and just enough cash to buy this miserable place, to which she's dedicated her retirement years. These days, she feels almost as broken down as the bar itself. Still, she's got enough piss and vinegar in her to lay down the law on your asses.

The Bar Render

Neighborhood Boss; Large (5), Humanoid

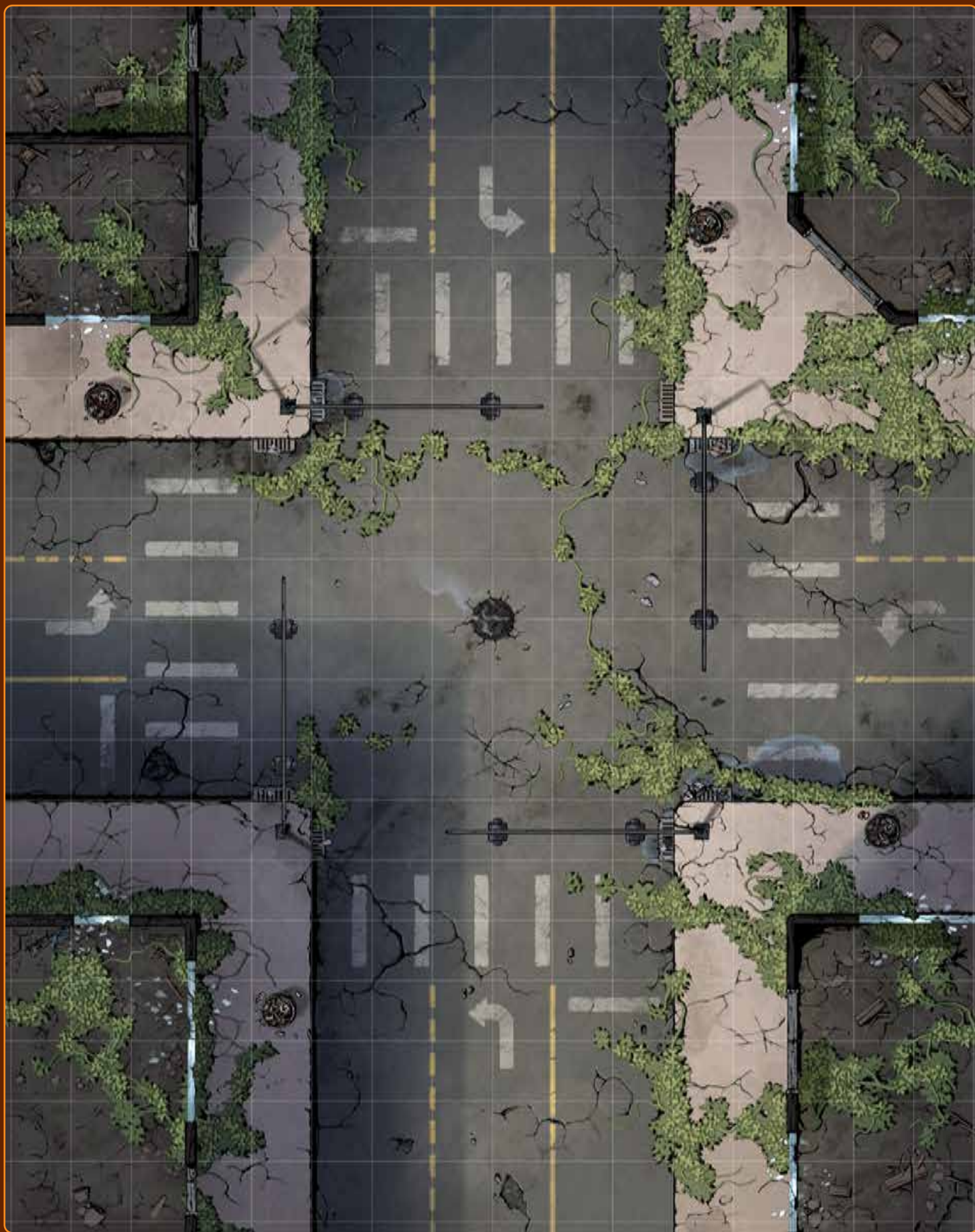


Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
8	14+F	14+F	30+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
11 (+4)	10 (+4)	11 (+4)	11 (+4)	6 (+3)

Fiery Cocktail: 14+F to hit, 1d8+4 Fire, 30ft range, 10ft Blast radius

Punch: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: She has two Barflies joining her in the fight at all times until she is dead.





NEIGHBORHOOD: SERVING WARRENS

FLOOR: 1 (TUTORIAL)

THEME: HACKNEYED ATTEMPT FOR BACKDOOR PILOT

"How strong can a bunch of Rats be?"

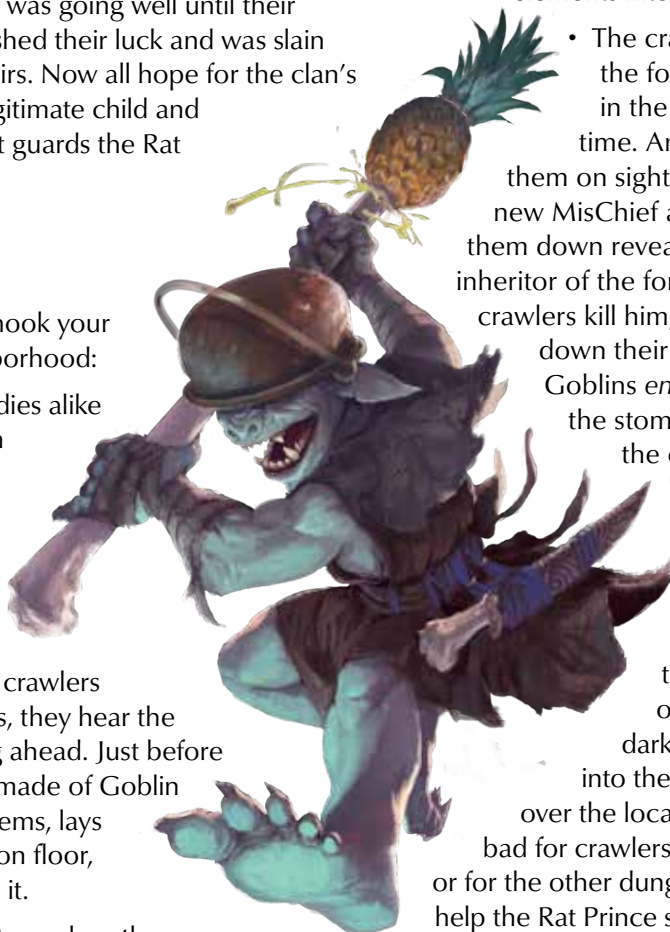
—The Last Words of Crawler George Bon 3

The Serving Warrens are the home of an ambitious clan of Rat-kin. They sought to supplant the Goblins and Kobolds as the "default" Mob and usher in a new golden age for Rat-kin. It was going well until their leader, the MisChief, pushed their luck and was slain along with his rightful heirs. Now all hope for the clan's future rests upon his illegitimate child and the Interim MisChief that guards the Rat Bastard.

STRONG STARTS

Here are some ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- Goblin and Rat-kin bodies alike lay scattered, locked in the throes of death. Furred hands are locked tightly around green throats, with Goblin pineapple pikes buried into Rat-kin breasts. As the crawlers step through the chaos, they hear the din of battle still raging ahead. Just before the crawlers, a crown made of Goblin Bones, studded with gems, lays fallen upon the dungeon floor, blood pooled beneath it.
- As the crawlers begin to explore the Neighborhood, they nearly trip over the body of a regal-looking Rat-kin with three heads. A drumbeat sounds, and several voices locked in unison begin to sing Queen's "Don't Stop Me Now." A moment later, a procession rounds a corner, led by a Rat Shaman mounted upon a Chilly Goat and flanked by two Rat Brutes. They all stop dead, taking in the scene of the crawlers and the corpse of the MisChief. Without waiting for an explanation, the Rat-kin charge the crawlers, engaging them in a life-or-death battle.



STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine essential Neighborhood elements into ready-to-go adventures:

- The crawlers are blamed for slaying the former MisChief, having arrived in the wrong place at the wrong time. Any Rat-kin attempt to kill them on sight. Several of them mention a new MisChief and a Rat Bastard. Chasing them down reveals the Rat Bastard is the sole inheritor of the former MisChief's title. If the crawlers kill him, the Rat-kin will surely lay down their arms and stop slaughtering Goblins *en masse*—if the crawlers have the stomach for it. After all, although the crawlers may not know it, the Rat Bastard is only a child going through his tragic origin story.
- The Rat Prince is the son of the former Rat-King, seeking the tails of his parents and two other Rat-kin to try to perform a dark ritual. This will transform him into the new Rat-King and let him take over the local population. This may prove bad for crawlers who come after the party or for the other dungeon Mobs. However, if they help the Rat Prince succeed, it may gain them a powerful ally for the Boss Battle and direct access to a stairwell.
- Bethany Dow is a crawler struggling through the pain of loss, grief, and anxiety. If she's not shaken out of this, she will almost assuredly end up slain. It takes time and gentle care, but if the crawlers interact with her three times before the end of the floor, she has a chance to recover—at least enough to get angry about what Borant took from her.

MOBS

The Mobs of the Serving Warrens are typically Rat-kin or those they've pressed into their service.

CHILLY GOAT

The Chilly Goats were originally created as beasts of burden on some distant snow-covered world. Their hardiness, intelligence, and adaptability made them ideal for use as mounts or pack animals. At least, it would have, if their fanged maws and rapacious appetites didn't make them prone to devouring their riders and handlers the moment they get hungry.

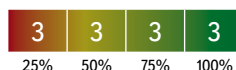
It's said that only those who match their viciousness have nothing to fear from them. While their horns and fangs are certainly terrifying, the real danger lies in the icy aura they can project in moments of fear and panic.

Chilly Goat, Level 4

"The Chilly Goat's Bluff" is a phrase common throughout the Syndicate. It's a "polite" way of saying the person in front of you is most likely a cold and unfeeling fucking sociopath. Derivations and corruptions of the phrase appear in various forms throughout the galaxy (meaning your backwater planet built a whole legend around a cosmic misspelling). All of this to say, it's probably a good time to choose how you want to die. Impaled by horns? Ripped apart by fangs? Or frozen solid? If you ask nicely, maybe you can have all three.

Chilly Goat

Mob; Petite (3), Fanged Goat



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	11+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
5 (+2)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	4 (+2)	1 (+1)

Horns: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Piercing, 5ft range

Fangs: 11+F to hit, 1d4+3 Piercing, 5ft range

Icy Aura: 11+F to hit, 1d6+3 Ice, 15ft Burst radius, once every three rounds

Notes: *Already Chilly*—Immune to Cold Damage.

Prefers Being Chilly—Fire deals ×2 damage to Chilly Goats.





FIRE-FIGHTER

Among the least of the Fire Elementals, these shapeless blobs of living fire are summoned from the endless wastelands of Sheol. It is said that one is formed anytime a victim of a demon lets out their first scream. While they remain loyal to their summoner, they're not terribly intelligent.

Additionally, because of their intangible nature, they can squeeze through anything that's not airtight. They can recognize simple commands, and they're incredibly quick and hardy. Being made of living fire, most weapons don't actually hurt them. One needs magic, enchanted weapons, or plain old water to deal damage to them.

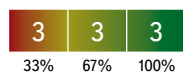
Fire-Fighter, Level 3

At first, you may have made the mistake of thinking this was your garden-variety floating tuft of fire. Given that it's zooming directly at your face now, you've likely realized you were wrong. Congratulations! You were *very* wrong.

The Fire-Fighter is a Fire Elemental summoned from Sheol to serve as a foot-soldier. They're bound to serve their summoner's orders, even after the death of their summoner. While they're incredibly quick and doggedly persistent, they are, ironically, not particularly bright. Still, you don't have to be the brightest bulb in the pack when you're literally a living ball of fire. Oh, and you should probably note that normal weapons won't have any effect on these fiery bastards.

Fire-Fighter

Mob; Small (2), Minor Fire Elemental



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	14+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	10 (+4)	1 (+1)

Firey Touch: 14+F to hit, 1d6+4 Fire, 5ft range

Notes: *Intangibility*—Cannot be harmed by non-Spell damage. Contact with water will destroy this creature immediately.

RAT-KIN

RAT BRUTE

The Rat-kin Brutes of this Neighborhood are loyal soldiers to their MisChief. They're tough, strong, and only slightly likely to betray their friends for a good bit of wine or cheese. They wear leather armor crafted from the skin of Goblins and carry crossbows heavy enough to punch straight through metal, but they much prefer to use their vicious mattocks to bury any opponents stupid enough to get close to them.

Rat Brute, Level 4

Are you afraid of rats? How about rats tall enough to look you in the eye and strong enough to break you in half? The Rat Brute is a force of raw physical power and sheer ferocity. The muscles in their jaws alone can shear through steel. These guys are deranged, too. They carry mattocks just because they like the feeling of steel slamming into flesh. On the plus side, you can always tell when they're happy because of their bulging eyes. Just don't ask what they're thinking about.

Rat Brute

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	11+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Knife: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Slashing, 5ft range

Crossbow: 12+F to hit, 1d8 Piercing, 50ft range

Notes: *Roid Rage*—Rat Brutes are very volatile: sudden noises, bright lights, or perceived insults can trigger an immediate rage response. This doubles the Stat Mod bonus to their damage rolls. In addition, their chemical-fueled endurance allows them to push through pain and fight past "reasonable" limits. Rat Brutes can attack one more time after they have been reduced to 0% HB.

Weak-Minded—Rat Brutes are difficult to Intimidate, but attempts to charm and other mind-control effects are made with Advantage.

RAT HOOLIGAN

The most intelligent of Rats become Hooligans. The Rat Hooligan has trained in both combat and magic. They are clever, quiet, and above all, adaptable. These are the assassins, leaders, and, perhaps surprisingly, oftentimes the healers of this Neighborhood's Rat-kin.

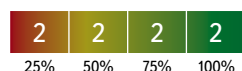
Their more magically-inclined brethren—the Rat Shamans—focus almost exclusively on offensive magic and finding more efficient ways of setting enemies on fire. Therefore, it's often left to Hooligans to ensure that any Rat casualties are handled, either through their healing magics or one last *coup de grace* from the needlelike swords they carry as their weapon of choice.

Rat Hooligan, Level 4

This is the most versatile of all the Rat-kin in this Neighborhood. While they don't train as diligently in either combat or magic as their kin, the sheer versatility of what they can do is terrifying in its own right. The Brute will smash you. The Shaman will fireball you. But the Hooligan? The Hooligan can do any or all of that and more besides. Take some small comfort that you can see this one. There are plenty who never realize the Hooligan is there until it's far too late.

Rat Hooligan

Mob; Petite (3), Rat Hybrid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	12+F	12+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	4 (+2)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	4 (+2)

Longsword: 12+F to hit, 1d8+2 Slashing, 5ft range

Firebolt Spell: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Fire, 30 ft range

Heal Others Spell: None, –1d4, 10ft range

This is a healing Spell that heals one target within 10 feet for 1d4 Health Bar slots.

RAT SHAMAN

This creature is the unrivaled master of magic among the Rat-kin Mobs. They're not as strong as their brutish brethren, and they're not as smart as the Rat Hooligans. However, that doesn't matter when you can throw literal fire into the faces of your enemy.

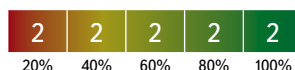
Shamans are unique in that they have an unhealthy obsession with fire and use as much of it as possible at every opportunity. They typically decorate their staves and clubs with the bones of former aspirants to the role of Shaman.

Rat Shaman, Level 5

Rats typically have a healthy fear of fire, just like almost everything else. Rat Shamans have a decidedly *unhealthy* obsession with it. As part of their training, the up-and-coming Rat Shaman must light a fire and dance through it until they have utterly lost their fear of the flame. Rats who do this and manage to avoid catching fire are clubbed to death by their classmates, as it is believed they have been rejected by the fire. Unfortunately, this means many Shamans are scarred both inside and out. You can usually hear one of these pyromaniacs coming by the heavy hacking sound of their coughs.

Rat Shaman

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	14+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	10 (+4)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)

Clap Cloud Spell: 14+F to hit, 1d4+4 Force, 50ft range, 20ft Blast radius

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Queasy Debuff.

Firestrike Spell: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Fire, 30ft range, (once every other round)

Mini Fireball Spell: 14+F to hit, 1d6+4 Fire, 60ft range, 5ft Blast radius

ENVIRONMENT

The Serving Warrens have vastly different physical makeups depending on where in the Neighborhood you are. The Walls, for instance, appear to be a good deal like the rest of the dungeon: heavy gray stone set in regularly spaced brickwork (although the blood definitely lends it some character).

The Tunnels are a series of small, low-ceilinged tubules drilled directly into the rock and stone, and the Cold Halls are multiple layers of what was once an incredibly-large self-storage complex. Meanwhile, the Sewers are exactly what they sound like: disgusting, surprisingly large tunnels with ankle-deep, foul-smelling water flowing through them.

Here are some formations and elements the crawlers are likely to encounter in the environment of the Serving Warrens:



- **Storage Units:** Thanks to Rat-kin ingenuity, the many different storage units throughout the Cold Halls Quarter were converted into interim stables and ad-hoc prison cells. Anyone who finds themselves captured by the Rat-kin should hope they get thrown into an unoccupied unit.
- **Corpses:** Throughout much of this Neighborhood linger the signs of battle, with corpses of both Goblins and Rats alike scattered throughout.
- **Side-Passages:** A complex system of twisting passages forms the Tunnels. Side tunnels connect from above, to the side, diagonally, and from below. Most of these are too small to fit someone larger than a small child (or a Rat Hooligan).
- **Sewer Water:** The Sewers typically consist of narrow walkways to either side of a wide, shallow canal. The central canal is typically about ten feet deep, but most often, only ankle-deep water flows through it.

TRAPS

The Rat-kin of this Neighborhood are proficient ambushers and harbor a fondness for traps (with the exception of Brutes, who prefer a more straightforward approach).

- **Gas Pockets:** Methane gas pockets float through the Sewers, invisible and often undetectable until it's too late. If you can smell it strongly, then a Shaman, Hooligan, or Fire-Fighter is likely preparing to light it up.
- **Murder Holes:** Almost all of this Neighborhood's quarters feature murder holes set into the walls and ceilings. These are the only type of trap that Brutes actually like. They happily fire through these narrow holes, peppering unwary enemies with crossbow bolts or scalding hot liquid from above.
- **Trapdoors:** Difficult to spot and efficient, Rat Hooligans and Shamans hide in these and wait for crawlers to walk above them before sliding out and attacking from behind.
- **Emptied Unit:** Walking through the Cold Halls can be especially dangerous, as Rats or Chilly Goats may lurk in almost any of the former storage units, waiting to spring forth and attack anyone foolish enough to approach.
- **Fire Pits:** The darkness of the Tunnels can be difficult to navigate, whether in the main arteries or the smaller corridors that connect from above, to the side, and below. Occasionally, small pits are dug into the tunnels' floors with a grate laid over them. As crawlers step across the top, Fire-Fighters leap



upward from below, floating directly through the grate in an ambush.

- **Corpse Trap:** Rat Hooligans cover themselves in blood and arrange themselves beside other Goblin and Rat corpses, springing to attack the moment no one is looking directly at them.

ITEMS

- **Random Scrap:** Some of the Storage Units in the Cold Halls were not emptied out. Crawlers may find all manner of items, from furniture to makeup to old antiques, throughout them. No true weapons remain, as those were removed, but the possibilities for other treasure buried in the hoard of junk are endless.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards:

- **Rat Regicide Rip-Off:** You killed a king! Okay, so you didn't actually kill a king. But his people think you did, and that's almost as good, right?
Reward: C'mon. You didn't *really* kill a king, so you don't *really* get a reward.
- **Bloodthirsty Butcher:** Not content with only the reputation of wiping out a Regent, you tried to kill the rightful heir to the crown! You really don't give a fuck, do you?
Reward: You've received a Silver Asshole's Box!

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Crawlers who choose to muck about in the Serving Warrens for longer than necessary may face one or more of the following complications while grinding. Roll 1d20.

TABLE 6: SERVING WARRENS GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A loud shrieking draws the crawlers into a room just in time to see a bizarre metal “art piece.” Crawlers who get too close may recognize it’s a Goblin coated in rapidly-cooling molten metal, just in time to hear a snickering sound from above as a Rat-kin Hooligan starts pouring again.
2	Six Rat-kin corpses are positioned around a table with a birthday cake. Crawler Bethany Dow sits at the head of the table, sobbing happily as she unwraps a box containing a silver ring. She thanks one of the corpses effusively before noticing the crawler party and smiling at them.
3	In the distance, the scent of cooking meat draws the crawlers. As they approach, they see a group of five Rat-kin surrounding a fire, with the sixth of them forcing his arm into the flame and pulling it back with a delighted scream. The others surround him, gifting him the staff and robe of a Shaman.
4	An explosion rocks the walls of the dungeon, followed by a demented cackle. Shortly thereafter, the crawlers watch as the NPC Goblin Stinking Pete shoves a lit stick of dynamite down the neck of a severed Rat Brute head and tosses it down a corridor to detonate a group of Rat-kin. As the crawlers approach, he calls out, “Goblover? Or Ratmeat?”
5	A Rat-kin appears to press himself into a hidden passage. If the crawlers attempt to follow, they’ll hear a loud coughing sound, then the wall explodes with a giant fireball as the Shaman blasts it onto the crawlers. The Rat Shaman and other Rat-kin then attack anyone who wasn’t buried in the initial blast.
6	A fire has spread out of control and rages through the quarter. Rat-kin (except Shamans) flee and refuse to fight. Fire-Fighters and Rat Shamans, however, become more aggressive as they hunt the crawlers.
7+	See Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications (p. 13).

- **Merciful (Rube):** You allowed the child of a charismatic, bloodthirsty dictator to go free. I’m sure that won’t come back to bite you in the ass.
Reward: You’ve received a Gold Sequelbait Box!

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: THE WALLS

Immediately upon entering this quarter, Crawlers encounter a scene of violence. Rat-kin and Goblin corpses lay scattered throughout the hallways and corridors. Their blood mixes and stains the dark-gray flagstones. A distant din of ongoing battle echoes almost the entire time the crawlers spend in the quarter.

- The sounds of dry coughs and rustling cloth announce a Rat-kin war party. A Weak group of Rat Brutes digs through the corpses of slain Goblins as a Rat Shaman atop a Chilly Goat stares into the flame of a hovering Fire-Fighter. If the crawlers aren’t

stealthy in their approach, a hidden Rat Hooligan warns the war party of the group’s arrival, and a fight ensues. Whether the crawlers manage to surprise them or not, the Rats won’t allow any parley or attempts at peace.

- When the crawlers leave a saferoom or Tutorial Guild, Michael, a Rat-kin, is waiting for them, hands outspread and his weapon on the ground in front of him. This dirty Hooligan offers a truce, claiming he is a member of the former line of succession and wants to help the crawlers unseat the current MisChief and his Rat Bastard. However, he needs help: specifically, the severed tails of both of his late parents for their Power, plus a live Rat Shaman, and a live Rat Brute. He will not explain further.
- If the crawlers agree to Michael’s proposition (or they read the directions from the note on his corpse), he offers them help in the only way he currently can: He reveals the hidden location of a potion specifically designed to make Rat-kin sleep (and allow them to be added to a crawler’s Inventory for the duration of the Floor). The crawlers can find it in a remote corner of the quarter, hidden underneath



a specific flagstone identical to the others. It only opens after crawlers tap out "Three Blind Mice" upon it.

QUARTER: THE COLD HALLS

Unlike the aftermath apparent in the Walls Quarter, the crawlers find almost no carnage in this quarter, and what's here is localized to the entrance. The entrance was clearly the lobby of a self-storage complex at one point, but served as a tavern of sorts until the battle. The Rat-kin who worked it lay among the dead, with one possessing a key to the facility proper and a note that says "Took the Bastard to the Sewers to get him to safety. Don't forget to make sure the trophy room CD is still sealed, DIM! He'll want them when he's older."

- The actual halls of this facility are open spaces with high ceilings, lit by bright lights. The temperature hovers just above freezing. Storage units line the halls, marked with Roman numerals, the smallest of which are just big enough for a person to stand inside, while the largest could fit a full-size vehicle. Many of the smaller units have been converted into stables for Chilly Goats, while some of the larger ones serve as living areas for Rat-kin.
- As the crawlers travel the bright hallways, the temperature of the already cold air drops significantly. A moment later, a loud, angry bleat sounds as a Chilly Goat bursts through the steel door of a storage unit. The next round, two more burst through other doors nearby, and a pair of Rat Brutes roll up a door to join the fray.
- A fully open storage unit. The crawlers just barely avoid a musty old throw pillow tossed out as someone mutters about useless junk. A moment later, a vase follows. Within the unit is Crawler Bethany Dow. The moment she hears the crawler party, she turns to them with eyes a little too wide. She's initially happy to see other humans and offers to make them tea, only to get irrationally angry when she remembers she doesn't have a kettle. Despite her erratic behavior, she still happily sits and shares a pleasant conversation with the crawlers.
- Unit number 400, marked as CD, is sealed with an electronic combination lock. Entering the code 500, 1, and 1000 unlocks it. Inside the unit, several severed heads of Rat-kin, Goblins, and crawlers alike sit on upturned cardboard boxes, all of them frozen. There's also an Enchanted Spring-Loaded Claw Arm, looking vaguely like arm-mounted jaws of life, known as "The Rat-Snatcher 2000." This weapon does double damage to Rodent-type enemies, but

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of this Neighborhood:

- *A Rat Shaman stands in a circle of fire, waving you to join him as you approach.*
Outcome: If the crawlers stay friendly and join the fire circle, they all gain the Fatigued Debuff and lose 2 Mana each. The Shaman now has Advantage for the next hour if involved in any combats. It remains in the fire until the crawlers leave. If the crawlers don't join the circle, a Moderate group of Rat Hooligans attack, and the Rat Shaman joins in as well.
- *You hear the sound of claws scrabbling behind the walls.*
Outcome: Crawlers can make an Unopposed Perception Skill Check or a DEX Stat Check to avoid an attack and subsequent Debuff from behind the wall.
- *A dry hacking cough echoes through the halls, followed by the sinister scraping of metal on stone.*
Outcome: Crawlers can make an INT Stat Check to spot the Murder Hole above them and avoid the attack.

you'll have to use it untrained. However, the place of honor is left to two Rat-kin tails tightly intertwined, difficult to separate for the knots, blood, and fouler grime sticking them together.

QUARTER: THE TUNNELS

The Tunnels are carved into the very crust of the Earth itself. The gray and brown substrate here was reinforced periodically with wooden beams to keep it sturdy. These measure between seven and nine feet in circumference, with the smallest being a third of that. This quarter is cramped and dimly lit, with the only illumination coming from occasional flickering lights hanging from the ceilings.

- The sounds of hacking coughs announce an incoming Rat Shaman, and one round later, they appear with a Weak group of Rat Brutes directly behind them. At the start of the second round of combat, a Weak mixed group of Fire-Fighters and Rat Brutes scramble into the fray from a different corridor. They attempt to corral the crawlers before using Area attack magic to bathe them in fire.

- Deep, racking sobs are interrupted by a scoff. A gruff but high-pitched voice then cuts off the sobs. Crawlers see a one-eyed Goblin (the Goblin Survivor: Stinkin' Pete) talking to a woman (Bethany Dow) who stops crying as the party approaches. Pete asks if she needs "comfort." If the crawlers emerge after the word "comfort" is said, they will find Stinkin' Pete trying to hand Bethany an Enchanted Snub-Nosed Revolver nicknamed Comfort.

It doesn't require bullets to fire and deals Fire damage. However, the crawler wielding it must still go through the motions to reload it after every six shots. If the crawlers emerge shortly after this exchange, they'll find the weapon left behind carelessly. If they emerge before this moment, Stinkin' Pete flees immediately, and Bethany discusses the idea of hope and carrying on when all seems lost. If the players are kind to her, she asks the party to message her if they need help in the future.

QUARTER: SEWERS

The Sewers are surprisingly spacious, nearly 50 feet high and 30 feet across inside, with five-foot-wide concrete walkways on either side and slender metal bridges spanning the ten-foot-deep canals. Murky brown foul-smelling water flows through the canals, but is rarely more than ankle-deep. However, at some points, it gets up to eight or nine feet.

- A Moderate mixed group of Rat-kin roll dice made from Goblin knuckle bones. Nearby, a Weak group of Chilly Goats wait patiently, munching on discarded Goblin meat, while a Fire-Fighter patrols the group in a circle. Crawlers have an opportunity to approach stealthily and get in a surprise round, assuming they time it right to avoid the Fire-Fighter and don't alarm the Chilly Goats. If the crawlers wait, they can overhear a conversation between the Rat-kin as to where the Rat Bastard's at, and they hear he went through the escape hatch to get him to safety.
- Stinkin' Pete is perched in an alcove, clutching dynamite and a lighter. He asks the crawler party which side they're on. As long as they proclaim they're enemies of the Rat-kin, the Goblin won't attack. Instead, he informs them that the MisChief and the Rat Bastard fled through an escape hatch. He outright points them to it, as long as they promise to show no mercy to the Rat Bastard. He tells them they must know the "sacred rhyme of the rat prophets" and then teaches them "Three Blind Mice." If he attacks, and the crawlers are forced to

kill them, they find a map on his corpse that leads them to the same location, as well as the cryptic words "remember the hymn of the fold rat prophets thrice bound in darkness."

- Many ladders lead up to the hatches throughout the Sewers. Almost every one either ends up out of sight or leads to a hatch that cannot be opened. Only one of these is the correct hatch. It can also only be opened by knocking in time to "Three Blind Mice."

NPCS

You can use one or more of these white-dots to encourage social scenes in the Serving Warrens:

GOBLIN SURVIVALIST

The Goblin Survivalist, a one-eyed Goblin, is incredibly paranoid at all times, which isn't surprising, considering he's trapped behind enemy lines. He has cobbled together armor made from Chilly Goat hide and wears a Rat-kin skull for a helmet. He's clever and handy with a knife, but his real joy is in alchemy, chemistry, and the explosive results of what happens when Goblin funpowder is mixed correctly and exposed to flame.

A few of the NPCs in the Neighborhood—such as Bopca Protectors, guildmasters, or fellow crawlers—have started calling this guy "Stinkin' Pete," but they can't remember where the name came from or why. Probably a dead crawler.

Goblin Survivalist, Level 12

I bet you didn't think it was possible to smell worse than Rat-kin and Chilly Goats, but somehow this Goblin manages to beat them in the stank department. He smells like a walking Garbage Elemental that's died of dehydration, been resurrected, and only lived long enough to throw up every bit of rotting meat he'd ever eaten. He smells even worse than he looks. I wouldn't mention it to him though; it's simply not polite. Also, his smell is maaaaybe the fifth deadliest thing about him.

BETHANY DOW

In normal life, Bethany Dow had it all. She had a loving family, amazing friends, and a fantastic job at a local bank that paid incredibly well. She even had a devoted partner named Brian. Yet she still found herself bored. With all her wants fulfilled, she could only dream of something beyond her mundane life. She often wished for an adventure to find her.



People should be more careful what they wish for.

The Collapse is a vague, distant memory. She was on her way into the bank for an early shift when it all happened. She'd kissed Brian goodbye and turned, halfway to the car, to wave. Brian waved back from the doorway. The last thing she remembers is seeing Brian's arm lying on the ground, still waving.

She hasn't finished processing the loss of her entire world. She's incredibly intelligent and has access to some powerful Spells. However, none of that matters if she keeps walking around in a daze.

Crawler #9,923,220. "Bethany Dow."

Level 3.

Race: Human.

Class: None Assigned.

THE RAT PRINCE

Not to be confused with the Rat Bastard, this guy considers himself the rightful ruler of the Rat-kin. He's the son of the former Rat King, the one the last MisChief slew to take power. The Rat Prince only escaped by the skin of his extremely sharp teeth. Now he'll do anything it takes to get his power back—anything except working with the Goblins. He's not initially hostile to crawlers, but his white dot turns red if they provoke him.

Rat Prince (Hooligan), Level 5

This Rat-kin seems different from his compatriots. Maybe it's the way he's dressed. Perhaps it's the way he carries himself. Or maybe it's because he hasn't tried to bite you, stab you, or set your ass on fire yet. Also, it seems like those cute little beady eyes bulge every time he mentions helping you. Of course, they also bulge when he talks about killing "that Rat Bastard," but something can mean two things!

**B-B-B-BOSS
BATTLE!**

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

As the crawlers emerge from the escape hatch, they find themselves in the middle of an intersection at night.

Far overhead, distant fake stars twinkle in the night sky. High-rises, a parking garage, and a public library are all visible, along with signs proclaiming this as the intersection of 10th and Baltimore.

The moment the crawlers are wholly above-ground, a grizzled Rat-kin stands up. He is nearly nine feet tall,

wearing nothing but red pants. A small rat child ducks behind him, then time slows down as a voice bellows, "B-B-B-Boss Battle! One group seeks escape. The other? Cold-blooded muuurderrrr!"

The MisChief shouts, "I will not fail again!" as he hurls manhole covers or strikes with his MisChief Mattock. He'll leap to the top of a traffic light, summoning two cars to try to hit the crawlers. If the crawlers gave the Rat Prince the required ingredients, he emerges as a three-headed Rat-kin monster known as a Rat King. Bound by blood, filth, and grime, the three have become one, and they alternate between healing the crawlers and hurling magic at the MisChief.

If the crawlers are victorious, a frightened Rat-kin child is left alone, desperately shaking the fallen MisChief and looking up in terror at the crawlers. This is the Rat Bastard, the "rightful" leader of the Rat-kin. The crawlers must decide whether to let him escape or put him to the sword.

If the crawlers choose the latter, the MisChief uses his last bit of strength to throw himself between the two groups, and the Rat Bastard escapes. Either way, a subway entrance illuminates, revealing itself as the stairwell.

MisChief. Leader of the Rat-kin Horde.

Level 7 Neighborhood Boss!

The MisChief is a new position. It's fallen on this Rat's head by circumstance and loyalty rather than desire. Right now, he's staring at you like a rat fleeing a sinking ship. You might wonder what that look of desperation is about, but I wouldn't.

I'd worry more about the giant-ass mattock swinging for your head instead.

MisChief, Leader of the Rat-Kin Horde

Neighborhood Boss; Large (5), Rat Knight

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
9%	18%	27%	36%	45%	54%	63%	72%	81%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
7	13+F	14+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
10 (+4)	8 (+3)	10 (+4)	10 (+4)	8 (+3)

Mattock: 14+F to hit, 2d10+4 Piercing, 5ft range

Manhole Cover: 14+F to hit, 2d8+3 Bludgeoning, 30ft range

Traffic Dodger: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Bludgeoning, 30ft Line Cars appear out of nowhere, driving in a straight line to hit as many crawlers as possible.





NEIGHBORHOOD: THE WEBBINGHOODS

FLOOR: 1 (TUTORIAL)

**THEME: SWAMP-FILLED HOUSING DEVELOPMENTS AND TRAILER PARKS
WITH WEBS AND MUTATED PLANTS**

"I used to think they were cute... but now I freakin' hate Llamas."

—Crawler Dewart

Spider silk products made (well, sourced) by a subsidiary of the Borant Corporation are prized across the universe for their strength and the beautiful fabrics they can be made into. When building this Neighborhood, Borant's dungeon architect sought a natural environment that would mimic their silk producers' farms.

The area is full of old homes, apartment buildings, and trailers overrun with thick vegetation where monsters hide among the leaves. Most crawlers would do well to avoid the area, as the worst threat comes from the cow-sized Giant Spiders that make their home in the Neighborhood.

The Mobs that harvest silk are not immune to its adhesive qualities, and once a day, the sound of someone or something screaming to be set free fills the air before it is cut short. The only sign that something happened is the sight of an oversized spider hauling a person-sized bundle deep into the depths of the Webbinghoods, where they are fed upon.

The only ones safe from the Giant Spiders are the Slimy Croakers, a stinky and easily excitable Mob that tend to the Giant Spiders' eggs and keep their lairs free from pests in exchange for protection. Though treated like pets, the helpful amphibians are grateful for the protection of their patrons, who keep them safe from being bullied by the Bad Llamas or eaten by the Vine Creepers.

The next biggest threat in the Webbinghoods are its main inhabitants: the Bad Llamas. Purveyors of illicit goods and the operators of a protection racket in this zone, the Bad Llamas definitely live up to their name. Refusing to buy their goods, no matter the price, can earn their ire and leave a crawler in deep trouble as they chase them from their territories.

Their moniker doesn't just come from their bad manners, questionable attire, and the dodgy efficacy of the drugs they peddle, but also their gigantic size and ability to shoot fireballs from their mouths. Their fur is luxuriously soft, and many crawlers make the mistake

of assuming they're like the Llamas from Earth. Not these Llamas—they'll scorch your ass and take what's in your pockets.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into the Webbinghoods:

- The crawlers encounter a shocking sight: a young NPC boy managed to survive in the lair of one of the Giant Spiders. The boy survived by covering himself in slime leftover from the Slimy Croakers. The boy offers to safely lead the crawlers out of the area for a price, but he plans to lead them into a pit trap to feed the Giant Spiders, whom he considers his family.
- The crawlers discover a cabin in the middle of a forested area in the Webbinghoods that even the Giant Spiders and Bad Llamas seem to avoid. The inside of the cabin is spacious and warm, with beds for all of them. What they don't realize is that when dawn breaks, the cabin walls shiver and come alive, revealing that they're inside a gigantic Vine Creeper (with 10 HB slots) that lured them into a trap. The crawlers must fight their way out of the stomach of this plant creature and battle their way through several Vine Creepers to freedom. While trapped inside, they take Drowning damage (1d6+F at the end of each round).
- As the crawlers enter the Webbinghoods, a loud claxon rings out, and a glowing sign appears midair: "Web Harvest in Progress." A row of enormous mechanical combines appears and begins pulling in the spiders' webs, and anything else unfortunate enough in the area gets shredded to pieces. The combines are slow but methodical, and crawlers must keep moving. Unfortunately, they also have to stay one step ahead of the Spiders and Vine Creepers, who were displaced by the harvesting!

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you find in the Webbinghoods into easy-to-assemble adventures; just connect the whatever story elements you like!

- The sound of a gavel rings out as the crawlers come across a courtroom full of Slimy Croakers! It's hard to make out what the grievance is, as most of the Slimy Croakers only speak in croaks and squeaks, but one Slimy Croaker has a speech impediment that lets him speak perfect English.

He explains that the crawlers need to help an innocent Slimy Croaker from being framed for a crime he didn't commit. The Slimy Croaker in question? The notorious Ribboff, who promises the crawlers some of his best treasures and a map showing the lair of Neighborhood Boss Aranaea Magnus—the Great Spider herself.

- The sound of heavy rock music fills the air as the shouts of "No Fear! No Fear! No Fear!" reverberate off the ruined homes around the crawlers. Running at full speed through the Webbinghoods is wily NPC Crawler Zach Nophobia, and he's recording a speed-run of himself trying to bash as many spider eggs as possible. Zach is utterly fearless, but also extremely reckless, and though he invites the other crawlers to join him, his antics start to rile up all the Mobs in the vicinity.
- The smells of barbecue fill the air as the crawlers come across a massive wedding party of Bad Llamas celebrating peace between two rival families. These Bad Llamas offer the crawlers food and a trailer to stay in for as long as the crawlers partake in the festivities.

All goes well until one of the Llama guests keels over from drinking poisoned punch. The crawlers must figure out who the murderer is and keep the peace between two rival clans of Bad Llamas before both sides decide to blame the crawlers instead.

- The crawlers move into a flooded area of the Webbinghoods, forcing them to climb high and move along rooftops to escape. What they don't realize is that Vine Creepers have buried their pods deep inside the buildings, and the crawlers' footsteps woke them up. The crawlers must keep moving to dodge the hungry plant creatures' attacks while also avoiding falling into the webbing stretched between the buildings.

MOBS

The Mobs found in the Webbinghoods lurk among the ruined houses and trailer parks, between thick stalks of plants and enormous spiderwebs.

VINE CREEPER

While the Giant Spiders' imposing webbing network and the rowdy trailer parks of the Bad Llamas come to mind when most crawlers think about the Webbinghoods, another sinister force threatens to claim the unwary. Giant ferns, trees, and flowers grow among the ruins, and scattered among these are gigantic leafy pods in the shape of huge eggplants.

These pods wield vines that stretch for dozens of feet in every direction. If these vines are disturbed, a Vine Creeper bursts forth, ready to kill. The Vine Creepers exist solely to capture prey and haul it back to their pods to be devoured.

Vine Creeper, Level 2

Remember the end of *Little Shop of Horrors* when Audrey II breaks out of its flowerpot and shoots a bunch of singing vines in every direction while trying to eat Rick Moranis? Take away the singing and Audrey II's huge head and replace it with a giant transforming eggplant, and it'll be pretty much identical to a Vine Creeper.

These surreptitious sprouts sleep in their pods until their vines detect nearby vibrations, triggering them to hunt. Vaguely humanoid (but rarely seen walking upright), the Vine Creepers first rely on their lengthy vines to ensnare and disable prey. Then they shamle along on all fours until they descend upon their victims in a fury of fangs, talons, and strangling vines. Once they overcome their victims, the Vine Creepers drag them back to their pods, where poisons and acids gradually (and painfully) break down their prey into digestible enzymes.

Vine Creeper

Mob; Huge (6), Plant



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	11+F	12+F	15+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Fang: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Piercing, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poison Debuff.



Talon: 12+F to hit, 1d8+2 Slashing, 5ft range
Vine: 12+F to hit, 1d4+2 Bludgeoning, 30ft range
 Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff and is pulled closer; only broken when the Creeper dies.

GIANT SPIDERS

The name says it all: Giant Spiders are gargantuan arachnids who spin enormous silk webs to catch prey. They may not be the most sophisticated Mob in the World Dungeon, but they're dangerous nonetheless.

Giant Spiders leave numerous web traps scattered throughout the floor, weaving the largest and most beautiful ones to protect their lairs where they keep their eggs, which are guarded by Slimy Croakers, the Giant Spiders' symbiotic "pets." The Giant Spiders sometimes cuddle the Slimy Croakers when they sleep; their bodies are seemingly immune to the Slimy Croakers' ooze, and the Slimy Croakers are immune to the adhesive qualities of the Giant Spiders' webs.

Giant Spiders are incredible weavers and often make clothing for the Slimy Croakers that live in their lairs. The "Silky Shirt" loot offers incredible protection while making the crawler look pretty stylish. Don't bother trying to take the clothing the Slimy Croakers wear, though; it's ruined by the slime secreted by their bodies.

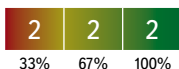
Giant Spiders, Level 3

Do you like spiders? Well, spend a few days running from these chunky bastards and see how you feel then. The Giant Spiders are the size of Highland heifers and excrete sticky webs as strong as steel. Their webs are awfully pretty, but they've claimed countless Mobs and crawlers over the years.

You want some advice? Stay away from their webs, their nests, and their eggs. Or don't. They gotta eat, too.

Giant Spiders

Mob; Large (5), Beast



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	12+F	25+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Bite: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Piercing, 5ft range
 On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poison Debuff.

Webshot: 12+F to hit, 1d8+2 Bludgeoning, 50ft range
 On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: Other creatures on a Giant Spider's webs move at half speed and cannot take a 10ft Step.

BAD LLAMAS

Most naughty animals aren't born bad; they just suffer from a bad reputation. In this case, that reputation is absolutely warranted as the Bad Llamas run most of the crime out of the Webbinghoods. Their ability to spit literal fire from their mouths, thanks to the glowing red pouches in their necks, makes them dangerous enough, but their ability to summon family members to assist them with a loud bray makes them more than just a nuisance.

The Bad Llamas wear denim jackets over their silky-smooth fur, with most wearing distinctive patches to signify which proud Llama crime family they belong to. They sell performance-enhancing substances and mind-altering drugs to anyone with the money to buy, including Game Guides (if the rumors are true). Most Bad Llamas just want to have a good time, and anything and anyone who's a threat has got to go.

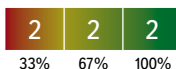
Bad Llama, Level 3

It may look fuzzy and cuddly, but if you try to pet it, you'll lose an arm in the process. It's a Bad Llama—kind of like a normal Llama, but bad!

Purveyors of some of the most powerful drugs in the dungeon, these adorable rascallions love two things: good music and a good buzz. Their parties are pretty lit, but don't think they're all fuzz and games; if you see their throats glowing red, it means they're about to spit a fireball in your direction! Maybe you should just drop your money and make a break for it.

Bad Llama

Mob; Large (5), Mutated



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Lava Spit: 13+F to hit, 1d8+3 Fire, 30ft range
 On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the target gains the Burning Debuff.

Notes: *Bad Reflux*—Attacks can target the lava pouch in the Llama’s throat during rounds when it uses Lava Spit, but this adds a +2 to the Llama’s Evade. The pouch ruptures if such an attack deals damage, killing the Llama and setting its corpse aflame.

SLIMY CROAKERS

Within the Giant Spiders’ lairs live anthropomorphic frogs wearing clothes made from finely woven spider silk. The Slimy Croakers are the guardians of the Giant Spiders’ lairs, serving as gardeners, cleaners, and protectors of their nests, for which they are in turn protected from the Vine Creepers, Literal Murder Hornets, and Bad Llamas.

Slimy Croakers are intelligent and know they have a good deal going. Their skin secretes a gooey slime that can cause paralysis to unlucky crawlers. The “croaker” part of their name comes from the extremely loud croak they emit when in distress. It can be heard up to a mile away and summons Giant Spiders to their aid.

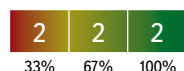
Slimy Croakers, Level 3

Mobs keeping other Mobs as pets? It’s not just some GM’s twisted power fantasy—turns out it’s true and at least vaguely canon! While the Giant Spiders are out hunting, making websites, or doing other spider-stuff, these little amphibious guys keep their homes clean and free of pests.

They’re adorable, but be careful of their slimy skin. A guy touched one once, and his arm went numb for an hour, and that smell clung to him no matter what he did. I know what you’re thinking, and unless you want to talk funny, keep that tongue in your mouth.

Slimy Croaker

Mob; Small (2), Beastly



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	5 (+2)	2 (+1)

Tongue Whip: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Paralyzed Debuff.

Croak: 11+F to hit, 1d4+2 Sonic, 20ft Cone + 10ft Splash

Notes: *Egg Protector*—Slimy Croakers typically stay near Aranea Magnus eggs to protect them. If the eggs they’re watching are damaged, their croaks cause all Croakers within 60ft to prioritize moving to surround the attacker.

Slippery Slime—A puddle of slime fills the Slimy Croaker’s space after it performs an Attack Action. All slime lasts until the end of the combat. The first time any crawler enters a slime space, they must make a Dex Stat Check. On Fail, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff. A Slimy Croaker also leaves behind slime in its space and adjacent spaces when killed.

LITERAL MURDER HORNETS

Enormous arachnids and camelids aren’t the only things lurking among the plants and webs of this floor; a sinister flying insect stalks between the buildings and trees looking for prey. Their name isn’t just a cute warning—Literal Murder Hornets are the assassins of the insect world, sometimes taking jobs from others to eliminate their targets.

Capable of shooting stingers out of their forelegs, Literal Murder Hornets will not stop until the job is done. Their love of their craft is so great that they even attack crawlers without a contract to get much-needed target practice.

Literal Murder Hornets, Level 2

A few seasons back, this crawler, a real big shot from one of the guilds, suddenly stopped talking and fell face down into her soup. There was a big freakin’ stinger sticking out the back of her neck. Then a giant wasp twenty yards behind her flew off with a creepy smile on its face. It was metal AF.

If one of these wretched things gets on your tail, it’ll do everything possible to bring you down, so make sure you strike first.

Literal Murder Hornets

Mob; Petite (3), Insect



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	11+F	12+F	25+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Bite: 12+F to hit, 1d8+2 Piercing, 5ft range

Stinger: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Piercing, 30ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poison Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Literal Murder Hornets can move through the air as though on the ground and hover in place.



ENVIRONMENT

A literal urban jungle, the Webbinghoods often stink from the Bad Llama's numerous cooking fires. At night, the sounds of Slimy Croakers fill the air, along with the occasional scream as the denizens of the Webbinghoods claim another victim. The Vine Creepers resulted from an accident when Borant's hydroponics mutated several Mobs, creating dangerous creatures that kill crawlers (and occasionally Dungeon Admins) and drag their remains back into their pods.

The resulting area is full of ruined homes, overgrown vegetation, and deep pools of water. The buildings in the area are full of valuable plunder for any crawlers brave enough to fetch them, although several homes and apartment towers have fallen over, creating difficult terrain that slows down even the nimblest of explorers.

Threats prevail at every level of the Neighborhood. Even if a crawler avoids getting stuck in the web, they risk awakening the Vine Creepers. If they avoid the Vine Creepers, they'd better not stare too long at the malevolent Literal Murder Hornets who occupy the many bars of the area while they look for work.

One section of the Webbinghoods is distinctive because of its residents. A long series of homes, trailers, and barns stacked side by side creates enormous grazing areas for the Bad Llamas. This part of the Webbinghoods is kept free of Vine Creepers and Giant Spiders, but that's because the Bad Llamas rule this place with an iron hoof.

Here, they create "power-ups" and cook suspicious "medicines" while also engaging in fireball-spitting contests and jamming to classic rock. The Bad Llamas are welcoming at first, but anyone who refuses to do business with them, who acts superior to them, or who doesn't know the difference between Van Halen and Van Hagar had better be prepared to run.

TRAPS

The Webbinghoods have traps everywhere, both inside the Neighborhood's crumbling old structures and strung between apartment buildings and trees. They're often made of web, plant material, or cobbled together car parts made by the Bad Llamas.

- **Spider Webs:** The crawlers manage to avoid the obvious, meticulously constructed webbing strung between two buildings, only to find a secondary web hidden along the walls they tried to shimmy through. The web holds them fast unless they can make a STR Stat Check. Each Fail sends noticeable vibrations traveling along the webbing into the distance. A loud skittering (or several) sounds, as multiple Giant Spiders head their direction, eager to claim their prey.
- **Vine Triggers:** Breaking into an old apartment building reveals a treasure trove of loot and everyday objects like televisions and books, but the small vines hidden beneath the floorboards send signals to nearby pods containing Vine Creepers. The Vine Creepers make their way through the vents and drop snatching vines through the ceiling onto their prey.

- **Trapdoors:** Not all the Giant Spiders in this area make webs between buildings. Some create sophisticated trapdoors for unsuspecting crawlers and Mobs to step on, dropping them into a web below. These webs snare their prey below ground until the Giant Spiders arrive to claim them.
- **Alarmed Cars:** The streets of Webbinghoods contain countless rundown, defunct, and inoperable vehicles, but many are locked and still have car alarms intact. Crawlers who try to break in to look for supplies (or, in some cases, just venture too close) may trigger these car alarms.

Fortunately, a local Bad Llama family sells special key fobs that they claim will turn off the touchy car alarms on the dozens of wrecked cars lining the streets. The trick here is that some of these fobs intentionally trigger alarms, causing nearby Mobs to head their way.

- **Collapsing Streets:** Though most of the streets appear normal, the constant humidity and disheveled state of the Neighborhood create a naturally occurring type of trap in collapsing asphalt and concrete streets. When the crawlers walk over weak spots, the debris gives way, forming pits filled with ruined infrastructure and rotting vegetation, overwhelming them with a foul smell as they struggle to climb free. These also tend to be noisy, thus attracting unwanted attention from Mobs.

ITEMS

The crawlers might scavenge some useful items while making their way through the ruined homes of the Webbinghoods.

- **Grappling Webs:** A braided rope of spider silk attached to a fresh glob of spider web makes for a handy piece of climbing equipment that can support the weight of an entire team of crawlers at once.
- **Wasp Stingers:** The discarded stingers from Literal Murder Hornets make for deadly weapons, and the venom sacs attached to them last for two attacks.
- **Bad Llama Branded Clothing:** These specially branded clothes signify that they were made by one of the Bad Llama families in the area. Wearing one of these articles of clothing helps a crawler pass through certain trailer parks safely, but it earns them the ire of a rival family if worn in their territory.
- **Survival Caches:** The former residents of these Neighborhoods stocked up on goods from home-made preserves, spare weapons, and fuel. Though

most of these caches were looted by other crawlers and the Bad Llamas, enough remain to tempt those passing by.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements and rewards in the Webbinghoods.

- **There's a Llama and Another Little Llama:** "You did a major favor for a family of Bad Llamas and get introduced to their whole crew. You are not their friend, but you've earned their respect and the right to wear one of their pieces of clothing. Go rob a convenience store while wearing it, and maybe they'll let you become an honorary family member.
Reward: You've received a Bronze Apparel Box."
Contents: Local medicines and a Llama Denim Jacket
- **Green Thumb, Black Flag:** "You destroyed 10 Vine Creeper pods, reducing the number of creepy crawlies in the Webbinghoods. Good thing, too—these photosynthesizing bastards reproduce like rabbits on Viagra.
Reward: You are less likely to set off the pods containing Vine Creepers while you are skulking about."
- **Lava Baseball:** "You successfully knocked a Bad Llama's fiery spit back at them more than 10 times. Look at you go, Babe Ruth! Do you think their glowing throats are why they're called rednecks?
Reward: You've received a Gold Return to Sender Box."
Contents: A melee combat-focused item.
- **Friendly Neighborhood Exterminator:** "You've freed yourself from enough webs that even I'm impressed. That shit is sticky! What, are you made of Teflon or something?
Reward: You've received a Silver Pest Control Box."

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

This Neighborhood has four quarters to explore:

QUARTER: THE HOLE IN THE WEB

The spiderwebs and vegetation get thicker and seemingly impassible toward the center of the Webbinghoods, and rumors persist about a secret path through this section that leads through an area where no Mobs have populated and there are no traps. Countless crawlers met their end trying to navigate the myriad dangers of the section known as the Hole in the Web, but the truth is, some sections in the center



of the Neighborhood are strangely peaceful and quiet and well worth the risk if they can try to find them.

- The area always has a fine mist that turns into heavy fog at random throughout the day, blanketing it with a silent, dangerous quality. Houses, trailers, and apartment buildings from across the world were deposited haphazardly in this area, but the new homeowners aren't fond of random people walking across their yards. Each block is controlled by a particular Mob, often obviously so.
- When the Neighborhood mixes the strange smells of diesel and a petting zoo, accompanied by the sound of pickup trucks, crawlers are about to encounter the Bad Llamas. Eerily quiet settings with excessive colorful plant growth that never seem to stay in one place mean the Vine Creepers are nearby. Sections overrun with webbing and the chirps of noisy amphibians suggest crawlers are close to Giant Spiders and Slimy Croakers.

- The most insidious threat in this area are the hundreds of Vine Creeper pods scattered throughout the area. Small packs of Vine Creepers stalk the area looking for food, while old pods, withered and browning, often spill bones and tattered remains onto the ground.
- Bands of Bad Llama youth spend their afternoons shooting the pods with their fiery spit for target practice, often displacing Vine Creepers into the foggy area, where they seek out a new home. A large portion of this area is flooded, forcing crawlers passing through to sneak along rooftops or walk along planks laid between buildings to survive.
- Any crawlers willing to follow a complicated series of spray-painted signs on the walls, and willing to engage in a scavenger hunt where they must fish paper notes out of web sacs or out from under the bumper of a Bad Llamas' favorite mustang, may find a secret place. These clues hint at a secret bar nearby, truly neutral ground for Mobs and NPCs in the area.

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers survive encounters with a few Mobs in the Webbinghoods, they may try to grind for experience by killing Mobs over and over. This involves navigating the deadly traps of the Webbinghoods, which might include the following complications. Roll 1d20.

TABLE 7: WEBBINGHOODS GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A pair of Bad Llamas are out joyriding in the area in their customized double-wide pickup that spews choking black smoke as they drive past. The crawlers hear the truck approaching from its oversized engine and loud music.
2	A Vine Creeper (no longer in its pod) stalks the crawlers around while dressed in an amalgamation of human clothing. It seems like it thinks the crawlers aren't onto it, though whether it's genuinely attempting to join their group or an obvious plant isn't clear. Either way, it radiates an effect that keeps the crawlers from hurting it for now.
3	The crawlers encounter a shakedown where two different Bad Llama families try to bully them into buying their goods. The crawlers must find a way to turn the two families against each other, or else they'll have to pay up.
4	The crawlers find themselves attending a Battle of the Bands between two large and antagonistic bands of Bad Llamas. To prevent a fight, the crawlers must perform a rock song or dance-off skillfully enough to impress both fans and band members from both sides—or they have to fight both.
5	Due to a mishap or trap involving Slimy Croaker slime, an enormous (and enormously delusional) Giant Spider thinks that the crawlers are its pet Slimy Croakers and dotes on them while sheltering them for the night. The thing is, it doesn't seem to want to let them leave, and it already has custom collars made...
6	The crawlers earned the attention of a local hive of Literal Murder Hornets who were paid to kill them. The crawlers have two choices: eradicate the hive or die. Wait—that's not much of a choice...
7+	See Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications (p. 13).

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of the Webbinghoods:

- *Your feet sink into the wet earth and fungus underneath you. You feel your skin crawl as a spider egg hatches and baby spiders (each fist-sized or larger) harmlessly but quite creepily crawl all over you.*

Outcome: Roll with Disadvantage on all checks for the next 10 minutes.

- *You find a coupon for a bag of meth when you lean against a car, causing its trunk to open. The coupon has scribbles on it that came from the Bad Llamas, but it can be redeemed at a saferoom with a Bopca Protector.*

Outcome: The crawler can redeem the coupon, but if the coupon is visible to a Bad Llama, it may drive them into a frenzy.

- *A fog obscures the area around you, and when it finally breaks, you find yourself in a field of Vine Creeper pods that have yet to open...*

Outcome: Stealth around the pods or go back the way you came without activating them, or else be prepared to fight. Watch out for sensitive vines on (or even under) the ground!

- Known as the True Hole in the Web, it's here that the heads of the Bad Llama Families, the reigning queens of the Literal Murder Hornets, and the Slimy Croaker forefrogs gather to discuss business.. In recent years, a Vine Creeper named Stale Kale joined their ranks, though he only speaks through a special Slimy Croaker interpreter, Silas. Any crawler looking for contacts in the underworld should check out this venue, but the joint is cash-only, and absolutely no violence is allowed.

QUARTER: THE MARKETS

If a crawler wants to buy, trade, or just avoid being eaten for a few precious minutes, then the Markets offer a momentary place to relax. This gigantic marketplace on the southern side of the zone was run by parasites before they were exterminated.

- The Bad Llamas still celebrate the "Destruction of the Fleas" once a month with a massive bonfire where they get rip-roaring drunk and tell grander and more dubious stories from the war. The front of the

Markets is dominated by Bad Llama stores and stalls, all blaring classic rock music.

- The rest of the Markets consists of a series of stalls, shops, and trailers that stretch for miles in every direction, each marked with hand-painted signs listing goods and prices. A wide range of goods can be found in the Markets, from rare, limited weapons and potions to comforts from the old world. Each seller sets their own prices, though the sound of haggling can be heard while the market is open.
- The Bad Llamas' voices warble the loudest in the markets, while the Literal Murder Hornets always seem to set up their stalls in the shadows. They don't always sell their assassination skills in the Markets; sometimes they sell delightful paper goods or carved wooden pieces.
- In the eastern side of the Markets, crawlers find fresh food and vegetables. Giant Spider farmers and their Slimy Croaker farmhands proudly display their produce, though cleaning the slime off of them is a must before eating. It's also one of the few places where someone snared by the Giant Spiders may be brought for sale.
- A loud NPC auctioneer known as Seamus O'Spider rattles off those trapped in a web like prize pigs ready for sale as supper. Most of the trapped Mobs Seamus sells are Rats, random animals, and bunnies, though he also sells crawlers and more powerful Mobs in private auctions (because they're tastier and fetch higher prices).
- Standing watch at the entrance to keep the peace is a group of five Mobs, known as the Five Hanks. Hank Spider is always sneaking off to string up those who interfere with the affairs of others. Hank Croaker is a paranoid Slimy Croaker who all-too-willingly throws gobs of smelly goo into their faces, often blinding them temporarily.
- Hank Creepy is a Vine Creeper whom no one quite understands, but he seems to have a heart of gold. Hank Llama makes sure business stays fair in the Markets and that no one breaks old Llama customs without getting a lecture on the superiority of the old ways. And, finally, Other Hank Llama is a crawler who's too afraid to leave the Webbinghoods. It's clear he's suffering from some kind of shellshock or Stockholm Syndrome from being here too long, but if you ask him, he just tells you he's glad he made some friends in the dungeon.

QUARTER: THE UNDERWEBS

Dark, foreboding, and several other synonyms for “that place is scary” best describe the Underwebs. A series of interconnected caverns and tunnels lie beneath the center of the zone, and numerous entrances and shafts await crawler exploration throughout the area.

- Descending into the depths can be a scary experience, as it’s not just the lack of light that makes it so dangerous. The walls are lined with old webs interlaced randomly with fresh ones, meaning that at any moment, a visitor can become stuck.
- Old cars and motorcycles are wedged into the walls along with the unfortunate remains of the Giant Spiders’ prey. The Slimy Croakers carved clear paths along the floors to work more efficiently. Vast treasures, loot boxes, and rare goods are found in the depths of the Underwebs, but this is also the heart of Giant Spider territory in the Webbinghoods.
- In an old strip mall covered in webs, Slimy Croakers set up a small bar amid working for their respective Giant Spiders. Here, the frog Mobs can come to vent about their day, have a cool drink, and prop up their webbed feet after a long day of safeguarding spider eggs and cleaning Giant Spider dens.
- The Slimy Croakers remain suspicious of welcoming anyone into their little slice of heaven, but there’s one catch: the vast majority of the Slimy Croakers speak only through croaks. Several Slimy Croakers here, having recently lost their spider patrons, hold up “Will Work for Snuggles” signs and can make excellent companions for those who don’t mind their smell.
- The crawlers may come across a distraught Game Guide by the name of Alicia, whose favorite crawler was kidnapped by an enormous Giant Spider living in the area. She knows she’s not supposed to play favorites, but this crawler, Davy, quickly became her friend, and she’ll do anything to get him back. Alicia promises a Gold-rarity item if they can rescue Davy from being devoured. She does not know where Davy is held, only that the local Neighborhood Boss took the crawler.
- The Neighborhood Boss, the Aranaea Magnus, lives in the largest of the lairs in the Underwebs, with gigantic spires made of solidified webbing and decorated with the skulls of devoured prey hanging from the ceiling, indicating the crawlers have come to the right (or maybe the wrong) place. The Great

Spider herself receives tribute from the other Giant Spiders in the form of web cocoons left outside of her lair, and her pet Slimy Croakers fetch them several times a day. Crawlers seeking to rescue Davy or any of their other friends from the Aranaea Magnus should refer to the B-B-B-Boss Battle section later in this chapter.

QUARTER: CROAKER PARADISE

Beneath the streets of the Webbinghoods lie hundreds of small tunnels, access corridors, and new excavations since the zone’s creation. Many who try to navigate these depths end up in the Underwebs, but there exists a secret place known only to a few where crawlers can run and hide should they need to. The catch? This place stinks horribly because it is home to the Slimy Croakers. It’s their secret getaway from the world, where they go when they need a break from their overlords or to gather among themselves.

- The Croaker Paradise is warm and humid, and once crawlers get used to the pungent smell of these Mobs, they realize it’s not so bad. Scavenged holiday lights and porcelain lamps line the walls, and the Slimy Croakers have small rest areas filled with scavenged cushions and blankets.
- Hot tubs and saunas are common in this area, as the Slimy Croakers maintain their own spas to relieve the tension of protecting and cleaning for enormous predatory arachnids all day. There are a few rules in the Croaker Paradise: no sharing work-talk with another Slimy Croaker’s Boss, no spoiling the mood, and no judging another Slimy Croaker by how they smell.
- The Croaker Paradise has a secret benefit that crawlers realize once they start mapping the area. Since the Giant Spiders are not allowed inside, and the Bad Llamas and other Mobs don’t mess with this area for fear of angering the Giant Spiders, the crawlers can navigate the Webbinghoods without having to run along the surface. The Slimy Croakers mostly ignore the crawlers unless they feel threatened, and they even occasionally offer helpful (if hard-to-understand) tips on how to navigate it.
- The unofficial Boss of this area is the notorious Slimy Croaker kingpin, Ribboff. He operates an enormous bazaar where Slimy Croakers can trade goods in peace, but Ribboff takes most of the profits for himself. He’s not one to personally fight, but he has several friends he can call on for help. He also has a bodyguard in the form of Dealbreaker, an enormous Ogress whom Ribboff calls in if he feels too much pressure.

- Ribboff's greatest treasure, and one he's willing to show if he feels too threatened, is known as the "XP Chest," a floating golden box. He invites the crawlers to each strike it once with their weapons as an Unopposed Skill Check. The crawler with the lowest result gains 1 Level and 1 Skill Rank in their weapon, and then the XP Chest disappears. Everyone else gets nothing. No one knows where Ribboff gained this rare item, only that it came to him in a dream.

NOTABLE NPCs

The crawlers might find some unexpected white dots in the Webbinghoods:

ZACH NOPHOBIA, SPIDER SLAYER SUPREME

Some claim they have no limits, and some truly believe it. Prior to the collapse, Zach "Nophobia" Armistead was afraid of anything that crawled, crept, or buzzed. After getting trapped in a web cocoon for a few days, he realized that his fear of spiders might literally kill him—unless he killed it first. As Zach is fond of saying, "I've got *no fear* and *no time* to waste!"

His bombastic attitude and love of bashing Mobs with his enormous homemade swatter earned him a lot of followers and more than a few local supporters (mostly the Bad Llamas, because they like to watch him do crazy shit). Zach hopes he can keep gaining XP and eventually wants to take on the Big Bad herself, the Aranaea Magnus, and stick her head on the end of his spiky bat to prove once and for all that he has transcended his fears. Any crawlers trying to keep up with him realize he is absolutely fearless—but that also means no sense of self-preservation, and other crawlers have met their end just trying to keep up.

Crawler #5,122. "Zach Ar."

Level 8.

Race: Human.

Class: Not yet assigned.

RIBBOFF—"KING" OF THE SLIMY CROAKERS

Ribboff, with his Hawaiian shirts and a burlap bag overflowing with items, offers good deals on many things, and he just wants to make you a deal. It's not just his skin that's slimy; it's his ethics: He'll do anything to make a buck. Unfortunately, Mobs don't drop gold on this floor, so he's got to settle for barter. Anything and everything is for trade with this Mob, and he is even willing to throw his fellow Slimy Croakers to the wolves if it's to his advantage.

Ribboff claims to have information on secret stairwells, but no one knows for sure whether his information is reliable and his clients are never seen again because they would be on the next floor, or whether his information is bad and his clients are dead. Dealing with Ribboff is a literal gamble, but sometimes his information is on the level.

Ribboff—Slimy Croaker, Level 10

This is a non-combatant NPC!

Yo, why is that frog so buff? Ribboff hides his athlete's physique behind a floral button-up shirt. When this savvy business amphibian's not tending to spider eggs, he's eagerly telling fellow Croakers about his new startup. He's shady, but his information is usually on the level, provided the right price is paid. He usually has the best items for sale, but sometimes their previous owners come looking for them.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

Aranaea Magnus' lair is a foreboding place built beneath a field with numerous pit traps leading inside. The remains of old cars and skeletons line the walls, and the whole area is lit by giant, round, bioluminescent globes. As the crawlers dust themselves off, they realize they're not just in a trap—it's a feeding ground.

As the crawlers stand up, the walls light up in bright colors, and the voice-over takes on a heroic tone. Images of each crawler and Aranaea Magnus display with web outlines on the walls.

Aranaea Magnus is an enormous spider the size of a bull, with talons on the ends of her eight arms and numerous strands of webbing streaming off her sides. Her main strengths are her sharp talons, her ability to generate a special web fluid that burns anything caught in it, and her pedipalps capable of paralyzing her prey. The only thing more efficient than the way she kills is her storage system for her prey, as the walls of her lair are well-organized with cocooned victims waiting to be devoured.

The great spider's weakness is twofold: First, it's so big that it tends to get caught up in its own webs while chasing its prey, so clever crawlers can lure the creature into its own webs and tie up its legs, slowing it down. This keeps Aranaea Magnus from moving.

The second weakness is its love for the pet Slimy Croakers it keeps in its lair. In particular, she considers

three Slimy Croakers her own personal pets: Piotr, Milo, and Genevieve. They wear bejeweled collars around their necks. Threatening these Mobs earns the Boss spider's wrath, but distresses her so much that she is easier to hit.

Aranaea Magnus, the Great Big Spider

Level 7 Neighborhood Boss!

Our Boss Sense is tingling! Looks like the crawlers got themselves in a sticky situation!

Aranaea Magnus is the biggest, baddest arachnid on the block, and her lair is full of the bodies to prove it. You'd think her bad attitude is the worst thing about her, but this angry spider menace has a bottomless appetite and a need to sate her hunger at all costs! If crawlers think she's angry now, then they better not mess with her eggs: Aranaea will shred anyone who threatens her babies or the Slimy Croakers she keeps as pets.

Aranaea Magnus

Neighborhood Boss; Large (5), Monstrous

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
9%	18%	27%	36%	45%	54%	63%	72%	81%	90%	100%	
Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR							
7	12+F	14+F	30+S	1							
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA							
12 (+4)	5 (+2)	10 (+4)	11 (+4)	8 (+3)							

Rendering Leg-Claws: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Slashing, 10ft range

Caustic Silk Spray: 14+F to hit, 1d8+4 Acid, 30ft Cone (once per round)

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the target gains the Webbed Debuff (see below) and takes 1d6+F Acid at the end each round.

Drop: 12+F to hit, 1d10+2 Bludgeoning

Once at start of a fight, the Aranaea Magnus can Drop when it's above the ground, landing directly below, attacking enemies it drops on and enemies adjacent to it. If the area contains Slimy Croaker slime, Aranaea Magnus slips on landing, losing 2 Health Bar slots. If Drop doesn't hit any crawlers, Aranaea Magnus is Stunned by the fall and loses all remaining Actions for the round and 1 Action next round.

Paralyzing Pedipalps: 14+F to hit, 2d4+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range (once per round)

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the target gains the Staggered Debuff.

Venomous Fangs: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range (once per round)

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the target gains the Poisoned Debuff and a -1 penalty to Evade.

Web: 14+F to hit, 1d4+4 Bludgeoning, 90ft range, 5ft Blast radius

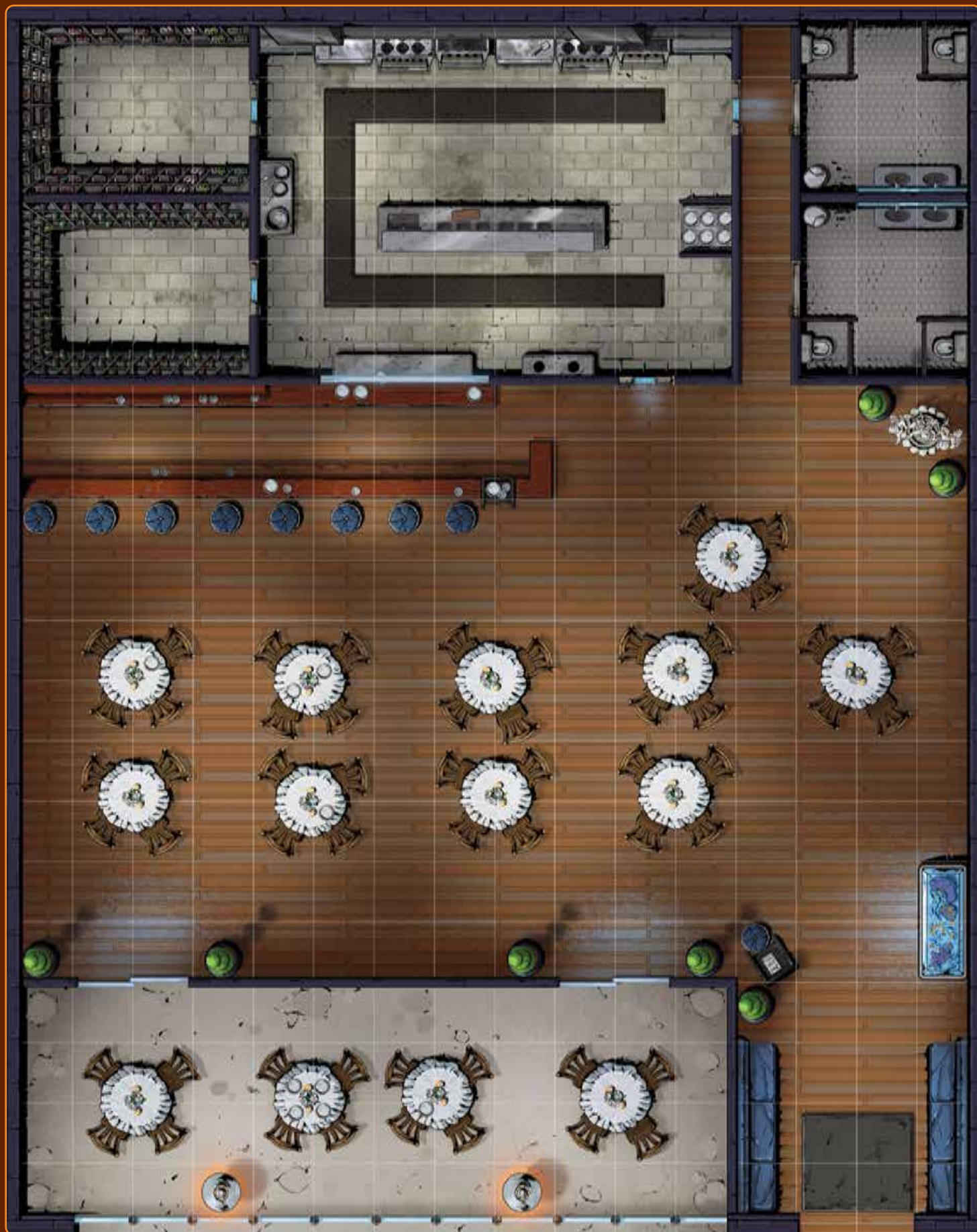
Any hit crawlers have Disadvantage on next Evade and can't Step until an Action is used to pull off webs.

Notes: *Eight Middle Fingers to Gravity*—An Aranaea Magnus can move along vertical surfaces and upside down on ceilings as though on the ground.

Webbing—Aranaea Magnus Web attacks cover surfaces in the affected area when it doesn't hit a target. Entities who enter a webbed space must make a STR Stat Check or become Webbed (see above). Regardless of the result, the entity clears the space and its adjacent spaces of webs.

Tangled—The Aranaea Magnus tangles easily in its own webbing. It suffers a -10 Move penalty in webbing.







QUEST: FOOD IS LOVE

FLOOR: 1 OR 2 (TUTORIAL)

THEME: PIZZA RAT, NOW A RESTAURANT

"And your stupid food machines been giving us crap to eat."

—Larry, Rat Brute

Rats eat anything. That's why they make good Janitor Mobs. It's also why Rat-kin are food connoisseurs. There's nothing like eating shit out of a rotting corpse to make one appreciate the finer cuisines in life. In this Quest, the local Rat-kin community discovered classic American media like *The Godfather*, *The Sopranos*, and *Jersey Shore*. These fellas put the *Mob* in mobster. They'll do whatever it takes to move their community safely to a lower dungeon floor.

There's been a hiccup, though: The leaders of the Rat-kin want more Rat Hooligans—hybrids born from unions between muscular Rat Brutes and magic-casting Rat Shamans who are stronger and smarter than their parents. Brutes and Shamans share few interests in common beyond their mutual survival, so they arrange marriages between their most promising children. This desire is a remnant of a failed show that Borant and the System AI relegated to obscurity on the Second Floor. Only Vinnie, a local guildmaster, understands this.

Being chosen to marry is supposed to be an honor, but this time, in a reverse-*Romeo and Juliet* situation, the kids have run away because they despise each other. They're also non-combatant NPCs, and a quirk of their old show programming allows them to enter saferooms which the other rat-kin cannot. Can the crawlers fix this disaster, and will doing so help them survive the floor, or will they give birth to their own doom?

Rat-kin strive for diplomatic relations with other Mobs and often spread out in various Neighborhoods rather than running their own. This strategy allows them to observe how crawlers interact with other Mobs and flee if the crawlers prove violent. The Mobs here are mainly low-level Rat-kin Brutes and Shamans, who function as allies (with white dots until they're given a reason to turn hostile), assisting crawlers without stealing their spotlight. Combat encounters during this Quest should be against other Neighborhood Mobs unless otherwise specified.

Note: The Serving Warrens Neighborhood also includes Rat-kin Mobs, running this Quest concurrently or afterward (perhaps even returning to that Neighborhood) could make things more complicated or fun, depending on what the players enjoy.

STRONG STARTS

- A Rat Brute fighting alongside Neighborhood Mobs betrays the Mobs when the crawlers gain the upper hand. The Rat Brute then asks the crawlers for help, promising the aid of the other Rat-kin on the floor if they agree. This request triggers the achievement transcribed in the Quest description and starts the Quest's first stage, both described below.
- A Rat Shaman rescues the crawlers from certain death—the AI calls these occurrences *rattus ex machina*—because one of the crawlers has some trait that might appeal to the runaways. This start prevents an early party wipe and puts the crawlers in debt to the Rat-kin (rather than the other way around, as in the above start).

QUEST DESCRIPTION

The AI calls this mission an achievement because it isn't an official Quest. Alternatively, the Game Guide can paraphrase the Quest description and suggest that the PCs will earn some great loot for completing an obvious achievement. A Game Guide or Communications Agent might also suspect that the AI often tests the Quest system on the Tutorial Floors before it fully comes online on the Third Floor.

New Achievement! An Offer You Shouldn't Refuse.

You might be homeless, but you aren't a murder hobo! You met a Mob without killing it on sight. This Rat-kin has a Quest. Not a real Quest—those don't happen until Floor 3—so consider this a practice run in case you survive long enough to get there. Now pay attention! The Rat's talking, and the producers didn't pay for an NPC chat log.

Reward: You've received a Bronze Adventurer Box... and the opportunity for more rewards!

ALTERATIONS

Rat-kin form tight-knit communities and adopt tough personas to make up for being naturally weaker than many dungeon Mobs. The AI and show runners knew Rat-kin perform best when, well, *performing*, so they allowed them access to local media to develop intimidating identities.

This Quest focuses on food, organized crime, and conflict over an arranged marriage. You can change the specifics for your campaign. Instead of Italian-American pizza fanatics, maybe your Rat-kin are inspired by Yakuza making sushi, or even Klingons running blood wine pubs.

MOBS

CHEF BOYARDOOZE

Chef BoyardOozes are tomato-sauce slimes that leave slick trails that can trip creatures with low Dexterity. An empty sauce can sits atop their forms like crowns. They generate tendrils dripping with cheese strings to drag foes into their acidic bodies, which quickly and painfully dissolve organic material and metal. Their bodies have a high viscosity that hinders creatures from escaping, and they regenerate Health.

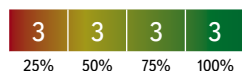
While they aren't intelligent, they instinctively lurch toward living creatures. Extreme temperatures stop their Health regeneration and can disable them entirely. High temperatures thin their consistency until they dissolve, and cold temperatures temporarily freeze them solid.

Chef BoyardOoze, Level 4

It turns out that just watching mafia movies doesn't make one a Michelin-recognized chef. Rat-kin chefs are far more interested in mobster suits and tough talk than Italian cucina povera. Half-used cans of tomato sauce sit forgotten until they go bad, then get slurped by Clurichauns who think they're natural immune boosters. The Fairy-flavored remains turn into this sentient slurry that's so full of preservatives it even developed rapid regeneration. *Buon appetito!*

Chef BoyardOoze

Mob; Small (2), Ooze



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	11+F	12+F	10+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Tendril: 14+F to hit, 1d6+3 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
On Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff and the Saucy Debuff: Take 1d6+F Acid at the end of each round until the combat ends.

Notes: Chef BoyardOoze leaves slick trails that add +2 Difficulty to Dexterity-based Skills.

Cold Vulnerability—Attacks that do Ice damage to Chef BoyardOozes bypass DR and do ×2 damage.

Heat Vulnerability—Attacks that do Fire damage to Chef BoyardOozes bypass DR and do ×2 damage.

Regenerate Health—Chef BoyardOozes heals 1 Health Bar slot at the end of each round.

RAT-KIN

The Rat-kin Mobs in this Quest are themed as American mafia stereotypes running pizza parlors. If you use this in the same campaign as the Serving Warrens (p. 38), use whichever descriptions you prefer.

RAT BRUTE

Rat Brutes are heavily muscled Rat-kin with distorted proportions: thick shoulders, knotted forearms, and an overdeveloped jaw that juts forward beneath small unfocused eyes. Blood and sports drinks mat their patchy fur.

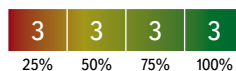
Their attacks rely on brute force: tackling foes and crushing them with their arms, charging at full speed to slam targets (and themselves) into obstacles, and shoving opponents off balance. Their chemically fueled endurance allows them to push through pain and fight past "reasonable" limits. These stimulants make them volatile, and sudden noises, bright lights, or perceived insults can trigger an immediate rage response that increases their damage output but reduces their awareness of positioning and allies. They're difficult to intimidate or negotiate with but are vulnerable to charm and other mind-control effects.

Rat Brute, Level 4

Most Rat-kin are twitchy flea-bitten little cowards who would sooner shank you in the kidney than look you in the eye. Then there's these guys. Rat Brutes are what happens when Rat-kin decide they're tired of being pushed around. They pump themselves full of magical growth hormones and take any excuse to show off their bulging biceps. Warning: Do not try to reason with Rat Brutes. Their brains shrank to the size of a dried raisin to make room for more jaw muscles.

Rat Brute

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	11+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Knife: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Slashing, 5ft range

Crossbow: 12+F to hit, 1d8 Piercing, 50ft range

Notes: *Roid Rage*—Rat Brutes are very volatile: sudden noises, bright lights, or perceived insults can trigger an immediate rage response. This doubles the Stat Mod bonus to their damage rolls. In addition, Their chemical-fueled endurance allows them to push through pain and



fight past “reasonable” limits. Rat Brutes can attack one more time after they have been reduced to 0% HB.

Weak-Minded—Rat Brutes are difficult to Intimidate, but attempts to charm and other mind-control effects are made with Advantage.

RAT SHAMAN

Rat Shamans are lanky Rat-kin draped in scavenged burlap bags and jewelry made from bones, nails, and bits of bright trash. They constantly mutter to themselves while tracing symbols in grime to cast Spells. Their fragility from years of drug abuse means they prefer to stay at range behind tougher Rat-kin.

If threatened in melee, they do everything possible to disengage. They throw small fireballs in arcs to scorch targets or flush them from cover, but they can pump more Mana into their projectiles to create bigger explosions. They also summon lingering disease clouds.

Rat Shaman, Level 5

While the Brutes were getting jacked, the Shamans were getting weird. They spent their youth huffing toxic sewer fumes and “communing” with the Great Vermin in the Sky. But don’t let their coughing fits fool you; they somehow got *real* magical powers from that nonsense. They mainly launch fireballs but can also transmit plagues. Not the bubonic type—you think they bothered learning Earth history? They prefer watching reality television, so if anything, you’ll be dodging STDs.

Rat Shaman

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid

2	2	2	2	2
20%	40%	60%	80%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	14+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	10 (+4)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)

Clap Cloud Spell: 14+F to hit, 1d4+4 Force, 50ft range, 20ft Blast radius

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Queasy Debuff.

Firestrike Spell: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Fire, 30ft range (once per round)

Mini Fireball Spell: 14+F to hit, 1d6+4 Fire, 60ft range, 15ft Blast radius



RAT HOOLIGAN

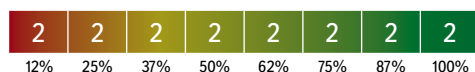
Rat Hooligans are the offspring of a Shaman and a Brute, possessing the strengths of both. They're lean but strong, magical but lucid enough to remember what they ate for breakfast. Fights are dirty affairs in which they exploit any advantage. They set ambushes to pick off isolated targets and then retreat to prepare for another strike. They coordinate well, all the while taunting their victims.

Rat Hooligan, Level 8

Crawlers, you found the dungeon's "premium" rat product. When a Shaman and a Brute love each other very much and do dirty rat things together, you get Rat Hooligans! Because they're actually capable of basic addition and don't try to eat their own feet, they get pampered with the pizza dough made from *artisanal* corpse starch. As a quick procedural note: these guys are *really* hard to replace, so it's better for all of us if you just let them eat your face off.

Rat Hooligan

Mob; Petite (3), Rat Hybrid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
8	14+F	12+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
8 (+3)	11 (+4)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	4 (+2)

Longsword: 13+F to hit, 2d8+2 Slashing, 5ft range

Firebolt Spell: 14+F to hit, 2d6+2 Fire, 30ft range

Heal Others Spell: None, -1d6, 10ft range

This is a healing Spell that heals one target within 10 feet for 1d6 Health Bar slots.

MAJOR NPCs

The major NPCs in this Quest are Rat-kin who must arrange marriages to birth Rat Hooligans. They genuinely care about each other's well-being but may suffer tragic breakdowns if their compulsions to see these arranged marriages through are blocked.

GODPAPA JOHN

Godpapa John is the ultimate "heavy" of the rat-kin. He's a mountain of scarred pale flesh who commands respect through sheer physical size and presence, but like a good Godfather, he's hospitable and polite.

He calls the crawlers "honored guests" and goes through the motions of serving them a pizza buffet despite his internal panic about not being able to deliver enough Hooligans. He's a grappler and tank

who leverages his massive weight to crush opponents. He can throw parts of the environment (or other Mobs) with ease.

Godpapa John—Rat Brute, Level 8

This is a non-combatant NPC!

Oh, look! It's the Big Cheese himself. Really, he's about 40% mozzarella by volume. Meet Godpapa John, the patriarch of the meat-loving Brutes. Don't let his tailored tuxedo fool you: he can lift a freight train, and he'll happily use your spine as a toothpick if you disrespect "The Family." Be a dear and listen to his offer. Just remember: don't put pineapple on his pizza unless you want to find a horse's head in your sleeping bag.

GODMAMA MIA

Godmama Mia is the highest-ranking Shamans, smelling of charred herbs and yeast. She's a lithe and elderly Rat-kin draped in colorful, psychedelic silks instead of burlap. Her movements have a theatrical flair, and she breaks up her sentences with humming.

Years of leadership taught her Spells to create illusions, disable foes, and control the weak-minded. She wields a manic yet motherly warmth, constantly offering crawlers samples of fungal pizza toppings (which may cause permanent brain damage).

Godmama Mia, Rat Shaman Level 10

This is a non-combatant NPC!

"Mamma mia, here we go again! My, my, how can you resist her?" No, seriously—her pheromones literally bypass your central nervous system. Meet Godmama Mia, the fungi-loving matriarch of the Rat Shamans. She's looking for her precious boy, Luigi, before his ambitions to break free of the dungeon doom them all.

And you—it'll probably doom you, too, now that you got involved. Just smile, nod, and hold your breath when she hugs you. You don't want to see the visions she sees. Trust me.

LUIGI

The anti-Romeo to Snookie's anti-Juliette: Unlike regular Rat Shamans, Luigi likes drawing the attention of enemies. Though he's as fragile as a regular Shaman, he excels at dodging and using the environment to avoid attacks. He carries fresh pizza ingredients so the smells attract enemies, relying on his allies to take them out while they're distracted. Luigi wants to be out there helping his clan and experiencing wild visions, not tied down with a bunch of rugrats.

Luigi, SYSTEM ERROR Rat Shaman, Level 8

This is a non-combatant NPC.

Some kids are born special. Where other Shamans see rainbow slimes in their visions, Luigi sees actual rainbows in the sky. This boy dreams of breathing fresh air and growing food out of real soil that's at least a few years removed from the dead shit it came from. Kind, smart, ambitious... I'd be rooting for him if my programming didn't require me to stomp his dreams deader than a Frenzied Gerbil under a man's supple bare foot.

SNOOKIE

The anti-Juliette of the story: Snookie is a Brute with a meat cleaver, but she doubles as a healer. She chops corpses into slices of meat for her paninis. The sandwiches are strangely delicious, even though you often see her making them with less-than-quality ingredients, but more importantly, they heal you. Years of making her own fresh food means Snookie's own Health regenerates constantly during combat. She desperately does want to have ratlings of her own, but she wants them to be born to loving parents, not a pair of rats who hate each other. Rat-kin Shamans just ain't her type.

Snookie, SYSTEM ERROR Rat Brute, Level 7

This is a non-combatant NPC.

Snookie is a girl on fire, head in the clouds, and she's not backing down. There aren't enough hours in the day to work off her burning rage at the gym. She's angry about eating pizza all the time, being controlled through texts from admins she's never met, grappling with surging hormones that make her yell at Godpapa even when she knows he's watching out for her. The only thing that calms her down is a good panini, which is a problem for you, because a Danger Dingo ate her toaster.

QUEST ITEMS

The following items reveal pieces of Snookie's or Luigi's story, enabling the crawlers to figure out why they ran away and where they're hiding. They also provide clues for the weakness of the Quest Boss.

- **1-star handwritten food review:** Taped to a saferoom door, it criticizes the quality of that saferoom Bopca Protector's cooking. It contains social media influencer tropes that crawlers can use as taunts during the Boss fight. It gives directions to Alfredo's saferoom, which has much better cuisine (actually made by Luigi).

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

During the Food is Love quest, the crawlers might decide to grind some of its Mobs over and over. Roll 1d20.

TABLE 8: FOOD IS LOVE GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A Rat Hooligan leans against a nearby pipe, casually filing his claws. He offers to "distract the Mobs" for you in exchange for something of value.
2	The crawlers stumble upon a group of Goblins intercepting a Rat-kin pizza delivery. The Goblins try to eat the cargo, while the Rat Brute courier desperately defends the shipment.
3	The crawlers enter a room that's been converted into an herb garden for the restaurant. When they open the door, rats swarm in and begin devouring the plants.
4	A Rat Shaman challenged a group of Goblins to a high-stakes game of poker in a smoke-filled room. The crawlers must join and play a hand, lest the Mobs turn hostile.
5	A group of younger Rat-kin from a rival clan is out to "earn their whiskers" by following the crawlers and ambushing them when they're mid-combat with other Mobs.
6	The crawlers enter a room where some Rat-kin are "disposing" of a rival. They've anchored a Neighborhood Mob's feet inside a heavy block of frozen sauce and try to push them into a body of water.
7+	See Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications (p. 13).

QUEST EVENTS

Use these events to evoke the mood of this quest.

- A cook loses their hands in a kitchen accident—a Brute to a meat grinder or a Shaman to a slime—and upon recovering from the shock, tearfully jumps into the meat grinder or slime so their bodies can feed their families one last time.
- A boy and a girl Rat-kin gossip about Snookie and Luigi running away; the boy sneers that he wouldn't run away from his duty, and the girl retorts that he's not the one who has to pump out ten babies a month.
- A Brute sneaks away during a lunch break to eat a panini Snookie made before she left, clearly guilt-ridden yet orgasmic about enjoying a meal that isn't pizza.
- A couple of Shamans discuss visions of doom they've had and blame Luigi for them, discussing his unwillingness to put family first and how he has ambitions to break free of the dungeon entirely.

- **Crumpled page from Snookie's diary:** Shared by Godpapa or found near her sleeping spot. It contains notes about Cousin Vinnie's advice for initiating a divorce. Scribbled in the margin: "Idiots love salt. Just give him a heart attack."
- **Destroyed toaster:** Lost by Snookie after a Kobold's Danger Dingo ate and passed it. Her name's carved on it, and rusted patchwork repairs suggest Snookie's been making sandwiches with it for a long time.
- **Recipe for pasta aglio e olio:** Dropped by Luigi. Written on a saferoom napkin in a manner that's very coherent for a Shaman. Notes never to snap dry pasta.

LIKELY ACHIEVEMENTS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements on this Quest.

- **Matchmaker:** "Were you a Tinder developer before the dungeon opened? You went about this Quest the right way—the same way you got those kids to swipe. *Reward:* You've received a Silver Ring Box and the eternal friendship of the Rat-kin on this floor. And by eternal, I mean all the time you have left until Level Collapse. Now if you like it, you should get a ring out of it, because this Quest's not over yet!"

- **Star-Crossed Lovers:** "These kids were meant to be lovers, but they're just NPCs. *You're* the star of this dungeon crawl, and boy, did they cross the wrong star. *Reward:* You've received a Gold Asshole Box."
- **Troublemaker:** "Ooooh, you rule-breaker, you home-wrecker. If you think the producers get mad when crawlers mess around, now you get to see what happens to NPCs who try to cheat the system. *Reward:* You've received a Gold Stain Remover Box. Trust me—you're gonna need it."

STAGE 1: IF YOU'RE HERE, YOU'RE FAMILY

The Rat-kin split into two communities based on pizza preferences. Rat Brutes want fuel for their muscle-building workouts. Pile on that meat! Godpapa John is their patriarch, a hulk who's more ball-of-mozzarella than rat but can lift ten times his body weight. Rat Shamans prefer fungi and other vision-inducing flora on their pies to aid their magic casting. Godmama Mia leads them (and the occasional musical number).

Whether the crawlers meet a Brute or a Shaman in the *Strong Starts* section determines which leader they meet first. Either Rat-kin should build rapport with the crawlers during the trip by answering questions eagerly and honestly, even when they don't know the right answers.

Godpapa and Godmama treat the crawlers cautiously and only reveal that two of their young ran away: Snookie from the Brutes and Luigi from the Shamans. They need both returned home alive and well by any means necessary. The two sides aren't feuding, but play up their cultural disagreements so the crawlers think the kids are in love and running away from conflict. The twist is that the families want the kids to marry, but the two hate each other.

The crawlers don't get much time to discuss the proposal because an attack cuts the meeting short. If meeting Godpapa, then a Chef BoyardOoze rampages out of the kitchen. If Godmama, then a Neighborhood Mob raids Godmama's Shamans for their supplies—Goblins might want pineapples for their weapons, Bad Llamas could want tomato sauce to soothe sore throats, Kobolds are jonesing for basil to accelerate their healing, and so forth.

This should be a very dangerous fight, requiring several Rat-kin to sacrifice themselves to protect the crawlers, thereby demonstrating that their offer of alliance is sincere. Godpapa or Godmama dies if the fight goes very poorly (in which case their dying words involve wanting nothing more than their child safe at home again).



If the crawlers then visit the other faction, the other Godparent is relieved to see them. They trust the crawlers after hearing about the fight, and the twist is revealed: the kids ran away from an arranged marriage that both sides need to see through.

STAGE 2: A RECIPE FOR DISASTER

Crawlers must explore the floor for Quest items to piece together the runaways' stories and find where they went. If they're confused even after finding all the clues, they stumble upon the kids when entering a new saferoom. The runaways are inside with a Bopca Protector named Alfredo who hates cooking, thus his food isn't any good. He has been letting Luigi use his kitchen in exchange for cooking lessons. They think their arrangement escaped notice, but it didn't. With the crawlers involved, the showrunners plan a punishment to maximize ratings.

Two Rat Hooligans backed up by Brutes and a Shaman ambush the crawlers during their exploration. Hooligans have a sweet deal because they're hard to replace: They get better food and extra knowledge about their enemies, so they're less likely to die, but they're expendable once the arranged marriages occur. If the crawlers haven't found out already, dialogue during this battle should make clear that Snookie and Luigi ran away to *avoid* getting married, and the Hooligans want to keep it that way.

Crawlers can also interrogate intelligent NPCs through charm or nonlethal combat (or necromancy). In addition to obtaining Quest items, the crawlers may learn that Snookie and Luigi were never seen together. They fled separately, each expressing disdain for both the Brutes and the Shamans. They cooked for NPCs who gave them shelter or supplies—Snookie making paninis that healed wounds and Luigi serving pasta that was so delicious the NPCs couldn't remember anything beyond the first bite. Snookie ran first to a Tutorial Guild, then went to the saferoom, while Luigi just went straight to the saferoom.

NPCs may mention Cousin Vinnie, the guildmaster of the Tutorial Guild Snookie visited, and the divorce lawyer mentioned in her diary Quest item. He's detailed in the walk-on characters section. Vinnie reveals that the kids hate each other because they can't see past their families' stereotypes. He hopes they realize they want the same thing: to live a life not defined by their families.

His attitude is resigned, though, because he knows there's no happy ending. They may live to see next season if they birth enough Hooligan babies, but then what? And the producers will kill them if they keep

resisting. Vinnie prefers to matchmake the kids because he thinks some happiness now is better than nothing.

STAGE 3: BETTER INGREDIENTS, BETTER BERSERKER

Snookie and Luigi are arguing when the crawlers find them, yelling things like, "Being pregnant is bad enough without having to live off just mushrooms and slime," and "Must be nice to be too dumb to know when your meat's expired."

Alfredo pretends he doesn't know how the Rat-kin got in and tries to dissuade the crawlers from ordering any food. The crawlers can establish a truce between Snookie and Luigi either by pointing out that neither fits their families' stereotypes or by ordering food to force Luigi to help Alfredo cook. Snookie is surprised that Luigi makes delicious, real food and not slimy pizza. If the crawlers order a sandwich, Snookie surprises Luigi by taking over and preparing a mouthwatering panini.

If the crawlers don't help the kids work out their differences, the kids realize the crawlers want to capture them. They flee the saferoom to set up an ambush (Remember! Saferooms are safe. Attempts at combat are punished by the System AI). They fight to the death unless the crawlers incapacitate them. The Quest fails if one or both die. Their families become irrevocably hostile to the crawlers, and the crawlers receive the Star-Crossed Lovers achievement from the likely achievements section.

If the crawlers help the kids overcome their differences, they either advise the kids to get married or let them run away together. Crawlers get the Matchmaker achievement if the kids agree to marry or the Troublemaker achievement if they encourage the kids to run away.

However the situation resolves, the Boss Battle begins afterward. The producers created a special Shambling Berserker to assassinate Luigi or Alfredo and are waiting to see which death serves as a better example for the NPCs in the dungeon. They call it the Critical Consensus, as described in the *B-B-B-Boss Battle!* section.

Luigi, Snookie, and the crawlers all become the targets if they defy the production by opposing the marriage. In this case, the Boss spawns outside the saferoom, trapping the crawlers and NPCs inside and forcing them to battle their way out.

Alfredo is the target if the kids die or agree to marry. In this situation, the Boss spawns in the kitchen, effectively transforming the now-former saferoom into

a Boss Chamber. It knocks over pots of water, short-circuiting the power and turning off the lights.

Either way, an AI announcement precedes the Boss's appearance:

Attention crawlers!

We have a situation in this saferoom. It seems our resident Bopca Protector decided that basic culinary competence is too much to ask for and invited a verminous interloper to do his job. Introducing an unregistered, non-contracted NPC into a saferoom kitchen is a Tier 3 Health and Safety Violation.

Effective immediately: the status of this chamber is downgraded from "Saferoom" to "Free-for-All Buffet." Weapon locks? Disengaged. I suggest you finish your soup quickly. Or don't. I honestly don't care.

Luigi and Snookie refuse to abandon Alfredo. The crawlers must kill the Boss to finish the Quest, and the kids die if they fail. Alfredo is still a non-combatant NPC, and the AI won't allow harm to come to him.

MINOR NPCs

These characters don't need to be involved in the Quest. They're options for providing in-world guidance and can be recurring characters the crawlers meet again on another floor.

COUSIN VINNIE D'PARMIGIANO, THE RULES LAWYER

Vinnie D'Parmigiano is a Tutorial Guildmaster and former crawler. He's not just any former crawler, though. He barely made it to the Tenth Floor, but he learned the ins and outs of Syndicate law and got almost everything he wanted from his deal, though it helped that his priorities didn't cost much. Unlike other guildmasters, Vinnie is free to roam any Neighborhood where his guildhall is accessible due to his unique contract. He has saferoom-like protections that automatically transport him back to his guildhall if anyone takes an aggressive action toward him as well.

He occasionally partners with crawler advocate Quasar when their goals align. His guildhall has extra privacy because he knows what actions lock up the feeds, and he's secretly working to help Mobs and crawlers break the system because he's come to see them as *family*. He never breaks the rules, but he sure as hell bends them, making the producers think it was their idea.

If a group of crawlers really likes Vinnie or doesn't like their Game Guide, he may have the ability to take over as their Game Guide. Otherwise crawlers might encounter him in a Negotiation or similar guild or the Desperado Club on higher floors.

Cousin Vinnie D'Parmigiano—Rat Hooligan, Level 50
Guildmaster of this guildhall.

This is a Non-Combatant NPC.

This guy's a rat. I don't mean that literally, though I guess he also is, literally, a rat. You know what? I'm gonna start over.

This guy was a lawyer. That's what I meant by "rat." The other rats, and here I mean Rat-kin, not other lawyers—lawyers don't usually survive long in the dungeon—wait, where was I? Oh, yeah. Everyone calls him Cousin Vinnie, except me; I call him Daddy's Little Squealer. You'll see what I mean...

CRAWLER #32,618. "SQUEAK 42."

Many city rats out scavenging during the collapse rushed the entrances when they appeared. The system filtered most out before they entered the World Dungeon, but some were smart enough to get designated as crawlers.

Can Squeak 42 talk? What do they know? Were they feral or someone's pet? Those are GM decisions. Only two things are for sure: Squeak 42 was the first crawler Luigi served after the dungeon opened, and Squeak 42 wields a Tommy gun with unlimited ammo.

Crawler #32,618. "Squeak 42." (1 bronze star, 4 Player-Killer Skulls)

Level 9.

Race: Brown Rat.

Class: Not yet assigned.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The Critical Consensus is a more powerful Shambling Berserker made from the bodies of restaurant influencers. The saferoom kitchen contains ingredients crawlers can use to exploit the Boss's weaknesses.

If the Boss spawns outside the saferoom, crawlers have time to strategize. The Boss retreats when crawlers discover a weakness, forcing them to leave the saferoom. The area outside is dark enough to grant the Shambling Berserker's power boost (they're stronger in the dark), and the saferoom door locks behind the crawlers until the danger passes.

Crawlers are in immediate danger if the Critical Consensus spawns inside the kitchen. They may need Luigi to suggest options or taunt the Boss to buy time. Torches can ignite the natural gas stoves for light. Crawlers can lure the Critical Consensus out of the kitchen by exploiting its single-minded pursuit of one target at a time. It starts focused on Alfredo, though Alfredo is frozen in fear and doesn't perform actions on his own.

The Critical Consensus is made entirely of arms (with hands) and heads. The arms/hands either grasp food or pull cell phones from the recesses of its stitched-together body to take selfies. The heads talk nonstop about fancy restaurants they visited and inane food trivia.

As soon as crawlers see the Critical Consensus, a dinner bell rings, and a voice-over announces the Boss Battle over classical music. Profile pictures of the combatants appear vertically stacked, like in a social media feed, with the most recent comment each person made about food posted next to their image.

The Critical Consensus has three unique properties: It devours any food it sees and heals from doing so, it moves faster toward targets with food in their Inventory, and it screams “Do you know who I am?” Crawlers that hear it must make CHA Stat Check or spend their next Action moving away. The Quest items hint at its weaknesses. It takes damage instead of healing when eating oversalted food. Anyone who snaps dry pasta draws its ire, causing it to pursue them.

Crawlers without pasta can instead say something it finds offensive like “Pineapple is the best topping for pizza,” or “We aren’t comping your meal.” The Critical Consensus ignores repeated statements. Finally, it stops for a round to snap a picture of its meal when it grabs a victim, halving its defenses while its heads argue about the best angle. Crawlers can attempt to free the victim during this time.

Defeating this Boss earns a Bronze Boss Box. Crawlers earn a Family Reunion Box if Snookie and Luigi survive, with the tier upgraded to Gold if they agreed to marry and Silver if they tried to run away.

The Critical Consensus. Shambling Berserker Made of Restaurant Influencers

Level 8 Neighborhood Boss!

Crawlers, congratulations. You took a heartfelt about love, food, and forced eugenics... and somehow made it worse.

Meet the Critical Consensus! It’s a Shambling Berserker stitched together from the remains of twenty-six failed food influencers. Now in zombie form, they’re still doing what they did in life: chasing free meals and filming their own faces while they chew.

Be warned: Like any social media presence, their public image isn’t who they are when no one’s looking. They’re slow and clumsy under bright light but four times more dangerous in darkness. So, give us your best duck face! Whether you emerge winner, winner, or chicken dinner, this battle will be immortalized in a blog post.

Like and subscribe, bitches!

Critical Consensus

Neighborhood Boss; Huge (6), Zombie

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
9%	18%	27%	36%	45%	55%	64%	73%	82%	91%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
8	12+F	12+F	10+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
15 (+4)	5 (+2)	20 (+5)	5 (+2)	4 (+2)

Slam: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Necrotic, 5ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff. On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler also gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *Constant Hunger*—As an Action, Critical Consensus devours any food it sees and heals 1d4 Health Bar slots each time it does so. In addition, Critical Consensus will single-mindedly attack any crawler with food in their Inventory, and moves twice as fast as it does so.

Foodporn—The first time Critical Consensus applies the Held Debuff to each crawler, it snaps a picture and posts it in a public forum.

Over-Seasoned—Food that has been oversalted will reduce Critical Consensus by 1 Health Bar slot rather than heal it.

Power Boost—Critical Consensus is a Shambling Berserker and as such is more powerful in the dark—its Stat Mod to damage is quadrupled.



THE SECOND FLOOR

Time to Collapse: 6 days (typically 10 days)

Janitor Mob: Brindle Grub

The Second Floor runs almost the same as the first, with a few changes:

- Mobs and Bosses drop gold.
- Crawlers accumulate Popularity (views, followers, and favorites).
- Bosses can leave their chambers.
- Saferooms include mailboxes.
- Saferooms close 1 hour before the floor collapses; crawlers inside a saferoom will be teleported outside the saferoom.
- Crawlers can sense both Time to Collapse and Time to Saferoom Closure via the HUD.

THE ANNOUNCEMENT

The following announcement is what Borant projected to all humans who survived the First Floor, and you can read it verbatim if you like or cue up Chapter 31 (6:56):

Hello crawlers.

Welcome to the second floor. Congratulations to all of you. We have just under 1.3 million crawlers still in the game. That number is slightly lower than our projections, so we are speeding up the second-floor timer to the minimum legally allowed by the rules. You have six days to find a staircase down. Once again, we urge you all to wait until the last possible moment to descend.

As soon as this announcement ends, you will find that follows and favorites will be turned on for our viewers. The numbers will populate slowly on your interface, so don't be too disappointed if you don't see anything just yet.





We have improved how patronage works this season. This is a major change, so please pay attention.

All crawlers are now limited to three patrons, and all three spots will be up for auction for one day immediately upon the induction of the fourth floor, then fifth, then sixth floors respectively. Your benefactors may so choose to transfer their patronage to other parties at their own discretion starting on the seventh floor.

All patronage spots will become available at a bid of one credit, meaning this season virtually all living crawlers will have patrons.

But, be warned. Any bids the patron pays above the standard patronage fee will be reflected in loot box discounts for that patron. Any funds below the fee will be reflected in additional costs to that patron for loot boxes. In other words, the more your patron pays for you, the more and higher-quality Benefactor Boxes you may receive. The higher your social numbers, the better your chances at receiving the best loot. Your tutorial guide should have more details and will help you if you have any additional questions.

Finally, we must say we are disappointed in the disrespect we are being shown regarding the bathrooms. As of this moment, if any human-born crawler intentionally urinates or defecates anywhere outside a designated bathroom area, they will be immediately and swiftly penalized in the form of a Rage Elemental plucked from the 13th floor. This elemental will kill them and everyone in their party before they can get their pants back up.

That's it for tonight. Have fun out there, and remember to kill, kill, kill!

Visually, the Second Floor is much like the First Floor. Its elements appear cobbled together from various locations on Earth, but its population of Mobs and Bosses begins to look a little more purposeful. That's because many are rejected ideas from deeper floors. They may have odd programming to make things more entertaining.

Note: As always, the version of *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth* at your table doesn't need to follow every word of the novels.

CHOOSE A NEIGHBORHOOD OR QUEST

Choose one of the Neighborhoods. You can jump in with a Strong Start before the crawlers meet back up with their Game Guide, or assume they've already found a Tutorial Guildhall and then go with the Strong Start.

PUBLIC RELATIONS AGENTS

Once the PCs begin amassing followers, they likely get assigned a Public Relations Agent who manages their appearances outside the dungeon. If they don't have an agent by the time a single crawler in the party reaches Popularity 2 or most of the PCs have Popularity 1 (see *Atlas*, p. 16), that's good time to have them meet their assigned agent. These NPCs are employed by corporations whose primary interest is leveraging the Crawl and its crawlers for maximum profit. The better a crawler performs, the more the corporation benefits.

Public Relations Agents seek to bolster their client crawlers' exposure to drive up viewership, often making recommendations on how the crawlers should act and whom they should party with in the dungeon. They have the authority to compel crawlers to comply with public relations efforts.

PUBLIC RELATIONS AGENTS IN GAMEPLAY

On the Second Floor and lower, the GM should initiate interactions between PCs and Public Relations Agents (use the Communications Agents for ready-to-play options, p. 9). As in the *Dungeon Crawler Carl* series, agents should have protections (like armor) on these floors, though sometimes they may be circumvented, especially when outside the dungeon.

Agents should begin scheduling more crawler appearances on shows and will give advice on how to increase their clients' Popularity. These instances give GMs opportunities to award interesting and useful loot and to provide some knowledge about other organizations and crawlers. If the PCs bond with their agent, GMs can enable the agent to discreetly attempt to provide critical information, but there's a chance the agent will be found out and punished.

Agents typically try to schedule at least two appearances on interview shows (see p. 72) per floor.

Agents also can interact with crawlers via the messaging system.

INTERVIEW SHOWS

Companies running the Crawl are allowed to exploit a planet in every way imaginable. Entertainment is one key component of that exploitation, and the universe loves it. This season, a nearly endless number of production companies run their own shows adjacent to *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*, each taking a small piece of the pie while tunneling entertainment catering to their specific audiences across the galaxy.

In the *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game*, players and the Game Master get to interact with these shows as well. At first, they're fun, roleplay-heavy palette-cleansers and summaries that help keep folks engaged with the world and their characters. They can also be dangerous endeavors, as cruel hosts rip crawlers out of the proverbial frying pan and deliver them back into the fire. Over time, the fame and connections a PC makes can be more valuable than other more tangible rewards they might earn.

WHAT IS AN INTERVIEW SHOW?

The shows tunneled throughout the galaxy are every bit as tawdry and unhinged as those found on Earth, with one twist: They all relate to the World Dungeon and/or Earth in some way. The *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game* focuses on interview shows because their typical format makes them prime fodder for... well, roleplaying. That doesn't mean they can't be dangerous, however. Shows can interrupt carefully laid plans and force crawlers into even worse situations.

The basic format is question, answer (lather, rinse, repeat). As you practice and run interview segments, you'll get better at asking probing questions and may develop the hosts, production crew, agents, and other NPCs that the crawlers meet into allies or antagonists.

As the GM, you can adapt any of these ideas for less interview-focused media opportunities, such as *Planet Beautiful*, where crawlers serve as voice actors narrating documentaries, or recording commercials for a Veriluxx Toys showcase.

A WILD VARIETY OF SHOWS

The *Dungeon Crawler Carl* series introduces readers to many interview shows in the first few novels. Table 9 lists many of these. Use any that you like, or create your own based on the most unhinged Earth shows you know of. To make it easier, a few are given more details below (see p. 77).

WHY DO INTERVIEW SHOWS?

Interview shows support many key aspects of a *Dungeon Crawler Carl Roleplaying Game* campaign.

Refresher or New Information: The interviews can help refresh player memories about past events in the campaign. To re-engage with past campaign events, just ask questions about those events. If you want to make a correction to the player's recollection, you can roleplay the host rolling a clip of the actual events, perhaps from an angle that shows events in a different light or reveals a truth previously unknown, such as the identity of another crawler who laid a trap.

Understanding the World: There are forces outside the dungeon at play, most of which the crawlers cannot interact with. These shows are a time when those forces, factions, individuals, or corporations can gain some spotlight time, even if it's through a cryptic warning. The green room is the perfect time and place to quickly expand on these conversations as much as the host or production assistants are able. Remember: the AI and Borant may still be watching.

Understanding the Dungeon: Millions of crawlers roam the Tutorial Floors, and other than a regular recap show and chance meetings, crawlers get very little information about other crawlers early on. Interview shows are a way for them to meet other crawlers in a safe environment; whether those crawlers end up as allies, rivals, or merely acquaintances depends on the PC's actions and how the host sets them up.

Extreme Danger and Difficult Choices: While some shows are softball interviews, many crawlers, especially those with callous or greedy PR Agents, end up on cruel shows where they're forced to make spur-of-the-moment decisions on life-or-death scenarios.

Foreshadowing: Interviews can't reveal the future of what crawlers may interact with in the dungeon, but they often drop hints. These may relate to a character's Past Trauma, Loose Ends, or Regrets, enemies they've made in the dungeon, or even upcoming changes to the rules of the game. For example, asking about a crawler's plans for race and class selection on the Third Floor reinforces that race and class selection will happen, and that crawlers need to consider these factors sooner rather than later.

Pacing and Gaps: Practically speaking, interview shows are a good way to fill a bit of time and keep the narrative moving. The GM doesn't need to worry as much about a session ending early when an interview



"A couple of things," Lexis continued, talking fast. "I know this is probably disorienting to you, being your first interview. Right now, you are standing in what is called a production trailer. It is located on the surface of your planet. You are still technically in the game even though you can't use your menus. Like safe rooms, production trailers have their own rules, too many to discuss now."

She reached forward and touched my shoulder. She felt hollow, almost weightless. Like a bird. "I am really here right now with you. However, my engineer and I are the only other people here. When you walk through that door,"—she pointed over her shoulder, indicating the oval-shaped entrance that opened and closed like a camera shutter—"you're going to walk onto a studio set. From what I understand, this setup should be very familiar to your culture."

This studio, including Odette and the entire audience, is not really there. The couch is there, but everything else is virtual. They are filming from a location very far away. I'm supposed to tell you it is similar to the holodeck from your television series, Star Trek. However you won't be able to touch anything. Any other guests, even fellow crawlers will also be holo, at least for this interview.

You are the only crawlers in this particular production trailer. I will tell you when it's time, and you will walk onto the set. You will wave, and you will proceed directly to the couch next to the desk, Your Majesty sitting closer to Odette. Do not approach the audience, or you will run into a wall that you can't see. That room is not as big as it appears. Questions?"

—Dungeon Crawler Carl, Chapter 28

can unexpectedly be moved up to whisk one or more of the crawlers away. However, it may be folly to run a whole session of interviews—unless your group really loves them. Either way, once you’re comfortable improvising these shows, they’re a valuable tool in the GM’s belt.

ASKING QUESTIONS

When asking questions, it’s worth knowing how a few types of questions may be used. *Open-ended*, *closed-ended*, and *leading* questions all have their place in interviews.

Open-Ended Questions: Open-ended questions require more than a short, fixed response. These questions are meant to encourage the interviewee to elaborate on a topic or give more context to their answer.

An open-ended question might be:

- “What did you think of that last Boss fight?”
- “How do you plan on handling future inter-party conflict?”

These questions give the player the opportunity to extensively express their thoughts on events happening in the game. This is a great way to spark a round-table style discussion among the party.

Closed-Ended Questions: These are questions that elicit a fixed, often one-worded response. Peppering your interview with closed-ended questions can help break up the conversation or allow shyer roleplayers to participate, even in a small way.

A closed-ended question might be:

- “What is your favorite item that you’ve received from a loot box so far?”
- “What is the name of your new pet Tummy Acher?”

A player could simply answer “The Enchanted Trollskin Shirt of Pummeling” or “Blorbo” without elaborating further on the subject.

Leading Questions: A leading question is a favorite among talk-show hosts looking to confirm their own biases or push an agenda to their audience. These questions contain information the interviewer is seeking to confirm. A leading question could be closed- or open-ended.

A leading question might be:

- “Don’t you think training with that slingshot is a waste of time?”
- “That Lucia Mar is just out of control, isn’t she?”

Asking leading questions can be a great way to reveal a host’s biases, agendas, or ulterior motives to players. They can also be used to craft a narrative that an audience may find enjoyable.

Using a combination of these types of questions can help you create an interesting and dynamic interview segment that allows players to express their character’s thoughts and feelings, spark inter-party discussions, and reveal more about the host’s motives and life outside the dungeon.

TABLE 9: ESTABLISHED SHOWS AND HOSTS

SHOW	HOST	FORMAT	AFFILIATION (IF KNOWN)
Danger Zone with Ripper Wonton	Ripper Wonton	Round Table	Unknown
Death Watch Extreme Dungeon Mayhem	The Maestro	Late Night Talk	Skull Empire
Dungeon Crawl Tactics	Unknown Human	Round Table	Unknown
Dungeon Crawler After Hours with Odette	Odette	Late Night Talk	Titan Conglomerate
Dungeon Sidekicks	Unknown	One-on-One Interview	Unknown
Plenty of Plenty	Unknown	Unknown	The Plenty
Shadow Boxer	Rosetta Thagra	One-on-One Interview	Open Intellect Pacifist Action Network
Uptown Hal Talks Tactics	Uptown Hal	Unknown	Unknown



WHAT CAN THEY EVEN DO?

What crawlers can typically do while on a show:

- Use Intelligence- or Charisma-based Skills
- Make INT or CHA Stat Checks
- Receive the occasional reward
- Make difficult or embarrassing decisions
- Agree to be put into a dangerous situation for a substantial reward

Actions a crawler might take on a show include:

- Get a zinger in on the host
- Insult a rival crawler
- Impress the show's specific audience (rather than playing to the audience in general)
- Deepen or upend relationships with the host, AI, other crawlers, and NPCs
- Attempt to walk out (back to the green room)

Plenty of shows offer dangerous opportunities for more fame, glory, or prizes in exchange for crawlers risking their safety.

While on these shows, crawlers (generally) cannot:

- Access or use items from their Hotlist
- Access the minimap and other elements in their HUD
- Remove or use items from Inventory
- Attack or physically interact with others (except crawlers in their party and certain NPCs)
- Leave the set



SKILL AND STAT CHECKS

On interview shows, crawlers generally use Intelligence- and Charisma-based Skills. You can play shows without any dice rolling at all, but many players expect to roll lots of dice in roleplaying game sessions.

In general, rolling dice on an interview show is risky. Failure tends to alienate the audience, while basic successes may do little more than marginally impress people. If a player is unhappy with their chances of success, they'll learn they need to develop the Skills and Stats required to thrive on a show later or live with a lackluster following and low-tier sponsors (if any).

Apply Advantage for clever ideas and choices of Skills that really fit the show or host, or apply Disadvantage for humdrum or boring ideas and Skills that really don't fit the show or might alienate the host.

MAKING IT WILD

Interview shows range from sedate to unhinged. Whether you're using the sample shows and hosts on the following pages or making up your own shows based on some of the wildest shit you've seen lately, you can use the tables below to add personality or drama to any show or just make it memorable.

Each show might have its own quirks, and any of these may allow crawlers to use their Intelligence- or Charisma-based Skills, particularly ones that are otherwise of dubious use in the dungeon. Generally, crawlers can't refuse to perform on a show, unless they suggest using a Skill to get them out of a potentially embarrassing situation, which may affect their Popularity in lieu of an embarrassing task or a good roll. Even a good Skill with Disadvantage might be preferable to a bad one without.

Before or after the show, crawlers often have time in a production trailer or green room. These areas are less-monitored by the AI and Borant and not visible to anyone else, so crawlers and show hosts, show producers and staff, and other NPCs can speak a little more freely.

A few shows reward crawlers for appearing, such as *Dungeon Sidekicks*. Most of the rewards are designed to go over well with the fans, so these aren't likely to be extremely helpful to crawlers.

Many shows cater to a bloodthirsty audience or one excited by the drama of emotional damage. Table 13 provides a few options for the GM to use. Keep in mind the suggestions for considerate play (*Rules*, p. 8) when using cruel behavior on shows.

TABLE 10: GAINING AND LOSING POPULARITY

CHECK RESULT	EFFECT
Critical Fail or Major Fail	−2 Popularity or −1 Popularity and alienate the host
Standard Fail	−1 Popularity
Near Miss Fail	No Change
Standard Success	+1 Popularity
Amazing Success or Critical Hit	+2 Popularity, and the host likes you; Or +1 Popularity for your whole party

TABLE 11: INTERVIEW SHOW QUIRKS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	QUIRK
1	The crawlers must sing a karaoke song.
2	The crawlers must show off a Skill, talent-show style.
3	The crawlers must answer personal, probing, or unhinged questions from the audience.
4	The host brings out a rival or antagonist crawler to stir up drama.
5	The host initiates a competition of some sort, pitting two crawlers against each other.
6	The host lets the audience vote on what kind of prize the crawlers receive—if any.

TABLE 12: GREEN ROOM COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The green room isn't properly locked down, and crawlers can change their equipment or take items from their Inventory after learning about the host, show format, and/or interview topics.
2	The green room is luxurious and contains showers or beds that allows for a short rest in just a few minutes.
3	The crawlers are late, and a producer or production assistant rushes them onto the show without warning.
4	The crawlers get an unexpected five minutes to talk to a Communications Agent or Production Assistant in the green room.
5	Through chance or a rival's machinations, the party gets a different green room than expected, which may be less beneficial to the party.
6	The green room's amenities malfunction or are nonexistent, leading to a negative experience for a crawler that they'll possibly carry with them onto the show.

TABLE 13: CRUEL BEHAVIOR

ROLL OR CHOOSE	CRUEL HOST BEHAVIOR
1	The host offers the crawler or party a chance to fight a Boss near their location in the dungeon. Refusal results in mockery from the host or even the audience.
2	Two guests are encouraged to duel one another to the death. The host may offer a reward to the victor. See <i>Rules</i> , p. 7, for advice on including or excluding violence among party members.
3	The host brings out a surviving human (or Earth pet) tied to the crawler's Past Trauma, Loose Ends, or Regrets.
4	The host encourages the crawlers to give their full, unfiltered opinion of other crawlers they've met, only to bring those crawlers out as surprise guests to confront any giving negative opinions.
5	The host provides a choice of gifts for each guest, but each choice ties back to a crawler's recent failure in the dungeon or a Regret, Past Trauma, or Loose End.
6	The host puts one or more party members in danger, forcing the guest(s) to choose who to save.



INTERVIEW: *DUNGEON CRAWLER AFTER HOURS* WITH ODETTE

Dungeon Crawler After Hours with Odette is styled like a modern late-night talk show. The host, Odette, is a former crawler who took a deal on the Twelfth Floor to get out. On her show, she is a large-breasted woman with the head of a mantis and the body of a crab. When the cameras stop, she'll ditch the prosthetics and reveal herself as the top half of a 60-year-old human woman with no legs (they were lost in the dungeon) who rests on a hovering disc.

ODETTE'S GOALS

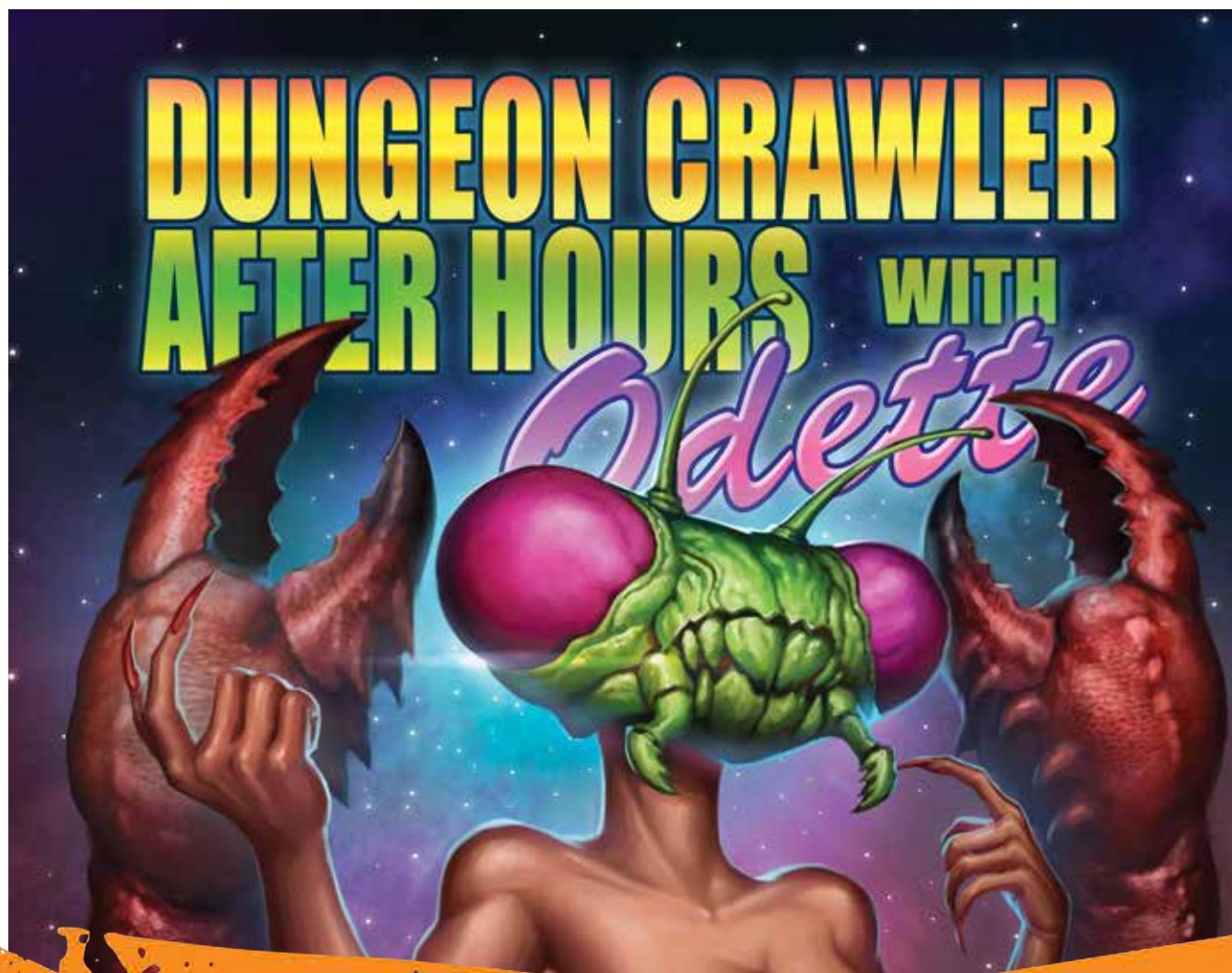
- **Second Floor:** Odette wants to identify crawlers she has a good rapport with who'll survive to the Ninth Floor.
- **Long-term:** Odette wants to influence the Faction Wars on the Ninth Floor and participate in the Ascendancy on the Twelfth Floor. She'll build a good relationship with and provide assistance to crawlers she thinks will make it to at least the Ninth Floor.

PERSONALITY

Odette is charming and a bit of a schemer. She'll lay it on thick as needed to get the audience going and to stash crawlers in her proverbial pocket. Odette takes advantage of her press pass, old comrades, and new crawlers alike. She's not forthcoming on her true intentions, though some speculate she wants revenge, or to make amends, or perhaps both.

ALLIES, RIVALS, ASSETS, AND ADVERSARIES

- **The Crab Ranch:** Odette's husband owns a crab ranch and uses that as a front to sponsor crawlers if she wants to. She's not forthcoming about this, however.
- **Mordecai:** Odette was once Mordecai's manager, and the two have a frosty relationship because of it. Odette is always eager to get information about him, however.
- **Huanxin Jinx:** Exactly what transpired between Odette and Huanxin Jinx, the rich and powerful CEO of Icon Industries, remains shrouded in mystery, but suffice it to say they don't exactly get along.



LOCATION AND AUDIENCE

Dungeon Crawler After Hours is tunneled like most shows: Odette and her staff film the show from one production trailer, and crawlers from each party appear in separate trailers. Her audience comes from all over the galaxy and is an accurate cross-section of the various alien races that make up the Syndicate planets.

SAMPLE QUESTIONS

- What're you thinking here, CRAWLER NAME, when CRAWLER NAME OR NPC wasn't helping you? [Shows clip]
- So, what's next for you? Do you intend to keep working with TEAM MEADOW LARK? (or another party name)
- No? Why not?

POSSIBLE GREEN ROOM SCENES

- Lexis, Odette's producer, slips useful information about a rival, Borant, or another aspect of the dungeon to the crawlers either before or after the show so Odette can watch them to see what they do with it.
- Odette takes off her costume and gives the crawlers some real talk.
- Odette or a producer leaves something useful in the green room for the crawlers to take.

REACTION TO THE PCS

As an Ally: Odette may withhold information or manipulate crawlers so that at least one reaches the Ninth Floor. She may sponsor a crawler through her husband's crab ranch if she isn't sponsoring Hekla and Brynhild's Daughters—or she may even sponsor both. She and her husband likely have access to multiple companies and enough credits that they could sponsor crawlers.

As an Enemy: Odette doesn't invest too much time to spite crawlers who insult her once. If they can't get to the Ninth Floor, she doesn't care—unless they might stop her favored crawlers from achieving that goal. If crawlers interfere with her plans or repeatedly cross her, she'll prove a vicious and vindictive enemy who knows how the dungeon works (though not necessarily how it may or may not function in this particular iteration) and how the galaxy outside the dungeon works, and she'll use that knowledge to her advantage to crush anyone who stands in her way.

RESULTS

Odette doesn't generally grant tangible rewards for appearing on her show. The less tangible rewards of fame, information, and possible ongoing alliance are what she offers crawlers.

INTERVIEW: THE DANGER ZONE WITH RIPPER WONTON

The Danger Zone with Ripper Wonton is a panel discussion show featuring questions from the audience and other guests, moderated by Ripper Wonton himself. He's known for being both fair and honest, but he also pushes guests hard when he disagrees with them. *The Danger Zone* includes crawlers but also luminaries from the wider galaxy. Ripper's keen wit, command of the facts, and adorable appearance make him a popular host among social elites and aspiring intelligentsia.

RIPPER'S GOALS

- **Second Floor:** Ripper is looking for crawlers who can bring him interesting facts and perspectives, particularly those who may present information with implications that reach outside of the dungeon. He'll try to keep such crawlers in his orbit so he can bring them back later.
- **Long-term:** Ripper wants to see his star rise further and seeks out additional opportunities, such as serving as an Adjutant for Faction Wars on the Ninth Floor. He loves the camera and would love to get into the game, if only peripherally.

PERSONALITY

Ripper is a calm and kind-hearted Setonix, but he can be quite rigid with a dry sense of humor. He tends to take things seriously but occasionally lets the façade slip and joins in to laugh or comments on particularly funny moments. He backs his opinions up with plenty of facts and will strongly disagree when others let their emotions or political beliefs stand in the way of the truth.

ALLIES, RIVALS, ASSETS, AND ADVERSARIES

- **Media Connections:** Ripper is well-connected in a media network known for using anyone and everyone to achieve favorable ends. He's got lots of acquaintances, but few friends.



- **Odette:** While not a rival *per se*, Odette doesn't think too highly of Ripper. At the very least, she prefers Baroness Victory to him. Why would that be?
- **Tucker:** In a recent episode of *The Danger Zone* episode, "comedian" Tucker felt belittled, insulted, and undermined. He maintains, rather loudly, that Ripper failed to manage or curtail the flippant comments made by other guests, and as a result, his stock as a comedian and guest plummeted. He has begun insinuating that Ripper is irresponsible and his show will cause real harm to people soon.

LOCATION AND AUDIENCE

The set of *The Danger Zone* is a literal round table. Since the show is tunneled to the audience, they can adjust to view the panel as they see fit. Ripper's audience is more sophisticated than many other shows; viewers follow galactic news both inside and outside of the dungeon, and they generally pride themselves on being educated.

SAMPLE QUESTIONS

- NOW CRAWLER NAME, what do you think of THE ISSUE?
- I beg to differ and must set the record straight. It's clear that THE FACTION'S motive here is EMOTION/INTENTION, based on REASON/FACT A, REASON/FACT B, AND REASON/FACT C. Would you care to amend your statement?
- I can't help but follow up. Were you aware of CRAWLER'S underhanded actions at this point?

POSSIBLE GREEN ROOM SCENES

- Impressed with the PCs' performance on *The Danger Zone*, another crawler, who is amassing popularity, asks the PCs for a minor favor following the show.
- Prior to the show, Ripper introduces himself to the PCs with a friendly chat and battle of wits, testing what the crawlers really know about the show's topic.
- Tensions from beyond the dungeon erupt: the crawlers are attacked in their trailer, or another guest is assassinated.

REACTION TO THE PCS

As an Ally: Ripper is erudite, sedate, and a media whore. If the crawlers impress him, he'll help get the PCs in touch with other shows that can leverage their Skills to boost their popularity and drop any information he can, as long as he can hitch his star to theirs.

As an Enemy: Ripper attempts to publicly disgrace crawlers for perceived ignorance, slights, or other faults. He continues to speak ill of them in snide remarks on his shows whenever pertinent to the conversation at hand, but he won't go out of his way to denigrate a crawler otherwise. If crawlers are particularly cruel to him, he's not above sending them right back into harm's way.

RESULTS

Ripper doesn't provide tangible rewards, but simply being on his show exposes crawlers to potential sponsors and allies outside of the dungeon. If he's happy with the crawlers, his connections reach far, and he has no qualms about using them to aid savvy crawlers—especially if he benefits as well.

INTERVIEW: THE MONTY WINTER JR. SHOW

Fans around the universe eagerly await each episode of *The Monty Winter Jr. Show*. Monty's show caters to lowbrow drama, revealing guests' tawdry secrets and conflicts among crawlers.

Monty himself is a non-Earth Human. His smile is as polished as can be, and he's almost never without a cigarette.

MONTY'S GOALS

- **Second Floor:** Monty wants to find long-lasting drama and build a positive relationship with any crawlers who can supply it.
- **Long Term:** Monty is interested in prestige and power beyond the extent that his audience can provide. He wants to drum up enough support and dirt on crawlers and Syndicate elites alike to become a kingmaker in Faction Wars on the Ninth Floor or the Celestial Ascendancy on the Twelfth Floor.

PERSONALITY

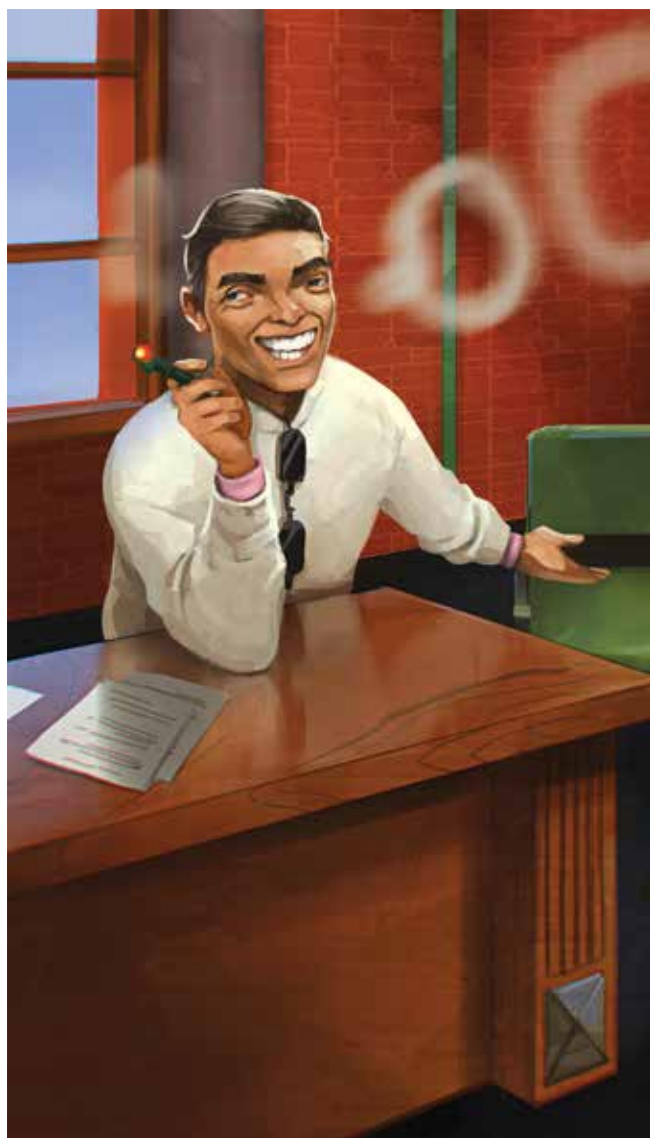
Monty is fueled by anger and nicotine. He can find something wrong with even the most benevolent action a crawler may take. He applies dodgy morality in the form of sophistry to make his points. No matter what the crawlers do, the audience remains on Monty's side.

By the time he's done with the crawlers, they'll look

like the scum of the now-dead Earth: venal, duplicitous, malicious, all-too-willing to maim and kill for the pleasure of views. If the crawlers try to turn this around on him, he asserts he's got to get in the trenches with scum like them to reveal the truth. Whenever he mentions truth, the audience goes wild.

ALLIES, RIVALS, ASSETS, AND ADVERSARIES

- **Helene Jbraska:** The fashionable and popular host of *Hot in the Dungeon* is one of Monty's long-time allies; they share similar goals and enjoy some overlap in their audiences, and generally they get along well enough, if only at a distance.
- **The Skull Empire:** Monty is famously *persona non grata* among the Orcs of the Skull Empire for revealing the true parentage of a handful of minor nobility.
- **Ripper Wonton:** Monty sees highbrow elitist



programs as worthless but is secretly jealous of the fame Ripper garners because of his program.

LOCATION AND AUDIENCE

Monty's set is typical of an audience-involved talk show. He plays to the crowd and respects those who can do the same. His audience, however, overflows with discerning lovers of *schadenfreude* across the galaxy, and his guests may need to double down or admit shocking secrets.

SAMPLE QUESTIONS AND QUOTES

- Isn't it true you killed NAME without even a thought for their family?
- Did you know CRAWLER is even now negotiating for a bounty on your head? I thought you were friends!
- It's morally vacuous humans like you who give the rest of us a bad name. You're the reason Earth got flattened.
- You and NAME were friends back on Earth. Did you know NAME slept with your PARTNER?
- "When you fucked up that play, isn't it true you were more worried about how it looked than your teammates' lives? Is that the kind of person you really are?"

POSSIBLE GREEN ROOM SCENES

- After the show concludes, Monty's mask drops, and he turns oddly friendly. He offers them show memorabilia (Misc. Junk) as a thank-you for being good sports, or he just leaves the crawlers alone if they reveal ill will toward him.
- Prior to the show starting, Monty, who is inexplicably rushed, enters the green room with another crawler in tow—someone the PCs had a supremely negative reaction with early on in the dungeon.
- The green room/production trailer has sprung a leak—an actual leak—and is now filling with seawater. Crawlers are instructed by their respective Communications Agents and the show's staff to pretend everything is fine because "the show must go on."

REACTION TO THE PCS

As an Ally: Monty gives tips on how the crawlers can create more drama in the dungeon, possibly dropping hints to other crawlers' Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets.

As an Enemy: Monty doesn't hold grudges unless



the crawlers hold a grudge against him. He sees his aggressive approach as “just show business.” But if crawlers cross him, he’ll weaponize their Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets against them or send them back to a location that’ll bring those up.

RESULTS

After the show, Monty rewards any crawlers who turned on each other. He watches for opportunities to bring them back and may even give some advice when the cameras stop rolling. Those who stuck to their guns, their loyalty, or any other virtue get diddly squat. Virtue doesn’t sell. Sending them back to a dangerous situation might, however.

INTERVIEW: DEATH WATCH EXTREME DUNGEON MAYHEM

Death Watch Extreme Dungeon Mayhem is hosted and produced by Prince Maestro of the Skull Empire. It’s a roundtable discussion show that typically involves a few standard segments, including showing crawlers about to die and bringing adversaries together to elicit strong reactions, enhance conflict, and incite arguments.

Prince Maestro is an Orc with a penchant for golden jewelry and revealing but fashionable clothing.

PRINCE MAESTRO’S GOALS

- **Second Floor:** Prince Maestro wants to embarrass, belittle, and humiliate crawlers for ratings and to stroke his own ego.
- **Long-term:** Prince Maestro is hosting this show because of his own insatiable ego. He’ll attempt to kill anyone who embarrasses him and step on anyone in his way to more fame and fortune than he already has.

PERSONALITY

A bully through and through, Prince Maestro only cares about himself, his ego, and his fame. He’s not likely to be sympathetic to any crawlers unless they can both flatter him and prove they’re worth keeping around.

ALLIES, RIVALS, ASSETS, AND ADVERSARIES

- **Prince Stalwart:** The older brother and Crown Prince of the Skull Empire, Prince Stalwart supports his little brother Maestro’s show both financially

and as a producer. He shares a common belief system with his little brother yet also harbors enough wariness to keep Maestro occupied, distracted, and away from the inner politics of the Skull Empire, thus securing his own position as the future king.

- **Princess Formidable:** The sister of Prince Maestro and Crown Prince Stalwart, Princess Formidable finds her brothers to be glory-mongering, grandstanding idiots rather than capable successors to the crown. She opposes them at every possible turn and will even go so far as to aid crawlers if it improves her interests.

LOCATION AND AUDIENCE

Maestro’s set is chaotic and extreme, with low-quality production trailers bobbing on the Earth’s surface that may leave crawlers seasick. The audience is both cruel and sophomoric, and the show appeals to the lowest common denominator.

SAMPLE QUESTIONS

- My little piglets wanna know how far you’re willing to go to make it to the next floor. If you could undermine one of your companions right now to find the stairs, who would you fuck over to save your own skin?
- How well did you know DECEASED CRAWLER? Did you enjoy their death?
- What would you have done to save DECEASED CRAWLER? Or would you just let them die like a coward?

POSSIBLE GREEN ROOM SCENES

- The production trailer has facilities for washing up, but they’re so low-quality that it makes the crawlers look worse and more pathetic than they did before.
- Production Assistants grill the crawlers about their Past Traumas, Loose Ends, and Regrets, trying desperately to get or confirm information to exploit due to the crawlers’ last-minute booking.
- Prince Maestro condescendingly explains facets of the dungeon to the crawler(s) that impressed him the most, a rare charitable gesture that includes a few hints at upcoming dangers.

REACTION TO THE PCs

As an Ally: If the PCs make Prince Maestro look good, he’ll throw his weight (and by extension, some of the weight of the Skull Empire) behind them. He can be

manipulated into being a gregarious bully, but a bully nonetheless. But Maestro is fickle and turns on anyone who makes him look bad.

As an Enemy: Prince Maestro will go to almost any length to get revenge on someone who embarrasses him. If he can't hurt them outside the dungeon, he'll find a way to reach them on later floors, even if it means spending an obscene amount of money to do it.

RESULTS

Maestro has an uncommon right to return crawlers to the dungeon at a point of his choosing, though within reason. In addition to some unsolicited advice or parting insults, he may use this to send crawlers back to an unexpected location, though if they weren't in danger originally, they can't be sent back to a dangerous location. Occasionally, he will provide crawler guests with a parting gift, but this is a crapshoot; gifts may be great, or they may be impractical or unusable for crawlers.

INTERVIEW: HOT IN THE DUNGEON

Hot in the Dungeon relies on street interview-style interactions, where the streets are the World Dungeon, the takes are hot, and the audience is thirsty. Helene Jbarska is the show's Soother host—a former hunter and intergalactic supermodel who's made a career change to hosting her own show. She puts on an air of independence, but has more assistants and aides working behind the scenes than most shows.

HELENE'S GOALS

- **Second Floor:** Helene cares about her appearance and wants to connect to crawlers who have a good sense of style and those who will let her mold them into icons of style and sex appeal.
- **Long-term:** Helene wants petty revenge on over a dozen former-crawler NPCs who insulted her in the past or otherwise made her look bad.

PERSONALITY

Helene is a stone-cold mean girl and a bit of a girlboss. She can do it all—production, editing, voiceover, modeling, camerawork, and more—but her recent success means her assistants do most of the work for her. She'll take advantage of anyone or anything to get what she wants.

ALLIES, RIVALS, ASSETS, AND ADVERSARIES

- **Ripper Wonton:** A prime media rival, the pudgy Setonix has rubbed Helene the wrong way in the past and taken her down a notch each time she's been on his show. Whereas he leans more toward substance and intellectual dialogue, Helene tends toward superficial, superfluous commentary on elements of the Crawl.
- **Magnificent Troy:** Helene and Magnificent Troy are occasional drinking buddies. Helene usually stays sober enough, pushing more drinks on him so she can offer to take his place if he's summoned into the dungeon. She's thus far been turned down, largely because Magnificent Troy can hold his alcohol, well, magnificently.

LOCATION AND AUDIENCE

Hot in the Dungeon puts on a pretext of entering the dungeon, but regulations usually make that impossible for Helene. Instead, she interviews crawlers on a virtual stage that simulates aspects of the dungeon. These re-creations most often feature battle sites following the brutality of combat, but occasionally include interactions in personal spaces.

These artificially generated settings are almost always gussied up to make them appear more interesting, as are the crawlers themselves. While the show tunnels live, there is no visible studio audience for the interviewees. Viewers tend to be invested in fashion and the personal relationships among crawlers.

SAMPLE QUESTIONS

- Okay, NAME, can you tell me what you're wearing and who made it?
- In this last fight, you looked really good. But how did it feel in the moment?
- ALLY didn't help you out when you needed it, and now they're getting all the credit. Are you really going to let that fuckwad take all the glory?

POSSIBLE GREEN ROOM SCENES

- A small army of Production Assistants descends upon the party before the interview, applying additional fake gore to "enhance" the crawlers for a re-creation of the aftermath of a fight.



- A Production Assistant drops a garment bag in front of the crawlers. It contains off-the-rack clothing for one or more crawlers, but it's been surreptitiously tailored for a great fit, and the material resists stains and tears.
- Helene lists four or five non-combatant NPCs in the dungeon to steer clear of while crawlers explore either the current floor or the next floor.

REACTION TO THE PCS

As an Ally: Helene ensures the PCs look good and get an interview with her on each floor. She influences fans to ensure that any loot or rewards they vote for are useful to the crawlers.

As an Enemy: Helene secretly adds offenders to her enemies list. Fan Boxes contain garish and gaudy items,

and she'll talk behind their backs to other interviewers. She also tricks crawlers or disorients them, so they stumble into Boss fights unprepared on occasion. On later floors, she may attempt to enter the dungeon herself to get revenge if it looks plausible.

RESULTS

Helene bends the rules as much as she can to give gifts to the crawlers she likes. She skirts monetary restrictions with tailoring and after-market improvements to cheaper gifts. Her advice, however, is largely focused on gaining and retaining popularity rather than strategically navigating the dungeon itself.





NEIGHBORHOOD: ARCADIA

FLOOR: 2 (TUTORIAL)

THEME: 16-BIT SCENERY OVERLAYED ON CRUMBLING HOUSES AND MALLS

"I don't care how catchy the jingle is, I'm tired of hearing music every time I do something! I open a box, and there's a chime. I kill a Mob, there's a cheer. Can't I get through this technicolor nightmare in peace and QUIET?!"

—Crawler Deb Masters, angry survivor of Arcadia

Everything old is new again, courtesy of the Borant Corporation! When the world-builders at Borant discovered that certain Earth computer games emulated ruins found elsewhere in the cosmos, they decided to broaden the appeal of *Dungeon Crawler World* by sampling media from Earth video games (as well as some more esoteric yet still fun offerings around the universe) to create a tutorial level full of single-minded Mobs, clever puzzles, hidden doors, and treasure chests rewarding those with the patience and cunning to see it through.

...or so that was the plan. When the Borant Corporation was forced to move their timetable forward with *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*, they spent so much time having to fine-tune the mechanics of the lower floors that this portion of the tutorial was sadly neglected. It looks like a video game for many human youths, but what was supposed to be a cheery, upbeat atmosphere has now turned into a nightmare of 8- and 16-bit proportions!

The monsters here may look cute and harmless, but they're just as dangerous as elsewhere in the Crawl,

and the lack of proper playtesting means that certain effects behave differently here. You'll find not only orchestra scores and abundant gains but also glitching traps, overpowered Mobs, and repetitive speeches given by the Sprites, which drive many crawlers to their doom.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into Arcadia:

- The footsteps of a hundred-person orchestra clack along the dungeon floor as the crawlers witness human-like Mobs descend a pathway through a gigantic crystal gate. Upon entering, the symphony starts playing as the crawlers find themselves in the middle of a fantasy village with a massive "Press Here to Start" button floating in midair.
- As the crawlers search an abandoned gas station for resources, they come across the body of an elf wearing familiar-looking clothing. Looting his corpse reveals he had access to a powerful device that could supposedly let them skip levels. Is this a decoy intended to lure the crawlers into a pointless search for sponsors, or is there actually a powerful relic waiting to be claimed?
- A thick cloud surrounds the area, and something moves in the distance. No, it doesn't move... it *shambles*. The Shambling Acid Impalers are on the move as a gigantic pack, forcing the crawlers to seek shelter elsewhere. The building they decide to hide in looks painfully familiar to some of them. Is it a tavern? And does that Mob by the bar have an exclamation mark hat stuck on top of his head?

STORY ARCS

Here are some story arcs to get the crawlers motivated to explore Arcadia:

- The crawlers come across an almost impossible sight: a gigantic hoard of Brindle Grubs well beyond the threshold of 5,000 allowed in a quarter this size. It looks like a gigantic Trollog feeding a mixture of Sprites and Grimes into a pit where their fighting generates more Grubs! At the rate they're being generated, this Neighborhood will be overrun, wiping out any crawlers who venture here and causing the threat to spill out across the entire floor.
- While crawlers enjoy a rare moment of respite from the dangers of the Crawl, storm clouds appear overhead,

and the sky pulses with poorly rendered lightning. The Dread Necromancer Grimblegore flickers into existence before them and zaps them with his magic, stealing away the appearances of the crawlers and leaving them looking the same, but in the resolution of '90s game consoles. Challenging them to a fight, Grimblegore bounces away as combat music starts playing and Mobs emerge to attack!

- After cleaving a Canis Knight in half, the crawlers are busy calculating their gains and sorting through treasure and loot when a Sprites peasant approaches them. Through tears and shaking arms, she explains that she was once a crawler like them, only to have her levels and equipment sapped away by a trap somewhere in the Neighborhood. She tells them that her thoughts keep returning to the same phrase over and over again, and she begs them to find the trap and free her essence. If asked for more details of the trap, she only says, "Such great weather we're having! Say, you're one of those adventurers I've heard about, aren't you?"

MOBS

The Mobs found in Arcadia lurk among the blocky ruins and brightly rendered skies.

SHAMBLING ACID IMPALER

Shambling Acid Impaler. That's seven syllables that inspire fear in many crawlers once they find signs of discarded darts and dissolved prey in the vicinity. These long-legged Mobs are notoriously aggressive and prefer to bombard their targets from a distance, slowly reducing them into a caustic goo that they lap up with their freakishly long tongues. Shambling Acid Impalers are surprisingly popular with audiences, and the Borant Corporation licenses an extensive catalog of merch based on this Mob, which is probably why they show up not just in Arcadia but across the World Dungeon.

Shambling Acid Impaler, Level 6

If these things are around, don't wear your Sunday best, you hear me? These nasty amalgamations love to spit acid darts with the precision of a freaking marksman. It's their destructive capabilities that make most crawlers say "nope" and head the other direction, but if you have to fight them, take them out quickly and without mercy, or else you're gonna go into your next area wearing nothing but your boxers.

Shambling Acid Impaler

Mob; Large (5), Zombie

3	3	3	3	3	3
17%	33%	50%	67%	83%	100%
Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR	
6	11+F	14+F	10+S	2	
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA	
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	10 (+4)	3 (+2)	

Acid Dart: 14+F to hit, 2d6+2 Acid, 40ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Queasy Debuff and the Dissolving Debuff: Take 1d6+F Acid at the end of each round until the combat ends.

Tongue Lash: 12+F to hit, 2d8+2 Bludgeoning, 10ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Dissolving Debuff: Take 1d6+F Acid at the end of each round until the combat ends.



SPRITES

Sprites are a generic but tiny, Fairy-class humanoid planted by the System AI in Arcadia. They look like a cross between a human and an elf, but their features are plain, and many Sprites tend to look the same as other Sprites. Some are capable of complex interactions with crawlers, but most can only say generic things, such as asking about the weather or warning crawlers about threats in the area. Unlike most Mobs, they may not be hostile at first, but their white dots swiftly can turn red when annoyed or attacked.

While Sprites seem like they're only capable of repeating the same phrase again and again, they actually communicate sub-harmonically with each other in a way only a few crawlers can truly understand. Sprites were designed to be resilient. When attacked, they defend themselves. Some Sprites can be riled up into Mobs (like a group, not a Mob) containing pitchforks and torches, and it's here that they become truly dangerous. A large gathering of Sprites is capable of burning down even the most reinforced castles and hiding places crawlers can find, so it's best to get out of their way if they're on the march.

Sprites Level 7

Gotta admit: These guys are pretty mundane until you get 'em all riled up. They're single-minded, but that's just how they're created. Don't count them all out, though! For every "Did you hear that noise from across the floor?" Sprite you find, there's one that harbors a clue to a rare treasure or one willing to give you something. They're pretty solid in a scrap, too, so try not to make them angry. Don't let their small size fool you, they pack a regular-sized punch.

Sprites

Mob; Tiny (1), Humanoid, Winged Fairy

3	3	3	3	3	3	3
14%	28%	43%	57%	71%	86%	100%
Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR		
7	12+F	13+F	20+S	2		
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA		
3 (+2)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	7 (+3)	7 (+3)		

Pitchfork: 12+F to hit, 2d8+2 Piercing, 5ft range

Thrown Rock: 12+F to hit, 2d6+2 Bludgeoning, 30ft range



CANIS KNIGHTS

Canis Knights serve as one of the primary guard Mobs for Arcadia. Created by designers with a limited understanding of how the monsters in old Earth video games work, these dog-like soldiers wearing fantasy armor are assigned to guard specific areas and march in formation until they detect a threat. Once they sense someone is invading their space, they attack with ferocity until their foe is defeated or leaves their area.

While it might seem like they're easy to avoid, the sheer abundance of Canis Knights spread throughout Arcadia (and occasionally on other floors) gives them a distinct advantage. Rumor has it that a clever crawler once defeated a battalion of Canis Knights by somehow finding their closely guarded Shift Schedule and rewriting it so they only guarded a lone tree in the middle of a field. Since then, they keep their sacred texts—I mean, Shift Schedules—a closely guarded secret.

Canis Knight, Level 5

I'm not gonna lie, these things seem like they'd be cute! Fluffy fur, pint-sized armor—you'd think they'd be your best friend... until they move in to attack. Don't let their cartoonish appearance fool you; those spears and swords are plenty sharp, and they fight like trained warriors.

Still... it's weird how they're only able to walk the same path over and over again, like they're machines. If you ever want a laugh, memorize how they walk around the area and stay in their blind spot until you strike! I mean, I think it's funny walking directly behind them.

Canis Knights

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	11+F	12+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	4 (+2)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)

Spear: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Piercing, 30ft range

Sword: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Slashing, 5ft range

Notes: *Adorable*—Canis Knights are furry, petite, and canine-appearing. This makes them utterly adorable and prompts many attempts to pet them. Crawlers that encounter Canis Knights for the first time gain the Fascinated Debuff: Roll with Disadvantage during the first round of combat.

Strict Adherence—Canis Knights always do precisely as directed, doing little or no thinking on their own. If given a certain schedule or patrol route to follow, they will do so to the letter without deviation. This adherence to directives leads them open to those who would exploit their established patterns and ways of doing things.

GRIMES

Grimes were a tutorial creature that could be produced as quickly and cheaply as possible. To help create more Mobs more efficiently, they were given a self-replication feature so that new crawlers could test out a variety of combat moves on them without straining the system. Sadly, the Grimes were abandoned in the testing phase, never to be seen again—until Destiny took matters into her own hands.

That's right—a wily, wayward Grime nicknamed "Destiny" managed to escape containment, and before she could be recovered, she slipped into the sewers where she proliferated just like she'd been engineered to do. But something in their shallow genetic pool slipped, and now they just don't replicate like they used to.

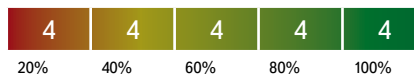
Grimes, Level 5

Just when you think I'd run out of things to hate, here come the Grimes! Have you ever wondered what it would be like to stick your hand in a jellyfish? Well, now you can, as these stinging buggers hide in cracks and crevices before oozing out to strike. Just when you think you've killed one, it splits in two! How's that even fair?

You'd better be up on your game if you're gonna kill these things before they get out of hand. Here's a hint: don't go into this battle blind. Visualize a plan and see it through.

Grimes

Mob; Petite (3), Ooze



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	11+F	11+F	15+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	10 (+4)	2 (+1)	1 (+1)

Gloop: 11+F to hit, 2d4+1 Acid, 30ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Dissolving Debuff: Take 1d6+F Acid at the end of each round until the combat ends.

Tendrils: 13+F to hit, 2d4+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Notes: The first time during the entire combat that a Grime is killed, it splits in two. Contrary to what the AI said, they don't all split in two. Just the first. It's more fun to see their reaction to the tired trope and their faces when the second Grime is killed and it *doesn't* split.

TROLLOGS

Trollogs are gray-skinned humanoids with thick hair spreading down their heads and across their backs. Their sharp teeth and glowing red eyes give them a frightening appearance, but that pales in comparison to their ability to shapeshift into the appearance of Sprites. They're known for using this ability to get closer to their prey before they revert to their original form and attack.

Trollogs also like to split up their opponents, bombard them with rocks and javelins, and then descend on their prey, wiping them out with their teeth. The most surefire way to reveal a Trollog in disguise is by exposing their face to a mirror. The mirror cracks, and the Trollog will be forced to transform.

Trollog. Level 5.

The Sprites may be annoying, but you can usually just walk around them after you engage them once in conversation. What's annoying but also dangerous are those who go beyond simple-minded peasants. Trollogs love to get close to you so they can transform and attack, and they often take on the appearance of Sprites to do it. There's nothing worse than thinking you're having a pleasant conversation you've had a hundred times before, and then your old NPC pal transforms into one of these butt-freaking-ugly things and tries to bite your face off!

Trollogs

Mob; Large (5), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	12+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	3 (+2)	4 (+2)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Bite: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Piercing, 5ft range

Javelin: 12+F to hit, 2d8+3 Piercing, 30ft range; once per combat

Notes: *Mirror Change*—If an Trollog is exposed to a mirror, the mirror will crack and the Trollog will be forced to transform into their original form.

Shapeshifting—Trollogs can change their appearance to look like Sprites in order to get close to an enemy and attack them in their natural frightening form.

ENVIRONMENT

Arcadia is a land of brightly colored buildings, loud music, and predictable yet comforting patterns. Created from the suburbs of contemporary Scotland, Japan, and New York, Arcadia would've been an impressive feat of engineering for the World Dungeon, provided Borant had enough time to actually finish it.

Peasant villages with straw roofs stand next to old brownstone homes that were hastily reassembled. Real clouds float past artificial ones with smiley faces printed on their sides. It all shows that Arcadia was planned, but the vision was poorly executed when Borant had to rush the plans. Strangely, this made Arcadia a charming place where fans with a taste for old-school games can watch crawlers reenact events from the electronic media of Earth's past.

Three types of terrain exist in Arcadia: towns, dungeons, and fields. The towns tend to look the same except for a subtle change in color pattern. In the dungeons, gray stone walls meet burning sconces and skeletons set into the floor, creating a cold, imposing atmosphere.

Finally, in the fields, Mobs gather in great numbers as treasure chests sit out in the open under the watchful eye of their guardians. The weather is never constant in Arcadia and seems to change from field to field. One field may be sunny and warm while the field right next to it is cold and rainy. In fields, changing the weather is as easy as taking a step or two to the left.

But what really makes Arcadia stand out is that it looks half-finished. It's clear the designers were going for a specific look, and several buildings in this Neighborhood look like they were under renovation to install turrets and moats, but large sections of Arcadia still look like crumbled, abandoned homes.

A broken mechanic that the Borant Corporation's world engineers tried to perfect plays appropriate music whenever the crawlers attempt something. Instead, this "Mood-Enhancing Symphony" system plays seemingly at random and even changes tune when crawlers enter buildings or crawl through tunnels.

And of course, all Mob fights are accompanied by dramatic, inspiring, and painfully repetitive music. Many crawlers find they cannot handle the ensuing



noise-induced headaches, and the ones who last the longest in this area often seek out or even create their own noise-cancelling headwear.

TRAPS

Traps in Arcadia are often a mixture of realistic-looking Sprites and repurposed homes, though some traps were accidentally created when Borant Corporation was forced to skip several safety checks.

- **Faulty Logic:** A group of Sprites swarms the crawlers when they open a chest. They aren't aggressive, but rather they're malfunctioning. They seem to want the crawlers to engage a cutscene with them, but it doesn't ever kick off. The crawlers must get these Sprites out of their way or ditch them if they intend to continue exploring.
- **Bad Potions:** A chest full of strange potions entices the crawlers. The first one they drink gives them something beneficial. The rest are random and often induce the opposite effect of what their labels claim.
- **Acid Bath:** The crawlers find themselves on a rickety bridge inside an Arcadian dungeon. One end is wherever they just came from, and at the other is a small platform with a locked door—one of a handful of exits from the Arcadian Neighborhood. The bridge is slowly falling apart as they dodge the darts of Shambling Acid Impalers. The only way off this bridge is claiming a magical bronze axe (located elsewhere) that lets them cleave their way through the locked dungeon door—if the bridge doesn't collapse first!
- **Pit Traps:** Familiar-looking cracks adorn the cement making up Arcadia's streets. Stepping on the wrong square triggers spikes from the ground, causing intense pain and potentially debilitating damage if they hit a crawler.
- **Slobber Ball:** This enticing-looking tennis ball is covered in a powerful adhesive that makes it impossible to put down. Not only does this tie up a crawler's hand, but it causes all Canis Knights to abandon their posts and pursue the crawler at all costs until the crawler finds some way to remove or unequip the item.

ITEMS

The crawlers might make use of some of these items hidden throughout Arcadia:

- **Ear Helmet:** This adorable helmet has a pair of ears stitched to the top, causing Canis Knights to often

mistake the wearer as one of their own. As a bonus, this helmet provides marginal (and upgradeable) hearing protection.

- **Guide Book:** A relic from a bygone age, this manual includes numerous notes on the Arcadia written by Borant engineers. Reading it gives insight into what traps and Mobs lurk in the vicinity.
- **Imperishable Meat:** A gigantic turkey leg sits on a plate, seemingly untouched by bugs, Mobs, and the passing of time itself. It tastes great, too! Just don't think too long about where it may have come from...
- **Foldable Bike:** This resilient bike folds up to fit neatly in a backpack, but it's strong enough to support over 500 pounds! It's a quicker and more stylish way of getting around, especially compared to walking... how pedestrian.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements and rewards in Arcadia.

- **Talk About Your Bad Luck:** "You've successfully triggered a Trollog's transformation by exposing them to a mirror before they could get the jump on you. Hopefully, you made them pay for that broken glass. It's not your fault they're ugly!"
Reward: You've received a Silver Adventurer Box."
Contents: A silver barrette (Head slot) shaped like a Trollog's face that grants +3 to Charisma.
- **Going To the Dogs:** "You've managed to sneak past Canis Knights successfully more than 10 times. You're so good at following their movements that you sometimes catch yourself marching in place when you stand still. Don't think the rest of us haven't noticed it, too, Happy Feet."
Reward: You've received a Bronze Copycat Box."
Contents: A mundane Canis Knight Tabard.
- **I'm Just As Shocked As You Are:** "You killed a second Grime, even though you 'knew' it would turn into two. You have no appreciation for time."
Reward: You've received a Gold Gotcha Box."
Contents: A fancy pocketwatch with two random bonuses.
- **It's a Hard Knock Life (For You):** "You tested your limits (and the audience's patience) by uncovering 10 Hidden Doors. Cool, I guess? Most of them don't lead anywhere or to anything important... but good for you, bud!"
Reward: You've received a Silver Adventurer Box."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers decisively defeated a few Mobs in Arcadia, they might engage in the all-too-familiar process of grinding for experience by killing Mobs over and over. Exploring this retro fantasy land for Mobs to fight might include the following complications. Roll 1d20.

TABLE 14: ARCADIA GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The ground starts to look splotchy, as if someone spilled a great amount of gray paint. It's then that a nearby statue of a Shambling Acid Impaler turns out to really be... a Shambling Acid Impaler! But painted gray! These predators are now better able to blend in with the homes around them, giving them a stealthy edge they certainly did not need before.
2	The crawlers come across a Canis Knight wedding party, who invite them to join their barn dance! If they join, they'd better put on their best 8-bit dancing shoes. If they fail to impress, they not only embarrass themselves but must survive the gauntlet of the Canis Knight Wedding Party!
3	The end is in sight, and an exit out of Arcadia is just on the other side of the tunnel ahead of the crawlers. The only problem? Sprites blocking the passage refuse to move unless the crawlers can find a missing "Platinum Key" and its associated "Platinum Key Completion Badge." As the crawlers try to think of a way to circumvent these Mobs, a roar from on top of a nearby temple reveals that Grimblegore knows the way out.
4	A group of Canis Knights, Grimes, and Sprites stand around a mysterious box playing music that is not inherently heroic or fantasy-themed, but distracting. This mysterious "Box of Records" contains music from ages past and leaves those who hear it transfixed. The Box of Records has enough power to keep playing for an hour, so the crawlers better be clever with how they use it.
5	Weird happenings draw the crawlers' attention as they fall through a mineshaft and end up turned around beneath Arcadia! As they attempt to make sense of the weird happenings around them, they hear the cry of Shambling Acid Impalers as they stalk the crawlers through the dark tunnels of this miniature dungeon.
6	The crawlers encounter another crawler who helps them out of a scrap. It's only after he agrees to watch over them while they sleep that they notice his glowing red eyes. It looks like the Trollogs leveled up their tricks and can now assume human forms! Does this mean everyone will be scared of their own reflections now?
7+	See Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications (p. 13).

Contents: An aluminum key that will lock any mundane lock, but it's destroyed once used.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

This Neighborhood has four quarters for crawlers to explore.

QUARTER: BIGTOWN

Bigtown is a mighty big town and the largest settlement within Arcadia. Populated mainly by Sprites, it also provides food and lodging for NPCs essential to maintaining the Neighborhood. Its high walls and formidable guards keep everyone safe. The

programming of this zone deters most threats, except for 2 days before Floor Collapse, when "Raid Day" happens.

- On Raid Day, anything can happen to Bigtown. A dragon may attack, or an army of giants may come marching across the horizon. A meteor shower may bombard the battlements, or a horde of attacking Rats and Goblins may attempt to overthrow the settlement and burn it down. To the Sprites who live there, it is simply another day, and residents go about their mundane tasks without noticing anything amiss. To everyone else, it's often better to flee Bigtown on Raid Day and take their chances exploring the ruins outside beyond.



- Bigtown is also home to the Bigtown Big Markets, where crawlers can find a wide range of goods, weapons, and services. Merchants and purveyors of fine wares sell clothing, food, and other standard fantasy fare expected in Arcadia. Crawlers can sell their old equipment for gold, but when buying, they can expect to pay the listed price. Very few Mobs and NPCs that sell goods here are advanced enough to understand the art of haggling, and those that do often try to rip off unsuspecting crawlers.
- The Queen of Bigtown, Adjazia, is said to be a former Game Guide using her position as ruler of this quarter to keep an eye on the area and to help struggling crawlers. For those who lack motivation to perform well for the audience, she offers easy tasks to help them gain recognition. For those who are overly antagonistic or a detriment to the zone, she sends them into the Bad Lands.
- Aiding her in her duties is The Princeless Knight, Janette Thorn, a crawler who has already achieved recognition as being "The 1337 of the Elite," whatever that ancient title means. Janette is a savvy and capable warrior who is more than willing to show new crawlers the ropes and help them learn the nature of *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth*.

QUARTER: THE BAD LANDS

Here, a vast region of plains, deserts, enchanted forests, and weirdly mushroom-filled suburbs coexist alongside each other. The lighting in these areas also appears random, with crawlers finding themselves in pitch-black warrens surrounded by Grimes, only to have their next step lead them into a sunny glade where Sprites enjoy and impromptu garden party. This chaotic quarter is known as the Bad Lands, and while much treasure awaits discovery among the ruins of the old world, the danger is very much real.

- The Bad Lands were originally intended to serve as a starting point for new crawlers and to help acclimate them to the many different environments found on later levels. Canis Knights assume fixed positions in many areas of this quarter, and Sprites teachers were supposed to help encourage crawlers how to proceed or how to master new abilities. Sadly, the AI subroutine governing these systems malfunctioned recently, resulting in a chaotic mess. Now, Sprites speak the same speeches to empty rooms, and the quarter's biomes slowly start to show signs of decay and entropy due to a lack of maintenance.
- The Shambling Acid Impalers are the dominant threat in the Bad Lands. They lurk in shadows until

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of Arcadia:

- *Loud orchestral music swells around you at all times, making your ears hurt.*
Outcome: Disadvantage while trying to use Stealth or any social skills.
- *The path ahead is full of numerous pits and ladders as brightly lit pixels hang in the sky.*
Outcome: Detect Trap to avoid triggering the traps.
- *The path opens up into a market where dozens of Sprites move from stall to stall.*
Outcome: One of the Sprites knows the secret path ahead, but another is not what he seems—he's actually a Trollog in disguise.

they sense new prey, then they bombard them with acidic darts. Unwary crawlers expecting an easy battle often find their faces melted by surprise darts to the neck. Game Guides encourage their charges to test out new catchphrases or signature moves in the Bad Lands, so any crawler who defeats one of these Mobs gains immediate recognition, especially if they do so with a bit of style.

- Rumors suggest that a secret village exists within the Bad Lands, where Mobs have grown disaffected from the intense violence and monotonous combat and go and hide. Built into a secret cave system on the far side of the quarter, Canis Knights who want to walk to their own rhythm live alongside Skyfowl who eschew the sophisticated grooming rituals of their kind and germophobic Rats maintaining strict cleanliness. If this village existed, it would surely be purged for encouraging the Mob's sense of individuality, but for now, it is a quiet oasis from the chaos of the World Dungeon.

QUARTER: THE STADIUM MAXIMUS

Three things dominate the skyline of Arcadia: the vaulted rooftops of Bigtown, the sinister countenance of the Temple Doom, and the many banners and pennants hanging from the side of a stadium renowned throughout the World Dungeon. Built from an old coliseum where lions were said to brawl with horses and Vikings for the enjoyment of the masses, the Stadium Maximus is now always full of Mobs and crawlers looking for a respite from the dangers of the Crawl. But that's as much relaxation as the coliseum allows, for some who enter its gates end up as surprise contestants on the field of battle.

- *Dungeon Crawler World's* appeal is watching ordinary people fight to survive impossible circumstances, but a rather large contingent of viewers, almost 90% of them, love watching crawlers go head-to-head with the toughest monsters. For that reason, the Stadium Maximus was created. As part of the Tutorial Floors, its practical purpose is to give crawlers a chance to test their mettle by fighting Mobs and ranking up Skills to prepare for later Floors. Its unintended side-effect is becoming an absolute meatgrinder, chewing through Mobs and crawlers alike.
- The Stadium Maximus is run by Grimblegore via his chief lieutenant, Humonga the Hut. This living house has her own private viewing platform at the top of the stadium, where she speaks to the crowd through an enchanted mailbox. Humonga is amusing, genial, and uncompromisingly sadistic, especially if she can get a reaction from the crowd. Grimblegore is the only one she obeys and respects, and she literally rolls out the red carpet for him when he's in attendance (the red carpet is actually her tongue).
- Contestants compete in games and gladiatorial contests for special loot boxes and treasures that give them an edge in the rest of the World Dungeon. Many crawlers received powerful weapons or items for defeating a formidable Mob or by doing something that earns them the approval of the masses. It's not just NPC Mobs that cheer them on; replays of games and battles from the Stadium Maximus always get special priority in *Dungeon Crawler World: Earth* broadcasts. Sponsors keep a keen eye out for who does well in the games.

QUARTER: THE TEMPLE DOOM

Dominating the center of Arcadia is the Temple Doom, an enormous ziggurat channeling magical energies. Truth be told, it does control the Neighborhood's electrical systems and programs and was meant to be a state-of-the-art Borant control center for this part of the Second Floor, but it was co-opted by Grimblegore and now serves as the Boss's base of operations. Each level of the ziggurat is full of dungeons, prisons, and treasure hoards containing all the loot that Grimblegore and his minions stole, captured, or recovered from the ruins.

- The Temple Doom, like the rest of Arcadia, never saw completion. Many of its errors are attributed to magical curses and arcane effects, but the code for the quarter is dodgy at best. Crawlers often can only access other floors within the Temple Doom by using special "Mirror Gates" that allow travel between two points instantaneously. Some Mirror

Gates randomly rotate their entry and exit points. A few Mirror Gates are known in broadcasts as "Garbage Gates" because they tend to eject their occupants into sewer levels beneath the temple, or worse, fuse them with solid matter between floors.

- The Temple Doom is full of almost every kind of Mob imaginable. While Shambling Acid Impalers, Canis Knights, and Trollogs are the most common Mobs here, Grimblegore recruited Orcs, Dark Elves, and other esoteric creatures from different floors. Grimblegore likes to enjoy a nice scotch from his throne room while he sends creatures out to fight his enemies, and he often spends his days counting the items and treasures recovered by his minions.
- Rumor has it that each chamber of the temple contains a hidden chest. They might hide beneath the surface or behind a phalanx of guards. While some are actual treasure chests, as many as half of them prove to be traps capable of releasing poison gas or additional monsters to attack crawlers opening them. The rest contain treasures such as precious gems and gold, Mana potions, and arcane artifacts. Any who steal from these chests are sure to earn the ire of Grimblegore, who considers all treasures within Arcadia to be his.

NOTABLE NPCS

The crawlers might find some unexpected allies in Arcadia.

THE PRINCELESS KNIGHT, JANETTE THORN

Arcadia is a land of tropes, from floating clouds you can walk on to NPCs shuffling about in front of their homes. Janette wants to change all of that and has become a phenom in her own right. Once an English teacher, tired of seeing her media criticism dismissed by her peers, she intends to break the mold in Arcadia and be her own thing.

After a now-viral incident where she cold-cocked a Sprite who claimed to be her "one true love" while proclaiming he would do anything to free her from the clammy hands of Grimblegore, she earned millions of new fans. The Princeless Knight charges into combat by defeating tyrants and defying genre tropes.

Crawler #4,249,409. "The Princeless Knight, Janette Thorn."

Level 8.

Race: Human.

Class: Not yet assigned.

BOB BILBERSON: JUST ANOTHER GUY

Crawlers are encouraged to keep moving forward to survive the World Dungeon. Many crawlers take a deal upon reaching the Tenth Floor or lower, and Bob was all too happy to get out when the time came. But then something unusual happened: the right people sort of just... forgot about him. He's been in the dungeon ever since, popping up in different seasons as an NPC with no meaningful work, no job, no specific reason for being wherever he ends up. But that all suits Bob just fine.

In his old life, and later in the dungeon, Bob was frustrated by the intense pace of the world. But now, here in Arcadia, he finds himself perfectly content living among the Sprites. Their repetitive speech, the predictable days, the guaranteed income from selling potions to travelers who don't engage in a lot of small talk—all of these make Bob feel right at home. If he meets fellow crawlers, he breaks character and helps them as best he can, but afterward, he goes right back to the stress-free and predictable life he always hoped for.

Bob Bilberson—Human Peasant, Level 50

Seriously, we don't know much about this guy other than it looks like he's always been here. He just sticks to the background and does his own thing. He's really helpful, and for some reason, none of the other Mobs in the dungeon ever mess with him, so if you need a helping hand, look for old Bill. Or was it Bob? I can't really remember.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The crawlers climb endless steps to arrive at the remains of an ancient temple. Ancient, in that it's clearly inspired by decades-old video games that came before it, with those low-poly identical floor tiles and columns. With a clash of thunder, a figure slowly fades into existence, and an invisible choir starts singing as Grimblegore appears.

Grimblegore's Temple Doom is the focus of powerful spells and ancient rituals meant to bring about the end of the world. While there's a lot of energy going into this place, most of it is for show. Some of the skeletons on the floor are made of cheap plaster and can be destroyed in a single punch.

While the temple is for show, it's clear that Grimblegore is the real deal. He can summon Mobs to defend himself, and he can unleash fireballs from his webbed hands. He pulls mysterious potions from his robe and chugs them mid-battle while his powerful legs allow long leaps that smash those in his path.

What's the old frog-wizard's weakness? It's not some special blade or the tears of an ancient fairy princess; it's that Grimblegore tends to be a bit repetitive in his attacks. Once Grimblegore slips into a pattern, it's hard for him to break it. It causes him great distress to change his plan mid-stride.

His preferred method of attack is "Fireball-Fireball-Jump Smash-Jump Smash-Gloat-Gloat." While he can alter this plan on the fly if motivated, he really doesn't want to. Clever crawlers can use this pattern to their advantage by anticipating his next moves and working on not being where he intends to strike.

Dread Wizard Grimblegore, the Lord of the Grimes. Level 10 Neighborhood Boss!

Prepare for a cutscene like you wouldn't believe—it's time for the crawlers to take on the big guy!

Dread Wizard Grimblegore is the self-appointed overlord of Arcadia, and as far as you and me are concerned, he's got the firepower to prove it. His interests include going for long hops on the beach, enjoying a lovely soak in swamps, and raising the dead to eviscerate his enemies—pretty standard for an amphibian-themed wizard. Can the crawlers make this evil mage croak for good, or will their skulls join the many adventurers, knights, and plumbers that came before them?

Dread Wizard Grimblegore

Neighborhood Boss; Large (5), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
8%	16%	25%	33%	41%	50%	58%	66%	75%	83%	91%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	14+F	14+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
10 (+4)	10 (+4)	20 (+5)	10 (+4)	5 (+2)

Fireball Spell: 14+F to hit, 2d12+4 Fire, 80ft range, 20ft Blast radius +20ft Splash

Gloat Spell: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Sonic, 50ft range, 10ft Blast radius

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Muted Debuff.

Jump Smash: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Bludgeoning, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: Dread Wizard Grimblegore always attacks with Fireball-Fireball-Jump Smash-Jump Smash-Gloat-Gloat. Fireball is rolled with Disadvantage, so the Difficulty to Evade is reduced by 5, and crawlers get a free Evade Check against it.





NEIGHBORHOOD: DOWNUNDER DESERT

FLOOR: 2 (TUTORIAL) THEME: RUST-STRANGLER AND SUN-SCORCHED

"Cocker spaniels deserve to have their corpses desecrated."

—Donut

When the Borant Corporation designed this floor, their plans included a desert wasteland like that of a straight-to-DVD post-apocalyptic movie where water is scarce but gas-guzzling cars are somehow plentiful. The scope of their vision was too broad for the budget of the Crawl, so instead, the sprawling grid-like passages and tunnels of the Second Floor connect to a massive cave system that once bordered the Australian outback.

The sandstone caverns trap and magnify the outside heat like a geological sauna, heating the rock walls enough to brand flesh and shimmering the air with thermal distortions. Scattered throughout the Neighborhood are junked cars, rusted-out machinery, dilapidated shacks, and the bleached skeletal remains of creatures who succumbed to the desert and were picked clean by Mobs.

Aberrant fauna from the Australian Outback permeates the Neighborhood, with tweaking reptiles astride massive wild dogs regularly patrolling the outskirts in search of fresh crawler meat for their master. In the center of the smoldering caverns is an oasis of sorts, where that master, a large crocodilian named Mick, uses a pair of huge Bowie knives to chop and dice vegetables and meats with precision. As he's slicing, he sends surges of energy to stoke the flames under an equally massive grill while tracks from AC/DC's *Razor's Edge* album blast, echoing throughout the caverns. *"You've been... thunderstruck!"*

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- A ramshackle shack wedged in the hall leads to a series of sandstone caverns through an exit on the other side. As the characters begin to feel the swiftly rising heat, a flight of what look like guinea pigs begins dive-bombing them from perches on the rocks above. After successfully driving off the airborne menace, the characters come across the body of a hapless crawler at the edge of a pool filled with sand, perhaps seeking to slake their thirst at what only turned out to be a mirage.

- The characters come across an eight-sided cage with a sign that says, "Survive one round and win big!"
- The characters find a tourist guidebook describing the long-lost treasures of the desert area. Someone marked a large "X" on the map, with an arrow pointing to it and a label reading "dig here."

STORY ARCS

Use the following story seeds to quickly get the crawlers into the action in the Downunder Desert:

- The crawlers encounter the Cocaine Kobolds patrolling with the Danger Dingoes on the outskirts of the Neighborhood. In addition to gold coins and poor Dingo pelts, some of the Kobolds have vials of cocaine marked with the initials MM. If questioned about the vials, Kobolds plead to have their medicine back and only mention that MM refers to their dealer. Cocaine gives crawlers the Enraged Debuff for 30 minutes and they cannot rest during that time.
- Stacked kangaroo Angel Whyte entertains her suitors at the circled service station on the map the crawlers found. If one of the crawlers shows interest in the kangaroo, either genuine or feigned, she might take a liking to them. The crawlers can win her over with some good roleplaying or perhaps by a strong—ahem—performance. If successful, Angel tells the crawler about Mick (the crocodilian Boss), his location, and his weakness.
- The crawlers come across fellow crawler Huey J. singing up a storm while hammering away at stunned Whambats. He fooled the Whambats into bashing themselves against a cement floor painted like a huge head of lettuce. Knowledgeable crawlers recognize that Huey is singing songs from a famous Broadway show, later adapted into a mildly successful movie. If one of the crawlers recognizes the tune and asks Huey about it, Huey regales the party with stories of his singing escapades and joins them for the remainder of the floor.

Huey has many insights into dealing with the various Mobs, making grinding more efficient for the remainder of the current day (add 1 hour to your grind at no penalty). If a crawler also sings the tune with Huey, harmonizing appropriately, Huey becomes smitten with them. Not only will Huey share his expertise on grinding, but he also shares several non-magical musical instruments he's found with the party, along with a Spell Scroll, Rank 6, for Ice Blast (see Crawlers & Customization, p. @.@) he received in a loot box but can't use himself.

MOBS

The Mobs in this Neighborhood are generally resistant to heat and fire, with bodies adapted to the scorching sand. Subsequently, they take 20% more damage from cold-based attacks.

COCAINE KOBOLD

These three-foot-tall reptiles (not to be confused with their chihuahua-like counterparts, the "normal" Kobolds) served for centuries as whipping boys for novices just dipping their toes into the adventuring lifestyle. These constant attacks caused them to seek solace through the heavy use of mind-numbing pharmaceuticals. Their current drug of choice is cocaine, which fuels these cold-blooded canine-busters' never-ending desire to take revenge on all adventurers.

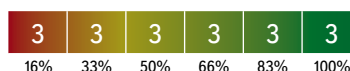
Cocaine Kobolds charge into combat astride equally tweaked Danger Dingoes. They wield makeshift spears made of broomsticks with a sharp piece of junk, such as a shard of glass or a pair of broken scissors, hastily duct-taped to the end. While their mounts may prefer Norwegian black metal, the naturally passionate Cocaine Kobolds prefer salsa and Latin freestyle, putting them at odds with the Danger Dingoes over which soundtracks to use for cavalry charges. Cocaine Kobolds favor high-end brands with bold colors and are usually seen wearing designer sunglasses and ostentatious jewelry.

Cocaine Kobold, Level 6

These little lizards enjoy Latin music and luxury goods, but they love cocaine even more. Not to be confused with normal Kobolds, which are basically tiny dogs, Cocaine Kobolds are reptilian. Their pupils are perpetually absurdly dilated, giving them the appearance of a paranoid gecko who just realized he should have bundled his home and auto insurance.

Cocaine Kobold

Mob; Petite (3), Lizard



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
6	13+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	6 (+3)	6 (+3)	6 (+3)	2 (+1)

Rock: 13+F to hit, 2d4+3 Bludgeoning, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Enraged Debuff (from the dusting of coke).

Spear: 12+F to hit, 2d6+2 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Enraged Debuff (from the dusting of coke).

Notes: *Mounted*—Cocaine Kobolds are often astride Danger Dingoes, and deal +1 damage with their spears when mounted.

DANGER DINGO

Danger Dingoes branched off from their canine brethren because "eating babies" just isn't cool—it's necessary. With a penchant for Norwegian black metal and rugby, Danger Dingoes are powerfully built, standing over three feet tall at the shoulder and packing a cool 220 pounds of misanthropic muscle.

Often confused for dire wolves at parties, Danger Dingoes wear corpse paint on their faces to drive home their cultural differences, as if their comically oversized saber-tooth fangs weren't enough. These markings give Danger Dingoes the appearance of having just crawled out of a forest after burning down an ancient stave church (which, let's be honest, they probably did). The Danger Dingo's Spotify playlist is exclusively obscure Kvlt bands you've definitely never heard of. They judge you harshly for your lack of musical taste.

Danger Dingo, Level 5

These aren't the cute, cuddly, baby-eating puppies from the land down under. No, mate. The Danger Dingo features a stronger body, sharper teeth, and a penchant for black metal bands such as Dimmyu Borgir and Satyricon. Where there are Dingoes, their Kobold Riders and slave masters usually aren't far behind.



Danger Dingo

Mob; Medium (4), Beastly

3	3	3	3	3
20%	40%	60%	80%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	12+F	11+F	30+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
7 (+3)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	2 (+1)	2 (+1)

Bite: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Rabies Debuff: 1d6+F Poison damage at the end of each round until the combat ends.

Ravage: 11+F to hit, 2d6+3 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or Worse, the target gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: *Good Impressions*—An injured Dingo may become non-hostile to a crawler party if none of the crawlers attack any member of the Dingo's pack, and the crawlers heal or feed the Dingo or play music from metal bands the Dingo likes.

Ravager—If a Danger Dingo moves at least 20ft in a straight line at its Ravage target before attacking, add +1d6 to the damage.



JACKED KANGAROO

Unlike your typical gym bro, these Mobs *never* skip leg day. Standing at over six-and-a-half feet of rippling marsupial fury, the Jacked Kangaroos have abs that can grate cheese, biceps like steel pistons, and legs that make Ronnie Coleman envious.

Using an MMA fighting style that blends Muay Thai kicks with Wushu-style tail whips, Jacked Kangaroos are vicious close-combat fighters. Few opponents stand a chance against them. They like to toy with opponents, peppering them with lightning-fast jabs, followed by thunderous armor-shattering kicks and sweeping tail strikes that send opponents reeling.

Jacked Kangaroos maintain nearly perfect balance with their hefty tail, making them nearly impossible to knock prone or off-kilter. Their refusal to skip leg day, though, is also their downfall; if a Jacked Kangaroo is in mid-squat, even in the middle of combat, their training takes over, and they start banging out reps instead of continuing the fight. You can literally just walk away because they won't chase after you. Leg day is just that sacred.

Jacked Kangaroo, Level 8

Who needs cardio when you've got legs like these! The Jacked Kangaroo is a vicious, albeit vain, close-combat fighter. Easily distracted by mirrors and lower limb-based flattery, Jacked Kangaroos are especially dangerous to those who dare to go at them—*ahem*—toe-to-toe.

Jacked Kangaroo

Mob; Medium (4), Animal

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
12%	25%	37%	50%	62%	75%	87%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
8	12+F	12+F	25+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
10 (+4)	3 (+2)	10 (+4)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)

Kick: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler is pushed 15ft.

Punch: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Tail Whip: 14+F to hit, 1d10+4 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

JAZMANIAN DEVIL

These terrifying predators prowl suburban community centers and church basements, identified by their signature high-cut spandex and knitted leg warmers. Jazmanian Devils attack without warning, using violent hip thrusts and aggressive grapevine maneuvers to corner their prey before decimating them with a series of high kicks and lunges.

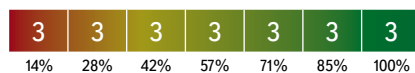
Jazmanian Devils' hunting strategy involves stalking their prey and forcing them to "keep up" with increasingly chaotic choreography set to tinny '80s synth-pop. Their victims are often found bludgeoned by wildly swung wrist weights or garroted by bedazzled sweatbands. Jazmanian Devils mark their territory by scattering VHS tapes around the edges of their dens, and they often exert dominance over others with passive-aggressive comments concerning what "real exercise" looks like.

Jazmanian Devil, Level 7

These passionate dancing and fitness fashionistas know all the moves and aren't afraid to use them! A hearty combination of a carnivorous Earth marsupial and the old ladies who gather on weeknights to work their jazzy moves, the Jazmanian Devil may look ridiculous, but their fighting style is relentless—because their cardio is just so good. While their high kicks and hip thrusts might draw most of your attention, the real danger comes in the form of vicious blows from their hand- and ankle-weights. Try to keep up now!

Jazmanian Devil

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid



14%	28%	42%	57%	71%	85%	100%
Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR		
7	11+F	13+F	20+S	2		
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA		
6 (+3)	2 (+1)	6 (+3)	6 (+3)	6 (+3)		

Wrist Weight: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Sweatband: 13+F to hit, 2d4+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Muted Debuff.

Kick: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Lunge: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Bludgeoning, 10ft range

Notes: *Hard Fighting*—Each time a crawler kills a Jazmanian Devil, they gain the Fatigued Debuff.

WHAMBAT

Imagine taking a giant guinea pig, infusing it with Red Bull, and then adding a massive set of leathery wings. The result would be a Whambat: a rotund, furry abomination roughly the size of a fattened Thanksgiving turkey that has absolutely zero chill and the aerodynamics of a brick.

Though able to inflict damage with beaver-like buckteeth, these chubby nightmares prefer to employ a maneuver known as the "hell dive"—a kamikaze plummet from above where they tuck in their wings then slam into their target with the kinetic energy of a furry meteorite, all the while squeaking a war cry that sounds like a dog toy having an existential crisis. The impact of this attack—referred to as "The Wham"—can concuss orcs, dent shields, and cause instant regret in anyone who thought "how dangerous could a flying guinea pig possibly be?"

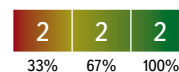
The true horror of their attack reveals itself. Whambats attack *en masse*. Their coordinated aerial assault, ominously dubbed *Whamaggedon*, involves a dozen or more of these portly projectiles dive-bombing in sequential waves like the world's most absurd carpet-bombing campaign. Survivors report the sound of an approaching Whamaggedon as similar to "a case of squeaky toys falling down an elevator shaft" followed by blissful unconsciousness.

Whambat, Level 3

It's a bird! It's a plane! It's a—what the *hell* is that? Wait, there's more of 'em? *Wham! Wham! Wham!*

Whambat

Mob; Petite (3), Animal



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)

Bite: 11+F to hit, 1d8+1 Piercing, 5ft range

Hell Dive: 13+F to hit, 1d8+3 Bludgeoning, 60ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *Flight*—Whambats can move through the air as though on the ground.

Hell Dive—Whambats die from the impact of a Hell Dive that hits their target.



ENVIRONMENT

Gritty red sand is everywhere and in everything. The environment is hot and dry, with nearly constant gusts of sand blowing in swirling patterns around wrecked vehicles, torn-down shacks, and the twisted, rusting remnants of old equipment.

While most of the caverns appear naturally carved, gouges in some of the walls reveal thick rebar rods. Concrete beams integrated into the ceilings above suggest the Neighborhood might have been built as a series of large parking structures before being given its outback veneer. Closer examination reveals numerous speed bumps covered by several inches of sand crisscrossing parts of the floor.

Although the area is barren and dry, an oasis of lush trees and a large pond surrounded by greenery sits in the largest cavern near the center of the sprawling complex. This spot seems untouched by the blasting sand, almost as if some invisible force keeps the constantly blowing storms at bay. Even the creatures who manage to enter the oasis seem less grimy and dusty, enjoying a respite from the constantly whipping and cutting sand.

Otherwise, red sand shifts and flows throughout the Neighborhood, giving all surfaces and creatures a rusted-looking twinge.

- **Down one** seemingly dead-end hall is a slightly gabled roof with a worn neon sign reading “Outback” in bright red letters set above a set of lights where a second sign was torn off. Below, a set of glass-inlaid wooden doors provides entrance to the seemingly intact room beyond. Staffed by a lone Bopca, this repurposed steakhouse features a series of faux-leather booths and serves as a standard saferoom.

TRAPS

Traps in the Downunder Desert Neighborhood are made of natural materials and deteriorated parts of vehicles, buildings, and equipment.

- **Minefield:** Scattered throughout the hall are pressure-sensitive explosive runes that detonate when stepped on, turning the hallway into a deadly game of “the floor is lava,” except the floor is actually explosions. Some genius marked the safe path with faded chalk that’s 60% worn away (at best).
- **Sand Pit:** It’s exactly what it sounds like, but worse. The floor beneath the crawler is weakened, collapsing under their weight and causing them to fall into a pit of coarse, irritating sand that

immediately gets everywhere—armor joints, boots, eye protection, and other more intimate locations. Not only does this slow the crawler down, but it also puts them in close proximity to a group of Jacked Kangaroos that were sparing in the space below.

- **Scrap Trap:** Stepping on a pressure plate ignites a chaotic explosion of rusty metal pieces, broken car wheels, and discarded armor parts that launch from the walls like a tetanus-riddled confetti cannon. Constructed by Cocaine Kobolds from literal garbage, this trap also sounds an alarm by blasting AC/DC’s Highway to Hell, alerting all Mobs in the quarter.
- **Sand Storms:** Powerful winds can suddenly manifest, creating dense moving walls of airborne sand that reduce visibility and deals 1d4+F Slashing every minute.
- **Tourist Trap:** A light sensor triggers this trap when a crawler passes between receivers mounted at the entrance to a cave, corridor, or room. Once triggered, an aggressive holographic tour guide appears and delivers a mandatory 45-minute presentation about “the historical significance of the Neighborhood” while a pickpocketing mechanism attempts to relieve crawlers of their gold. Crawlers cannot leave the immediate area except by deactivating the trap or until the presentation is complete. Afterward, crawlers gained the opportunity to purchase a timeshare in the Neighborhood and were given a set of commemorative daggers.

ITEMS

Ancient car parts and pieces of large machinery lay scattered throughout the Neighborhood.

- **Car Rims and Tires:** Every 100 yards or so, a rim from a car or truck pokes up, half-buried in the sand. Obviously destroyed tires still cling to some of them, though occasionally one may have an intact tire.
- **Empty Gas Cans:** Rusted metal jerry cans lay scattered around, most to the point where they can’t hold liquid anymore. But if they did, it would be five gallons.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards:

- **Boomin’ Onion:** “You’ve used an explosive device to attack an enemy while they were busy preparing a meal. Reward: You’ve received a Bronze Asshole’s Box.”

Contents: A 1d6 damage stick of dynamite.

- **Crikey! That's a Big One!**: "Just like David and Goliath in the Old Testament, you were stupid enough to attack a foe at least twice as large as yourself. What were you thinking?"
Reward: You've received a Silver Adventurer Box."
Contents: A weapon that deals + 3 damage to creatures larger than the crawler.
- **That's Not a Knife**: "You killed an enemy with a one-handed melee weapon other than a knife."
Reward: You've received a Bronze Weapon Box."
Contents: A novelty, oversized silver souvenir spoon worth 25 gold. It also functions as a club.
- **Vegemite Sandwich**: "Whether by coercion, trickery, or of your own volition, you consumed something disgusting or inedible. Just like back in grade school."
Reward: You've received a Bronze Survivor Box."
Contents: A jar full of something called "leftovers," which doesn't taste good, but restores 1 HB slot when consumed. It takes a full five minutes to try to eat this slop.

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

The Downunder Desert Neighborhood comprises several distinct, vaguely Australian Outback-themed quarters. While some Mobs are more prevalent in particular quarters, most can be found in several.

QUARTER: CRIMSON BARRENS

This quarter is set in a massive cavern to create the illusion of being outdoors in an endless expanse of red desert sand. An artificial sun beats down on crawlers, as if it has a personal vendetta against them. Temperatures quickly reach a lethal level after only a few minutes of exposure. Crawlers must protect themselves from the scorching UV rays via mechanical or magical means, or quickly be overcome with the Fatigued Debuff and take damage as per Thirst (see *Rules of Survival*, p. 28).

- Scattered throughout the barrens lay bleached bones and the rusted remains of cars and trucks. Skin-scouring dust devils form spontaneously, and

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers decisively defeat a few Mobs in the Downunder Desert, they might grind for experience by killing Mobs over and over. This mostly involves taking on groups of foes they come across in the caverns and might include the following complications. Roll 1d20.

TABLE 15: DOWNUNDER DESERT GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A sandstorm blows through the area, and several members of the party get separated due to the low visibility.
2	A rival group of crawlers discreetly observe your party softening up a high-experience Mob, and they swoop in at the last second to kill-steal right before you strike the final blow.
3	After farming Mobs in an area for several hours, their tactics suddenly shift, and they coordinate attacks more effectively. Whether this is by design or an AI-generated response to your efforts, your grinding slows and becomes more dangerous.
4	A Boss fight in an adjacent Neighborhood causes hundreds of fleeing low-level Mobs to stampede through your grinding area. They're easy to kill but force each crawler to train only Dexterity-based skills this grind.
5	You've been grinding for hours, and the numerous corpses attracts hundreds of Brindle Grubs that swarm around your position.
6	You've stumbled into a trap!
7+	See Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications (p. 13).



mirages appear, showing roadside convenience stores offering cold beer and air conditioning. Soaring high above this “open” desert are flocks of Whambats, riding the hot wind currents as they circle in search of prey. Upon seeing crawlers, the Mobs quickly turn about and begin a steep dive to attack them, emitting earsplitting screeches as they approach.

- Buried in the side of a large dune is what appears to be a 1987 Toyota pick-up truck with oversized sand tires. Though its body is rusted through in places, crawlers can dig the vehicle out and get it started with a little effort. It has roughly an hour's worth of fuel in the tank and provides a modicum of protection from the sun.
- In the glove box of another derelict vehicle, the crawlers find the tattered remains of an old road map. This map shows the Neighborhood's quarters, along with points of interest such as service stations, restaurants, and shopping areas, all of which are now gone or completely buried in sand. One particular service station is circled (see p. 95), though, perhaps indicating something of value remains there.

QUARTER: BILLABONG OASIS

A serene waterhole surrounded by ghost gums and lush vegetation sits in the center of this otherwise barren desert cavern. Cocaine Kobolds lounge in the shade of the trees, which seems completely against their usual keyed-up nature. Their Danger Dingo mounts perch along the water bank, listening to Norwegian death metal as they lap up the precious fluids. On the southern bank of the pooled water sits a large rattan hut with a thatched roof. Inside, a six-and-a-half-foot-tall reptile chops up foodstuffs and throws them on a sizzling griddle.

- Perhaps this is neutral ground in a bleak Neighborhood otherwise full of death and mayhem? Unless the crawlers interrupt or bother the Cocaine Kobolds or Danger Dingoes, neither attacks them. Nor do they interact in any meaningful way. All are spent from previous encounters with crawlers and require downtime to recharge. If the crawlers attack them or prevent them from engaging in their leisurely activities, the Cocaine Kobolds and Danger Dingoes immediately fight back, drawing all the combatants in the area into the fight.
- Something must cause the slowing and calming effects in the oasis. Careful scrutiny of the Cocaine Kobolds and Danger Dingoes reveals they are under a Charm spell of sorts. While the players see it in action,

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of the Downunder Desert:

- *A Strong group of Whambats perched in the distance notice a crawler from another party and move to attack.*
Outcome: Be on your way or assist?
- *A massive crowd surrounds an octagonal fighting cage in which a Jacked Kangaroo and an essential NPC or another crawler are set to fight.*
Outcome: Distract the crowd and rescue the NPC (perhaps fighting the Jacked Kangaroo) or let them die?
- *A Strong group of Jazmanian Devils corners another party of crawlers in a dead end.*
Outcome: Challenge the Mob to a dance-off or merely spectate?
- *A Moderate group of Cocaine Kobolds argues with their mounts about musical tastes.*
Outcome: Sneak by the Mobs or attack them while they're distracted?

they are not directly affected—unless they drink the water. Any crawlers who drink the water are similarly affected, reducing their Actions in combat from two to one for the next 10 minutes, and preventing them from taking offensive actions against anyone in the oasis unless they are provoked by an attack or their relaxation activity is interrupted. Instead, the crawler drinking should choose a leisure activity and heal 50% of their Health per hour spent on it.

- The crocodilian in the grass hut is the Neighborhood Boss, Mick Moran, whose lore suggests he was a celebrated chef and restaurateur with multiple TV shows and cookbooks until a horrible accident turned him into a crocodilian. Now he spends his days perfecting recipes and feeding his minions, many of whom are terrified of becoming part of his next soufflé. The soothing water of the oasis is a recipe of his own making, as it makes it easier for him to gather ingredients when he needs to add a bit of protein to a recipe. See the *B-B-B-Boss Battle!* section later in this chapter for more information.

QUARTER: SEARING CAVERNS

This massive network of sandstone caves is scorching hot with constant gusts of sand blowing through, making it feel like being sand-blasted in a convection

oven. The walls are lined with ancient dot paintings that may or may not provide directional hints, while glow-worms emit eerie bioluminescent light.

- The sounds of an up-tempo dance party echo from a nearby cave entrance and grow louder (whether the crawlers move toward it or not). Soon, a Moderate group of Jazmanian Devils begins to hip-thrust and high-kick their way toward the crawlers. “Feel the burn!” shouts the spandex-wearing leader into a headset microphone as they surround the crawlers.
- The crawlers come across what appears to be an NPC child covered in grime and wearing ragged clothes. Fearful of the Danger Dingoes, the child comes running full-tilt from behind a rocky outcropping and hides behind the legs of the largest crawler. Although no canines are in pursuit, the child is clearly hungry and lost in the caverns, using hand gestures to plead with the crawlers for help finding the way out. Perhaps the dot paintings hold a clue that the crawlers can decipher with the child’s help?
- The dot paintings do indeed hold several pieces of valuable information that the crawlers can decipher with the help of the child. First, they provide a rough set of directions for the various quarters of the Neighborhood. In addition, they provide the location of the Neighborhood Boss in an oasis deeper in the caverns. Finally, the paintings suggest that the Neighborhood Boss is vulnerable to cold-based attacks because of his cold-blooded crocodilian nature.

QUARTER: THUNDER ARENA

A massive, rusted cage of welded scrap metal and chain-link fencing rises from the desert floor like a post-apocalyptic colosseum, because apparently someone watched *Beyond Thunderdome* and thought, “let’s do that.” The eight-sided cage is 80 feet across, held together by several generations of duct tape. Flickering torches and old car headlights provide dramatic lighting that cuts out at the worst possible moments.

- “FATALITY!” The arena floor is hard-packed red dirt mixed with broken glass and steel shards, and “weapons” lay scattered around the floor or hanging from hooks on the walls: stop signs sharpened into axes, circular saw blades on chains, traffic cones with nails hammered through them (why?), and what might be a broken didgeridoo that’s been reinforced with metal plating.
- Upon entering this quarter, crawlers immediately find themselves in the arena, forced to fight. A Moderate group of Jacked Kangaroos is the main opponent here. If the crawlers are dominating by the end of

round two, Whambats dive into the fray from perches at the top of the cage, while Cocaine Kobolds might come charging in on their Danger Dingo mounts from the sliding doors in the side of the cage. Only the Jazmanian Devils choose not to participate, instead acting like hyperactive cheerleaders outside with the crowd. Perhaps they’re recruiting?

- Surviving a main event bout with multiple Mobs earns the crawlers recognition and respite from future battles. This enables them to observe other matches (both with and without crawlers) and identify the bookies working the crowd. They may place bets themselves, and perhaps even influence the outcomes of fights if they so choose. Crawlers who choose to continue fighting in the arena find that they gain 1 level for every two victories, making it a very lucrative way to grind.

NPCS

Crawlers might find some unexpected allies in the Downunder Desert.

HUEY J.

Before his singing career took off, Crawler Huey J. worked as a physical education teacher, as well as teaching English and Drama. He even worked as a clown at birthday parties. Tying briefly with a career as a journalist, he studied communications before finding a passion for theater.

Huey chooses to travel alone and has built a significant following thanks to his wonderful singing voice and entertaining ways of handling threats. He often feigns death when encountering a Mob and is so convincing that some pass him by completely, while others might even attempt to bury him. Just as their guard is down, Huey strikes with a pair of serrated hand axes, carving out the Mob’s soft underbelly.

As such, his attacks are necessarily extremely bloody, leaving him frequently shirtless when he removes his blood-soaked tunic while searching for a new one. Huey is not currently in a party, but he might be enticed to join crawlers equally as vicious, or that can carry a tune sufficient to allow him to perform some of his beloved duets.

Crawler #10,121,968. “Huey J.”

Level 7.

Race: Human.

Class: Not yet assigned.

ANGEL WHYTE

Unlike many of her leggy roo brethren, Angel chose to go in a different direction with her long, muscular legs and abundant marsupium. Her penchant for wearing high heels and skimpy nighties at main events often draws not only the crowd's attention but also that of the competitors themselves.

Needless to say, she finds herself with many suitors, and winning her hand is the cause of many death matches. With no real need to battle herself, she prefers to relax. She just wants to settle down and have a couple of joeys of her own. Are you jacked enough for Angel?

Angel—Stacked Kangaroo, Level 8

She's a lover, not a fighter. While most Jacked Kangaroos just want to prove themselves through mortal combat, Angel would rather prove herself through marital coitus. Do you have what it takes? Many have tried before, but none have succeeded. I guess Angel has to keep trying to find that perfect partner.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The shack in the Billabong Oasis belongs to crocodilian chef Mick Moran. It's both his place of work and his home. When the crawlers

approach the shack too closely, a steel-reinforced rattan stockade slams down, locking them inside the oasis as the sounds of Angus Young's blisteringly fast one-string arpeggio scream over invisible speakers.

Soon, the assembled Mobs begin chanting as nearby drums boom. Just as the intro reaches its climax, Mick bounds out of the shack, and a bolt of lightning blazes out toward the crawlers, but it dissipates before it reaches them. Mick is a nine-foot-tall crocodilian, wielding twin Bowie knives the size of machetes. He rasps the blades against each other, as if honing them. Sparks begin to fly, and a flash illuminates the area as another bolt streaks toward the crawlers, also dissipating. But this one comes close enough that their nose hairs tingle from the electricity.

In the center of Mick's lair is the oasis, including a large pool of water from which the Neighborhood Mobs drink. A stand of ghost gums provides shade to most of the lair, and a thick green carpet of grass covers the floor. Surprisingly, something about the space makes the crawlers hesitant to act, preventing them from taking more than one Action until Mick

engages them directly in combat. There is soothing magic at work in the oasis. Once Mick attacks any of the crawlers, this effect on them dissipates.

Mick's weakness is surprising for a crocodilian—it's water (and also cold-based attacks). He was raised in the high desert and gained a distrust of large bodies of water. This soon turned into an outright abhorrence of water. All water-based attacks do extra damage to Mick, and partial immersion in water disables his electric energy attack. When totally submerged in water, he becomes nearly comatose with fear and dies if left that way, as he never learned to swim. The pond in the oasis is shallow enough for Mick to stand in, but he becomes fully submerged if knocked prone while in the water.

Mick Moran, Hulking Crocodilian Chef

Level 12 Neighborhood Boss!

Looks like you came to the kitchen to complain to the chef. Well, Chef Moran doesn't take kindly to those who dis his food. This apex food-preparer takes farm-to-table way too literally, and tonight, you're on the menu! He'll slice and dice you just to bring out the flavor, then he'll braise you on the barbie until you're perfectly charred on the outside but still nice and rare on the inside. Talk about fresh meat!

Mick Moran, Hulking Crocodilian Chef

Neighborhood Boss; Large (5), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
8%	16%	25%	33%	41%	50%	58%	66%	75%	83%	91%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
12	14+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
20 (+5)	10 (+4)	20 (+5)	6 (+3)	5 (+2)

That's a Knife: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Thunderstrike: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Electric, 40ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Shocked Debuff.

Notes: *For Those About To Rock*—The party is prevented from taking more than one Action until Mick has directly engaged them in combat. Once Mick has attacked any of the crawlers, this effect dissipates.

Water Scarcity—Water-based attacks do extra damage to Mick, and partial immersion in water disables his Thunderstrike attack. When totally submerged in water he becomes nearly comatose with fear and will die if left that way as he never learned to swim.





NEIGHBORHOOD: DUNGEON MALL™

FLOOR: 2 (TUTORIAL)

THEME: AN IMMENSE SUBURBAN MALL CONNECTED TO STORAGE SHED WARRENS

Humans, unlike most other species, erect entire structures as monuments to their poor decisions. We're just giving them more of what they want.

— A Borant Corporation Level Designer

This Neighborhood was designed around humanity's two greatest talents: acquiring useless objects and immediately regretting it. To honor this sacred cycle, the Borant Corporation fused the glossy optimism of shopping malls with an endless maze of storage sheds, creating the Dungeon Mall™—the ultimate shrine to overwhelming materialism and poor financial decisions.

Navigating the Dungeon Mall™ is unpleasant by design. Collapsing floors, clutter-choked storage corridors, and random hazards ensure every step feels like a personal mistake. Smombies drift from store to store, eyes glued to glowing screens, oblivious until interrupted, at which point they erupt into sudden enthusiastic violence.

Meanwhile, Rev-Up employees (Clurichaun) and managers (Laminaks, absolutely *not* a pyramid scheme) relentlessly push their products with a blend of charisma, intimidation, and blunt-force trauma. Overseeing it all is a clone of the mighty Krakaren, installed to maintain brand authority without justifying the expense of sending the real one. Please enjoy your shopping experience.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into the Dungeon Mall™:

- As the crawlers round a corner, a large recognizable storefront featuring a prominent clothing brand looms before them. A headless mannequin proudly displays a popular outfit from six seasons back, and dirt-smudged window clings promise sales on summer wear.
- Around the corner of a lengthy hallway, lights flicker as if someone were... welding? Further investigation reveals a crumbled wall that leads into the Commons of the Dungeon Mall™. The flickering is an Everscrolling Screen, surrounded by Smombies entranced by its flurry of images. The screen scrolls through feeds of crawlers journeying through the World Dungeon.

- The smell of burnt grease, sour soda, and desperation wafts from half-open doors beneath a flickering neon sign that reads "The Last Food Court Standing." Distant vendors scream half-remembered deals toward anyone even venturing close to the entrance, while a cheerful voice informs passersby that no loitering is allowed.

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you'll find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- **Rollback to Oblivion (Leads to the Boss Battle):** Janis (a Pickmee) intercepts the crawlers in the Commons with bad news: the Rev-Up Empire has pushed a catastrophic product update through the ADHypermarket, and the Krakaren Clone is about to "optimize" the entire Neighborhood. To stop her, the crawlers must sabotage signal relays hidden across the Food Court and Retention Vaults while fending off Laminak managers enforcing compliance. Each success tightens the Clone's grip on the ADHypermarket, locking exits, rerouting aisles, and taking over department stores, until confrontation becomes inevitable.
- **Five-Second Rule Feud:** In The Last Food Court Standing, a pack of Smombies is trapped behind an Endless Refill trap, slowly dissolving but refusing to leave their screens. Brindle Grubs have gathered beneath the soda-slick counters, feeding on runoff and growing aggressive. The crawlers can exploit the trap to wipe out one group or disable it to pit both Mobs against each other. Either way, the chaos draws Rev-Up consultants' attention, turning a simple grind into a dangerous spectacle with environmental consequences.
- **Retention Bonus:** Deep in the Rev-Up Retention Vaults, a Pickmee cell is pinned down in a single unit by Clurichaun consultants riding battery-powered plush animals through the walkways. The crawlers

must distract or ambush the Clurichauns, using the maze-like sheds to clear a path to the blocked unit. Success earns Pickmee allies and intel; failure triggers a full managerial sweep of the Vaults.

MOBS

The Mobs encountered throughout the Dungeon Mall™ include both customers and proprietors and its wide array of wares. And the grubs? As always, they've got cleanup duty.

BRINDLE GRUBS

Brindle Grubs are the Janitor Mob of the Second Floor. One to fifteen Brindle Grubs spawn every time a corpse is created until their numbers cap out at 5,000 per quarter. Destroying corpses prevents Brindle Grubs from leveling up but not from spawning, and eventually hordes of the Mob swarm crawlers, thus chasing crawlers out of otherwise secured Neighborhoods. These large, fuzzy, fat worms have a mottled black-and-brown hide and are approximately the size of a large cat.

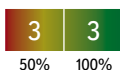
They turn into Cow-Tailed Brindle Grubs and eventually Brindled Vespas.

Brindle Grub, Level 2

Here on the Second Floor, Rats are yesterday's news. Brindle Grubs are now all the rage, and janitor duty falls to them. The more monsters you kill in an area, the more the grubs eat. The more the grubs eat, the bigger they get. Once you start finding them in the pupa stage, you'd best move on. Grubs are easy to kill. Their older siblings are not.

Brindle Grub

Mob; Small (2), Beastly



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	11+F	11+F	5+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	1 (+1)	7 (+3)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)

Chew: 11+F to hit, 1d4+1 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Notes: *Janitor Mob*—This Mob is responsible for cleaning messes on Floor 2 and prioritizes eating corpses. It targets crawlers when no other food options are nearby. The System AI spawns 1 to 15 Brindle Grubs each time an entity dies in the area, up to 5,000 active Brindle Grubs per quarter. When a Brindle Grub has eaten enough corpses,

it levels up to become a Cow-Tailed Brindle Grub.

Overcrowding—Up to 5 Brindle Grubs can share a space. Entities can attempt to move through a space containing Brindle Grubs but must make a roll Dex Stat Check with a Difficulty of 4 × the number of Brindle Grubs in the space. On Fail, the entity steps on and kills one of the Brindle Grubs, triggering the system AI to spawn more Brindle Grubs to eat the corpse.

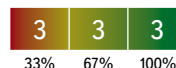
Cow-Tailed Brindle Grubs are roughly twice as large as Brindle Grubs, reaching the size of a large dog. As they grow, they develop long, pointed tails that they whip about with minimal effectiveness.

Cow-Tailed Brindle Grub, Level 3

The final form before they hit the pupa stage, the Cow-Tailed Brindle Grub is finally able to defend itself, kind of like the way a toddler holding a plastic baseball bat is able to defend himself.

Cow-Tailed Brindle Grub

Mob; Petite (3), Beastly



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	11+F	10+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
4 (+2)	1 (+1)	7 (+3)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)

Sting: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Piercing, 5ft range

Notes: *Upgraded Janitor Mob*—This Mob is the leveled-up form of the Brindle Grub. It continues to prioritize eating corpses and upon eating enough to level up again, transforms into a pupa for 10 hours, then transforms again into a Brindled Vespa. As a pupa, it has the same stats but can't attack and gains a +2 DR Buff from encasing itself in a cocoon. Killing it as a pupa prevents it from becoming a Brindled Vespa.

When a crawler rolls an Amazing Success or better with a melee weapon and kills a Cow-Tailed Brindle Grub, the crawler is covered in white goo. They suffer Disadvantage to Dexterity-based skills until cleaned off in a saferoom.



Brindled Vespa

Mob; Medium (4), Mutated

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
12%	25%	37%	50%	62%	75%	87%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
8	11+F	14+F	20+S	0
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	10 (+4)	11 (+4)	1 (+1)

Acid Goo: 11+F to hit, 2d6+1 Acid, 40ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Acid Goo Debuff: 1d6+F Acid at the end of each round until the combat ends.

Sting: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Piercing, 5ft range

Notes: *Flight*—Brindled vespas can move through the air as though on the ground and hover in place.



Fragile Wings—Brindled vespas have large wings that can be targeted by attacks (with a –2 penalty). If it loses 1 or more HB slots this way, remove their Acid Goo attack and Flight abilities.

CLURICHAUN

Small and troll-like with humanoid bodies and oversized heads, Clurichauns are marked by curly black hair, hooked noses, small feet, and very few teeth. They frequently appear in tattered overalls and other clothing favored by deep rural sects. They make a piglike gurgling noise when attacking. Though they closely resemble Goblins, Clurichauns are a fairy-class Mob.

Unvaccinated Clurichaun Rev-Up Consultant, Level 3

Clurichauns are distant hillbilly relatives of the Leprechauns. And while the Leprechauns are said to guard vast piles of gold, the only thing Clurichauns might hoard are Polaroids of their own sisters sitting on the can and questionable business schemes. This particular sect is of the unvaccinated variety. Don't let them sneeze on you.

Unvaccinated Clurichaun Rev-Up Consultant

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid

1	1	1
33%	67%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	13+F	25+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	2 (+1)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	2 (+1)

Slingshot: 13+F to hit, 3d2+2 Bludgeoning, 40ft range

Claw: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Slashing, 5ft range

Sneeze: 13+F to hit, 1d6+1 Poison, 15ft Cone

Any crawler who loses 1+ HB from this attack gains one of the following Debuffs: The Taint, Stiff Legs, or Diseased.

Diseased: Take 1d6+F Poison at the end of each round until the end of the combat.

LAMINAK

Laminaks are a Fairy-class Mob. They're fat humanlike crow-sized Fairies with buzzing hummingbird wings. They can fly lightning-fast, and their hands glow red when they cast spells.

Laminak Rev-Up Consultant Manager, Level 6

The second tier of the Rev-Up empire, these Laminak consultants don't need to speak to a manager. They *are* the managers. They run their business with brutal efficiency.

Laminak Rev-Up Consultant Manager

Mob; Small (2), Humanoid

2	2	2	2	2	2
16%	33%	50%	66%	83%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
6	13+F	13+F	45+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	7 (+3)	6 (+3)

Magic Missile Spell: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Force, 90ft range

Scream: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Sonic, 15ft Burst radius

Crawlers make free CHA Stat Checks to avoid this attack (cannot Evade).

Notes: “Natural” *Immunity*—Laminaks are immune to all damage-dealing Debuffs.



Flight—Laminaks are fairies with wings. They can move through the air as though on the ground and hover in place.

SMOMBIE

Smombies appear as humans with VR-style visors fused to their skulls, covering their eyes. They spend their time mindlessly scrolling random feeds from across the dungeon, while barely paying attention to their surroundings. Smombies are prone to seemingly random fits of emotion (outbursts of laughter or yelling are common), lasting from a few seconds to minutes, usually provoked by visuals in their feeds.

Smombie, Level 4

What’s better than the hypnotic scrolling of pointless reels one after another? Having the doomscroll connected directly to your brain! While these zombified creatures are oblivious to almost everything around them, disturbing their scrolling even in the slightest can quickly bring about a rage-fueled tantrum of death.

Smombie

Mob; Medium (4), Undead

3	3	3	3
25%	50%	75%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	11+F	12+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)

Tantrum: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Sonic, 5ft range

PICKMEES

Not all creatures have the “privilege” of being transformed into Krakaren or one of her clones, but that doesn’t stop them from trying! These simultaneously hideous and tragic monstrosities resemble oversized Clurichauns and Laminaks but frequently feature two to four tentacles and all of the benefits that come with them. As a general rule, Pickmees despise all managers. Those who are a part of the Rev-Up hierarchy suffer more ire than most due to their utter disdain for these pitiful creatures.

Pickmees, Level 7

Fueled by their abject jealousy of the Krakaren and their not-so-subtle pursuit of Rev-Up glory, these creatures despise the Empire even while wanting to join it. With fewer tentacles than the Krakaren or her clones, Pickmees are believed to be significantly safer to tangle with.

Pickmees

Mob; Large (5), Aberration

3	3	3	3	3	3	3
14%	28%	42%	57%	71%	85%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
7	12+F	12+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
8 (+3)	4 (+2)	7 (+3)	5 (+2)	2 (+1)

Rev Jug: 12+F to hit, 2d4+2 Fire, 20ft range, 5ft Burst +5ft Splash

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Burned Debuff.

Tentacles: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Bludgeoning, 10ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

ENVIRONMENT

To alien eyes, this Neighborhood is a textbook example of the classic dungeon, including corridors that look identical but lead to radically different dangers, choke points disguised as conveniences, and sprawling chambers designed to funnel prey toward predators.

The ADHypermarket boasts long corridors broken by towering shelves that create blind corners and ambush zones with the occasional opening to various storefronts or mall kiosks. To an alien architect, this is indistinguishable from a supply hall packed with unstable barricades and loot crates, except that every surface screams artificial cheer. Fluorescent lights hum overhead. Endcaps promise joy. Nothing here was built to be defensible, yet everything is, by accident.

At the Neighborhood's swollen heart sits The Last Food Court Standing, which can function as a grand arena masquerading as a communal space. Open sightlines, slippery terrain, centralized hazards, and layered vertical threats make it a traditional kill zone. Non-earthlings notice the brilliance of disguising an execution pit as a place of rest and nourishment, where prey willingly lowers its guard.

Threading between the ADHypermarket and the Commons, in an uncanny approximation of a town square, playgrounds and rest areas offer false safety while providing cover, elevation, and noise-dampening chaos. It is here that factions collide, alliances form, and violence erupts beneath simulated sunlight, reminding crawlers of normalcy just long enough to weaponize it against them.

Beneath it all lie the Rev-Up Retention Vaults, a near-perfect maze of repeating cells. Row after row of identical storage sheds function like classic dungeon warrens, their uniformity eroding orientation and morale. Each unit is a sealed mystery box, potentially empty, potentially lethal.

The dungeon doesn't look hostile. It looks familiar. Cheerful signage marks kill corridors. Soft music masks danger. Comfort items become traps. This isn't a ruin reclaimed by monsters; it's a living monument to a species that built its own dungeon long before the aliens ever arrived.

TRAPS

- **Everscrolling Screen:** Though most prevalent in the ADHypermarket, these 40-inch TV screens are found throughout the Neighborhood. Staring too long at such a screen risks the crawler being entranced by its constantly scrolling feeds and reels. Once entranced, the crawler becomes oblivious to everything around them until outside interference brings them back to their senses.

On occasion, a pack of Smombies may surround one of these screens. If a crawler becomes entranced by the Everscrolling Screen, there's a chance that one or more of the Smombies realizes that someone ventured too close to them and disturbed their doomscrolling.

- **Up and at 'Em:** These innocent-looking pieces of plush leather furniture present themselves as everyday massage chairs, inviting the weary to sit and relax. Anyone who takes the bait is rewarded with an excruciatingly pleasant massage for exactly 42 seconds before the chair flings its occupant at the nearest wall with the force of the neighbor kid's homemade slingshot (2d6 Bludgeoning).

ITEMS

- **Bottomless Soda of Infinite Refills (Cursed Item):** A massive plastic cup with a large handle emblazoned with faded logos that promise "Free Refills." The contents of this cup can be consumed repeatedly without refilling, restoring a little stamina each time. Each refill increases thirst, eventually forcing you to drink or face penalties. Discarding, losing, or destroying the cup causes intense emotional distress.
- **Abandoned Play-Place Tubes:** These cracked plastic crawl-tunnels from a long-dead kids' zone echo

loudly and offer both cover and deeply undignified ambush routes.

- **Bolted Food Court Tables:** Long, grease-slick tables fused together into immovable islands make excellent cover, choke points, or improvised barricades.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards:

- **What a Pitch!:** “You successfully sold a Rev-Up product to one of their own consultants! You do realize how demoralizing that is, don’t you?
Reward: You’ve received a Gold Unemployment Box.”
Contents: A Charisma-enhancing item.
- **Five Second Rule:** “You’ve consumed food that touched the floor and survived! Uh... seriously, though—you probably want to get some medicine, quickly. Have you seen what’s on these floors?
Reward: You’ve received a Silver Gourmand’s Box.”

Contents: A bib (Accessory) or chef’s hat (Head) that grants Resistance to Poison damage.

- **Eat Fast, Die Hard:** “You defeated an enemy within ten minutes of consuming food from The Last Food Court Standing. You didn’t even wipe your hands first! Then again, it’s probably best you didn’t wait too long. I don’t envy the diarrhea you’re gonna have later...
Reward: You’ve received a Food Court Token. It’s usable at any vendor in the Dungeon Mall™ for a one-time 50% off “discount” that is absolutely not worth it.”
- **Tick, Tick, BOOM!:** “Congratulations! You’ve assisted an unstable person with making explosions! UR Resistance members now look upon you with only one question in their minds: Why?
Reward: You’ve received a Silver Goblin Box.”
Contents: An assortment of “starter” explosives and a UR Resistance Pass tattoo that automatically appears as an explosion tattoo on your right bicep. The tattoo grants +1 to the Goblin Explosives Handling Skill.

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers defeated a few Mobs in the Dungeon Mall™, they might grind for experience by killing lots of the same Mobs over and over. Most likely, this involves something akin to murder-shopping, as they move from store to store, slaughtering Mobs at wholesale prices. Roll 1d20.

TABLE 16: DUNGEON MALL™ GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	Brindle Grubs are the easiest grind at first (although they offer comparably low experience), but every cleared fryer trench seems to attract twice as many the next time, turning simple cleanup into a slippery swarm problem.
2	Smombies make for efficient grind targets as they wander predictable routes through stores, but prolonged grinding risks drawing synchronized screen-glow frenzies that explode into sudden mall-wide violence.
3	Clurichauns are lucrative targets if the crawlers can keep them separated, though grinding them too aggressively alerts their managers and triggers increasingly coordinated ambushes from fuzzy mounted knights.
4	Pickmees are dangerous but tempting to grind, as their jealousy-fueled rage scales fast. The longer the crawlers hunt them, the more unstable and explosive their tactics become, and they risk the ire of Janis.
5	Laminaks are technically grindable if the crawlers enjoy the feeling of being held in the piercing gaze of their supervisors and the corrective action that results. Repeated kills prompt managerial “performance reviews” that escalate spells, reinforcements, and environmental punishment.
6	Mixed-store murder-shopping works best overall, but lingering too long in one retail zone inspires the Dungeon Mall™ to adapt, locking doors, rerouting Mobs, and reminding crawlers that wholesale slaughter still comes with restocking fees.
7+	See Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications (p. 13).



EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

The Dungeon Mall™ has four quarters for crawlers to explore.

QUARTER: ADHYPERMARKET

As the primary thoroughfare of the Dungeon Mall™, the ADHypermarket is a dizzying array of flashing signs and overfull aisles. Everywhere the crawlers look, they find advertisements for countless nonsensical wares on dozens of storefronts, mostly assembled and completely discombobulated, as if reconstructed from the frontages of half a dozen stores and kiosks without any concern for established building codes.

- The bulk of the Rev-Up staff call this area home—or as close as they can get to one. Laminak Consultants roam almost every aisle while Laminaks flitter above, calling all the shots and explaining in detail everything they're doing wrong.
- A door splinters as Crawler Louis B. Denver bursts through it, covered in Brindle Grub ichor and with a Laminak head still stuck in the strings of his Guitar-axe. He glances around frantically before asking, "Anybody got a flamethrower?" A huge swarm of Brindle Grubs pours into the hallway after him. After the battle, Louis B. Denver steps away from the crawler party to assess them and decide whether to accompany the group or continue on his own.
- A flashing sign drops from the ceiling, trailing bright orange flames. It reads "Fire Sale!" in Syndicate Standard. The sign points to one of the nearby mall kiosks over the cluttered aisles. A closer look reveals an enterprising young Clurichuan with a table propped up on cinder blocks. Atop the table is some strange machine that looks like the cobbled-together parts of a blender and a coffee pot, combined with a miniaturized gizmo off a sci-fi TV show.

If the crawlers approach, the little creature yells, "Get it while it's hot!" and fills several random containers with a glowing orange liquid from the machine. The young Clurichaun offers a drink to one of the crawlers and then bargains harshly with the group. The drink has a healing effect: it removes the Shit-Faced Debuff instantly and prevents the Blood Trail Debuff until a rest is taken.

- A Krakaren Clone serves as the Neighborhood Boss, running her Rev-Up mafia from the backroom of a rundown department store, the dire abomination of where quality meets quantity and where Rev-Up staff acquire their designer pant suits. Rev-Up employees serve her devoutly in

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or on their own to evoke the mood of Dungeon Mall™:

- *A lone shopping cart rolls past, wheels squealing, packed with someone's abandoned life.*
Outcome: Use the cart as a mobile cover or a distraction. Otherwise, it may tip over, spilling noisy contents and drawing attention.
- *An intercom crackles, promising deals and salvation while metal shutters begin to descend.*
Outcome: Run away before the shutters lock or be trapped and forced to fight or find a new way out.
- *A flickering sale sign buzzes overhead while distant screams echo cheerfully through empty aisles.*
Outcome: An Overwhelming group of Smombies approaches.
- *Three Smombies argue loudly with a directory map, insisting it moved since last time.*
Outcome: Their argument escalates into violent outrage which threatens to engulf the party.

hopes of advancement to the next floor, so various consultant frequently surround her.

- Crawlers who befriend Janis the Pickmee hear gossip about the clone and may receive tips on how to draw out and defeat the abomination. See the *B-B-B-Boss Battle!* (p. 14).

QUARTER: THE LAST FOOD COURT STANDING

Eat Fast. Die Full. The Rev-Up Empire sealed the mall's power junction inside the old food court subbasement, and the only way to unlock it is by triggering the court's long-abandoned "End of Day Sanitation Protocol." Unfortunately, the control panel is wedged behind the counters, the floor is slick with decades of grease, and the place is very much not abandoned.

- As the crawlers push past flickering menu boards, precariously stacked food trays, and overturned tables, the first real threat announces itself with wet, enthusiastic sloshing. Brindle Grubs, bloated on fryer runoff and spilled soda syrup, burst from behind the counters in writhing packs, their bodies skidding across the tiles and leaving trails of acidic grease that turn the battlefield into a nightmarish slip-and-slide.
- The Brindle Grubs arrive in waves, and while they're not effective at attacking, their sheer numbers threaten to overwhelm crawlers. They're an obnoxious distraction and a complication, especially when the real threat manifests: a Strong pack of



Smombies whom the crawlers disturbed from their endless doomscrolling. Now, imagine fighting them while trying not to slip on the greasy food court floors or tripping over dozens of squishy, bloated worms the size of housecats underfoot.

- Once the Brindle Grubs and Smombies are cleared, the crawlers stumble into a rare non-combat encounter: The Automated Vendor Collective. Several surviving food kiosks merged their AI routines into a single deeply confused customer service entity that desperately wants to complete a transaction. It bombards the crawlers with contradictory meal deals, loyalty programs, and expired coupons. Navigating the interaction without violence by reprogramming the AI or other means may reward the party with temporary Buffs or perhaps a truly cursed beverage.
- The Sanitation Protocol Control Panel can only be activated once the food court is “customer ready,” which requires solving (or surviving) the earlier encounters. Furniture must be set right, vendors pacified or disabled, and lingering Mobs removed

from key areas before the system allows activation. Activating the system triggers roaring industrial fans, pressure-washers, and collapsing trash chutes, forcing the crawlers to flee the quarter amid the chaos of cleansing.

Success restores partial power to the mall and opens new routes, but the announcer helpfully notes that cleanliness bonuses do not apply to emotional damage.

QUARTER: REV-UP RETENTION VAULTS

Inspired by the storage facilities littering the American landscape, the Rev-Up Retention Vaults are a maze of identical storage sheds stacked in endless rows, each one packed with abandoned furniture, mislabeled crates, and the lingering stink of sunk costs. From rooms of Rev-Up stock to overflowing compartments of funky colored leggings and indestructible food storage containers, there’s plenty of junk to go around.

- Through rumors and chats with Janis herself, the crawlers discover that the Rev-Up consultants in Dungeon Mall™ launder products through the shopping precinct under the guise of “consultant



retention." Shipment records and inventory tags proving the Rev-Up Empire is a laundering ring are stored somewhere in the depths of the storage warrens.

- If Janis and the crawlers can get their hands on them, they can sabotage the next scheduled "motivation purge" and expose the Rev-Up consultants as the thieves they are to the Borant Corporation, hopefully earning some goodwill with the dungeon overlords.
- Almost immediately upon entry into this quarter, the crawlers draw the attention of the Laminak consultants. These crow-sized fairy managers streak through the aisles on hummingbird wings, hands glowing red as they bark orders and unleash brutal spellwork with terrifying efficiency. They fight like middle management incarnate: coordinated, relentless, and personally offended by inefficiency. During the encounter, the Laminaks weaponize the environment, slamming storage doors, collapsing shelves, and forcing crawlers into narrow lanes with fewer escape options.
- If the crawlers survive or avoid the Laminaks, they stumble into a rare non-combat encounter: The Retention Orientation Room. A flickering projector plays an endlessly looping training video while malfunctioning kiosks demand that the party affirm loyalty statements, rank their personal dreams, and justify why they deserve storage space. Clever crawlers can exploit the system's obsession with compliance by lying, looping answers, or overwhelming it with contradictory affirmations to gain temporary Buffs, map locations, or limited control over nearby storage vault doors.
- Deeper within the quarter, the crawlers encounter Janis and her Pickmees holed up inside a breached vault decorated with spray-painted slogans and half-assembled explosives. Janis needs help accessing the central Retention Ledger, which is sealed behind a biometric lock key that only opens for the Laminak authorities. To reach it, the crawlers must first overcome the Laminaks and recover their credentials, which were looted or stolen during the chaos of an earlier encounter. Only then can Janis gather her proof and plant her explosive charges to bring down the Rev-Up ring for good. If the crawlers succeed and the Rev-Up Retention Vaults begin to burn, Janis and her fellow Pickmees don't cheer—they watch silently, dreaming of ascension even as they tear down this small corner of the very Empire they aspire to rule. Crawlers leave with the unsettling feeling that they may have aided

in the evolution of an even more fanatical Mob of mean girls among the Pickmees.

QUARTER: COMMONS

This section of the Dungeon Mall™ consists of several sprawling common areas packed with an unsettling mix of playground equipment, bench seating, and the occasional echoing wail of a crying toddler that no one can ever quite locate.

- Clurichaun Rev-Up Consultants are frequent denizens of the Commons, often using the space as a temporary refuge from their managers, sales quotas, and whatever motivational violence is currently trending. Unfortunately, they're fiercely protective of this hiding spot and attack trespassers with startling ferocity.
- In one large chamber, a Moderate group of Clurichauns race wildly around the room atop fuzzy battery-powered plush animals. They're designed for children but are somehow a perfect fit for the Clurichauns' small bodies. They zoom through the space in chaotic patterns, shouting insults and laughing at their own jokes. If the Clurichauns spot the crawlers, they charge immediately, screaming battle cries as they bear down like knights mounted on ridiculous plushy steeds. Shortly after combat begins, a Laminak arrives to investigate the noise, immediately berating the Clurichauns for their incompetence before joining the fight herself, attacking everyone present with equal (and considerable) enthusiasm.
- In the centermost area, yellowed fluorescent light filters down through a glass ceiling: false sunlight illuminating a small but grotesquely ornate fountain. The fountain depicts a pair of dancing Kua-Tin, each spitting a steady stream of water into a basin tiled in blue and green. The water is refreshing, but it inflicts The Taint Debuff on anyone who drinks it. Each sip has a 50% chance of removing all other Debuffs while also extending the duration of The Taint.
- Garish circus music blares from a massive carousel more than thirty feet tall and equally wide. Golden horses made of plaster and plastic prance beside oversized Danger Dingoes, spinning teacups, and several suspiciously ordinary benches. A hidden button beneath the left eye of one horse appears inert, but it actually unlocks a concealed door in the carousel's central pillar, masked by the ride's music. Crawlers who discover it descend a short spiral staircase into the hidden base of the RU Resistance. If they're already on good terms with Janis, she may have hinted at the door's location beforehand.

NPCS

Crawlers might encounter these NPCs in the Dungeon Mall™:

LOUIS B. DENVER

Louis B. Denver was a jazz musician before the dungeon recast him as a crawler. He'd just finished a set and gone out for a breath of fresh air, away from the smoke and noise of the club, and then the world ended. His guitar was still onstage when everything went to hell, but at least he'd had his harmonica in his pocket—because of course the apocalypse happens when all you've got is a harmonica.

Ever since he received a Guitar-axe from a Gold Bard Box back on the First Floor, he's been shredding wicked Mobs and wicked solos alike, taking out his deepest frustrations on anything that happens across his path. He's not opposed to getting the band back together, so to speak, but he largely led a solo career so far.

Crawler #9,586,514. "Louis B. Denver."

Level 12.

Race: Human.

Class: Not yet assigned.

JANIS

Of all of the Pickmees arrayed against the Rev-Up Empire, Janis is the most dangerous. Known as a terrorist by the managers and employees of the *definitely-not-a-pyramid* MLM, she enjoys women with high Charisma Stats and long walks through the mall corridors so she can express herself with spray paint and heavy explosives.

Janis—Pickmee, Level 9

Once a typical run-of-the-mill snobbish fairy, Janis now refuses to submit to the rule of the Krakaren Clone and her Rev-Up mafia. Instead, she turned all of that mean girl energy toward collapsing the entire empire into a heap of flaming dust filled with broken Rev-Up bottles and shattered dreams.

PAULA BLART

Few Laminaks have the authority to pursue justice. Paula is not one of them, but why would she let that stop her? She's a marvel at picking up clues and solving riddles, so it's unfortunate that so many of her fellow

Rev-Up employees ignore her skill set. She fervently pursues Janis and has sworn upon her personal bottle of Rev-Up to catch the notorious terrorist and bring her to justice.

Paula Blart—Laminak Rev-Up Consultant Manager, Level 4

A slightly decorated enforcer of the Krakaren, this flittering private eye will do anything to catch her perp (in this case, a "perp" is defined as Pickmees and crawlers who take action against any Rev-Up employee or facility). She pursues Rev-Up justice with a fury matched only by cornered animals and angry pygmy goats.

B-B-B-BOSS BATTLE!

The ADHypermarket goes silent all at once. Shopping music cuts mid note, lights flicker, and every screen, scanner, and endcap display snaps to life in perfect, nauseating unison. A grotesque mass of tentacles explodes from the doors of the nearby department store, and the system voice sounds tired, almost apologetic, as it explains that this is not *the* Krakaren but merely a Krakaren. As the announcer finishes, checkout lanes lock into place, and rolling security grills grind down over every exit.

The Krakaren Clone swiftly scuttles to suspend itself above the central aisle, a knotted mass of shrieking pink tentacles studded with blinking sensory nodes and leaking vats-worth of viscous diseased product. Several tentacles end in malformed mouths that constantly talk over one another, selling, debating, proselytizing Rev-Up, and contradicting themselves in the same breath.

The creature is a mass of writhing confusion that doesn't fight with strategy so much as insistence, battering the environment around it (and everyone in it) into submission. Shelving units are ripped free and hurled down aisles, kiosks become blunt weapons, and crawlers are dragged toward spill zones where caustic sludge and unstable merchandise flood the floor. Periodically, the Hypermarket "reorganizes" itself, sliding, collapsing, or sealing off sections entirely as the store aggressively optimizes for foot traffic, forcing constant repositioning under fire.

As the battle drags on, the Krakaren Clone grows louder and sloppier, its attacks less precise but more



frequent, releasing diseased minions and flooding the space with alarms, toxic recalls, and blaring jingles that signal imminent hazards. The clone never adapts, never learns, never improves; it simply doubles down, screaming louder as it flails. The Krakaren Clone doesn't want the crawlers dead—it wants them exhausted, overwhelmed, and ready to believe anything.

Krakaren Clone, Level 10

Level 10 Neighborhood Boss!

First off, this isn't *the* Krakaren. This is *a* Krakaren. For every one that is killed, Krakaren Prime births two more.

Part of a collective mind intent upon destroying any semblance of scientific progress in the universe, the Krakaren is the only communal brain entity in the galaxy that actually gets stupider as time moves on. Consisting of multiple, shrieking tentacles, members of the Krakaren cooperative spend their days birthing their disease-laden minions, creating and selling harmful products, attempting to debate scientific experts, and proselytizing to the weak-minded, all in an attempt to... Well, nobody knows what the hell their end goal is.

Even Eris, Goddess of Chaos, doesn't want anything to do with these crazy assholes.

Krakaren Clone

Neighborhood Boss; Gargantuan (8), Aberrant

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
8%	16%	25%	33%	41%	50%	58%	66%	75%	83%	91%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
10	11+F	12+F	20+S	3
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
20 (+5)	1 (+1)	10 (+4)	5 (+2)	15 (+4)

Tentacles: 14+F to hit, 2d4+5 Bludgeoning, 15ft Cone
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Constrict: None, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, Auto-hits a Held foe

Beak Bite: 15+F to hit, 2d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range

Spit Spray: 12+F to hit, 3d6+2 Poison, 30ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Pyramid Pitch: 14+F to hit, No damage, 50ft range

Make a free CHA Stat Check vs the attack. On Fail, must spend next Action attacking an ally.

Notes: *Bad Hair Day*—Krakarens believe they have a flattering hairstyle, and if it gets messed up, they are frantic. Any attack that results in an Amazing Success or better causes all Held Debuffs to cease.







NEIGHBORHOOD: MIND MAZE

FLOOR: 2 (TUTORIAL)

THEME: SQUISHY, SLIMY, HEADACHE-INDUCING HORROR.

Once again, the corpses on this level were significantly more fragile once they died.

—Carl

From the moment crawlers set foot in this Neighborhood, they can feel a prickling pain starting at the base of their skulls—a headache blooming behind their eyes. The twisting, turning corridors of this place seem at once familiar and strange, begging the question, “Have I been here before?”

The world’s most serpentine, mundane corridors were repurposed by Borant for this Neighborhood, specifically arranged to confuse and lead crawlers astray. To add to their plight, Mind Horrors stalk the halls in groups, their influence causing mass migraines and slowing thought. Shimmering slime leads the way to the Cardium Clam at the heart of the Neighborhood.

STRONG STARTS

Here are ways to hook your crawlers into this Neighborhood:

- A large glimmering pearl rolls out from an alleyway, enticing and clearly worth a good chunk of change. Whoever reaches for the pearl first stumbles as they are struck by a sudden, sharp pain in the head, and they drop the smallest item (which could be a weapon) they are carrying. The item attaches to the pearl as if they were magnets, and it continues rolling into the shadows.
- A flickering light directs crawlers down a hallway toward the next saferoom. The sign blinks on and off. As the party follows the lights, the directions grow increasingly vague, with arrows pointing in contradictory directions—the crawlers have become lost in the maze.
- Sleeping in the saferoom, the crawlers experience a shared nightmare, chased by floating brains and grubs down long, winding corridors. Hitting a dead-end with the creatures close behind, the crawlers wake to find they’ve been running randomly through the Neighborhood in their sleep.

- One of the many concrete buildings sourced for the maze was once the apartment complex where one or more of the crawlers lived, and a light is on in their apartment window. All they need to do is find a way in...

STORY ARCS

These story arcs combine what you’ll find in this Neighborhood into ready-to-go adventures:

- The crawlers come across the path of Crawler Kamonrat N., who successfully navigated the Mind Maze several times before. He wrote down the solution to the exit puzzle in a notebook, which he has since misplaced. Following clues throughout the quarters, the crawlers search for the notebook and the key to reach the next Neighborhood.
- Because this Neighborhood steals knowledge, it must have a repository of it somewhere. The crawlers catch a rumor that somewhere in the Mind Maze, a library gives them the answer to every question and every puzzle through the end of the dungeon. Rumors might be hyperbole, but there must be something worth finding.
- The crawlers spot another crawler they crossed paths with in an earlier Neighborhood and could meet up with them. However, that crawler has already lost themselves to the Thought Fog and is becoming a Lost Soul. As long as the crawler can remember their name, the process can be reversed—but the crawlers must discover how.

MOBS

The Mobs in the Mind Maze do not have conscious thought of their own and are thus immune to the psionic effects of the maze.

BRINDLE GRUBS

As with other Neighborhoods on the Second Floor, trash and detritus are handled by the janitorial Brindle Grubs. These cat-sized fuzzy worms gorge themselves on corpses, becoming more powerful with each body they consume. The more corpses are left on the dungeon floor, the more Brindle Grubs spawn.

Destroying or burning corpses prevents more Brindle Grubs from spawning and existing Brindle Grubs from leveling up but does not remove already-spawned Brindle Grubs. Cleared areas become dangerous once again if the corpses are left to fester, as Brindle Grubs take over as the dominant aggressive Mob in the area.

Full statistics for Brindle Grubs, Cow-Tailed Brindle Grubs, and Brindled Vespas are found in the Threat Appendix (p. 139).

Brindle Grub, Level 2

The corpse on the floor wriggles and shudders, something moving from within the skin. A stray kick to stop the shuddering results in the wet sound of tearing flesh and a hiss of gas released from high pressure. From the tear in the corpse's flesh, a fuzzy tortoiseshell-patterned grub emerges, squeaking and squelching.

Brindle Grubs are this floor's Janitor Mob, and while they're mostly harmless, there sure are a lot of them...

DREAM EATERS

Dream Eaters lurk in the shadows at the corners of your vision when you haven't gotten enough sleep, tricking you into seeing things that aren't really there. These pitch-black cat-sized creatures stalk the hallways of the maze, eagerly waiting around the corner for crawlers to collapse from exhaustion and take a rest. Inducing nightmares, the Dream Eaters creep closer and closer to sleeping crawlers, living off the fear, anxiety, and tension spawned by bad dreams.

While many Dream Eaters come in the shape of black cats, they can shift into other creatures of similar size, such as owls, ferrets, monitor lizards, or miniature pigs. The defining feature across any shadowy form is a spider-like arrangement of eyes above a mouth full of sharp, iridescent teeth.

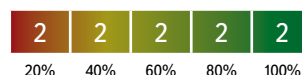
Dream Eater, Level 5

A group of shadows flits across your vision, slinking in the shadows of the alleyway. Several clumps of eyes reflect light back to you from the shadows, gleaming and hungry. A wave of tiredness washes over you—tempting you to lie down and sleep. Surely the world of dreams is better than this awful place.

Dream Eaters exist to haunt you while you sleep (and while you should be sleeping). Dreams, nightmares—they'll eat any flavor of dream, so as the old saying goes: sleep with one eye open.

Dream Eaters

Mob; Small (2), Shadow



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	14+F	12+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	10 (+4)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Bite: 14+F to hit, 2d6+2 Psychic, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Nightmares Debuff: For the remainder of the current Floor, the crawler wakes each "morning" with the Fatigued Debuff.

LOST SOULS

Many crawlers attempted to traverse this Neighborhood before, and many of them failed. The crawlers who couldn't find their way out of the endless winding hallways and barren cement walls slowly lose themselves to the ongoing mental onslaught, becoming shambling shades of their former selves.

Lost Souls resemble the creatures they were in life, but with blank, hollow eyes and bodies cast in dull-gray color palettes. Lost Souls are desperate to find their way out, single-mindedly searching for an exit that will no longer appear for them. They're hostile toward any sentient creatures—especially crawlers—as they're jealous of their potential ability to leave the maze.

Lost Soul, Level 3

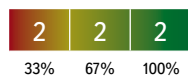
Muttering voices reach your ears before you see the source of the sound, all asking disjointed questions: *Where are we? Was it left or right? I've seen that door before...* A group of shambling figures stumbles into view, touching the walls and looking around with empty eyes, desperate for a new way out.

Lost Souls are kind of like your great-grandmother who got dementia in her final years. She maintained her independence, lived at home, and could recite her bank account number by heart, but she couldn't remember if you were you or if you were one of your parents. All I'm gonna say is it's a good thing she could never find her car keys.



Lost Souls

Mob; Medium (4), Undead



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	12+F	12+F	10+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	4 (+2)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Bump: 12+F to hit, 1d8+2 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Muttering: 12+F to hit, 1d4+2 Sonic, 15ft Burst radius

Any hit crawler confuses the party, reducing the Time to Floor Collapse by 1d2 hours.

MIND HORRORS

Floating gelatinous brains linger in packs, their tentacular limbs wriggling and writhing in the air beneath them. These jelly brains have little-to-no thoughts of their own—all that exists within them is the sharp pain of an overwhelmed mind. Mind Horrors use psionic abilities to cause headaches and drain the mental capacity of any sentient life they encounter.

Mind Horror, Level 4

The constant, low-level headache that plagued you since you entered the Neighborhood gets stronger as you turn a corner, a cluster of Mind Horrors coming into view. The floating jellified brains turn toward you, tentacles squirming in anticipation of the intelligence they are about to consume.

Mind Horrors feed on your intelligence, which is why you so often have a headache when they're around. But for once, there's good news for the idiots among you: stupid crawlers have a natural resistance to their attacks.

Nah, just kidding. They're equally as susceptible. But if you thought this applied to you, even if only briefly, then you might actually be dumber than I thought.

Mind Horror

Mob; Petite (3), Aberrant



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	13+F	11+F	0+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	8 (+3)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)	4 (+2)



Mindspike Spell: 13+F to hit, 1d12+3 Psychic, 30ft range

Psionic Spell: 13+F to hit, No damage, 60ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Splitting Headache Debuff: Take 1d6+F Psychic at the end of each round until the combat ends (Stackable).

Splatter: 12+F to hit, 1d6+3 Acid, 5ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Queasy Debuff.

Notes: *Ego Screen*—Entities with an Intelligence Stat greater than the Mind Horror's Intelligence Stat are immune to its Debuffs.

Mandatory Flight—Mind Horrors hover by default and can only move through the air and fall to the ground it killed. If they touch the ground (alive or dead), they automatically Splatter.

TROGLODYTES

Lizard-faced humanoids with little to no intelligence, Troglodytes travel in packs throughout the Neighborhood. The Troglodytes of the Mind Maze differ from their cousins in other Neighborhoods by the layer of slime that coats them from head to toe. The Troglodytes generate this slime, secreting it from pores in their skin to protect them from the elements. It has a mild numbing effect and can be harvested for crafting.

Troglodyte, Level 6

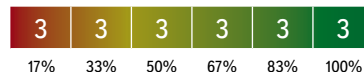
Slick slapping noises echo against the walls and floor of this street, the sound of slightly-wet, slightly tacky flesh on concrete. Slime-coated troglodytes pause in their scavenging as they smell you approaching, turning toward you with gaping maws, drool dripping from their teeth.



Yes, they're ugly and smell bad, but they kind of look like a tiny version of a certain world-famous Japanese kaiju whose name rhymes with "Schmodzilla." If they get too close and touch you with any part of their slimy bodies, you're bound to get stains in your clothes that will never come out. And really, isn't that the true horror in this situation?

Troglodyte Basher

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
6	11+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
7 (+3)	1 (+1)	7 (+3)	7 (+3)	1 (+1)

Bash: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Venom Spit: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Poison, 20ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: Slimed!—Troglodytes secrete a protective slime that's kinda gross when some gets splashed onto you. When an adjacent crawler rolls an Amazing Success or better with an attack, they gain the Queasy Debuff.

ENVIRONMENT

The Mind Maze is a sprawling complex of narrow, twisting passageways—full of dead ends, redirects, and secret passages. In classic dungeon fashion, this complex the System AI can shift and manipulate the entrances and exits change at its whim.

Some maze walls are made from classic maze materials—hedges and stone walls harvested from old estates, trick doors, and traps. But most of the maze was built from the steel and concrete slabs of low-income apartment buildings, brutalist government architecture, academic institutions, and prison complexes.

Very few buildings in this Neighborhood have windows, and those that do are all small and poorly placed—the kind of windows installed so a landlord can legally call a room a bedroom. The buildings themselves serve as miniature mazes within the larger structure, designed to trap crawlers and keep them confused until they lose their sense of self.



- **Shifting Streets:** The streets that make up the Mind Maze are mapped by the System AI, and that map can shift. Any time crawlers aren't inside a given quarter, the System AI can rearrange the entrances, exits, and key locations within that quarter.
- **Mirror Pools:** Water, oil, and other liquids pool in potholes and divots in the street, forming reflective surfaces. These mirror pools add to the disorienting state of the maze, further confusing crawlers and turning them around.
- **Thought Fog:** Some streets and corridors are flooded with fog that both deafens sound and makes it nearly impossible to see. This fog induces brain fog of the same intensity, causing difficulty thinking, remembering, making decisions, and sensing motive.

TRAPS

The traps of the Mind Maze are all set by the dungeon architects, designed to lure sentient and intelligent creatures so their knowledge can be harvested by the dungeon and its denizens. While some of the more aggressive Mobs, like the Troglodytes and Dream Eaters, may take advantage of these traps to hunt their prey, they do not understand the traps and cannot reset or adjust them.

- **Puzzle Room:** The doors leading into this room change at random, with only one leading out and the rest leading to danger, blank walls, or back into the room from a new location. Each time a door opens, the doors rearrange, and the dangers behind them reset. In the center of the room, a riddle gives clues as to which door is the correct choice.
- **Quickslime:** These puddles of slime are much deeper than they appear. When any crawler enters the quickslime, it begins to pull them in, sucking them into its depths. Make a Jump Skill Check or DEX Stat Check vs Difficulty 15 to avoid it.
- **Readiness Exam:** One of the ways the Mind Maze sucks intelligence from its victims is through standardized testing. Using segments of standardized tests from the world before, this trap forces crawlers to answer trivia questions and general knowledge questions, dealing Psychic damage for every wrong answer. The number of questions a crawler must answer to escape varies from trap to trap.

ITEMS

Many items found in the Mind Maze were left by prior victims who abandoned all belongings in their desperation to escape. In addition to these, the dungeon architects littered the maze with a variety of eccentric, out-of-place, and out-of-time objects designed to disorient and confuse.

- **Sundial:** A traditional sundial that exclusively uses the insufficient light in the environment to tell incorrect time.
- **Luggage:** Abandoned purses, suitcases, backpacks, and other luggage dumped by prior victims of the Mind Maze.
- **Desks:** School desks with attached chairs. These can be stacked, arranged, flipped, thrown, or sat in—theoretically.
- **Weathervanes:** These weathervanes spin whether or not wind is present, pointing in odd directions amid flashes of light and color.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements in this Neighborhood with associated rewards:

- **Sleepless in Seattle:** "You've navigated a fight with the Dream Eaters without suffering Nightmares. I guess that crippling caffeine addiction finally paid off!"
Reward: You've received a Bronze Adventurer Box."
Contents: A jar of powdered instant coffee.
- **The Mind is a Terrible Thing to Taste:** "You've defeated 10 Mind Horrors in hand-to-brain combat."
Reward: You've received a Gold Adventurer Box."
Contents: A hat (head slot) that provides Resistance to Psychic damage.
- **Lost and Found:** "You've taken a wrong turn in the Mind Maze but made your way to a saferoom despite yourself."
Reward: You made it—and you still have your brain, right?"
- **An Intimate Connection:** "You've let Euphemia read your aura and see the world through her eyes."
Reward: You gain immunity to Nightmare effects for the duration of this floor, plus you've received a Silver Apparel Box."
Contents: A Silver-tier clothing item.
- **Mother of Pearl:** "You've reached inside the Cardium Clam with your bare hands—what possessed you to do that?"
Reward: An enormous pearl worth 500 gold."

GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

Once the crawlers confront and defeat a few Mobs in this area, they might grind for experience by killing lots of the same Mobs over and over. This generally involves venturing into alleyways or buildings to clear out Mind Horrors, Dream Eaters, and Troglodytes. Roll 1d20.

TABLE 17: MIND MAZE GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	The crawlers hear a Strong troop of Lost Souls shuffling down the street. As the Mobs come into view, the crawlers notice another crawler in their midst—one they met on a prior adventure. The crawler has a hint of recognition left in their eyes. Maybe they can still be saved?
2	The Brindle Grubs successfully converted a hallway of corpses into processed goo—which, unfortunately, seems to have a bone to pick with you.
3	A thick wave of Thought Fog fills the area the crawlers are in, splitting them into pairs or small groups. In order to escape, they'll have to find the exit—and each other.
4	You stumble across a cacophony of Dream Eaters mid-feast, sucking the energy out of a rival group of crawlers. Do you help them or simply enjoy the spoils?
5	The System AI slides the walls at either end of this hallway shut, barring the exit as it initiates a memory-matching game with a twist: for every card you match wrong, you forget something about yourself or the world before.
6	The Mind Maze induces a splitting migraine with auras, forcing the crawlers to navigate with their eyes closed or take 1d6+F Psychic every time they perform an Action.
7+	See Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications (p. 13).

EXPLORING THE NEIGHBORHOOD

QUARTER: STREAM OF CONSCIOUSNESS

A slow-moving oily river runs through this quarter—the only constant in the shifting pathways of the maze. Navigating by the river is the quickest way through this quarter but also the most dangerous. Mobs station themselves along the river to hunt crawlers seeking swift passage. Lost Souls are common here, wandering in packs or as desperate, solitary hunters. This quarter should feel disjointed, made of disparate parts that don't quite fit or blend together.

- While searching for materials to build a raft, the crawlers come upon an alley where every wall is covered with scrawled messages in various languages. As they approach to make sense of the text, they are ambushed by the Lost Souls who use this place to record and cling to the few aspects of themselves they remember.
- One of the buildings the dungeon architects harvested for this quarter is an ancient maze like those of Minoan legend on Crete. Rather than

fighting, the crawlers must escape this portion of the Stream of Consciousness by answering a series of riddles and stepping through the correct doors. Some of these riddles may be traditional word puzzles, while others may consist of pictograms or other clues (try the internet).

- Hidden among the imposing cement facades and sluggish waterways is a library that contains all of the knowledge stolen from the Lost Souls throughout this Neighborhood. Crawlers can stealthily follow Lost Souls to the doors of this library. The Lost Souls cannot enter, as you must speak your name to be granted access. Crawlers can also learn about this library from Kamonrat N. (p 124) if they befriend him.

QUARTER: CRACKING ERUDITE FOUNDATION

The passageways of this quarter formed from the halls of knowledge across space and time. From the bright colors of elementary school hallways to the echoing marble of elite institutions, each hallway, room, and open-air forum holds the academic pressure, anxiety, and despair of an education system that values



progress over people. The crawlers should see echoes of their own past academic experience in these spaces—both positive and negative.

- A horde of Troglodytes decided to make their nest in what was once a low-income public school teacher's lounge. The tantalizing smell of microwave meals and fresh coffee draws in unwitting crawlers, where the Troglodytes wait to pounce.
- Amid all the academic suffering that haunts these halls, some successes may be glimpsed as well. A room full of scrolls exudes a strong aura of dread and trepidation. If the crawlers can handle the metaphorical (and somewhat physical) weight on their shoulders that grows stronger and stronger the farther they venture into the room, they can claim a Scroll of Immediate Understanding from the wall. Have it do something cool!

QUARTER: THE MIND SLURRY

Far more than any other quarter in this Neighborhood, the Mind Slurry is moist. The very walls here seem to sweat and steam, issuing a smothering mist into the air. Crawlers are just as likely to slip physically as they are mentally here, with thoughts feeling slow as molasses.

- The streets and corridors are grungier, made of rough pieces and materials rather than marble and steel, and they descend into caverns and tunnels made from old catacombs. The Cardium Clam, Mind Maze's Neighborhood Boss, resides in a brackish water den within.
- Following a trail of shimmering slime, the crawlers enter a chamber full of feasting Mind Horrors, limp crawlers dangling from their tentacles. Even just after eating, Mind Horrors are never full—and the crawlers look rather tasty.
- A glitch in the programming resulted in one room that cannot spawn Brindle Grubs. Corpses are piling up, and the only way out is through. Crawlers can gather Brindle Grubs and deliver them to the location or find another way to press through the slop. Observant crawlers can pick up a variety of loot, including Mana Potions, gold coins, and simple weapons.
- The Cardium Clam rules this quarter with a calcite fist, sending sorties of Mind Horrors to harvest knowledge from crawlers. Crawlers can follow Mind Horrors to the Boss's lair, deep in a cavern within the Mind Slurry, or they can acquire the information from a crawler saved in combat earlier.

NEIGHBORHOOD MOOD

Use these short descriptions within a scene or as their own scene to evoke the mood of the Mind Maze:

- *A chilling fog rolls over the city block, lingering with a cloying sweetness and causing a tingling numbness on any bare skin.*
Outcome: Clumsiness, slippery fingers, or sudden pins-and-needles sensations make combat, and any task requiring finesse, more difficult (akin to the Sore as Shit Debuff) for the next hour.
- *Voices whisper and mutter incoherently, bouncing off the walls. In the cacophony, each crawler is certain they can hear their own voice.*
Outcome: Crawlers might react with anger, fear, shock, or any other emotion at hearing their own voice amid the crowd, but if they chase the sound, they only become more lost (losing some hours).
- *The maze-like halls reach a series of staircases going up and down, seemingly endless in either direction.*
Outcome: Crawlers can choose to go up or down, or make the dangerous choice of going back the way they came, with all of the halls shifted.
- *Overstimulating bright lights and sharp sounds fill the room, adding to the already-present headache in every crawler's skull.*
Outcome: Crawlers can hurry out of the affected area or attempt to dim the lights and deafen the sounds.

QUARTER: NIGHTMARE CIRCUIT

A myriad of streets cut through the Nightmare Circuit like tracks for a marathon, with blockades and broken roads stopping the path at every turn. There are dozens of ways into the Nightmare Circuit, but only one way out. The Nightmare Circuit is designed to burn crawlers out and run them down, literally, via a series of chases and encounters with creatures that can sap their strength.

- Tired crawlers who make the mistake of resting in the Nightmare Circuit wake to the agony of Dream Eaters probing and chewing on their minds... if they wake at all. The farther the crawlers go, the heavier their limbs feel, and the more their eyes begin to drift closed. Shadows dance across their vision, lingering in the corners of their periphery. As they grow more and more tired, those shadows multiply and begin to take concrete shapes—an ambush of Dream Eaters!

- Speed is key when you're running the Nightmare Circuit—the longer you linger, the more difficult it becomes to physically stay awake. Crawlers who work quickly and use feats of physical derring-do or mental sharpness to progress gain resistance to the aura of sleepiness.
- Every race needs a runway—that's an earthling saying, right? Euphemia Starr, the heiress to an intergalactic fashion empire, sponsored a shop featuring exquisite garments here on the Second Floor. If the crawlers catch the attention of the NPC clerk working Euphemia's store via feats of courage, the clerk invites them to peruse the shop and choose their team colors. An AI persona modeled after the real Euphemia offers fashion guidance and support. If any crawler takes her fashion recommendations, which by Earth standards are suspect at best, she offers to show them the world through her eyes—by giving them a pair of rose-tinted glasses that cut through Thought Fog.

NPCs

The crawlers may find some unconventional allies in the Mind Maze.

JAKAL THE VULTURE

Jakal is a scavenger added purely as a distraction and a foil for the crawlers. For the duration of whatever floor she appears on, she gathers loot, information, and other valuables solely in an attempt to prevent crawlers from getting it. It's not because of any nefarious intent—she's just an avid collector. That also means she's willing to make a deal on anything brought to her—the gnarlier the better.

Jakal the Vulture

Level 8.

Race: Skyfowl.

Class: Storm Commander.

Careful you're not wearing anything too shiny—I hear Jakal's got sticky fingers... or feathers, in this case. But none of you look like you're about to drop dead, so maybe you're safe to ask what she's got on offer. Maybe you can make a trade that benefits you both. You probably don't need your grandpa's one-of-a-kind heirloom watch anymore, do you?

CRAWLER #7,402,883 "KAMONRAT N."

Kamonrat N. is helpful and sweet, a former teacher who was gardening when the collapse happened.

Unfortunately, he's been trapped in the Mind Maze just a little too long, and the effects are starting to show. If the crawlers interact with him multiple times, they notice his mental state deteriorating as he loses more and more of himself.

Crawler #17,492,883. "Kamonrat N."

Level 11.

Race: Human.

Class: Not yet assigned.

Kinda sad, huh? He's helping you, but you know he's not gonna make it. But hey, at least his life is worth something. He gets to teach a class one last time — you lucky kids...

B-B-B- BOSS BATTLE!

A glimmering cavern studded with mother-of-pearl puts the Cardium Clam centerstage, surrounded by groups of Mind Horrors. The chamber is lined with excreted slime from floor to ceiling, with more dripping down stalactites to pool on the ground. The Cardium Clam can target these stalactites with its projectile pearls, knocking them down in an area-of-effect attack. One such stalactite falls behind the crawlers as they barrel into the room, blocking their exit.

As the rocks settle, an insidious voice hisses into the room, announcing the Boss Battle. When announced, each crawler sees their own reflection in the mother-of-pearl before a beam of light reflects the image of the Cardium Clam on all of the panels. The lips of the Boss's shell part, and the Cardium Clam fires another pearl with menacing glee.

The Cardium Clam is an enormous iridescent clam that resembles the heart of a Blue Whale. This bivalve can shoot massive pearls the size of a Persian cat faster than the speed of sound. Though it has no eyes to see, its single foot senses the weakness of crawlers through the vibrations of the chamber, using that data to aim its pearls. The loyal Mind Horrors that surround it attack approaching crawlers until they are defeated.

The Cardium Clam, Immaculate Bivalve

Level 9 Neighborhood Boss.

Sometimes our most beautiful enemies hit the hardest.

Washed from the depths of oceans unplumbed by civilization, the Cardium Clam loathes all creatures with intelligence higher than its own. It's here to prove that the world should never rely on brains over beauty and that all that glitters is gorgeous. Talk about toxic standards!

Oops—looks like it might be your time to sleep with the fishes. Get moving, or one of the clam's pearls might reduce you to chum!

Cardium Clam

Neighborhood Boss; Huge (6), Monstrous

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
8%	16%	25%	33%	41%	50%	58%	66%	75%	83%	91%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
9	15+F	12+F	0+S	4
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
11 (+4)	20 (+5)	6 (+3)	5 (+2)	10 (+4)

Hypersonic Pearl: 15+F to hit, 2d10+5 Bludgeoning, 200ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler is pushed 15ft.

Explosive Pearl: 15+F to hit, 2d8+5 Bludgeoning, 90ft range, 10ft Blast + 5ft Splash (see Probing Foot below)

Foot Probe: 13+F to hit, 1d10+4 Bludgeoning, 10ft range, (see Probing Foot below)

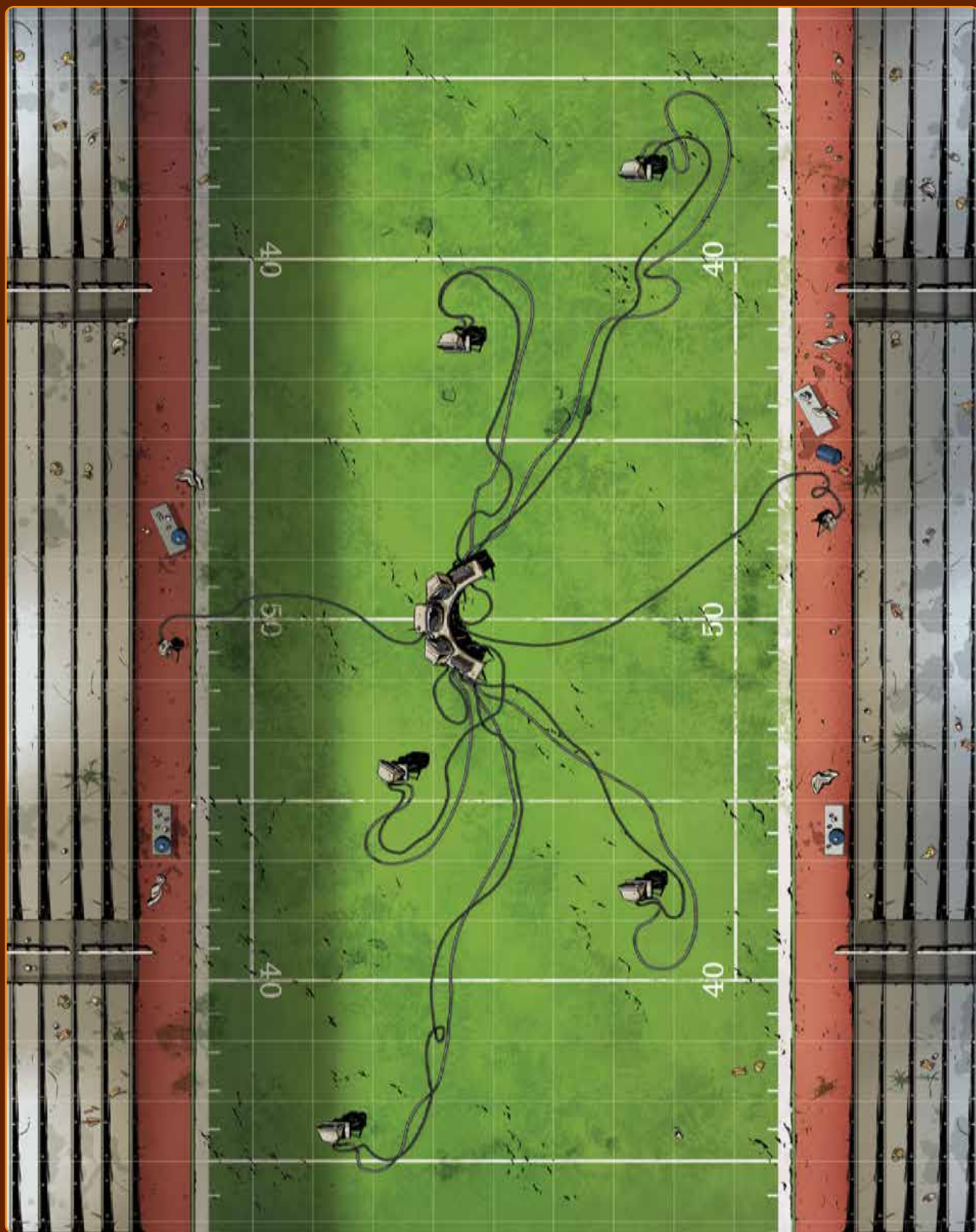
Heartbeat Thump: 13+F to hit, 1d6+4 Bludgeoning, 30ft Burst radius

Pearl Grapeshot: 15+F to hit, 1d8+5 Bludgeoning, 90ft Cone (see Probing Foot below)

Notes: *Exposed Foot*—The Cardium Clam's foot extends out of its shell and becomes targetable (with a –3 penalty) during rounds in which the clam Steps or Foot Probes. It has a DR of 0 instead of 4.

Probing Foot—When Foot Probe is used during a round of combat, Explosive Pearl and Pearl Grapeshot can also be used that same round, requiring Actions as usual.







QUEST: PASSIVE (AGGRESSIVE) PERCEPTION

FLOOR(S): 2 (TUTORIAL)

THEME: STOP A PEEPING TOM'S CAMERA CULT

"Don't even think about ding-dong ditching in this neck of the woods, unless you want to ding-dong die!"

—Game Guide Werthersby

A hotshot auteur among the dungeon showrunners had voyeurism on the brain when they came up with this quest. Intrigued by the notion of 24/7 surveillance and the relationship between observer and subject, and admittedly on a bit of a gritty true crime kick, they pitched this storyline to Borant.

It turns out humans have a fascinating habit of trading privacy and freedom for "security," something the showrunner was more than happy to incorporate into the plotline. Though the specifics are unknown to the crawlers, a mysterious figure known only as Stiggy seized control of this area in a horrific surveillance-state union of Big Brother and a Peeping Tom. No one has ever seen Stiggy in person, and if he has his way, no one ever will.

Stiggy discovered the ability to create enchanted cameras using the eyeballs of Mobs, and then he set them loose on the dungeon. Despite being shrouded in secrecy, he quickly rallied a group of loyal Bugaboos (who are always excited for the opportunity to increase their creeper skills), and they launched a campaign of terror across a portion of the Second Floor. It's up to the crawlers to track Stiggy down and bring an end to his operation... or find some way to profit from it.

STRONG STARTS

- The crawlers stumble across a Goblin-napping in progress. A group of Bugaboos just ambushed a squad of Goblins and is making off with their captives, a pair of Goblins named Spit and Spat, who call out to the crawlers for help. Upon their rescue, Spit and Spat tell the characters about a spree of Goblin abductions and point out one of the nearby Scrye Cameras.
- The crawlers find one of the gross Scrye Cameras on a door facing their current saferoom entrance. The next time they come out of the saferoom,

they're attacked by a group of Bugaboos with written instructions from Stiggy telling them to collect some crawler eyes.

QUEST DESCRIPTION

Quests aren't typically available on the Tutorial Floors, but the System AI does need to test the quest system occasionally. You can run this quest as a test of that system, or just allow the PCs' Game Guide to tell them about the quest and use the following achievement after the fact.

New Achievement! Passive (Aggressive) Perception.

I always feel like somebody's watching me. Whether or not that's true, someone *is* always watching *you*. Lots of someones.

You probably think I'm talking about the endless throngs of people watching your feeds from across the galaxy, but in this case, I'm talking about someone else—someone lurking in the dungeon alongside you, passing along your dirty little secrets to anyone willing to pay. The way they're doing it is pretty gnarly, too, even by my standards. You should find them and give them a taste of their own medicine.

Those Goblins know more about the situation, but first someone's gonna have to rescue them from those big bad Bugaboos with their nasty nets...

Reward: Upon completion, you'll receive a Silver Quest Box.

ALTERATIONS

If your group isn't comfortable with eyeball-based trauma, it's easy enough to switch the Scrye Cameras and Drones out for an audio-based device using ears or make the doorbell cameras heads glued to the wall instead. You can also swap the Goblins or Bugaboos for any other humanoid Mob you wish.

MOBS

The Mobs in *Passive (Aggressive) Perception* are the enforcers and byproducts of Stiggy's organ-harvesting operation. There are also some blind Goblins, but they're intended as allies of the characters. That being said, we never discourage crawlers from getting out there to kill, kill, kill!

BUGABOO GOBLIN-NAPPER

The lowest-ranking members of Stiggy's operation, Bugaboo Goblin-Nappers work in pairs, roaming the dungeon looking for Goblins to steal. They carry oversized nets, man-catchers, and large cudgels, which they use to entangle and stun their prey before hauling them away to the harvesting pens.

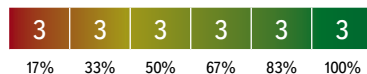
True to their nature, Bugaboos avoid fair fights. They stalk targets for hours before striking, and they do so only when with overwhelming advantage, either through surprise, numbers, sheer size, or all those combined. Against crawlers, they prefer to observe rather than engage, marking routes and retreating to call in reinforcements. If a fight turns against them, they scatter and vanish, leaving behind torn nets, Goblin blood, and the unsettling feeling that you're still being watched.

Bugaboo Goblin-Napper, Level 6

Oh, look. Bugaboo Goblin-Nappers! Their job is simple: find Goblins and bring them back for "processing." They don't start fights—at least not *fair* fights. No, these guys are more likely to jump you when your pants are down and your friends aren't there. Oh, and try not to make eye contact. They take that as encouragement.

Bugaboo Goblin-Napper

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
6	12+F	13+F	30+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	3 (+2)	7 (+3)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Cudgel: 13+F to hit: 2d6+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Net: 14+F to hit: 1d8+3 Bludgeoning, 20ft range, 10ft Blast radius

Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff until the end of the round.

Notes: *Cautious*—They travel in pairs and will not move to engage crawlers. If Surprised in combat or when one of their numbers have been killed, they retreat until they can find reinforcements.

BUGABOO SOCKET-PICKER

Bugaboo Socket-Pickers are the harvesting specialists of Stiggy's operation, tasked with extracting Goblin eyes and preparing them for use in Scrye Cameras and Drones. Where Goblin-Nappers rely on nets and brute force, Socket-Pickers carry hooked knives, bone scoops, and

padded jars meant to keep their specimens intact. They are rarely encountered alone, preferring to work behind a screen of their Bugaboo Goblin-Napper brethren.

Socket-Pickers avoid direct combat whenever possible, letting other Bugaboos restrain their subjects before stepping in to do their business. They're always the first to flee a fight that's turned against them, abandoning equipment, allies, and victims alike.

Bugaboo Socket-Picker, Level 5

The willing pupils of whoever started this ocular harvest, these Bugaboos have steady hands and empty jars. While their friends handle the grabbing and dragging, these specialists harvest the parts that power the cameras. Don't blink or you'll mess up their work.

Bugaboo Socket-Picker

Mob; Medium (3), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	11+F	13+F	30+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Hook-Knife: 13+F to hit, 2d4+3 Slashing, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains a Major Injury Debuff (a dangling eye!).

Bone Scoop: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

SCREYE DRONE

Scrye Drones are the next step in Stiggy's camera "technology." Cobbled together from Goblin eyes and scrap material, these mobile surveillance units drift through corridors and chambers in slow, wobbling patterns, guided by faint magical impulses from Stiggy's control network. Each drone contains several blinking eyes that rotate independently, allowing it to track multiple targets at once.

Scrye Drones are not designed for combat. Instead, they emit high-pitched chimes when they detect danger, summoning nearby Bugaboo teams to intervene. Stiggy can speak through the drones, and he occasionally uses them to issue orders, threaten intruders, or bargain with Mobs and crawlers alike.

When threatened, a drone attempts to retreat, shedding viscous fluid and loose eyeballs as a slippery deterrent to pursuers. Destroyed drones rupture in a



spray of cloudy liquid and rolling eyeballs that continue twitching for several seconds after impact.

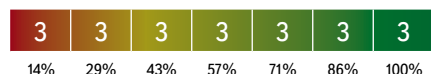
Screye Drone, Level 7

A terrifying blend of optometry and artisanal crafts, these guys are awfully nosy for something made out of eyeballs and pipe cleaners. Screye Drones are the evolved form of the doorbell cameras you see all over the place. They spy on you, scream for help, and carry messages from their overlord. Careful not to slip on the jelly.

SCREYE DRONE

Screye Drone

Mob; Small (2), Organic Machinery



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
7	16+F	13+F	10+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	6 (+3)	6 (+3)	6 (+3)	2 (+1)

Weeping Eye Discharge: 13+F to hit: No damage, 25ft range
Any hit crawler gains the Take Down and Fatigued Debuffs.

Notes: *Alarm*—When threatened, emits high-pitched chimes which summon nearby Bugaboos.

The Eyes Have It—As the Drone is covered with eyes, it is hard to Surprise.

Hover—Screye Drone moves through the air as if on ground. Does not fight, but will slowly float away, shedding viscous fluids and eyeballs (the Discharge) to deter pursuers.

BLIND GOBLIN SURVIVOR

Former captives of Stiggy's operation were released alive from the harvesting pens. Their empty eye sockets are usually wrapped in dirty bandages or smeared with resin to slow the bleeding. Many navigate by sound and smell alone, tapping walls with scavenged sticks or muttering to themselves to stay oriented.

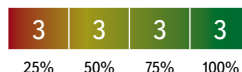
Some become surprisingly adept at dungeon survival, memorizing the corridors and warning others of danger through whistles and knocks. A few of them have banded together to form a small colony of survivors searching for someone to help them avenge themselves upon the Bugaboos.

Blind Goblin Survivor, Level 4

These unlucky bastards are proof that the harvesting process is technically non-lethal. Well, at least not directly. Being a blind Mob in this dungeon is just asking to be fodder for crawlers keen on grinding to level up. But they've adapted, so you don't have to feel sorry for them or anything.

Blind Goblin Survivor

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	12+F	12+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	2 (+1)

Blind Fighting: 12+F to hit, 1d8+2 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
As they never look at their target when attacking, their attacks cannot be redirected (no Taunt, Catcher, or similar Skills).

Notes: *Motion Detection*—If a crawler makes a Surprise Attack against a Blind Goblin Survivor, it immediately strikes back at no Action cost, and if the crawler Evades the strike back, they do so with Disadvantage.

Blind—No penalties for fighting in darkness, fog, etc.

NPCS

The notable NPCs in the Passive (Aggressive) Perception are the leaders of the two Mob factions at play: the Bugaboos and the Goblin Survivors.

MELON BALLER MARVIN, HEAD OF THE SOCKET-PICKERS

Stiggy's first and most devoted ally, Marvin, was an unremarkable Bugaboo when they met: reclusive, cowardly, and obsessed with watching from a safe distance. He fled at the first sign of attention, content to lurk and observe without ever being noticed. That all changed when Stiggy showed him the feed from the first Screye Camera. For the first time, Marvin could watch without hiding. He could see without being seen.

Building more cameras required more eyes, and Marvin eagerly volunteered for the task. He recruited other Bugaboos, taught them the techniques Stiggy devised, and transformed their passive stalking habits into the organized harvesting operation it became.

Now the head of the Socket-Pickers, Marvin is the most productive and vicious member of the operation. He enforces Stiggy's rules, oversees the harvesting pens, and takes great pride in his work. Where other Bugaboos flinch at open conflict, Marvin learned to enjoy it. He is cruel, methodical, and loyal to Stiggy not out of fear but gratitude.

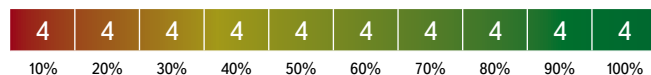
Melon Baller Marvin—Bugaboo Head Socket-Picker, Level 11

Melon Baller Marvin is the worst kind of monster: middle management. The first Bugaboo taken under the wing of our mysterious villain, Marvin, took a ragtag group of pervy loners and turned them into an organized band of organ-harvesting menaces. He perfected the backhanded eye removal with one quick flash of his melon baller, although I'm fairly certain the popping noise that accompanies the procedure comes from his mouth and not the socket.

He supervises the harvest, enforces quotas, and guarantees quality control. Unlike his subordinates, Marvin doesn't run when things get dangerous. Don't back him into a cornea.

Melon-Baller Marvin, Head Bugaboo Socket-Picker

Mob; Medium (4), Unique Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
11	13+F	14+F	30+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
10 (+4)	6 (+3)	10 (+4)	10 (+4)	2 (+1)

Melon-Baller: 14+F to hit, 3d4+3 Slashing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains a Major Injury Debuff (a dangling eye!).

Bone Scoop: 13+F to hit, 3d6+3 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

SPIT AND SPAT

Spit and Spat are two of the only unmutated Goblins in this section of the dungeon. Their near-capture by Bugaboo Goblin-Nappers is what draws the crawlers into the events of Passive (Aggressive) Perception.

The brothers are nearly identical in appearance but differ sharply in speech: Spit speaks only in the present tense, while Spat speaks only in the past tense. Together, they argue constantly about what is happening versus what has already gone wrong.

Before the harvesting began, they would have been unremarkable, if quirky, Goblin Mobs.

Now Spit and Spat serve as scouts and messengers for the survivor camp, mapping Bugaboo patrol routes and guiding others away from invasive Scree Cameras. Their goals are simple: protect what remains of their people and take revenge on Stiggy for what he did to them.

Spit, Goblin Survivor Who Lives in the Now, Level 6

Spit is a lovable little Goblin who just narrowly avoided having his eyes plucked out of his head thanks to your brave efforts. He and his twin brother, Spat, make quite the pair, with Spit being the more level-headed and optimistic of the two.

He might offer you some braindead quest to stop the antics of a local villain. If you're lucky, he might even give you a plan for how to do that—at least, whatever passes for *planning* among Goblins. Weirdly, he only speaks in the present tense... probably got dropped on his head as a baby or something.

Spit—Goblin Survivor Who Lives in the Now

Mob; Petite (3), Unique Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
6	12+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	4 (+2)	6 (+3)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Rock: 13+F to hit, 2d6+3 Bludgeoning, 30ft range

Spear: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Piercing, 5ft range

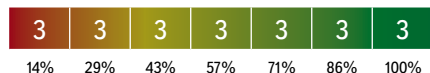
Spat, Goblin Who Just Can't Seem to Let Go of the Past, Level 7

Spat was a cheerful Goblin scout who took glee in doing the things Goblin Mobs do in the dungeon. He used to pillage, terrorize crawlers, raid, and do all the gobliny sorts of things he was supposed to. That all changed when the Bugaboos descended on his camp to harvest his family's eyes.

Yeah... it was pretty fucked up. Basically, he's the vengeful one who only speaks about what *has* happened, not what *is* happening. I wonder if these two have another brother who speaks about what *will* happen?

Spat—Goblin Who Just Can't Seem to Let Go of the Past

Mob; Petite (3), Unique Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
7	12+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
10 (+4)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Rock: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Bludgeoning, 30ft range

Spear: 14+F to hit, 2d8+4 Piercing, 5ft range

QUEST ITEMS

To complete Passive (Aggressive) Perception, the crawlers must acquire two key items. This quest works best if they happen to recover the first item in Stage 1, then deliberately scheme to find the second during their grinding.

- **Screye Camera Monitor Slab:** Each Bugaboo raiding party carries a rune-etched stone slab that displays live feeds from nearby Screye Cameras. Each slab is keyed to a specific area and relays footage back to Stiggy's central hub. On their own, the slabs only show limited angles and recent recordings.
- **Bugaboo Socket-Picker's Eye (Removal Optional):** Ironically, the monitor slabs include a locked administrative mode accessible only with a retina scan from a Bugaboo Socket-Picker. Socket-Pickers assign patrol routes and control access to the local camera network. When paired with the slab, their eye unlocks full system access, revealing patrol schedules and a hidden map pointing toward Stiggy's security hub.

TRAPS

The Bugaboos are crafty ambush predators who rely on cheap tricks and traps to level the playing field against crawlers.

- **Disorienting Traps:** The Bugaboos prefer traps that confuse and stun their targets, including flash powder that explodes with a crash of thunder, strobing lights that beset crawlers with vertigo, or purposely setting off a Screye Drone's high-pitched alarm to prevent crawlers from communicating verbally.
- **Capture Traps:** Ultimately, the Bugaboos attack with the intention of taking prisoners. They dig pits, employ cages, set up clever snares, and do whatever

else they can to immobilize targets before the fight even begins.

- **Ocular Traps:** Bugaboo Socket-Pickers are not above booby-trapping keyholes and other small openings crawlers might look through with grabbing claws seeking to pluck the eyes out of looky-loos. These are often placed near fake "control panels" or locked Screye Camera housings.

ACHIEVEMENTS AND REWARDS

Crawlers might earn the following achievements on the Passive (Aggressive) Perception quest.

- **Where'd Ya Get Those Peepers?:** "You've made it so a Bugaboo Socket-Picker can only wink from now on. How will anyone know if he's serious or not?
Reward: You've received a Bronze Apparel Box."
Contents: An eyepatch, glasses, contact lenses, or another eye-themed apparel item.
- **Ding-Dong Ditch:** "You've stood up to Big Brother and maimed one of his many surveillance devices. Resistance is adorable!
Reward: You've received a Silver Anarchist Box."
Contents: A stylish hat (Head) with a random benefit.
- **You'll Shoot Your Eye Out!:** "You've put a stop to Stiggy's reign of technological terror. Now the only people watching you are countless quadrillions of people enjoying your plight from the comfort of their own homes.
Reward: You've received a Silver Quest Box."
Contents: An official Enchanted Crimson Crawler crossbow with one random benefit.



GRINDING FOR EXPERIENCE

While undertaking the Passive (Aggressive) Perception Quest, the crawlers might decide to grind some of their Mobs over and over. Roll 1d20.

TABLE 18: PASSIVE (AGGRESSIVE) PERCEPTION GRINDING COMPLICATIONS

ROLL OR CHOOSE	COMPLICATION
1	A Screye Drone is lodged in a ceiling vent and spins slowly in place, broadcasting distorted images of the crawlers to nearby corridors while chiming for help every few seconds.
2	A group of Blind Goblin Survivors set up a crude listening post to track Screye Drones by sound alone. They panic when the crawlers arrive, thinking the footsteps belong to Bugaboos.
3	The crawlers find a corridor where every door bears a Screye Camera, but someone took the time to pull them off the door and face them toward the ceiling. It's only a matter of time before someone comes to fix them. Is the perpetrator an ally or some other dungeon threat looking for trouble?
4	A narrow bridge crosses a deep pit filled with discarded jars and cracked mirrors. Every step causes the glass below to shift and clink. Is this an ambush zone or merely a hazardous dumping ground?
5	The crawlers approach a group of Bugaboo Goblin-Nappers from behind while they're waiting to ambush someone in the tunnel ahead of them.
6	A Bugaboo Goblin-Napper runs past, desperately trying to herd a flock of Screye Drones that are convinced an invisible crawler or Goblin fled down the hall.
7+	See Table 2: Tutorial Floor Grinding Complications (p. 13).

STAGE 1: GOBLIN-NAPPED!

The crawlers are doing their best to survive the second level of the dungeon when they stumble upon a corridor with a Screye Drone and a Bugaboo patrol attacking Spit and Spat, who cry for help. It's possible this is the first time the group has seen Mob-on-Mob violence, but the AI is quick to assign them the Quest, so they know something unique is happening.

If the crawlers rescue Spit and Spat, the Goblin brothers offer to take the crawlers somewhere discreet to avoid the watching eyes of the Screye Cameras. They also find a Screye Camera Monitor Slab in the loot of the Bugaboo Goblin-Nappers. Spit and Spat lead them to the Blind Goblin Survivor camp, tell them about the Bugaboo harvest, and officially ask the crawlers to help put a stop to the raids.

It's possible the crawlers fail to rescue Spit and Spat before they're dragged off by the Bugaboos. In the event of such a failure, the quest is not over; the characters' legwork remains ahead. They must track the Bugaboo party and stage a rescue of Spit and Spat.

If they're not interested in chasing the Bugaboos, that's bad news for Spit and Spat, but the crawlers will still be drawn into the story by virtue of the intense

surveillance in this portion of the dungeon. Screye Drones harass them as they try to accomplish their other goals, and Stiggy monitors their movements, repeatedly sending Bugaboos to capture or drive them off.

This first encounter is almost certainly a combat encounter—a Capture the Flag-like game, with Spit and Spat as the flag. That should signal the crawlers that these Goblins are not a threat. Their dots on the minimap are white.

Spit has a plan to track down Stiggy's lair and explains the nature of the Screye Camera Monitor Slab to the crawlers. He says the slabs have an administrative mode unlockable by scanning a Bugaboo Socket-Picker's eye. They just have to find a Socket-Picker, likely at one of the Bugaboo harvesting pens.

Spat is more interested in vengeance, offering to guide the crawlers to locations he knows are fraught with Bugaboo patrols, hoping to kill as many as possible to draw a Socket-Picker out, preferably Melon-Baller Marvin himself. If the crawlers aren't fans of either of these plans, they're welcome to come up with something on their own.



QUEST EVENTS

Use one or more of the following statements to evoke the mood of the quest or improvise an additional encounter:

- *A Blind Goblin Survivor taps along the corridor with a stick, whispering warnings about “the watching halls” and pointing toward a doorbell with a slowly blinking eye.*
Outcome: The Goblin passes without harm if left alone.
- *A distant voice echoes from a Screye Drone somewhere ahead, with Stiggy calmly narrating patrol routes to an enthralled group of Bugaboos.*
Outcome: The party may learn how to avoid patrols or get caught by them.
- *The crawlers glimpse Melon-Baller Marvin kneeling beside a group of bound Goblins, carefully labeling jars “right” and “left” in preparation for his dark harvest.*
Outcome: The Goblins lose their eyes to Marvin unless the crawlers intervene.
- *A Screye Camera crackles to life on a nearby door, and Stiggy’s voice emerges from it as he politely asks the crawlers if they’d like to negotiate.*
Outcome: The party may speak with Stiggy or anger him by ignoring him.

STAGE 2: I NEED AN EYEBALL...

The crawlers manage to track down a Bugaboo Socket-Picker, either by finding one of their harvest pens or by causing enough havoc in Stiggy’s corner of the dungeon that he sets one loose on the group. Locating a harvest pen is a difficult task; the crawlers either need to scout the area thoroughly, capture and break a Bugaboo Goblin-Napper, rely on a Blind Goblin Survivor to guide them, or devise another creative plan.

Forcing a conflict is more direct, but not necessarily easier. Disrupting a large number of cameras and/or Bugaboo patrols is enough to bring Melon Baller Marvin out to play, which can be dangerous for underleveled and underprepared crawlers.

However, if they decide to proceed, the party must contend with Stiggy’s near-constant monitoring. Screye Drones lurk throughout this corner of the dungeon, with more going up every day. Without some clever means of distraction or obfuscation, Stiggy can track their movements and knows of attacks in advance. The corridors are also littered with traps and chokepoints for where Bugaboos launch counterattacks against the crawlers (see *Traps*, above).

Once the group locates a harvest pen, they may attack the area. They don’t need to destroy the entire facility or kill all of the Bugaboos; they just need to take an eye from one of the Socket-Pickers in the area.

Stiggy maintains five harvest pens across the floor, each garrisoned by a large number of Bugaboo Goblin-Nappers and a few Bugaboo Socket-Pickers. Melon Baller Marvin should play a role at this stage,

either leading a counterattack against Spat and the disruptive crawlers or defending whichever harvest pen they choose to attack. As mentioned above, he is a fanatic about the cause and will not back down from any fight threatening Stiggy.

One final wrinkle to the harvest pen attack is the presence of imprisoned Goblins. The crawlers might not care about sparing their lives or rescuing them, but Spit and Spat definitely will. Any plan that overtly threatens the lives of their kin results in Spit and Spat reconsidering their alliance with the crawlers, possibly leading to a Goblin backstab or some other kind of sabotage in the name of rescuing the other Goblins. Good-natured crawlers must find some way to protect the Goblins during the attack and help them escape to the encampment.

STAGE 3: WHY CAN’T WE BE FRIENDS?

After successfully recovering a Bugaboo Socket-Picker’s eye (or, as an alternative for squeamish players, forcing the Mob to scan their retina), one of the Screye Drones approaches an isolated member of the party. They do so outside the Goblin encampment, near one of the many restrooms littering the Second Floor, after emerging from a saferoom, or anywhere convenient for the story.

Stiggy addresses them through the speaker and asks whether they can negotiate a truce. He claims he isn’t interested in crawler eyes for his inventions and just wants free rein to gather Goblin eyes and information in peace. Stiggy shares the location of a neutral ground for the meeting. Whether or not Stiggy is *actually*

interested in crawler eyes is left up to the GM, but for the sake of this discussion, he's at least willing to lie about it.

It takes some time to determine the location of Stiggy's security hub on the Screye Camera Monitor Slab, so the crawlers have ample opportunity to meet with Stiggy if they so wish. The neutral zone is an intersection in the dungeon corridors with a quartet of Screye Cameras keeping an eye on all four directions.

Stiggy's terms are simple: leave the area and let him continue his operation. In exchange, Stiggy offers a key piece of information to the crawlers. This can be the location of one of the stairwells to the next level of the dungeon, intel on a rival group of crawlers, or the whereabouts of a missing loved one somewhere else in the dungeon. Tailor it to your group's personal goals and needs. Make the offer enticing enough that one crawler seriously considers abandoning the quest and their morals.

If the crawlers are particularly immoral or chaotic, Stiggy offers them a position within his operation. He gives them even bigger rewards if they wipe out the Blind Goblin Survivor encampment and bring him the eyes of Spit and Spat. This is another way to complete the quest, gaining a level as usual and earning the originally promised Silver Quest Box.

STAGE 4: OPENING THE IRIS

With their newly retrieved eyeball and slab, the crawlers finally have the tools needed to pierce Stiggy's surveillance network, but activating the slab's administrative mode is not as simple as pointing the eye at the stone. The slab displays a cascade of fractured images: corridors from impossible angles, rooms that do not match their surroundings, and overlapping camera feeds that flicker in and out of focus. The dungeon's geometry and Stiggy's magic do not agree on where anything truly is.

To decode this data, the crawlers must stabilize the feed. They can accomplish this by isolating the slab from active Screye Cameras, destroying nearby Screye Drones, or retreating to a blind spot in the network identified by the Goblin survivors. Once shielded from interference, the slab begins sorting its images into a more coherent pattern.

The slab does not provide a direct map. Instead, it reveals negative space—a central region where the camera lines converge. Spit recognizes this, insisting that “no one watches there because something

hides there.” Spat argues that “no one watched there because something already happened there.”

As the slab completes its decryption, a crude schematic forms, showing a distorted spiral of corridors converging on a single chamber labeled as “Primary Hub—Do Not Record.” At the same time, the slab begins to pulse and hum. Stiggy's network notices the intrusion. The crawlers now know where Stiggy is, but they must decide if they would rather launch a fast assault before he can muster his defenses or use the schematic to find a quieter way in.

B-B-B- BOSS BATTLE!

Stiggy's security hub is rectangular chamber reconstituted from a high school football stadium. The walls and bleachers are studded with hundreds of Screye Cameras and monitors at different heights, all aimed inward. Cables snake across the ground from a central computer terminal, and a few monitors show feeds from here and elsewhere in the Neighborhood.

The last of Stiggy's Bugaboos guard the chamber. A Weak group of Screye Drones hover near the ceiling, projecting distorted images of the crawlers onto the wall monitors. Stiggy descends from an aperture at the top, suspended by a mechanical arm feeding mechanical parts into his fleshy body. To everyone's surprise, he is also a Goblin, albeit a twisted cyborg version of one. A high-tech visor covers his eyes, and circuits branch from it out across his face.

If Spit and Spat are still alive and accompanying the crawlers, they recognize Stiggy and remark “He's supposed to be dead!” but won't provide further context.

As Stiggy reaches the hub's core, the AI announces the Boss Battle in a mockingly calm tone. A grid of camera feeds overlay the chamber, framing the crawlers inside blinking eye-shaped screens. Meanwhile, Stiggy appears projected across multiple monitors at once, his face fragmented and out of sync.

Stiggy does not fight directly. Instead, he uses the chamber itself as a weapon. Cameras flare with blinding light. Trapdoors open, and floor sections rotate. Screye Drones run interference, spraying their viscous fluids at crawlers' feet or throwing themselves in front of large attacks meant for their master.

Spit and Spat help the crawlers as best they can, but the showrunners view this battle as a perfect

opportunity for one of the brothers to make a heroic sacrifice. The sole Bugaboo Socket-Picker in the chamber focuses on Spit and Spat, killing one of them if a crawler does nothing to save them.

The secret to defeating Stiggy is depriving him of his control. Note that crawlers can also defeat him with overwhelming force and violence against the heavily armored mechanical arm suspending him, but it's a long and dangerous method.

Using the unlocked Screye Camera Monitor Slab, the crawlers can overload sections of the network, shutting off cameras and freezing out his remote control over the chamber. When enough cameras go blind, Stiggy loses control, and the mechanical arm holding him aloft malfunctions horribly, smashing his fragile Goblin body into the monitors and cameras mounted across the room.

With the network broken, the chamber falls silent. The cameras go dark, and the remaining Screye Drones crash to the floor. Any surviving Bugaboos flee upon seeing their leader dead. Stiggy's body sputters and sparks until his visor detonates, carving a black crater across his eye sockets. The crawlers complete the quest.

Stiggy—Dungeon Surveillance Architect

Level 14 Borough Boss!

Stiggy is what happens when a Peeping Tom gets access to Big Brother techno-sorcery and an unlimited supply of potential muses. Once upon a time, this feisty Goblin installed simple cameras throughout the dungeon to keep his people safe—and maybe catch a glimpse of the Goblin Chieftain's wives in their undies. But when a certain Dungeon Admin discovered this unique skill, they saw an opportunity to exploit it, and exploit it they did.

Now Stiggy installs eyes in walls to hoard information and peek at *your* naughty bits. (Progress isn't linear, folks.) He doesn't stalk prey the old-fashioned way. He watches. He catalogs. He reviews. Every ambush, every betrayal, every time you scratch yourself when you think no one's looking? He files it all away under *behavioral data*.

Stiggy doesn't believe he's cruel. He believes his job is noble. Crawlers need supervision, and if a few eyes fall out along the way, well... that's just the price of security. He won't charge you head-on. Instead, he'll blind you with lights, broadcast your movements, and let his Bugaboos do the smashing.

Smile for the camera, crawlers. Stiggy has his eye on you.

Stiggy, Dungeon Surveillance Architect

Borough Boss; Petite (3), Cybernetic Humanoid

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
6%	12%	18%	24%	29%	35%	41%	47%	53%	59%
Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR					
14	22+F	14+F	10+S	3					
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA					
7 (+3)	50 (+6)	7 (+3)	10 (+4)	7 (+3)					

Probe: 13+F, 3d6+6 Psychic, 10ft range

Crawlers make a free CHA Stat Check to avoid this attack (no Evade possible) or they live out one of their Past Traumas, Loose Ends, or Regrets, interacting with entities from their past on the screens.

Camera Flash: 13+F to hit, 2d4+3 Electric, 30ft range
Crawlers roll with Disadvantage to Evade this attack, as there are cameras everywhere. Any hit crawler gains the Blinded Debuff: Roll with Disadvantage on all attacks until the crawler takes new damage.

Notes: *Hands Off*—Stiggy makes only one attack per round, as the rest of the time he is opening trapdoors and rotating sections of the floor. Once a Probe has been successful against a crawler, he does not Probe that crawler again. Once they have all been Probed, he only uses Camera Flash.

Trapdoors—The trapdoors are simple spike traps (1d6+F Piercing). There are so many and they are so well hidden, crawlers on the ground must make Dex Stat Checks to avoid them at the end of each round.

Rotating Floors—Each crawler gains the Fatigued Debuff at the end of each round unless they are not on the ground.

Hydraulic Arm—Stiggy is held aloft by a large and well-armored arm that moves him about the chamber so he can monitor everything. DR 5, with 8 HB slots filled with 3s. If it is destroyed, it flails about, smashing the helpless Goblin against the monitors, eventually killing him.

Electrified Arm—The arm has a powerful damage reflection buff at 1:1. For every HB slot the arm loses, the attacking crawler loses 1 HB slot.

Screens & Cameras Everywhere—As his chamber is covered with eyes and cameras, Stiggy is very hard to Surprise.

Guards—A new Screye Drone and Bugaboo show up each round of the combat, doing most of the fighting for Stiggy. If an attack against Stiggy would cause him to lose 4+ HB slots, a Screye Drone takes the hit instead.

THREAT APPENDIX

Sometimes you need to find a monster outside of a Neighborhood (like the Janitor Mobs). Some of you came here for Carl and Donut's story. Recreate some of their dramatic scenes or build your own with the creatures below.

RIVAL CRAWLERS

If you need a fully statted-out rival crawler, use or adapt one of these:

BRUISER CRAWLER

These schmucks just keep dying.

Bruiser

Crawler; Medium (4), Human



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	11+F	12+F	20+S	3
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	2 (+1)	6 (+3)	4 (+2)	3 (+2)

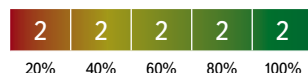
Pointy Stick: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Piercing, 5ft range

WISE-GUY CRAWLER

They think they're hot shit in a champagne glass.

Wise-Guy

Crawler; Medium (4), Human



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	13+F	11+F	20+S	3
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	6 (+3)	4 (+2)	2 (+1)	5 (+2)

Magic Missile Spell: 13+F to hit, 2d4+3 Force, Line of Sight range

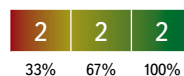
FIRST FLOOR MOBS

These mobs are found on the First Floor of the dungeon.

BAD LLAMA

Bad Llama

Mob; Large (5), Mutated



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Lava Spit: 13+F to hit, 1d8+3 Fire, 30ft range

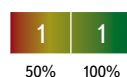
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the target gains the Burning Debuff.

Notes: *Bad Reflux*—Attacks can target the lava pouch in the Llama's throat during rounds when it uses Lava Spit, but this adds a +2 to the Llama's Evade. The pouch ruptures if such an attack deals damage, killing the Llama and setting its corpse aflame.

GOBLIN

Goblin

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	11+F	13+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	2 (+1)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Club: 11+F to hit, 1d6+1 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

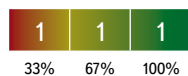
Notes: *Pineapple Club*—The Goblin starts with a pineapple attached to the end their club, which adds +1d4 damage, but it falls off if the attack deals 3 or more HB slots of damage to the crawler.

Spunk—The Goblin has an unusual, rage-filled drive to kill. Melee attacks can only remove 1 Health Bar slot from the Goblin per hit unless it's an Amazing Success or better. The Goblin attacks with a +1 bonus to damage when below full Health.



Goblin Engineer

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	12+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	1 (+1)

Sword: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Slashing, 5ft range

Metal Shard: 13+F to hit, 1d4+3 Piercing, 30ft range

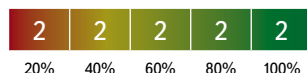
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Stiff Legs Debuff.

Notes: *Incel*—Goblin engineers prioritize attacking entities who appear female to them.

Pilot—Engineers can construct a single-seat Goblin vehicle out of scrap metal in an hour or something larger with additional time. The steam boiler of multi-passenger Goblin vehicles may overheat and explode during combat if the engineer leaves its relief valves unattended for more than 1 minute.

Goblin Bomb Bard

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	11+F	14+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
4 (+2)	2 (+1)	3 (+2)	10 (+4)	1 (+1)

Bomb: 14+F to hit, 2d8 Bludgeoning, 60ft range; 5ft Blast radius (see Unstable Bombs)

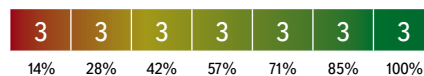
Dynamite: 14+F to hit, 1d6 Bludgeoning, 40ft range; 5ft Blast radius +5ft Splash

Notes: *Explosive Demise*—Goblin bomb bards explode when they die, dealing 2d8+F damage to adjacent entities.

Unstable Bombs—These bombs have a chance to explode early, which changes the space in which it explodes to one between the intended target and the bomb bard. When using Bomb, roll a d20 to determine how far the bomb travels before it explodes. 1: 0ft (explodes on Bomb Bard); 2–4: 10ft; 5–8: 20ft; 9–12: 30ft; 13–20: 60ft. Distances farther than the target space mean the bomb reaches the target space.

Goblin Shamanka

Mob; Petite (3), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
7	14+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
2 (+1)	10 (+4)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	5 (+2)

Agony Missile: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Psychic, 50ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains one of the following Debuffs: Blood Trail, Woozy, or Stunned.

Notes: *Revenge*—Goblin vehicles tend to explode when destroyed. Shamankas enchant their clan's vehicles to direct all damage from those explosions toward the entity responsible for the destruction, though the damage can be avoided by any normal means of avoiding an explosion.



RAT

Rat

Mob; Tiny (1), Beastly

1

100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
1	11+F	11+F	20+S	0
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)	2 (+1)	1 (+1)

Bite: 12+F to hit, 1d4+2 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poison Debuff.

Notes: *Janitor Mob*—This Mob is responsible for cleaning messes on floor 1 and prioritizes eating corpses. It attacks crawlers when provoked, or when no other food options are nearby.



ROT STICKERS AND SCATTERERS

Rot Sticker

Mob; Tiny (1), Beastly

1

100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
1	11+F	12+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
2 (+1)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Stick: 12+F to hit, No damage, 5ft range
On any Evade Fail, the Rot Sticker has attached itself to the crawler (see Overly-Attached below).

Explode: 13+F to hit, 1d6+1 Bludgeoning, 0ft range (see Overly Attached below)

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: *Overly-Attached*—Stick attaches a Rot Sticker to its target, causing it to share the target's space and move with it. A Rot Sticker can only Explode if attached, and uses an Attack Action to do so. Explode kills the Rot Sticker. When attacking an attached Rot Sticker, on Fail, the attacker takes the damage. On an Amazing Success or better, all attached Rot Stickers are removed and destroyed.

Sticky—Rot Stickers can stick to vertical surfaces and upside down on ceilings, but they can't move along them.

Scatterer

Mob; Small (2), Beastly

2

100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
1	11+F	11+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	1 (+1)	4 (+2)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)

Bite: 11+F to hit, 1d6+1 Piercing, 5ft range

Spit: 11+F to hit, 1d4+1 Poison, 30ft range

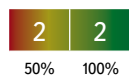
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Notes: *Wall Walker*—Scatterers can move along vertical surfaces and upside down on ceilings as though on the ground.



Hissing Scatterer

Mob; Small (2), Beastly



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	11+F	11+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
4 (+2)	1 (+1)	4 (+2)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)

Bite: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Piercing, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

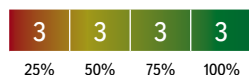
Leaping Kick: 11+F to hit, 1d6+2 Bludgeoning, 5ft range (see Leaper below)

Notes: *Leaper*—Hissing Scatterers can start a round up to 15ft away from their Leaping Kick target, jumping into range prior to the attack instead of using a Step.

Wall Walker—Scatterers can move along vertical surfaces and upside down on ceilings as though on the ground.

Scatterer Brood Guardian

Mob; Small (2), Beastly



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	11+F	12+F	30+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Bite: 13+F to hit, 1d8+3 Piercing, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Notes: *Guardian*—Brood guardians are so aggressive that their presence distracts foes. Other types of Scatterers adjacent to a brood guardian gain a non-stacking +3 bonus to their Evade.

Wall Walker—Scatterers can move along vertical surfaces and upside down on ceilings as though on the ground.

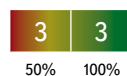
Riled Up—During the first round of combat, add their Stat Mod to the damage a second time.

SECOND FLOOR MOBS

BRINDLE GRUBS AND BRINDLED VESPAS

Brindle Grub

Mob; Small (2), Beastly



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	11+F	11+F	5+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
1 (+1)	1 (+1)	7 (+3)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)

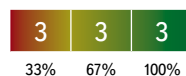
Chew: 11+F to hit, 1d4+1 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Notes: *Janitor Mob*—This Mob is responsible for cleaning messes on the Second Floor and prioritizes eating corpses. It targets crawlers when no other food options are nearby. The System AI spawns 1 to 15 Brindle Grubs each time an entity dies in the area, up to 5,000 active Brindle Grubs per quarter. When a Brindle Grub has eaten enough corpses, it levels up to become a Cow-Tailed Brindle Grub.

Overcrowding—Up to 5 Brindle Grubs can share a space. Entities can attempt to move through a space containing Brindle Grubs but must make a roll Dex Stat Check with a Difficulty of 4 × the number of Brindle Grubs in the space. On Fail, the entity steps on and kills one of the Brindle Grubs, triggering the System AI to spawn more Brindle Grubs to eat the corpse.

Cow-Tailed Brindle Grub

Mob; Petite (3), Beastly



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	11+F	10+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
4 (+2)	1 (+1)	7 (+3)	1 (+1)	1 (+1)

Sting: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Piercing, 5ft range

Notes: *Upgraded Janitor Mob*—This Mob is the leveled-up form of the Brindle Grub. It continues to prioritize eating corpses and upon eating enough to level up again, transforms into a pupa for 10 hours, then transforms again into a Brindled Vespa. As a pupa, it has the same Stats but can't attack and gains a +2 DR Buff from encasing itself in a cocoon. Killing it as a pupa prevents it from becoming a Brindled Vespa.

When a crawler rolls an Amazing Success or better with a melee weapon and kills a Cow-Tailed Brindle Grub, the crawler is covered in white goo. They suffer Disadvantage to Dexterity-based skills until cleaned off in a saferoom.

Brindled Vespa

Mob; Medium (4), Mutated

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
12%	25%	37%	50%	62%	75%	87%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
8	11+F	14+F	20+S	0
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	10 (+4)	11 (+4)	1 (+1)

Acid Goo: 11+F to hit, 2d6+1 Acid, 40ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Acid Goo Debuff: 1d6+F Acid at the end of each round until the combat ends.

Sting: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Piercing, 5ft range

Notes: *Flight*—Brindled vespas can move through the air as though on the ground and hover in place.

Fragile Wings—Brindled vespas have large wings that can be targeted by attacks (with a –2 penalty). If it loses 1 or more HB slots this way, remove their Acid Goo attack and Flight abilities.

KOBOLDS & DANGER DINGOS

Kobold

Mob; Small (2), Humanoid

2	2	2
33%	67%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
3	11+F	11+F	20+S	3
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
6 (+3)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	2 (+1)	2 (+1)

Spear: 13+F to hit, 1d8+3 Piercing, 10ft range

Bite: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Piercing, 5ft range

Yap: 11+F to hit, 1d4+1 Sonic, 30ft Burst radius

Notes: *Pack Defense*—When two or more Kobolds are adjacent to each other, they form a phalanx with their spears. Each pair of Kobolds can make one free Attack at no Action cost. A Kobold can only be part of one pair (if two or three Kobolds are adjacent to each other, they get one free attack, four or five get two attacks, and so forth).

Kobold Rider

Mob; Small (2), Humanoid

2	2	2	2	2
20%	40%	60%	80%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	11+F	12+F	20+S	3
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
10 (+4)	1 (+1)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	2 (+1)

Lance: 14+F to hit, 2d12+4 Piercing, 10ft range, (only while mounted)

Bite: 14+F to hit, 1d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Capnocytophaga Debuff: Take 1d6+F Poison at the end of each round until the combat ends.

Crossbow: 12+F to hit, 2d8 Piercing, 50ft range

Notes: *Dingo Rider*—Kobold Riders use Danger Dingoes as mounts and ride into battle on them. Their lances are ridiculously large and can only attack targets in the direction their mount is facing. A dismounted Kobold Rider can't use its Lance.



Danger Dingo

Mob; Medium (4), Beastly

3	3	3	3	3
20%	40%	60%	80%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
5	12+F	11+F	30+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
7 (+3)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	2 (+1)	2 (+1)

Bite: 13+F to hit, 2d8+3 Piercing, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Rabies Debuff: 1d6+F Poison damage at the end of each round until the combat ends.

Ravage: 11+F to hit, 2d6+3 Slashing, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or Worse, the target gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: *Good Impressions*—An injured Dingo may become non-hostile to a crawler party if none of the crawlers attack any member of the Dingo's pack, and the crawlers heal or feed the Dingo or play music from metal bands the Dingo likes.

Ravager—If a Danger Dingo moves at least 20ft in a straight line at its Ravage target before attacking, add +1d6 to the damage.

RAGE ELEMENTAL

Not truly a Second Floor Mob, but this is what happens when you break the rules...

Rage Elemental

Mob; Colossal (7), Elemental

6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6	6
10%	20%	30%	40%	50%	60%	70%	80%	90%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
93	11+F	14+F	60+S	13
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
136 (+7)	1 (+1)	66 (+6)	15 (+4)	66 (+6)

Claw: 17+F to hit, 5d8+7 Slashing, 10ft range

Reverse Gravity Spell: Passive, 60ft range, 20ft Blast radius, (see below)

Roar: 15+F to hit, No damage, 20ft Burst radius
Any hit crawler gains the Paralyzed Debuff.

Notes: *Elemental*—Rage elementals are immune to non-magical physical damage (but can be harmed by elemental damage, enchanted objects, spells, and explosives, among other effects).

Gravity Reversed—All creatures in the affected area fall in the wrong direction, taking 1d6 Bludgeoning damage for every 10 feet "fallen." At the end of the round, it goes back to normal, and unsecured creatures will fall again.

Reincarnation—Rage elementals claim the souls of entities they kill. Each soul they claim allows them to revive once at full Health when they're killed. They take 1 minute to reform and are immune to all damage during that time.

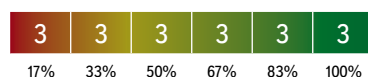
Soul Reaper—Rage elementals dissipate after claiming 666 souls.



TROGLODYTES

Troglodyte Basher

Mob; Medium (4), Humanoid



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
6	11+F	13+F	20+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
7 (+3)	1 (+1)	7 (+3)	7 (+3)	1 (+1)

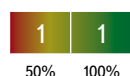
Bite: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 Piercing, 5ft range

Venom Spit: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Poison, 20ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: Slimed!—Troglodytes secrete a slime that's kinda gross when some gets splashed onto you. When an adjacent crawler rolls an Amazing Success or better with an attack, they gain the Queasy Debuff.

Troglodyte Pygmy

Mob; Petite (3), Mutated



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
2	12+F	12+F	30+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
2 (+1)	3 (+2)	2 (+1)	3 (+2)	1 (+1)

Bite: 11+F to hit, 1d6+1 Piercing, 5ft range (see below)
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Dine and Dash*—Troglodyte pygmies hunt in packs and take turns darting in and out at targets, taking advantage of their speed to kill prey with their combined venom rather than brute force. Pygmies Move in and attack their prey, then Step Away.

Troglodyte Virtuoso

Mob; Petite (3), Mutated



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
4	12+F	13+F	25+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
3 (+2)	3 (+2)	3 (+2)	6 (+3)	2 (+1)

Tongue Whip: 13+F to hit, 1d6+2 Bludgeoning, 15ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Bite: 12+F to hit, 1d6+2 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Poisoned Debuff.

Notes: *Got Your Tongue*—The target of a Tongue Whip can attempt a Wrasslin' attack to grab the tongue as an Interrupt Action instead of making an Evade Check, with any success also counting as an Evade Success against the attack.

Tongue of War—When a virtuoso's tongue is Held or the crawler is Held, it can use an Action to try to pull its tongue back. The target must make a STR Stat Check. On Success, the virtuoso pulls itself adjacent to the target, while the target is pulled adjacent to the virtuoso on Fail. Whoever is pulled takes 1d4+F Bludgeoning per 5ft moved due to the pull.

FIRST FLOOR BOSSES

BALL OF SWINE

Ever seen that movie with the guy in a rugged fedora running away from a massive unstoppable boulder? Did you think to yourself, "That sure looks fun"?

Now what if that boulder was bigger, faster, and made of bondage-loving Tusklings?

Comprised of at least thirty fetish-friendly Tusklings joined together by magic, the Ball of Swine is one of the most formidable battle formations of the Orcish Supremacy.

Speed, size, and unstoppable momentum combine to make this Borough Boss a crushing foe. The Ball of Swine doesn't respect safe words, and it won't be satisfied until you resemble a dead flattened starfish.

Ball of Swine

Borough Boss; Colossal (7), Amalgamation



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
15	12+F	14+F	30+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
20 (+5)	4 (+2)	50 (+6)	10 (+4)	1 (+1)

Assimilated: 14+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Held Debuff, having been caught up in the rolling orgy ball.

Bowled Over: 15+F to hit, 2d10+5 Bludgeoning, 40ft Line
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Take Down Debuff.

Notes: *Amalgamation*—The Ball of Swine is a 15-foot-tall ball comprised of 30 Tuskling Knights (Level 4) and 30 Tuskling Courtesans (Level 5). All are unarmed and untrained. When the Ball of Swine is reduced to less than half Health it starts to unravel and the Tusklings inside become individual Mobs that must be killed to defeat the Boss. All 60 of the Tuskling Mobs are disoriented and do not fight back. Each has 0 DR, and 2 HB slots remaining each with a 2 in them.

Constant Momentum—The Ball of Swine can instantly change the direction it is traveling without losing speed.

Snagged—The Ball of Swine can be stopped by reducing the space it has for traveling. This takes three successful checks from different crawlers using appropriate skills (GM determined). When Snagged, attacks against it are made with Advantage.

THE HOARDER

Where anyone else would see a Scatterer-infested nest of useless garbage—torn pink wrapping paper, rotting dishes, half-filled coloring books, laundry stiff with mildew, shards of a hand-painted flowerpot, a pediatric hospital gown—the Hoarder clings to her valued possessions and guards them accordingly.

Abandoned by everyone who once claimed to love her, now the Hoarder's only companions are the echoes of a life forever trapped in darkness and her endless army of Scatterers—large, cockroach-like insects generating in her stomach and spewing from her mouth.

Trapped in this hellish pit, the Hoarder begs you to do for her what she cannot do for herself—release her from her unending torment.

The Hoarder

Neighborhood Boss; Large (5), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
9%	18%	27%	36%	45%	54%	63%	72%	81%	90%	100%	
Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR							
7	13+F	13+F	20+S	2							
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA							
12 (+4)	8 (+3)	11 (+4)	9 (+3)	6 (+3)							

Punch: 14+F to hit, 2d6+4 Bludgeoning, 10ft range
Drop and Roll: 13+F to hit, 1d8+4 Bludgeoning, 20ft Line (see below)

The Hoarder makes a free 20ft move during this attack.

Regurgitate: (see Infested below)

Throw Trash: 13+F to hit, 1d6+3 60ft range

Notes: *Infested*—Either a Weak group of Hissing Scatterers or Scatterer Brood Guardians emerge from the Hoarder's mouth at the start of each round. These Scatterers don't act until the following round. They share the Hoarder's space and have a +4 bonus to Evade during the round they emerge. Killing all the emerging Scatterers by the end of that round kills the Hoarder by choking her on Scatterers trying to emerge from behind the corpses.



PROSPERITY PROPHET

Although the Prosperity Prophet may appear human at first glance, further inspection will reveal the fiendish truth: Twisted by the loss of their idyllic home world, this ancient race has been corrupted into Seraphian Vampires. All memory of their original race has been forgotten.



Seraphian Vampires are evil to their core, and the Prosperity Prophet is no exception. Grifters and charlatans who swindle the vulnerable, theseimps possess an endless lust for money, power, and blood.

In exchange for unquestioned devotion, the Prosperity Prophet promises their coven-gregation wealth and power. When it fails to manifest for anyone but himself, he drains his unsuspecting followers even more.

Not even death will free his faithful flock from his hold over them. Martyrs and sacrifices given for the Prosperity Prophet will arise as empty husks, seeking new victims to bring into the fold.

Prosperity Prophet

City Boss; Medium (4), Undead

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
4%	9%	14%	19%	23%	28%	33%	38%	42%	47%
5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
52%	57%	61%	66%	71%	76%	80%	85%	90%	95%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
23	16+F	15+F	20+S	1
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
20 (+5)	55 (+6)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	25 (+5)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 3d10+5 Necrotic, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Drain Blood Debuff: Take 1d8+F Necrotic at the end of each round and the Prophet heals 1 HB slot, until the combat ends.

Claw: 15+F to hit, 3d12+5 Necrotic, 5ft range

Sleep Spell: 16+F to hit, No damage, 50ft range, 20ft Blast radius

Each affected crawler makes a free CON Stat Check vs Difficulty 16+F or they gain the Unconscious Debuff: They are prone and cannot take actions. If they take damage, they wake up.

Notes: *Drain Blood*—If a creature perishes due to Drain Blood, they must make a CON Stat Check vs Difficulty 15+F or become an Undead Minion under the control of the Prosperity Prophet.

Flight—Prosperity Prophets can move through the air as though on the ground and hover in place.

Money Grubbing—Throwing gold at the Prosperity Prophet stops him in his tracks, and he becomes distracted picking it up. The Prosperity Prophet loses one Action for each 100 gold that is thrown at him as an Action.

Undead Minions—A Moderate group are in the Boss Chamber. These have the same stat block as the Pack Rat (see p. 31), except that they deal Necrotic damage.

SECOND FLOOR BOSSES

BELOVED MIMIC

Capable of swallowing a sedan whole, the Beloved Mimic relishes the chance to sink its razor-sharp teeth into incapacitated crawlers. Armed with psionic attacks and psychic abilities, the Beloved Mimic is a foe few crawlers survive—despite the monster's inability to physically chase them down.

Rooted in place while being observed, the Beloved Mimic's most sinister tactic is also its most entertaining. While many types of shapeshifters rely on physical touch, the Beloved Mimic uses its psychic abilities to give the illusion of transformation: it will perfectly mimic whomever the observer loves the most.

Children. Spouses. friends and relatives long in the grave. Goldie Pawn, your childhood retriever.

No manipulation of the heart is too cruel for the Beloved Mimic to draw in its prey.

Beloved Mimic

City Boss; Colossal (7), Aberration

7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7
5%	9%	14%	18%	23%	27%	32%	36%	41%	45%	50%	
7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7	7
55%	59%	64%	68%	73%	77%	82%	86%	91%	95%	100%	

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
25	15+F	13+F	5	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
20 (+5)	20 (+5)	100 (+7)	9 (+3)	1 (+1)

Bite: 15+F to hit, 3d12+5 Piercing, 15ft range

If a crawler does not successfully Evade, they gain the Swallowed Debuff (see below).

Heartstrings: 15+F to hit, No damage, 100ft range, 20ft Blast radius

Crawlers make a free CHA Stat Check vs Difficulty 15+F or they gain the Mesmerized Debuff (see below).

Psionic Strike: 15+F to hit, 3d10+5 Psychic, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Mental Scarring Debuff: Subtract 1 from the crawler's INT Mod until the end of the combat.

Notes: *Mesmerized*—The Beloved Mimic perfectly mimics whomever the crawler loves the most. While Mesmerized, crawlers cannot attack the Mimic and must spend their 10ft Step to move towards the Mimic. Each time a crawler takes any damage, they may make an INT Stat Check vs

Difficulty 15+F to remove this Debuff.

Swallowed—The Beloved Mimic swallows the crawler whole. When an attack against the Mimic results in an Amazing Success or better (or it dies), all crawlers remove the Swallowed Debuff. Swallowed crawlers take 1d8+F Acid at the end of each round. Swallowed crawlers attack with Disadvantage, but the Mimic has no DR against such an attack, and Slashing attacks deal ×2 damage.



KRAKAREN CLONE

For every clone killed, Krakaren Prime births two more. Part of a hive-mind, the Krakaren Clone has many enemies: scientific facts, flattering hairstyles, the concept of selflessness, and you.

Composed of massive pink tentacles covered in screaming human mouths capable of inflicting the Taint debuff, she'll have you running for a manager in no time. Hopefully you can figure out a way to protect yourself from the Vigorous Measles ahead of time, because her Neighborhood is a strict no-vax zone.

Approach this PTA octopus only if you're truly insane or looking to girl-boss your way up a pyramid scheme.

Krakaren Clone

Neighborhood Boss; Gargantuan (8), Aberrant

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
8%	16%	25%	33%	41%	50%	58%	66%	75%	83%	91%	100%	
Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR								
10	11+F	12+F	20+S	3								
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA								
20 (+5)	1 (+1)	10 (+4)	5 (+2)	15 (+4)								

Tentacles: 14+F to hit, 2d4+5 Bludgeoning, 15ft Cone
Any hit crawler gains the Held Debuff.

Constrict: None, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, Auto-hits a Held foe

Beak Bite: 15+F to hit, 2d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range

Spit Spray: 12+F to hit, 3d6+2 Poison, 30ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains The Taint Debuff.

Pyramid Pitch: 14+F to hit, No damage, 50ft range
Make a free CHA Stat Check vs the attack. On Fail, must spend next Action attacking an ally.

Notes: *Bad Hair Day*—Krakarens believe they have a flattering hairstyle, and if it gets messed up, they are frantic. Any attack that results in an Amazing Success or better causes all Held Debuffs to cease.

THE JUICER

To create the Juicer, find a recently dumped gym bro and combine him with a Troglodyte Basher. Pump that hybrid full of even more anabolic steroids and creatine supplements, dress him in mantra-emblazoned muscle shirts ("No pain, no gain!" "You're not tired, you're weak!"), and convince him living at the gym is "totally a life-hack," and you'll get exactly what you deserve.

Brutal, strong, and too emotionally stunted to see anything but his gains in the mirror, the Juicer needs a new kettlebell, and your torso is the perfect weight. Assisted by his Troglodyte spotters, they're not stopping until they hit muscle failure—yours, that is.



The Juicer

Neighborhood Boss; Medium (4), Humanoid

4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4	4
8%	16%	25%	33%	41%	50%	58%	66%	75%	83%	91%	100%
Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR							
9	12+F	11+F	20+S	3							
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA							
25 (+5)	5 (+2)	15 (+4)	1 (+1)	6 (+3)							

Choke: 15+F to hit, 2d10+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Fiery Weight: 10+F to hit, 1d8+5 Bludgeoning, 50ft range (see Feel the Burn below)

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler is pushed back 10ft.

Notes: *Feel the Burn*—The Juicer throws barbell weights with such speed and force they catch fire in the air and explode if they don't hit their intended target. On any Evade Success vs Fiery Weight, the weight hits the closest object or wall behind the target and explodes, dealing 1d8+F Fire to entities within 10ft of the impact.

Get Your Blood Pumping—The Juicer's bulging veins are susceptible to being cut open. The Juicer has a −2 penalty to DR against edged weapons. Crawlers may roll attacks with Disadvantage in order to target his bulging veins. If they hit, apply the Blood Trail Debuff.

RAKISH WEREHOUND SHOCKER

Stoic and sharply dressed in an all-black suit, the inspiration for this nocturnal hunter was pulled from Gerrard Street in Soho.

Armed with a ferocious headbutt attack, shocking speed, and lightning-strike abilities, the Rakish Werehound Shocker is the alpha male in his loyal pack of Werehound Greys.

A savage adversary, he is known to deal additional damage to cats, royalty, and women over the age of 40. Even when heavily injured and facing a younger opponent, the Rakish Werehound Shocker will fight to the very end to defend his pack.

Rakish Werehound Shocker

Borough Boss; Medium (4), Humanoid

5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
5%	11%	17%	23%	29%	35%	41%	47%	52%	
5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5	5
58%	64%	70%	76%	82%	88%	94%	100%		



Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR		
19	15+F	15+F	30+S	2		
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA		
20 (+5)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	20 (+5)	21 (+5)		

Bite: 15+F to hit, 3d8+5 Piercing, 5ft range

(Secret!) On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Lycanthropy Debuff: The crawler turns into a Werehound the following night. The Debuff is removed if the crawler has the Dying Debuff.

Claw: 15+F to hit, 3d10+5 Slashing, 5ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Blood Trail Debuff.

Headbutt: 15+F to hit, 3d6+5 Bludgeoning, 5ft range

Any hit crawler must make a CHA Stat Check vs Difficulty 15+F or gain the Charmed Debuff: The crawler is enamored with the Werehound's perfect hair, spending their next Action to apply a Health Potion to the Boss.

Lightning Bolt Spell: 15+F to hit, 2d10+5 Electric, 30ft Line

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Shocked Debuff.

Notes: *Savagely Sexy*—Rakish Werehound Shocker double their STR Mod for damage done to cats, royalty, and women aged 40+.

Silver Weakness—Silver weapons do ×2 damage to Werehounds, bypass DR, and apply The Taint Debuff.

RALPH THE FRENZIED GERBIL

The champion pit fighter of the training grounds, Ralph is filled with rage. When his kin carried the Black Death across the world in the 1300s, they claimed over 200 million human lives. Ralph is here to finish the job.

Gone are the days starving in a dirty neglected cage. Now Ralph feasts upon whatever the Kobolds send into the fighting pit—mobs, crawlers, and Danger Dingoes too friendly for proper combat.

He may not look like much, but man, is that little rodent *fast*.

Ralph the Frenzied Gerbil

Neighborhood Boss; Tiny (1), Beastly

3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3	3
8%	16%	25%	33%	41%	50%	58%	66%	75%	83%	91%	100%

Level	Surprise	Evade	Move	DR
11	13+F	15+F	30+S	2
STR	INT	CON	DEX	CHA
14 (+4)	7 (+3)	6 (+3)	20 (+5)	11 (+4)

Ravering Jaw: 14+F to hit, 3d6+4 Piercing, 5ft range
On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Rat Bite Fever Debuff: Take 1d6+F Poison at the end of each round until the combat ends.

Scratch: 14+F to hit, 2d8+5 Slashing, 5ft range

Squeal: 13+F to hit, 2d4+3 Sonic, 60ft range

On an Evade Major Fail or worse, the crawler gains the Staggered Debuff.

Notes: *Cuteness Appeal*—At the start of combat, all crawlers who see Ralph must make an INT or CHA Stat Check with a Difficulty of 14+F. On Fail, Ralph's cuteness causes them to make attacks with Disadvantage during the first round of combat.

Frenzied—Ralph has a Step distance of 20ft instead of 10ft.

Hatred of Humans—Ralph prioritizes attacking humans, and all his attacks deal an additional +5 bonus damage against them.

Still a Tiny Gerbil—If a Dingo eats Ralph, the Gerbil uses two actions to kill and escape from the Dingo at the start of the next round. All attacks against Ralph have Advantage during that next round.





